

Seminar on Algebraic Geometry of Bois Marie

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Intersection Theory and the Riemann–Roch Theorem

(SGA 6)

a seminar directed by

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Preface

The present edition of *Séminaire de Géométrie Algébrique 6* reproduces, up to minor changes, the first edition, distributed by the I.H.E.S. in the form of mimeographed exposés. The corrections made concern essentially printing errors, except in Exposés I and III, where slight modifications were made by L. Illusie to a few statements which were incorrect in the primitive version. Footnotes have also been added, especially in Exposé XIV by A. Grothendieck, in order to point out recent progress on questions that were still open at the time of the seminar.

Finally, note that Exposé XI, by D. Ferrand, on determinant theory for perfect complexes, was not written up and therefore will not be published; to avoid errors in references, we have left unchanged the numbering of the following exposés.

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Introduction

The purpose of the present seminar is to develop a global theory of intersections, and a Riemann–Roch formula, for arbitrary schemes. The reader will find a description of the programme of the seminar in Exposé 0. The possibility in principle of proving a Riemann–Roch formula for general regular schemes, along the lines of the well-known Borel–Serre report of 1958, was already clear at that time, at least for a projective morphism. The extension to the general case is less evident; the programme in which it belongs, and which is partly carried out in this seminar, goes back to 1960. As was also the case for the duality theory of coherent sheaves, an essential tool for formulating a satisfactory theory is Verdier’s theory of derived categories; familiarity with it is indispensable for understanding the seminar.

Apart from this theory, the study of the seminar requires little more than a general knowledge of the foundations of algebraic geometry as set out in EGA, chapters I, II, III. We shall only occasionally refer to EGA IV, for certain facts concerning flat or smooth morphisms, which for the most part also appear in the first exposés of SGA 1. Finally, to develop some results with the full generality desirable for applications, we sometimes use the notion of a ringed site and of a ringed topos, for which we refer to SGA 4, Exposés I to IV. A reader unfamiliar with the language of sites and topoi may everywhere replace these objects by ordinary topological spaces, the objects of the topos then being replaced by open subsets of these spaces; nevertheless,

we recommend that the reader assimilate the language of topoi, which provides an extremely convenient unifying principle.

The fundamental notion for the theory presented here is that of a perfect complex of modules, together with its various variants, developed in Exposés I, II, III. It seems clear that these notions, also important in other contexts in algebraic geometry, notably for formulas of Lefschetz–Verdier type in cohomology with discrete coefficients (SGA 5) or coherent coefficients, will also have a role to play outside algebraic geometry, especially in the formulation of a complex analytic variant of the Riemann–Roch theorem presented here, or of suitable variants of the Atiyah–Singer index theorem. Some indications in this direction will be given in Exposé II. Unfortunately, at present there is still no statement, even heuristic, which would encompass these two theorems, the first of which remains conjectural for the moment. A new idea seems to be missing, just as one is also missing in algebraic geometry for proving Riemann–Roch beyond projective hypotheses (cf. Exposé XIV, no. 2).

We shall make no use in this seminar of the local theory of intersections, set out in J.-P. Serre, *Algèbre locale. Multiplicités* (Lecture Notes in Mathematics no. 11, Springer), and merely point out here that Serre’s course had an evident influence on the genesis of the theory in 1957. Nor shall we use the theory of the Chow ring developed in the Chevalley Seminar of 1958, Exposés 2 and 3 (École Normale Supérieure). That theory is essentially tied to nonsingularity hypotheses, whereas the aim of our seminar is, on the contrary, to develop a theory of intersections on general schemes, and even on general locally ringed topoi. On this matter see the comments in Exposé XIV, nos. 4 and 8, which give the relations between our theory and that of the Chow ring and raise the question of a generalization of the latter. Thus one may say that the seminar presents a coherent and self-contained theory of intersections, but one which is by no means exhaustive of the different points of view useful, indeed indispensable, in intersection theory; consequently it should be complemented by the cited exposés of Serre and Chevalley.

We have appended to the seminar, as an appendix to Exposé 0, Grothendieck’s 1957 report, “Classes of sheaves and the Riemann–Roch theorem”, which served as the basis for the Borel–Serre seminar at Princeton in the same year and for their already cited article. That report sketches two proofs of the Riemann–Roch theorem for nonsingular quasi-projective varieties. The first, valid for the time being only in characteristic zero but giving, in return, a slightly more precise result in the case of an immersion, has not yet appeared in the literature, apart from the work of Borel–Serre and the present seminar. The report presupposes, of course, none of the other exposés of the seminar, and can even serve, like Exposé 0, as an introduction to the study of the latter, especially for a reader not yet familiar with Borel–Serre. The proof just alluded to applies essentially unchanged to the case of a projective morphism of complex analytic spaces, and will doubtless also apply in arbitrary characteristic once the problem of the operations “exterior powers” in the derived category is solved (cf. Exposé XIV, nos. 1, 2, 3). The absence of a study of this question is no doubt the most serious gap in this seminar, from the point of view we have adopted.

One will notice the absence, in the table of contents of the present seminar, of two of the participants mentioned on the cover page. One of them, J.-P. Jouanolou, took an active part in the technical elaboration of the first part of the seminar, but was prevented from taking part in the oral exposés; in particular, he is responsible for the linear-independence assertion contained in the important statement VI 1.1, giving the structure of the ring K° of classes of locally free modules on a projective bundle, which had previously been proved only under the assumption that the base scheme has an ample invertible module. The other, J.-P. Serre, gave two oral exposés which were logically independent of the rest of the seminar, and therefore preferred to publish them in the form of a separate article (cf. J.-P. Serre, “Grothendieck groups of split reductive group schemes”, to appear in *Publications Mathématiques*, no. 34).

As in the other parts of the *Séminaire de Géométrie Algébrique du Bois Marie*, the sigla SGA 1 to SGA 6 refer to the different parts of that seminar; the Roman numeral following the siglum indicates the number of the exposé, and the Arabic numerals following it correspond to the internal numbering of the exposé in question. For internal references within the present seminar the siglum SGA 6 is omitted, and references of the form I 4.9 are used, meaning: Exposé I, statement 4.9. The siglum EGA refers to the *Éléments de Géométrie Algébrique* of J. Dieudonné and A. Grothendieck.

Table of contents

Exposé	Title and author	Page
0	Outline of a programme for a theory of intersections on general schemes, by A. Grothendieck	1
Appendix	Classes of sheaves and the Riemann–Roch theorem, by A. Grothendieck	20
I	Generalities on finiteness conditions in derived categories, by L. Illusie	56
II	Existence of global resolutions, by L. Illusie	160
III	Relative finiteness conditions, by L. Illusie	190
IV	Grothendieck groups of ringed topoi, by L. Illusie	222
V	Generalities on λ -rings, by P. Berthelot	297
VI	The K° of a projective bundle: computations and consequences, by P. Berthelot	365
VII	Regular immersions and the computation of K° of a blow-up, by P. Berthelot	416
VIII	The Riemann–Roch theorem, by P. Berthelot	466
IX	Some computations of $K_\bullet$ -groups, by P. Berthelot	498
X	Formalism of intersections on proper algebraic schemes, by O. Jussila, with an appendix by A. Grothendieck, “Specialization in intersection theory”	519
XI	Not written up	–
XII	A relative representability theorem for the Picard functor, by M. Raynaud, written by S. Kleiman	595
XIII	Finiteness theorems for the Picard functor, by S. Kleiman	616
XIV	Open problems in intersection theory, by A. Grothendieck	667

Exposé 0

Outline of a programme for a theory of intersections on general schemes

by A. Grothendieck

The present exposé is introductory in nature, and its reading is not logically indispensable for the study of the seminar. It is addressed more particularly to readers familiar with the provisional version of the Riemann–Roch theorem, as it is presented in the Borel–Serre report or in Grothendieck’s report already mentioned in the introduction, cited below as [RRR], and reproduced as an appendix at the end of the present exposé.

1. Reminder on the Riemann–Roch formula

Recall the Riemann–Roch formula for a proper morphism

$$f : X \longrightarrow Y$$

of quasi-projective smooth schemes over a field k , and a coherent sheaf F on X , whose class in the group $K(X)$ of classes of coherent sheaves on X is denoted by $\text{cl}(F)$:

$$\text{Todd}(T_Y) \text{ch}_Y(f_!(\text{cl}(F))) = f_*(\text{Todd}(T_X) \text{ch}_X(F)). \quad (1.1)$$

This formula is valid in $A(Y) \otimes \mathbb{Q}$, where $A(Y)$ is the Chow ring of Y . The f_* on the right hand side is obtained by tensoring with $\mathbb{Q}$ the homomorphism “direct image of cycles”

$$f_* : A(X) \longrightarrow A(Y),$$

while the term on the left is the Euler–Poincaré characteristic of F relative to f :

$$f_!(\text{cl}(F)) = \sum_i (-1)^i \text{cl}(R^i f_*(F)).$$

The symbols ch_X , ch_Y denote the Chern characters on X and on Y , and T_X , T_Y the tangent bundles of X and Y . As is known, $\text{Todd}(-)$ and $\text{ch}(-)$ are universal polynomials with coefficients in $\mathbb{Q}$ in the Chern classes of the argument. Since the constant term of $\text{Todd}(-)$ is 1, it is an invertible element for every value of the argument. Thus, after multiplying by $\text{Todd}(T_Y)^{-1}$, formula (1.1) takes the equivalent form, more convenient for our purposes,

$$\text{ch}_Y(f_!(\text{cl}(F))) = f_*(\text{Todd}(T_f) \text{ch}_X(F)), \quad (1.2)$$

where

$$T_f = T_X - f^* T_Y \in K(X). \quad (1.3)$$

Thus T_f plays the role of a virtual relative tangent bundle of X over Y . When f is smooth, one simply has $T_f = T_{X/Y}$, whereas when $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is an immersion, one obtains

$$T_f = -\check{N}_{X/Y},$$

where $N_{X/Y}$ denotes the normal sheaf of X in Y .

One of the main aims of the seminar is to generalize (1.2) simultaneously in two directions:

- a) to get rid of the hypothesis that a base field k exists;
- b) to replace the regularity hypotheses on Y, X by a hypothesis of “local regularity” on f .

Finally, along the way, we shall also deal with the following problem:

- c) to eliminate the quasi-projectivity hypotheses which, in the absence of a base field, are expressed by the existence of ample invertible modules on X and Y .

2. Removing the base field

Let us first examine generalization a), while retaining the hypotheses of regularity and of the existence of ample invertible modules on X and on Y .

The definitions of $K(X)$, $K(Y)$ and of the homomorphism $f_! : K(X) \rightarrow K(Y)$ then present no new problem, thanks to the fact that X and Y are regular. The most natural way to give

a meaning to (1.2) would seem to consist in defining Chow rings $A(X), A(Y)$ and a group homomorphism

$$f_* : A(X) \longrightarrow A(Y),$$

in establishing a theory of Chern classes, giving maps

$$c_i : K(X) \longrightarrow A(X),$$

and similarly for Y , and finally in describing an element, the virtual relative tangent bundle,

$$T_f \in K(X).$$

2.1

For the latter, a definition presents itself rather evidently. One uses the fact that the morphism f , thanks to the hypothesis that ample invertible modules exist on X and on Y , may be factored as

$$X \xrightarrow{i} X' \xrightarrow{f'} Y,$$

where i is a closed immersion and f' is smooth; for example, one may take $X' = \mathbb{P}_Y^r$ for suitable r . One then sets

$$T_f = i^* T_{X'/Y} - \check{N}_{X/X'} \in K(X), \quad (2.1)$$

where $\Omega_{X'/Y}^1$ is the locally free module of relative 1-differentials of X' over Y , or the relative cotangent module of X' over Y , and $N_{X/X'}$ is the conormal module of X in X' , by definition equal to J/J^2 , where J is the ideal on X' defining X . The regularity hypotheses on X and X' also imply that $N_{X/X'}$ is locally free. Finally, $\check{N}$ denotes the dual of N . One verifies without difficulty, in Exposé VIII, that the element T_f defined by (2.1) is independent of the chosen factorization of f .

2.2

As for a definition, under the conditions considered, of a Chow ring and a corresponding theory of Chern classes, although it is plausible that such a theory should be developable on the model of smooth varieties over a field, it seems that this work has not been done at the present time. We shall therefore adopt another viewpoint, by directly defining a ring which replaces the Chow ring, and whose tensor product with $\mathbb{Q}$ is indeed isomorphic to $A(X) \otimes \mathbb{Q}$ in the classical case.

A first natural filtration of $K(X)$, the one considered in [RRR], is the topological filtration by the codimension of the support of coherent sheaves: $\text{Fil}^i K(X)$ is generated by the $\text{cl}(F)$ with F coherent and $\text{codim}(\text{Supp } F, X) \geq i$. A first question is the compatibility of this filtration with the multiplicative structure of $K(X)$. In [RRR], this compatibility is obtained, for X smooth over a field, by means of Chow's moving lemma. Assuming this assertion, one obtains a graded ring $\text{Gr}_{\text{top}}(X)$ and a canonical surjective homomorphism

$$\varphi : A(X) \longrightarrow \text{Gr}_{\text{top}}(X),$$

sending the class of a prime cycle Z to $\text{cl}(\mathcal{O}_Z)$; it then turns out, Exposé XIV 4.2, that the kernel is a torsion subgroup. Moreover, [RRR] shows how the images in $\text{Gr}_{\text{top}}(X)$ of the Chern classes $c_i(F)$ can be computed directly in terms of $\text{cl}(F) \in K(X)$ and the exterior-power operations λ^i in $K(X)$.

This shows that, for a noetherian regular scheme X endowed with an ample invertible module, the ring $\text{Gr}_{\text{top}}(X)$ is a convenient substitute for the hypothetical Chow ring $A(X)$. It also has

the advantage over the latter that certain computations of [RRR], leading to important formulas in this ring, are performed directly in it—formulas which, even for X projective and smooth over a field, have not at present been established in $A(X)$ itself (Exp. XIV, 4.3 and 6.4). To justify this viewpoint completely, however, one would have to solve the problem mentioned above of the compatibility of the topological filtration of $K(X)$ with its ring structure, a problem which seems essentially connected with Chow's moving lemma, itself the essential technical ingredient of the theory of the Chow ring which we have claimed to be able to avoid.

2.3

To avoid this problem, one endows $K(X)$ with a second filtration, finer than the topological filtration, and describable in purely algebraic terms from the structure of $K(X)$ as an augmented λ -ring. The definition of this filtration is suggested by the expression given in [RRR] for the Chern classes of an element $x \in K(X)$ in $\mathrm{Gr}_{\mathrm{top}}(X)$:

$$c_i(x) = \gamma^i(x - \epsilon(x)) \mod \mathrm{Fil}^{i+1} K(X), \quad (2.3)$$

where γ^i denotes a certain linear combination of the λ^j ($j \leq i$), made explicit in loc. cit., and where ϵ is the augmentation. One shows that $\gamma^i(x - \epsilon(x))$ is indeed of topological filtration at least i , which gives meaning to formula (2.3). One then defines the λ -filtration of $K(X)$ by the ideals $\mathrm{Fil}_\lambda^i K(X)$, where $\mathrm{Fil}_\lambda^i K(X)$ consists of finite sums of expressions of the form

$$\gamma^{i_1}(x_1 - \epsilon(x_1)) \cdots \gamma^{i_r}(x_r - \epsilon(x_r)), \quad i_1 + \cdots + i_r \geq i.$$

The associated graded ring for this filtration will be denoted $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X)$; it is this ring which will replace the Chow ring of X in the seminar. In the case under consideration here, one can moreover show that the canonical homomorphism

$$\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Gr}_{\mathrm{top}}(X) \quad (2.4)$$

is an isomorphism modulo torsion, justifying the viewpoint that, after tensoring with $\mathbb{Q}$, this ring can play exactly the same role as the Chow ring tensored with $\mathbb{Q}$. On the other hand, exactly what was needed has been done so that formula (2.3), with $\mathrm{Fil}_{\mathrm{top}}$ replaced by Fil_λ , defines a theory of Chern classes with values in $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X)$; the Chern classes in $\mathrm{Gr}_{\mathrm{top}}(X)$ are then deduced by means of the homomorphism (2.4). It is shown in Exposé V, using the fact proved in Exposé VI that $K(X)$ is a special λ -ring in the sense of [RRR], that is, a λ -ring in the sense of Exposé V, that this notion of Chern class satisfies all the usual formal properties reviewed in [RRR].

2.4

One should note a very appreciable advantage of the definition of $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X)$ over that of $A(X)$ and $\mathrm{Gr}_{\mathrm{top}}(X)$: it remains meaningful for an absolutely arbitrary scheme X , and more generally for an arbitrary locally ringed topos X . One then takes for $K(X)$ the group of classes constructed from locally free modules on X , which is again an augmented λ -ring, hence equipped with a corresponding filtration and an associated graded $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X)$. The price of this generality, however, is that when one is not willing to neglect torsion phenomena, i.e. to tensor with $\mathbb{Q}$, the properties of $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X)$ are in several respects less satisfactory than those of its two competitors (Exp. XIV no. 4). Thus, assuming again that $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is a proper morphism of noetherian regular schemes endowed with ample invertible modules, it is not true in general that the homomorphism

$$f_* : K(X) \longrightarrow K(Y)$$

maps $\mathrm{Fil}_\lambda^i K(X)$ into $\mathrm{Fil}_\lambda^{i-d} K(Y)$, where d is the relative dimension of X over Y , and hence defines, by passage to associated graded, a degree $-d$ homomorphism from $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X)$ to $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(Y)$. However, Exposé VII proves that this is true after tensoring with $\mathbb{Q}$, so that one obtains a degree $-d$ homomorphism

$$f_* : \mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X) \otimes \mathbb{Q} \longrightarrow \mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(Y) \otimes \mathbb{Q}, \quad (2.5)$$

which plays the role of the homomorphism “direct image of cycles” $A(X) \rightarrow A(Y)$.

Having said this, we see that we possess all the structural elements needed to give meaning to formula (1.2) when the existence of a base field is not postulated, with $f : X \rightarrow Y$ a proper morphism of noetherian regular schemes admitting ample invertible modules.

3. The case of general schemes

We now show how one can still give meaning to formula (1.2) when the regularity hypothesis on X, Y is abandoned and replaced by a local hypothesis on the morphism f , to be specified below.

3.1

A first difficulty comes from the fact that the observation which served as the starting point of the theory [RRR], namely that the group $K(X)$ of classes of sheaves on X is the same whether it is defined in terms of coherent sheaves or in terms of locally free sheaves, is essentially tied to the regularity hypothesis on X . For a general scheme X , say noetherian for simplicity, one must distinguish between these two groups; we shall denote them respectively by $K_\bullet(X)$ and $K^\bullet(X)$. The first is covariant in X for proper morphisms, the second contravariant in X for arbitrary morphisms. Notice that $K^\bullet(X)$ is naturally endowed with a ring structure, indeed with an augmented λ -ring structure, whereas $K_\bullet(X)$ no longer has, in general, a ring structure, but only a module structure over $K^\bullet(X)$. The homomorphism $x \mapsto x \cdot \mathrm{cl}(\mathcal{O}_X)$ from $K^\bullet(X)$ to $K_\bullet(X)$ is no longer an isomorphism in general. For our formulation of the generalized Riemann–Roch theorem, we shall work exclusively with $K^\bullet(X)$ and $K^\bullet(Y)$, to the exclusion of $K_\bullet(X)$ and $K_\bullet(Y)$. As noted in 2.3, these augmented λ -rings, equipped with their natural λ -filtration, give rise to graded rings $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X)$, $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(Y)$, and to Chern-class homomorphisms

$$c_i : K^\bullet(X) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X),$$

and similarly for Y . The difficulty, however, lies in defining a direct-image homomorphism

$$f_* : K^\bullet(X) \longrightarrow K^\bullet(Y), \quad (3.1)$$

which can no longer be defined by the naive formula

$$f_*(\mathrm{cl}(F)) = \sum_i (-1)^i \mathrm{cl}(R^i f_*(F)),$$

because even if F is locally free, the modules $R^i f_*(F)$ are in general no longer locally free, nor even of finite Tor-dimension, and the preceding formula loses its meaning. A solution to this difficulty is furnished by the viewpoint of derived categories. Indeed, whereas the $R^i f_*(F)$ are in general “bad” sheaves, say of infinite Tor-dimension, the complex $Rf_*(F)$ on Y , the direct image of F in the sense of derived categories, tends to be excellent. More precisely, when F has finite Tor-dimension over Y , for instance when f has finite Tor-dimension and F is locally free on X , then $Rf_*(F)$ is perfect on Y , that is, has coherent cohomology and globally finite Tor-dimension (Exp. III). It follows easily, Exp. IV, that its class in the Grothendieck group of perfect complexes has a meaning in $K^\bullet(Y)$.

3.2

To give a meaning to (1.2), it remains to impose on f a hypothesis making it possible to give a meaning to the homomorphism (2.5), i.e. ensuring that the homomorphism (3.1) just defined is, up to a shift and modulo torsion, compatible with the filtrations of these rings; and finally one must again define an element, the “virtual relative tangent bundle”,

$$T_f \in K^\bullet(X).$$

For the latter, returning to the definition proposed in 2.1, one sees that a hypothesis is needed ensuring that, with the notation of loc. cit., the conormal module $N_{X/X'}$ is locally free. The most natural hypothesis to this end is that i be a “regular immersion”, i.e. identify X with a subscheme of X' defined by an ideal which locally can be defined by an $\mathcal{O}_{X'}$ -regular sequence of sections of $\mathcal{O}_{X'}$. This hypothesis, purely local in nature, in fact does not depend on the choice of the factorization of f into an immersion followed by a smooth morphism (Exp. VIII), and, as above, the same is true for the class T_f defined by formula (2.1). When the hypothesis just considered is satisfied, the morphism f is called a “locally complete intersection” morphism. Such a morphism is also locally of finite Tor-dimension.

We shall also allow ourselves to omit the word “locally” in this terminology, which cannot cause any confusion.

If f is a locally complete intersection morphism, one introduces a natural notion of “virtual relative dimension” $d(f)$ by the formula

$$d(f)(x) = \dim_x(f^{-1}(f(x))) - \operatorname{codim}_x(X, X').$$

It is an integer-valued function, locally constant at the point $x \in X$, hence constant if X is connected; moreover it does not depend on the choice of the factorization (2.1). When this virtual relative dimension d is constant, when f is proper, and when X and Y admit ample invertible modules, one can prove (Exposé VIII), although this is far from a trivial result, that

$$f_*(\operatorname{Fil}^i K^\bullet(X)_{\mathbb{Q}}) \subset \operatorname{Fil}^{i-d} K^\bullet(Y)_{\mathbb{Q}}, \quad (3.4)$$

whence a homomorphism (3.3) of degree $-d$.

3.3

We have therefore assembled all the structural elements needed to give a meaning to formula (1.2) in the case of a proper locally complete intersection morphism of noetherian schemes X, Y , both admitting ample invertible modules. With a little additional care, this formulation in fact retains a meaning independently of any noetherian hypothesis.

In this general form, this Riemann–Roch formula will be proved in Exposé VIII. The reader will observe that the proof given in this seminar combines elements of the two proofs which appear in [RRR] and which were discussed in the Introduction. The need to resort to the methods of the first of these proofs, involving more K -formalism than the second, followed in Borel–Serre, is due to the need for a proof of the inclusion (3.4), a question which did not arise in the more restricted framework of [RRR] and Borel–Serre [2], where one could work with the Chow ring or the ring $\operatorname{Gr}_{\operatorname{top}}^\bullet$. From the second proof, we retain the introduction of the scheme obtained by blowing up Y along X in the case where f is an immersion. This technical artifice will no doubt disappear, and the proof in the case of an immersion will extend to the case where one no longer postulates the existence of an ample invertible module on Y , once the question raised in Exposé XIV, no. 1, concerning the introduction of exterior-power operations in the derived category $D^-(Y)$ has been resolved.

4. Removing the ample invertible module hypothesis

We must finally give a few indications of how one can still give a meaning to (1.2) in the absence of a hypothesis asserting the existence of ample invertible modules on X and Y .

4.1

First note that for an arbitrary scheme X , or more generally an arbitrary locally ringed topos, it seems beyond doubt that the “right” invariant which should replace the ring $K(X)$ of [RRR] is not the ring $K^\bullet(X)$ considered above, defined in terms of locally free modules on X , but rather the group $K(\text{Parf}(X))$ considered in 3.1, defined in terms of perfect complexes on X . We shall denote this group here by $K^\bullet(X)$, and distinguish it from the “naive” group of 3.1, denoted $K_{\text{naive}}^\bullet(X)$. This point of view is forced by the need to define a direct-image homomorphism (3.1) for a proper morphism

$$f : X \longrightarrow Y$$

of finite Tor-dimension, say between noetherian schemes; the non-noetherian case requires somewhat stronger local finiteness properties on f , cf. Exposé III. With the definition of $K^\bullet(X)$ now adopted, this homomorphism f_* is indeed defined in a trivial way by formula (3.2), where now F is an arbitrary perfect complex on X , which implies that $Rf_*(F)$ is also perfect.

4.2

This new definition of $K^\bullet(X)$ raises, however, a new problem in homological algebra: that of defining a λ -structure on $K^\bullet(X)$ compatible with its natural ring structure coming from tensor product in the derived category. If L and L' are two perfect complexes, then so is their total tensor product $L \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} L'$. More precisely, one would need to define “exterior-power” operations in the derived category $D^-(X)$, transforming perfect complexes into perfect complexes. This question has not yet been clarified at present, and, as was said in the Introduction, it constitutes the most serious gap in the seminar. Once this question is solved, and proceeding as in 2.3, one obtains a natural filtration on $K^\bullet(X)$, allowing one to form the associated graded ring $\text{Gr}^\bullet(X)$, which will play the role of the Chow ring, and to define a theory of Chern classes

$$c_i : K^\bullet(X) \longrightarrow \text{Gr}^i(X).$$

4.3

To give a meaning to formula (1.2) for a proper locally complete intersection morphism

$$f : X \longrightarrow Y$$

of noetherian schemes, one must still include in the statement of this formula the nontrivial inclusions (3.4), where d is the virtual relative dimension, in order to be able to define (3.3); and finally one must define the virtual relative tangent class

$$T_f \in K^\bullet(X).$$

When f admits a factorization (2.1) through an immersion into a relative smooth scheme, the definition of T_f presents no new difficulty. It can moreover be reformulated in that case, in a way more consonant with the spirit of derived categories, by considering the well-known canonical homomorphism

$$N_{X/X'} \longrightarrow \Omega_{X'/Y}^1 \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{X'}} \mathcal{O}_X \tag{4.1}$$

induced by the exterior differential, and the chain complex $L_{X/Y}$ defined from (4.1) by “extending by zeros”, with the complex equal in degree 1, respectively 0, to the source, respectively the target, of the homomorphism (4.1). Formula (2.2) then takes the more satisfactory form

$$T_f = \text{cl}(L_{X/Y}^\vee), \quad (4.2)$$

a formula which makes sense in $K^\bullet(X)$ when f is a locally complete intersection morphism, since in that case the complex $L_{X/Y}$ is manifestly perfect. The assertion that T_f is invariant relative to the chosen factorization of f can then be made precise as an invariance assertion for the complex $L_{X/Y}$: up to canonical isomorphism in the derived category $D(X)$, this complex is likewise independent of the chosen factorization (Exposé VIII).

4.4

When $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is an arbitrary morphism of schemes, one can still construct a canonical object $L_{X/Y}$ of the derived category $D(X)$, defined up to unique isomorphism, which on each affine open of X lying above an affine open of Y is isomorphic to the complex constructed according to the principle explained in the preceding paragraph. In the general case, however, “smooth” should be replaced by “formally smooth”, so that every algebra B over a ring A occurs as a quotient of a formally smooth algebra, for example a polynomial algebra. For such a definition it is not possible to proceed by simple gluing from the affine constructions, since the objects of the derived category $D(X)$ are, essentially, not glueable.

Here is a general construction of $L_{X/Y}$, valid more generally for every morphism

$$f : X \longrightarrow Y$$

of commutatively ringed topoi. Let $B = \mathcal{O}_X$ and $A = f^{-1}\mathcal{O}_Y$, so that A is a ring on the space X and B is an A -algebra. Let $T \rightarrow B$ be a homomorphism of sheaves of sets which generates B as an A -algebra, i.e. such that the corresponding homomorphism of A -algebras

$$C = A[T] \longrightarrow B$$

is an epimorphism of sheaves of sets; here $A[T]$ denotes the commutative A -algebra freely generated by T , that is, the sheaf associated with the presheaf

$$U \longmapsto A(U)[T(U)].$$

Let J be the kernel of $C \rightarrow B$, and consider, as in 4.3, the chain complex of length 1 defined by the natural homomorphism

$$J/J^2 \longrightarrow \Omega_{C/A}^1 \otimes_C B.$$

It is not difficult to see that, up to canonical isomorphism in the category $D(X)$, the complex so constructed is independent of the choice of T and of $T \rightarrow B$, so that it deserves the designation of the relative cotangent complex $L_{X/Y}$ of X over Y . One also verifies that, on every affine open of X over an affine open of Y , it is given, up to canonical isomorphism, by the procedure of 4.3.

In the case where f is locally complete intersection, one sees moreover that the result is a perfect complex, which makes it possible again to define an element T_f of $K^\bullet(X)$ by formula (4.2). Here again, in general, it would not have been possible to define T_f as an element of $K_{\text{naive}}^\bullet(X)$, and nothing permits one to suppose that T_f is globally isomorphic in $D(X)$ to a bounded complex with locally free components of finite type. This is therefore an additional justification for the point of view advanced in 4.1 in favour of the “sophisticated” $K^\bullet(X)$, in preference to $K_{\text{naive}}^\bullet(X)$.

4.5

Subject to the question raised in 4.2, we have therefore again assembled all the structural elements needed to give a meaning to (1.2) for a proper locally complete intersection morphism of arbitrary schemes; the noetherian hypothesis implicitly made in the preceding sections can in fact be eliminated without any essential difficulty. Unfortunately, this does not mean that, even subject to this reservation, the formula in question is established, even in the case where Y is the spectrum of an algebraically closed field of characteristic $p > 0$ and X is, say, a proper smooth algebraic scheme of dimension 3. See the comments in Exposé XIV, no. 2.

5. Analytic variant

In the form presented in no. 4, the Riemann–Roch formula (1.2) also has a meaning for a proper locally complete intersection morphism of complex analytic spaces, or of rigid analytic spaces in the sense of Tate. But of course the proof given in [RRR] applies to this case only when one assumes in addition that the morphism f is projective; and, as in the algebraic case, it seems that an essentially new idea is needed to treat the general case. The formula we have in view here is a formula with values in an “analytic Chow ring” $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X)$, or rather $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X)_\mathbb{Q}$, constructed according to the principle explained in 4.2, the difficulty encountered there disappearing, moreover, because one is in characteristic zero, as is noted in Exposé XIV, no. 1.

When X and Y are nonsingular, it is possible to give another version of the Riemann–Roch formula by proceeding as follows. First let X be an arbitrary complex analytic space, and let X^{top} be the same space equipped with the sheaf of rings of continuous complex-valued functions. We therefore have a canonical morphism of ringed spaces

$$X^{\mathrm{top}} \longrightarrow X,$$

which, by the evident contravariant nature of the functor $K^\bullet(X)$ in the variable ringed space X , defines a homomorphism of rings

$$K^\bullet(X) \longrightarrow K^\bullet(X^{\mathrm{top}}). \quad (5.1)$$

For simplicity suppose that X^{top} is compact; then, as in the case of a scheme admitting an ample invertible module, one proves (Exposé II) that every perfect complex on X^{top} is globally isomorphic to a bounded complex, locally free in each degree, i.e. to a complex of complex vector bundles on X^{top} , and hence that $K^\bullet(X^{\mathrm{top}})$ is canonically isomorphic to the well-known group $K(X^{\mathrm{top}})$ of topologists [1], defined in terms of complex vector bundles on the compact space X^{top} . Thus one may interpret (5.1) as a homomorphism from the $K^\bullet(X)$ defined in terms of the analytic structure to the well-known ring $K(X^{\mathrm{top}})$ of topologists. If now

$$f : X \longrightarrow Y$$

is a morphism of compact nonsingular analytic spaces, one knows how to associate to it, thanks to Atiyah–Hirzebruch [1], a group homomorphism

$$f_*^{\mathrm{top}} : K^\bullet(X^{\mathrm{top}}) \longrightarrow K^\bullet(Y^{\mathrm{top}}). \quad (5.2)$$

Using likewise the homomorphism f_* of (3.1), defined by formula (3.2), which here implicitly uses Grauert’s finiteness theorem [4] for a proper morphism of analytic spaces, one obtains a square of natural homomorphisms involving only groups of type $K^\bullet$, to the exclusion of rings of Chow-ring or cohomology type:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} K^\bullet(X) & \longrightarrow & K^\bullet(X^{\mathrm{top}}) \\ \downarrow f_* & & \downarrow f_*^{\mathrm{top}} \\ K^\bullet(Y) & \longrightarrow & K^\bullet(Y^{\mathrm{top}}). \end{array} \quad (5.3)$$

The Riemann–Roch type formula to which we are alluding consists in asserting the commutativity of this square. Note the difference in nature between this assertion, which does not neglect torsion phenomena and is situated in a group $K^\bullet(Y^{\text{top}})$ of an essentially discrete nature, and the Riemann–Roch formula of the type considered in no. 4, which is situated in a group of “Chow” type no longer of a discrete nature, but which, on the other hand, must be tensored with $\mathbb{Q}$. Let us note that formula (5.3) is proved at any rate when X and Y are nonsingular projective varieties [7], as is the formula of the type considered in no. 4, proved in this case in [RRR]. What is involved here is a plausible variant of the Atiyah–Singer index theorem, and of its generalizations due to Shih [7] and Atiyah, which obviously calls for a common generalization. Once the commutativity of (5.3) is proved, one would immediately deduce from it, using the “differentiable Riemann–Roch theorem” of Atiyah–Hirzebruch [1], a cohomological variant of the complex analytic Riemann–Roch formula, namely the commutativity of the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} K^\bullet(X) & \xrightarrow{x \mapsto \text{ch}(x) \text{ Todd}(T_X)} & H^{2\bullet}(X, \mathbb{Q}) \\ \downarrow f_* & & \downarrow f_* \\ K^\bullet(Y) & \xrightarrow{y \mapsto \text{ch}(y) \text{ Todd}(T_Y)} & H^{2\bullet}(Y, \mathbb{Q}), \end{array} \quad (5.4)$$

where the horizontal arrows are deduced from cohomological Chern classes, themselves deduced from the homomorphism (5.1) and from the ordinary Chern-class homomorphism

$$K^\bullet(X^{\text{top}}) \longrightarrow H^{2\bullet}(X, \mathbb{Z}),$$

the first vertical arrow is the same as in (5.3), and the second is the Gysin homomorphism in rational cohomology.

6. The covariant invariant $K_\bullet(X)$

In all that precedes, scarcely anything has been said except about the contravariant invariant $K^\bullet(X)$, to the exclusion of the covariant invariant $K_\bullet(X)$ whose existence was indicated in 3.1. If one regards $K^\bullet(X)$ as giving an analogue of the integral cohomology ring of a topological space, one should regard $K_\bullet(X)$ as giving an analogue of integral homology. The module structure of $K_\bullet(X)$ over $K^\bullet(X)$ then corresponds to the cap-product operation. The fact that, when X is regular, the natural homomorphism $K^\bullet(X) \rightarrow K_\bullet(X)$ is an isomorphism should be regarded as the analogue of the Poincaré duality theorem for oriented topological varieties, asserting that cap product with the fundamental homology class defines an isomorphism from cohomology to homology. These analogies moreover suggest the usefulness of also defining, for a finite polyhedron X , say, a covariant invariant $K_\bullet(X)$ whose relations to integral homology – spectral sequence, Chern homomorphism, and so on – would be analogous to those existing between $K^\bullet(X)$ and integral cohomology. Nor does it seem excluded that there might exist, in terms of these groups $K_\bullet(X)$, variants of the differentiable Riemann–Roch theorem valid for spaces more general than compact differentiable manifolds.

Returning to the case where X is an arbitrary noetherian scheme, one should endow $K_\bullet(X)$ with an increasing filtration, $\text{Fil}_i K_\bullet(X)$ being generated by classes $\text{cl}_\bullet(F)$, with F a coherent sheaf on X such that $\dim \text{Supp } F \leq i$. One will prove (Exposé X) the compatibility of this filtration with the module structure and with the filtration of $K^\bullet(X)$, i.e. the formula

$$\text{Fil}_i K^\bullet(X) \cdot \text{Fil}_j K_\bullet(X) \subset \text{Fil}_{j-i} K_\bullet(X), \quad (6.1)$$

which allows the graded group associated with the filtered module $K_\bullet(X)$, denoted $\text{Gr}_\bullet(X)$, to be endowed with a module structure over $\text{Gr}^\bullet(X)$. Its elements may in fact be interpreted as

classes of algebraic cycles on X , for an equivalence relation less fine than rational equivalence when X is of finite type over a base field k . If

$$f : X \longrightarrow Y$$

is a proper morphism of noetherian schemes, then

$$f_* : K_\bullet(X) \longrightarrow K_\bullet(Y) \quad (6.2)$$

is compatible with the filtrations and defines a homomorphism of graded groups

$$f_* : \mathrm{Gr}_\bullet(X) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Gr}_\bullet(Y), \quad (6.3)$$

giving rise to a “projection formula”, i.e. a formula which says that it is $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(Y)$ -linear; this formula is obtained by passage to associated gradeds from the analogous projection formula for the homomorphism (6.2), which is $K^\bullet(Y)$ -linear.

From the point of view proposed in the seminar, a manageable theory of intersections on noetherian schemes X , not necessarily regular, should consist in the combined study of the contravariant invariants $K^\bullet(X), \mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X)$ and the covariant invariants $K_\bullet(X), \mathrm{Gr}_\bullet(X)$. These play roles of essentially different nature, and their properties complement each other. Thus the covariant groups $K_\bullet(X), \mathrm{Gr}_\bullet(X)$ are easier to compute for certain nonproper fibrations, thanks to the “homotopy exact sequence” which one can establish for them ([RRR] and Exposé IX). For example, one proves (Exposé IX) canonical isomorphisms such as

$$K_\bullet(X[t]) \simeq K_\bullet(X), \quad \mathrm{Gr}_\bullet(X[t]) \simeq \mathrm{Gr}_\bullet(X),$$

which fail in general for $K^\bullet$ when X is a nonregular scheme. On the other hand, $K^\bullet(X)$ and $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X)$ lend themselves well to computations, thanks to their ring structures.

When one considers schemes X proper over a field, the projection

$$\pi_X : X \longrightarrow (\text{point})$$

defines a homomorphism, the “Euler–Poincaré characteristic”,

$$\chi_X = \pi_{X*} : K_\bullet(X) \longrightarrow K_\bullet(\text{point}) = \mathbb{Z}, \quad (6.4)$$

which induces on the subgroup $\mathrm{Gr}_0(X) = \mathrm{Fil}_0 K_\bullet(X)$ the homomorphism “degree of zero-cycles”

$$\deg_X : \mathrm{Gr}_0(X) \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}. \quad (6.5)$$

The multiplication homomorphism

$$\mathrm{Gr}^i(X) \times \mathrm{Gr}_i(X) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Gr}_0(X),$$

composed with the degree homomorphism (6.5), then furnishes a pairing

$$\mathrm{Gr}^i(X) \times \mathrm{Gr}_i(X) \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}, \quad (6.6)$$

which explains that, in certain respects, $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X)$ and $\mathrm{Gr}_\bullet(X)$ play dual roles, just as cohomology and homology do. Thus, if $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is a morphism of proper algebraic schemes, the two homomorphisms

$$f^* : \mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(Y) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X), \quad f_* : \mathrm{Gr}_\bullet(X) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Gr}_\bullet(Y)$$

are formally transposes of one another, in the sense of the pairings (6.6).

The homomorphisms (6.4) and (6.5), and the pairing (6.6) deduced from them, may be regarded as the source of numerical relations in intersection theory on proper algebraic schemes over a given field k . This point of view will be developed in some detail in Exposé X, which is essentially independent of Exposés VI, VII, VIII, centred on the proof of the Riemann–Roch theorem, and of Exposé IX. Some notions concerning the behaviour of $K^\bullet(X)$ and $\mathrm{Gr}^\bullet(X)$ under specialization will also be given there.

7. Picard groups and the determinant functor

As in every intersection theory, it is important to specify the place occupied in the theory by the Picard group, or group of classes of divisors in the classical terminology. Subject to a slight restriction, automatically satisfied when X is for instance quasi-compact, one establishes in Exposé X a canonical isomorphism

$$c_1 : \text{Pic}(X) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Gr}^1(X), \quad (7.1)$$

which shows the exact role of the Picard group in the theory we are proposing. This role justifies a more detailed study of the Picard group in Exposés XII and XIII, which are logically independent of the text of the seminar. Kleiman, in Exposé XIII, studies numerical equivalence and certain finiteness theorems for the Picard group, announced without proof in [6], using purely numerical techniques, not relying on the theory of the Picard functor and its representability, due to himself and Mumford, and markedly simpler than Grothendieck's initial proofs. The only result refractory to Kleiman's methods, and which he is obliged to use, is [6, C-07 (i)]; its proof and certain refinements, including certain representability theorems for the Picard functor, occupy Exposé XII. The latter is moreover of a spirit and technique entirely foreign to the rest of the seminar, and is connected with [5]; this exposé is logically independent of all the others.

Finally, in Exposé XI, of a nature appreciably more general than XII and XIII and closer to the general spirit of the seminar, one studies, on an arbitrary locally ringed topos, a remarkable functor called the “determinant functor”:

$$\det^\bullet : \text{Parf}_{\text{is}}(X) \longrightarrow \text{Inv}(X) \quad (7.2)$$

from the category of perfect complexes on X , whose morphisms are only the isomorphisms in the sense of the derived category $D(X)$, to the category of invertible modules on X . This functor is described, up to very little, by the requirement that it be of “local nature” and that it be given, for a bounded complex L with locally free components, by the formula

$$\det^\bullet(L) = \bigotimes_i \det(L_i)^{(-1)^i}, \quad (7.3)$$

where $\det(L_i)$ denotes the exterior power of maximal degree of the locally free module L_i . Although this exposé is also logically independent of the rest of the seminar, except for Exposé I, it nevertheless constitutes an important element of the general “yoga” proposed in the seminar and developed essentially in Exposés I to XI.

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Appendix to Exposé 0: RRR

Classes of Sheaves and the Riemann–Roch Theorem

by A. Grothendieck¹

Demonstration of the Riemann–Roch theorem (1 November 1957).

Chapter I. λ -rings (formal preliminaries)

1. Definitions	1
2. Examples	4
3. The λ -ring defined by a graded ring	8
4. The operations $\lambda^p(N, x)$	13

Chapter II. Classes of coherent algebraic sheaves and Chern classes

1. The theory of Chow	18
2. Definition of the Chern classes of coherent algebraic sheaves	22
3. Functorial generalities on $K(X)$	27
4. Some technical results	34
5. Sheaf-theoretic definition of Chern classes. Application to the study of immersion morphisms	43
6. The Riemann–Roch theorem	49

Chapter I. λ -rings (formal preliminaries)

1. Definitions

A λ -ring² means a commutative ring K with unit, provided with a family of maps

$$\lambda^i : K \longrightarrow K \quad (i \text{ an integer } \geq 0) \quad (1.1)$$

satisfying the following conditions:

$$\lambda_x^0 = 1, \quad \lambda_x^1 = x, \quad \lambda^n(x + y) = \sum_{i=0}^n \lambda_x^i \lambda_y^{n-i}. \quad (1.2)$$

For every $x \in K$ put

$$\lambda_t(x) = \sum_{n \geq 0} \lambda^n(x) t^n \in K[[t]]. \quad (1.3)$$

¹This is the literal reproduction of the report cited in the Introduction to the present seminar. The footnotes indicated by the signs (*), (**) were added in October 1967.

²In this seminar we rather say *pre- λ -ring* (V 2.1), reserving the name λ -ring for those satisfying the supplementary condition of page 3 (cf. V 2.4).

The preceding relations then say that $x \mapsto \lambda_t(x)$ is a homomorphism from the additive group K to the multiplicative group $1 + K[[t]]^+$ of formal series over K with augmentation 1, lifting the canonical homomorphism

$$1 + \sum_{i>0} x_i t^i \mapsto x_1.$$

Thus on the ring $\mathbb{Z}$ there exists a unique λ -structure compatible with its ring structure and such that

$$\lambda_t(1) = 1 + t. \quad (1.4)$$

One then has

$$\lambda_t(n) = (1 + t)^n, \quad (1.5)$$

whence

$$\lambda^i(n) = \binom{n}{i}.$$

The notion of a λ -homomorphism of λ -rings is clear; an *augmented λ -ring* is a λ -ring provided with a λ -homomorphism to $\mathbb{Z}$.

To define the notion of a *special λ -ring*, the following considerations are useful. Let k be a commutative ring with unit and let

$$K = 1 + k[[t]]^+$$

be the group of formal series with coefficients in k and augmentation 1. We shall introduce on it a λ -ring law whose additive structure is the multiplication of formal series. The multiplication of this ring will be denoted $f \circ g$. It is entirely determined by the condition that the coefficients $c_n = c_n(f \circ g)$ of $f \circ g$ are given by universal polynomials with integral coefficients in the coefficients $a_i = c_i(f)$ and $b_i = c_i(g)$ of f and g , respectively:

$$c_n = P_n(a_1, \dots, a_n; b_1, \dots, b_n), \quad (1.6)$$

that it be distributive with respect to the “addition” fg , and be given for linear factors by

$$(1 + at) \circ (1 + bt) = 1 + abt. \quad (1.7)$$

The P_n are computed by calculations with symmetric functions; P_n is isobaric of weight n in the a_i and isobaric of weight n in the b_i (where a_i and b_i have weight i), and moreover is symmetric in $a = (a_i)$ and $b = (b_i)$.

Similarly, the $\lambda^i(f)$ are determined without ambiguity by the condition that the coefficients

$$c_n(\lambda^i(f)) = c_n(\lambda^i(f))$$

of $\lambda^i(f)$ be calculated by universal polynomials with integral coefficients in the coefficients $c_n(f) = a_n$ of f :

$$c_n = P_{i,n}(a_1, \dots, a_{in}), \quad (1.8)$$

that the relations (1.2) be satisfied, and that, for $i > 1$, one have

$$\lambda^i(1 + at) = 1 \quad (1.9)$$

(1 is the zero element of the ring $K = 1 + k[[t]]^+$). The $P_{i,n}$ are again computed by calculations with symmetric functions, and one observes that $P_{i,n}$ is an isobaric polynomial of weight in in the a_i . Provided with the preceding operations, K becomes a λ -ring; its zero element is 1 and its unit element is $1 + t$. Also note the relation

$$(1 + at) \circ f = f(at). \quad (1.7 \text{ bis})$$

Let now K be an arbitrary λ -ring. We say that K is *special* if the additive homomorphism λ_t from K to $1 + K[[t]]^+$ is a λ -homomorphism. Thus this means that one has the formulas

$$\lambda_t(1) = 1 + t, \quad \lambda_t(xy) = \lambda_t(x) \circ \lambda_t(y), \quad \lambda_t(\lambda^i(x)) = \lambda^i(\lambda_t(x)), \quad (1.10)$$

or, more explicitly,

$$\begin{cases} \lambda^i(1) = 0 & \text{if } i > 1, \\ \lambda^n(xy) = P_n(\lambda^1 x, \dots, \lambda^n x; \lambda^1 y, \dots, \lambda^n y), \\ \lambda^n(\lambda^i(x)) = P_{i,n}(\lambda^1 x, \dots, \lambda^{in} x), \end{cases} \quad (1.11)$$

where the P_n and $P_{i,n}$ are the universal polynomials considered above. In particular the formulas (1.5) follow. One may show that the λ -ring $1 + k[[t]]^+$ constructed from a commutative ring k is special, but we shall not need this fact.

2. Examples

1) Let G be a group and k a commutative ring. Consider the group $K(G)$, the quotient of the free group generated by the classes of representations of G in finite-type k -modules by the subgroup generated by elements of the form

$$(\rho \oplus \rho') - (\rho) - (\rho')$$

(where $\oplus$ denotes the direct sum). Tensor product and exterior powers define on $K(G)$ a λ -ring structure. One may also pass to the quotient by elements of the form

$$(\rho) - (\rho') - (\rho''),$$

where ρ is a representation which is an extension of ρ' by ρ'' , trivial as an extension of k -modules. One obtains the group $K_r(G)$ of reduced classes of representations of G , and one checks that the λ -ring law passes to the quotient.

When k is an algebraically closed field of characteristic 0,³ one can show that $K(G)$, and a fortiori $K_r(G)$, is a special λ -ring. This is no longer true if the characteristic is not 0; however, if k is algebraically closed, $K_r(G)$ is still a special λ -ring. To prove this one is reduced to the case where G is a product $\mathrm{Gl}(m, k) \times \mathrm{Gl}(n, k)$ and where only rational representations of G are considered; our assertion follows from the explicit determination of $K_r(G)$ to be made below (Example 3). Finally, when k has characteristic 0, complete reducibility of rational representations of G shows that $K(G) = K_r(G)$.

Variants of the preceding example: G is an algebraic group defined over k and one considers only rational representations of G defined over k ; one may consider the case of a topological group, or of a Lie group, and continuous representations, etc.⁴

2) Let X be an algebraic variety, irreducible or not, defined over the field k . We may consider the quotient group of the free group generated by the classes of vector bundles on X (defined over k) by the subgroup generated by the elements of the form

$$(E \oplus E') - (E) - (E'),$$

³It is unnecessary for k to be algebraically closed; cf. VI 3.3 for a still more general result, encompassing all those that will be used in the present report.

⁴One could build other examples of λ -rings; for example, the set of equivalence classes of quadratic forms, the set of representation classes of a Lie algebra, etc. We promise that we shall not need all these examples in order to treat the Riemann–Roch theorem.

on which the λ -ring operations are defined by tensor product and exterior powers. If X is complete, this is a free group generated by the indecomposable vector bundles on X (thanks to Krull–Remak–Schmidt); knowledge of this ring and of its basis is equivalent to the complete classification of vector bundles on X and to knowledge of the elementary tensor operations on these bundles. If k is algebraically closed of characteristic 0, all other tensor operations on classes of vector bundles are then known by means of what follows in 3). One may make a more drastic passage to the quotient by the group generated by the elements

$$(E) - (E') - (E''),$$

where E is a vector bundle extension of E' by E'' . One then obtains a λ -ring, denoted $K(\xi(X))$, where $\xi(X)$ denotes the additive category of vector bundles on X defined over k . Using the results of Example 1), one shows that, if k is algebraically closed,⁵ the λ -ring $K(\xi(X))$ is special, and that the same is true of the first λ -ring defined here if the characteristic of k is 0, but not in the general case.

3) Determination of $K(G)$ and of $K_r(G)$ in some important cases. Suppose the field k is algebraically closed and that the group G is affine algebraic, connected, and “globally reductive” (the radical of G is isomorphic to $(k^*)^s$), and consider only rational linear representations. In characteristic 0, complete reducibility of rational linear representations of G shows that $K(G) = K_r(G)$ is the free group generated by the classes of irreducible rational representations. If T is a maximal torus of G , then

$$K(T) = K_r(T) = \mathbb{Z}(\widehat{T}),$$

the algebra of the group $\widehat{T}$ of rational characters of T ; one has $\widehat{T} \simeq \mathbb{Z}^r$ if r is the rank of G (this is independent of the characteristic). The Weyl group W operates on T , hence on $K(T)$, in a way which depends only on the operations of W on the free group $\widehat{T}$. There is an evident homomorphism of λ -rings, deduced from the injection of T into G :

$$K_r(G) \longrightarrow K_r(T)^W = K(T)^W, \quad (1.13)$$

where $K(T)^W$ denotes the set of fixed points of W in $K(T)$. The theory of linear representations of G ⁶ then proves the following theorem.

Theorem 1.1. The homomorphism (1.13) is an isomorphism.

Thus one sees that $K_r(G)$, once the “type” of G is known (characterized by W operating on a group $\mathbb{Z}^r$), does not depend on the characteristic, and that it is a special λ -ring. There is a canonical basis of $K_r(G)$ corresponding to the orbits of W in $\widehat{T}$; another basis is obtained as follows. Let $(\rho_i)_{1 \leq i \leq r'}$ be the classes of representations of G corresponding to the fundamental representations of $G/\text{rad } G$, and let $(\sigma_j)_{1 \leq j \leq r''}$ be a basis of the group of rational homomorphisms from G to k^* . Thus $r' + r'' = r$ (the rank of G).

Corollary. The ring $K_r(G)$ is identified with the subring

$$\mathbb{Z}[\rho_1, \dots, \rho_{r'}; \sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_{r''}, \sigma_1^{-1}, \dots, \sigma_{r''}^{-1}]$$

of the field of rational functions in the ρ_i and the σ_j with coefficients in $\mathbb{Q}$.⁷

In particular, $K_r(G)$ has no zero divisors. If $G = \prod_i \text{Gl}(n_i, k)$, the ring $K_r(G)$ is made explicit as follows. Let ρ_i be the representation of G deduced from the identical representation of $\text{Gl}(n_i, k)$. If one then considers the field of rational functions over $\mathbb{Q}$ in the indeterminates

⁵Unnecessary condition; cf. the preceding footnote.

⁶Cf. Chevalley Seminar 1956/58, *Groupes de Lie algébriques* (École Normale Supérieure).

⁷The derived group G' of G must be supposed simply connected for this statement to be correct.

$\lambda^j(\rho_i)$, $1 \leq j \leq n_i$, then $K_r(G)$ is identified with the subring generated by these indeterminates and the inverses of the $\lambda^{n_i}(\rho_i)$. This justifies our assertion that, at least in characteristic 0, the operations λ^i make it possible to reconstruct all tensor operations on vector bundles; this remains true over an algebraically closed field of arbitrary characteristic, provided one takes reduced classes.

Remarks. a) In Example 1), the ring $K(G)$ is augmented, the augmentation being defined by the degree of representations; by passage to the quotient, this augmentation defines an augmentation on $K_r(G)$. Likewise, the λ -rings considered in Example 2) are augmented when X is k -irreducible; in $K(\xi(X))$, the augmentation is defined by the rank of a vector bundle, that is, the dimension of its fibres.

b) When the field k is not algebraically closed, it is plausible that $K(G)$ is a special λ -ring in characteristic 0, and likewise for $K_r(G)$ in all characteristics.

c) In non-zero characteristic, Theorem 1.1 was graciously supplied by Chevalley.

3. The λ -ring defined by a graded ring

Let A be a graded commutative ring with unit. To simplify, assume that the degrees of A are positive and that $A^0 = \mathbb{Z}$. Denote by $\hat{A}$ the product of the A^i (this is a commutative ring with unit), and by $\hat{A}^+$ the kernel of the evident augmentation $\hat{A} \rightarrow A^0 = \mathbb{Z}$. Then $1 + \hat{A}^+$ is a subgroup of the multiplicative group of invertible elements of $\hat{A}$. Consider the abelian group

$$\tilde{A} = \mathbb{Z} \times (1 + \hat{A}^+), \quad (1.14)$$

whose elements will be denoted $[n, x]$, with $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ and

$$x = 1 + \sum_{i \geq 1} x^i \in 1 + \hat{A}^+ \quad (x^i \in A^i).$$

We write this group additively, thus:

$$[n, x] + [n', x'] = [n + n', xx']. \quad (1.15)$$

The zero element of this group is $[0, 1]$. We shall introduce on it an augmented λ -ring structure, compatible with its additive structure, the augmentation being $\varepsilon : [n, x] \mapsto n$. The product $[m, x][n, y]$ is completely characterized by the fact that it is written

$$[mn, x^n y^m (x * y)],$$

where $x * y$ is an element of $1 + \hat{A}^+$ whose components are expressed as universal polynomials with integral coefficients in the x^i and the y^i :

$$(x * y)^i = Q_i(x^1, \dots, x^i; y^1, \dots, y^i) \quad (i \geq 1), \quad (1.16)$$

the polynomial Q_i being isobaric of weight i . Moreover, $x * y$ must be distributive with respect to the “addition” xy and, for “linear” factors, must reduce to

$$[1, 1 + x^1][1, 1 + y^1] = [1, 1 + x^1 + y^1]. \quad (1.17)$$

The polynomials Q_i are evaluated by calculations with elementary symmetric functions. This is the calculation of the Chern classes of a tensor product of vector bundles by means of the Chern classes x^i and y^i of the factors and of their respective dimensions m and n . From (1.17) one deduces

$$(1 + x^1) * (1 + y^1) = \frac{1 + x^1 + y^1}{(1 + x^1)(1 + y^1)}, \quad (1.17 \text{ bis})$$

and an arbitrary product $x * y$ is computed term by term by decomposing formally

$$x = \prod_{i=1}^n (1 + \alpha_i), \quad y = \prod_{i=1}^n (1 + \beta_i),$$

where the α_i and β_i have degree 1.

In this way $\tilde{A}$ becomes a commutative augmented ring with unit $[1, 1]$; it may be interpreted as the ring obtained by adjoining a unit to the ring $1 + \tilde{A}^+$. Moreover, on $\tilde{A}$ one defines a filtration by putting $\tilde{A}^0 = \tilde{A}$ and denoting by $\tilde{A}^n$ the set of the $[0, x]$ with $x^i = 0$ for $1 \leq i < n$. This filtration is compatible with the product, for

$$\left(1 + \sum_{i \geq m} x^i\right) * \left(1 + \sum_{j \geq n} y^j\right) = 1 - \frac{(m+n-1)!}{(m-1)!(n-1)!} x^m y^n + \dots, \quad (1.18)$$

the omitted terms having degree $> m+n$. This formula shows that the graded ring $G(\tilde{A})$ associated with $\tilde{A}$ is identified with A from the additive point of view, but not from the multiplicative point of view. One can only say that the map η' from A to $G(\tilde{A})$ defined by

$$\eta'(x^i) = (-1)^{i-1} (i-1)! x^i \quad (x^i \in A^i) \quad (1.19)$$

is a ring homomorphism.

On $\tilde{A}$ introduce operations λ^i satisfying the axioms of λ -rings (Section 1, formulas (1.2)), well determined by the condition that the components of $\lambda^i[0, x]$ be deduced from the components x^i of x by universal polynomials with integral coefficients:

$$\lambda^i[0, x] = [0, \lambda^i x], \quad (\lambda^i x)^{(n)} = Q_{i,n}(x^1, \dots, x^n), \quad (1.20)$$

where $Q_{i,n}$ is isobaric of weight n , and such that

$$\lambda^i[1, 1 + x^1] = 0 \quad \text{for } i > 1. \quad (1.21)$$

The polynomials $Q_{i,n}$ are evaluated by a calculation with elementary symmetric functions: it is the calculation of the Chern classes of the exterior powers of a vector bundle by means of the Chern classes and the rank of that bundle. One then observes that $\tilde{A}$ is a special augmented λ -ring and that the $\tilde{A}^i$ are stable under the operations λ^j .

The augmented λ -ring $\tilde{A}$ may be considered as a functor in A . Consequently, the principal automorphism

$$x = \sum_{i \geq 0} x^i \mapsto \check{x} = \sum_{i \geq 0} (-1)^i x^i$$

of A defines an automorphism of $\tilde{A}$, denoted by the same symbol $\check{\cdot}$.

Proposition 1.2. Let $x \in \tilde{A}$ be of the form

$$x = [n, 1 + x^1 + \dots + x^n]$$

(so $x^i = 0$ for $i > n$). Then $\lambda^i(x) = 0$ for $i > n$, one has $\lambda^n(x) = [1, 1 + x^1]$, and finally

$$\sum_{i=0}^n (-1)^i \lambda^i(x) = [0, 1 - (n-1)! x^n + \dots]. \quad (1.22)$$

From this proposition, and from the fact that the $\tilde{A}^i$ are stable under the operations λ^j , it follows that formula (1.22) is valid whenever $\varepsilon(x) = n$, whether or not $x^i = 0$ for $i > n$.

Formula (1.22) admits the following generalizations. Let K be any λ -ring, and let n be arbitrary. For $x \in K$, put

$$\gamma^n(x) = (-1)^n \sum_{i=0}^n (-1)^i \lambda^i(x+n) = \lambda^n(x+n-1) \quad (1.23)$$

(the identity of the last two members follows from an immediate induction). In particular $\gamma^0(x) = 1$ and $\gamma^1(x) = x$. Next put

$$\gamma_t(x) = \sum_{n \geq 0} \gamma^n(x) t^n \in K[[t]]. \quad (1.24)$$

One deduces the formula

$$\gamma_t(x) = \lambda_{t/(1-t)}(x), \quad (1.25)$$

which is equivalent to

$$\lambda_s(x) = \gamma_{s/(1+s)}(x). \quad (1.25 \text{ bis})$$

This proves that the λ^i are expressed in terms of the γ^i , and that

$$\gamma_t(x+y) = \gamma_t(x)\gamma_t(y).$$

Consequently the maps γ^i define a new λ -ring structure on K . Formula (1.22) then shows that, for $K = \tilde{A}$ and every $x \in \tilde{A}$, one has

$$\gamma^n(x - \varepsilon(x)) = [0, 1 + (-1)^{n-1}(n-1)!x^n + \cdots], \quad (1.22 \text{ bis})$$

and hence the component x^n is obtained, up to the factor $(-1)^{n-1}(n-1)!$, by reducing modulo $\tilde{A}^{n+1}$ the element $\gamma^n(x - \varepsilon(x))$ of $\tilde{A}^n$.

The Chern homomorphism. For every graded ring A satisfying the preceding conditions, we shall define a homomorphism of augmented rings

$$\text{ch} : \tilde{A} \longrightarrow \hat{A} \otimes \mathbb{Q}. \quad (1.26)$$

This homomorphism is defined without ambiguity by the condition that it be an additive homomorphism, send 1 to 1, and be such that the components of $\text{ch}(x)$ in degree > 0 are given by universal isobaric polynomials with rational coefficients in the components of x , and that

$$\text{ch}([1, 1 + x^1]) = \exp x^1 = \sum_{n \geq 0} (x^1)^n / n!. \quad (1.27)$$

One immediately obtains the explicit expression of ch . Let η be the additive endomorphism of $\hat{A} \otimes \mathbb{Q}$ defined, for x^i of degree i , by

$$\eta(x^i) = \frac{1}{(-1)^{i-1}(i-1)!} x^i. \quad (1.28)$$

Then

$$\text{ch} \left(\left[n, 1 + \sum_{i \geq 1} x^i \right] \right) = n + \eta \left(\log \left(1 + \sum_{i \geq 1} x^i \right) \right). \quad (1.29)$$

Since this formula can be inverted, at least if A has only finitely many homogeneous components, one sees that in this case one has an isomorphism ch from the ring $\tilde{A} \otimes \mathbb{Q}$ onto the ring $\hat{A} \otimes \mathbb{Q}$, which completely elucidates the structure of $\tilde{A} \otimes \mathbb{Q}$.

Recall that, according to Hirzebruch [1], a formal series $f \in \mathbb{Q}[[t]]$ defines by universal polynomial formulas an additive homomorphism

$$1 + \hat{A}^+ \longrightarrow 1 + (\hat{A} \otimes \mathbb{Q})^+,$$

denoted $\mathfrak{C}_f$. When $f(t) = t/(1 - \exp(-t))$, we write simply $\mathfrak{C}_f = \mathfrak{C}$ (the initial of Todd). We extend the definition of $\mathfrak{C}(x)$ to $x \in \tilde{A}$. This said, we have the following result.

Proposition 1.3. Let $N \in \tilde{A}$ be of the form

$$N = [q, 1 + N^1 + \cdots + N^q]$$

(so $N^i = 0$ for $i > q$). If one puts

$$\lambda_{-1}(N) = \sum_{i \geq 0} (-1)^i \lambda^i(N) = \sum_{i=0}^n (-1)^i \lambda^i(N),$$

then

$$\text{ch}(\lambda_{-1}(N)) = (-1)^q N^q \mathfrak{C}(\check{N})^{-1}, \quad (1.30)$$

which is equivalent to

$$\text{ch}(\lambda_{-1}(\check{N})) = N^q \mathfrak{C}(N)^{-1}. \quad (1.30 \text{ bis})$$

4. The operations $\lambda^p(N, x)$

Let A be the ring of formal series, with coefficients in $\mathbb{Z}$, in two infinite sequences of indeterminates denoted $\lambda^i N$ and $\lambda^i x$ ($i \geq 1$). Put $\lambda^1 N = N$ and $\lambda^1 x = x$, and introduce on A the unique special λ -ring structure for which

$$\lambda^i(N) = \lambda^i N, \quad \lambda^i(x) = \lambda^i x,$$

and for which the operations λ^i are continuous. If one restricted oneself to polynomials in the indeterminates $\lambda^i N$ and $\lambda^i x$, one would have the λ -ring freely generated by N and x ; our ring A is its completion. One may then form

$$\lambda_{-1}(N) = \sum_{i \geq 0} (-1)^i \lambda^i N, \quad (1.31)$$

which is a formal series with constant term 1, hence invertible. Thus an element $\lambda^p(N, x)$ of A can be defined without ambiguity by putting

$$\lambda^p(N, x) \lambda_{-1}(N) = \lambda^p(x \lambda_{-1}(N)). \quad (1.32)$$

Theorem 1.4. Let J_q be the closed ideal of A generated by the $\lambda^i N$ with $i > q$. Identify A/J_q with the ring of formal series in the $\lambda^i x$ and the $\lambda^j N$ ($1 \leq j \leq q$). Then $\lambda^p(N, x)$ reduced modulo J_q is a polynomial, isobaric of weight p with respect to the variables $\lambda^i x$.

Let N and F be two vector spaces of finite dimensions q, q' over an algebraically closed field k of characteristic 0. Let $N^{(p)}$ be the kernel of the map

$$(a_1, \dots, a_p) \longmapsto a_1 + \cdots + a_p$$

from N^p to N . We make the symmetric group $\mathfrak{S}_p$ operate on N^p , hence on $N^{(p)}$, hence on $\Lambda(N^{(p)})$, and then on

$$\Lambda(N^{(p)}) \otimes \bigotimes^p F.$$

Consider this vector space as a graded module over $\mathfrak{S}_p \times \text{Gl}(N) \times \text{Gl}(F)$, and take its “alternating part”, which is a graded module over $\text{Gl}(N) \times \text{Gl}(F) = G$. Then

$$\lambda^p(N, F) = E_G \left(\left(\Lambda(N^{(p)}) \otimes \bigotimes^p F \right)^{\text{alt}} \right). \quad (1.33)$$

N.B. If M is a complex of G -modules, $E_G(M)$ denotes the alternating sum in $K(G)$ of the classes of the components of M , that is, the Euler–Poincaré characteristic of M . In formula (1.33), the first member $\lambda^p(N, F)$ denotes the element of the ring $K(G)$ obtained by substituting, for the variables λ_N^i and λ_F^i , the classes in $K(G)$ of the G -modules $\lambda^i(N)$ and $\lambda^i(F)$, respectively.

Proof. Expanding the second member of (1.32) by the second formula (1.11), one sees that the first assertion is proved if one proves the analogous assertion obtained by setting $x = 1$, i.e. if one proves that in the λ -ring $\mathbb{Z}[\lambda^1 N, \dots, \lambda^q N]$, where $\lambda^i N = 0$ for $i > q$, the element $\lambda^p(\lambda_{-1}(N))$ is divisible by $\lambda_{-1}(N)$. A priori, the quotient

$$\lambda^p(N, 1) = \lambda^p(\lambda_{-1}(N)) / \lambda_{-1}(N)$$

is a formal series contained in the quotient field K of the ring of formal series in the $\lambda^i N$ for $1 \leq i \leq q$. On the other hand, also denote by N a vector space of dimension q over an algebraically closed field k of characteristic 0, and consider the element

$$\mathcal{L}^p(N) = E_G((\Lambda(N^{(p)}))^{\text{alt}}) \in K(G),$$

where now $G = \text{Gl}(N)$. We know (Section 2, Theorem 1.3) that $K(G)$ is identified with the subring of K generated by the λ_N^i for $1 \leq i \leq q$ and by the inverse of λ_N^q . Moreover, in this ring one verifies easily that

$$\mathcal{L}^p(N) \lambda_{-1}(N) = \lambda^p(\lambda_{-1}(N)).$$

Since we are in a large field K and $\lambda_{-1}(N) \neq 0$, it follows that $\mathcal{L}^p(N) = \lambda^p(N, 1)$. Both members lie in the intersection of $K(G)$ with the ring of formal series in the λ_N^i , hence are polynomials in the λ_N^i .

To prove (1.33) in the general case, one verifies that the second member satisfies in $K(G)$ the formula analogous to (1.32), that is, that its product by $\lambda_{-1}(N)$ is $\lambda^p(F \lambda_{-1}(N))$. Likewise, the product of $\lambda^p(N, F) \in K(G)$ by $\lambda_{-1}(N)$ is $\lambda^p(F \lambda_{-1}(N))$, as follows from the fact that $K(G)$ is special. Since $K(G)$ is integral (cf. Section 2), and $\lambda_{-1}(N) \neq 0$ (same reference), formula (1.33) is proved. QED.

Remarks. a) When the dimension q' of F is at least p , formula (1.33) characterizes the polynomial $\lambda^p(N, x)$ in the λ_N^i ($1 \leq i \leq q$) and the λ_x^j ($1 \leq j \leq p$).

b) It is plausible that (1.33) remains valid if the field k is not algebraically closed.⁸ One would have to resolve this question if one wanted to prove the Riemann–Roch theorem over a non-algebraically-closed field of characteristic 0 by the method to be explained. The passage from an $\mathfrak{S}_p$ -module to its alternating part has reasonable meaning only when the base field has characteristic 0.

Let now K be any special λ -ring and let N be an element of K such that $\lambda^i N = 0$ for all sufficiently large i . Then for every $x \in K$ and every integer $p \geq 1$ one can consider the elements $\lambda^p(N, x)$, which are expressed by universal polynomials with integral coefficients in the λ_N^i and the λ_x^j . One has $\lambda^1(N, x) = x$ and formula (1.32) in K . To express the properties of the operations $x \mapsto \lambda^p(N, x)$, it is convenient to introduce a new λ -ring, denoted K_N . As a commutative ring, K_N is obtained by adjoining a unit to the ring whose underlying additive group is K and whose multiplication is given by

$$x_N y = xy \mu \quad (\mu = \lambda_{-1}(N)). \quad (1.34)$$

The map λ_t from K_N to $K_N[[t]]$ is defined by

$$\lambda_t(n, x) = (1 + t)^n \sum_{p \geq 0} \lambda^p(N, x) t^p, \quad (1.35)$$

⁸This is in fact proved by the same method.

where $\lambda^0(N, x) = (1, 0)$ (the unit element of K_N). I say that, with these operations, K_N is a special λ -ring. Thus one has to verify the formulas

$$\lambda_t(X + Y) = \lambda_t(X)\lambda_t(Y), \quad \lambda_t(XY) = \lambda_t(X)\lambda_t(Y), \quad \lambda_t(\lambda^i(X)) = \lambda^i(\lambda_t(X))$$

for $X, Y \in K_N$. One may restrict oneself to verifying these formulas when X and Y lie in K , and one checks that it suffices to verify them when K is the free special λ -ring generated by X, Y and N subject to the relations $\lambda^i N = 0$ for $i > q$. But the group homomorphism

$$K_N \longrightarrow K, \tag{1.36}$$

which sends unit to unit and on K reduces to the homomorphism $x \mapsto x\mu$, is a homomorphism compatible with the ring structures and the maps λ^i , as one verifies immediately. In the present case, its restriction to K is injective. Since K is a special λ -ring, it follows easily that the above relations are indeed verified for $X, Y \in K$, completing the proof of our assertion.

According to formula (1.23), it is natural, for $x \in K$ and $n \geq 1$, to put

$$\gamma^n(N, x) = \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \binom{n-1}{i} \lambda^i(N, x), \tag{1.37}$$

in other words, $\gamma^n(N, x) = \gamma^n(x_N)$, where x_N denotes x considered as an element of the λ -ring K_N .

Proposition 1.5. Let A be a graded commutative ring with unit, let N be an element of $\tilde{A}$ of the form

$$N = [q, 1 + N^1 + \cdots + N^q],$$

and let x be an arbitrary element of $\tilde{A}$:

$$x = [\nu, 1 + \sum_{i \geq 1} x^i].$$

Then, for every integer $j \geq 0$, one has $\gamma^{q+j}(N, x) \in \tilde{A}^j$, and the component of degree j of $\gamma^{q+j}(N, x)$ is of the form

$$(\gamma^{q+j}(N, x))^{(j)} = (-1)^{j-1} (j-1)! G_{q,j}(\nu, x^1, \dots, x^j; N^1, \dots, N^j), \tag{1.38}$$

where $G_{q,j}$ is a universal polynomial with integral coefficients characterized by the condition

$$G_{q,j}(\nu, x^1, \dots, N^j) (N^q) = (-1)^q (x * \lambda_{-1}(N))^{(q+j)}. \tag{1.39}$$

Proof. We may suppose that A is the ring of polynomials with integral coefficients in indeterminates x^i and N^j ($1 \leq j \leq q$). Since, combining (1.32) and (1.37), one has

$$\gamma^n(N, x) \lambda_{-1}(N) = \gamma^n(x \lambda_{-1}(N)), \tag{1.40}$$

and, for $n = q + j$, the second member has filtration $\geq q + j$ (use formula (1.22 bis), taking account of the fact that $x \lambda_{-1}(N)$ has zero augmentation), while $\lambda_{-1}(N)$ has filtration q (formula (1.22)), it follows that $\gamma^n(N, x)$ has filtration j , since by (1.18) the associated graded of A is integral here. Using the preceding formulas, one immediately obtains the indicated form for $(\gamma^{q+j}(N, x))^{(j)}$. QED.

Chapter II. Classes of coherent algebraic sheaves and Chern classes

1. The theory of Chow

Throughout this chapter, a base field k is fixed; for simplicity it will be assumed algebraically closed. A large part of what follows, perhaps all of it, is nevertheless valid without this restriction. The algebraic spaces and the regular maps considered will be defined over k .

An algebraic space is called *quasi-projective* if it is isomorphic to a locally closed subset of a projective space.

Let X be a nonsingular connected quasi-projective variety of dimension n . Denote by $A(X)$, and call the *Chow ring* of X , the graded ring of classes of cycles on X modulo rational equivalence. Thus $A^i(X)$ is formed from the classes of cycles of dimension $n - i$. The fact that $A(X)$ is indeed a graded ring follows from the following theorem of Chow.

Theorem 2.1.⁹ Every cycle on X is rationally equivalent to a nonsingular cycle. Given elements of $A^i(X)$ and $A^j(X)$, one can find nonsingular representatives of these elements, say Y^{n-i} and Z^{n-j} , which meet everywhere transversely.

A cycle is called nonsingular if its components are nonsingular subvarieties. Two cycles are said to meet everywhere transversely if every component of one cuts every component of the other transversely, i.e. if the two secant varieties are nonsingular at their intersection points and their tangent varieties there are in general position.

Let f be a morphism, i.e. a regular map, from X to Y (where X and Y are quasi-projective and nonsingular). Then f defines, using the preceding theorem, a homomorphism of graded rings

$$f^* : A(Y) \longrightarrow A(X), \quad (2.1)$$

namely inverse image of cycle classes. Thus $A(X)$ becomes a contravariant functor in X .

Let f be a proper morphism from X^n to Y^m (i.e. in Weil's terminology, the graph of f is complete over Y , cf. [3]). Then f also defines an additive homomorphism

$$f_* : A(X^n) \longrightarrow A(Y^m), \quad (2.2)$$

preserving the dimension of cycles, hence increasing the degree by $m - n$.

Thus, relative to proper morphisms, and ignoring multiplicative structures and gradings, $A(X)$ is a covariant functor in X . Let us record the classical formula

$$f_*(x \cdot f^*(y)) = f_*(x) \cdot y. \quad (2.3)$$

We shall also use Chow's theory of Chern classes. It consists in attaching to every vector bundle E on X (still assumed quasi-projective and nonsingular) Chern classes

$$c^i(E) \in A^i(X) \quad (i \geq 1),$$

in such a way as to satisfy the following conditions. Put $c^0(E) = 1$ and

$$\tilde{C}(E) = \left[\text{rank } E, \sum_{i \geq 0} c^i(E) \right] \in \tilde{A}(X) \quad (2.4)$$

⁹As a result of a misunderstanding on the author's part, the stated theorem is more than is presently known. In fact, one uses only the "moving lemma" of Chow, saying that two cycles can be moved in their classes so that their intersection is not excessive; cf. Chevalley Seminar 1958, *Anneau de Chow et applications*.

(see Chapter I, §3 for the definition of $\tilde{A}(X)$). The conditions to be verified by a theory of Chern classes are then expressed as follows:

$$\tilde{C}(E) = \tilde{C}(E') + \tilde{C}(E'') \quad (2.5)$$

if the vector bundle E is an extension of E' by E'' . If one puts

$$C(E) = \sum_i c^i(E),$$

this condition is expressed by $C(E) = C(E')C(E'')$. Formula (2.5) permits one to extend $\tilde{C}$ to an additive homomorphism from $K(\xi(X))$ (cf. Chapter I, §2, Example 2) to $\tilde{A}(X)$:

$$\tilde{C} : K(\xi(X)) \longrightarrow \tilde{A}(X), \quad (2.6)$$

and one wants $\tilde{C}$ to be a λ -homomorphism of λ -rings. This last condition may also be written

$$\tilde{C}(E \otimes F) = \tilde{C}(E)\tilde{C}(F), \quad \tilde{C}(\lambda^i E) = \lambda^i \tilde{C}(E), \quad (2.7)$$

for two vector bundles E and F ; of course $\tilde{C}$ is automatically compatible with augmentations. Let D be a divisor on X and let $L(D)$ be the vector bundle it defines. One wants

$$c^1(L(D)) = \ell(D), \quad c^i(L(D)) = 0 \quad (i > 1), \quad (2.8)$$

where, for any cycle Z , $\ell(Z)$ denotes its class in $A(X)$. Finally, one imposes that the c^i be functorial, i.e. that if f is a morphism from X to Y and E is a vector bundle on Y , then

$$c^i(f^!(E)) = f^*(c^i(E)), \quad (2.9)$$

where $f^!(E)$ is the inverse image of E on X . One may also write (2.9) in the following form: the notion of inverse image of vector bundles defines a λ -homomorphism of augmented λ -rings

$$f^! : K(Y) \longrightarrow K(X),^{10} \quad (2.10)$$

where here one writes $K(X)$ instead of $K(\xi(X))$, and (2.9) means that there is commutativity in the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} K(Y) & \xrightarrow{f^!} & K(X) \\ \tilde{C}_Y \downarrow & & \downarrow \tilde{C}_X \\ A(Y) & \xrightarrow{f^*} & A(X). \end{array}$$

Here the space on which $\tilde{C}$ is considered has been put as a subscript.

Theorem 2.2. There exists a theory of Chern classes satisfying conditions (2.5), (2.7), (2.8), and (2.9).

We shall also admit the following proposition.

Proposition 2.3. Let Y be a closed subset of X and let U be its complement. If x is an element of $A(X)$ inducing 0 on U , then there exists a representative of x which is a cycle carried by Y .

Corollary. Let $p = \dim X - \dim Y$. Then, if $i < p$, the homomorphism

$$A^i(X) \longrightarrow A^i(U)$$

is bijective. Every element of the kernel of $A^p(X) \rightarrow A^p(U)$ is a linear combination of components of dimension $n - p$ of Y ; hence it is proportional to $\ell(Y)$ if Y is irreducible.

¹⁰The notation $f^!$ used here is in conflict with that used in duality theory (cf., for example, R. Hartshorne, *Residues and Duality*, Lecture Notes in Mathematics, no. 20, Springer, 1966). This is why in this seminar we replace it by the notation f^* .

2. Definition of the Chern classes of coherent algebraic sheaves

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an abelian category, and let $\mathcal{C}_0$ be a subclass of $\mathcal{C}$. Denote by $K(\mathcal{C}_0)$ the quotient group of the free group generated by the isomorphism classes of elements of $\mathcal{C}_0$ by the subgroup generated by the elements of the form

$$(E) - (E') - (E''),$$

where E is an extension of E' by E'' and $E, E', E'' \in \mathcal{C}_0$. We must suppose that the classes of elements of $\mathcal{C}_0$, for the isomorphism relation, form a set. Denote by $\gamma_{\mathcal{C}_0}(E)$ the class of an object $E \in \mathcal{C}_0$ in $K(\mathcal{C}_0)$, and omit the subscript $\mathcal{C}_0$ when there is no danger of confusion. The group $K(\mathcal{C}_0)$ is the solution of a universal problem relative to functions

$$E \longmapsto f(E)$$

defined on $\mathcal{C}_0$, with values in an arbitrary abelian group A , which are additive in the sense that $f(E) = f(E') + f(E'')$ whenever E is an extension of E' by E'' .

Let F be an additive functor from $\mathcal{C}$ to $\mathcal{C}'$ and let $\mathcal{C}'_0$ be a subclass of $\mathcal{C}'$ satisfying the same condition as $\mathcal{C}_0$, such that for every $A \in \mathcal{C}_0$ the $R^q F(A)$ are in $\mathcal{C}'_0$ and are zero for q sufficiently large. We suppose that injective resolutions exist in $\mathcal{C}$, so that the derived functors $R^q F$ of F exist. Then F defines a homomorphism from $K(\mathcal{C}_0)$ to $K(\mathcal{C}'_0)$, still denoted F , by the formula

$$F(\gamma_{\mathcal{C}_0}(E)) = \sum_{i \geq 0} (-1)^i \gamma_{\mathcal{C}'_0}(R^i F(E)). \quad (2.11)$$

More generally, if one has a cohomological functor (F^i) from $\mathcal{C}$ to $\mathcal{C}'$ such that for every $E \in \mathcal{C}_0$ the $F^i(E)$ are in $\mathcal{C}'_0$ and are zero except for a finite number of i , one obtains a homomorphism from $K(\mathcal{C}_0)$ to $K(\mathcal{C}'_0)$. These remarks extend to multifunctors; moreover, the classical spectral sequences give transitivity properties which we shall not make explicit.

In particular, if F is an exact functor, formula (2.11) simplifies to

$$F(\gamma_{\mathcal{C}_0}(E)) = \gamma_{\mathcal{C}'_0}(F(E)). \quad (2.11 \text{ bis})$$

This applies in particular if $\mathcal{C} = \mathcal{C}'$, if F is the identity functor, and if $\mathcal{C}_0 \subset \mathcal{C}'_0$; one has a canonical homomorphism from $K(\mathcal{C}_0)$ to $K(\mathcal{C}'_0)$.

Theorem 2.3. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an abelian category and let $\mathcal{C}_0 \subset \mathcal{C}_1$ be two subclasses such that the isomorphism classes of objects of $\mathcal{C}_1$ form a set. Suppose that the following conditions are satisfied:

- (i) For every exact sequence $0 \rightarrow A' \rightarrow A \rightarrow A'' \rightarrow 0$ in $\mathcal{C}$ such that A and A'' are in $\mathcal{C}_0$ (respectively $\mathcal{C}_1$), one has $A' \in \mathcal{C}_0$ (respectively $A' \in \mathcal{C}_1$).
- (ii) Let $u : A \rightarrow B$ and $v : C \rightarrow B$, with $A, B, C \in \mathcal{C}_1$ and u surjective. Then there exist $L \in \mathcal{C}_0$ and homomorphisms $u' : L \rightarrow C$ and $v' : L \rightarrow A$ such that u' is surjective and $vu' = uv'$.
- (iii) For every $A \in \mathcal{C}_1$ there exists an integer $d = d(A)$ such that for every left resolution L of A by objects of $\mathcal{C}_0$ one has $Z_d(L) \in \mathcal{C}_0$, where Z_d denotes the cycles in dimension d .

Under these conditions, the canonical homomorphism from $K(\mathcal{C}_0)$ to $K(\mathcal{C}_1)$ is an isomorphism.

Principle of the proof. Let $A \in \mathcal{C}_1$. By (ii) and (iii) there exists a finite resolution L of A by objects of $\mathcal{C}_0$; put

$$\ell(A) = \sum_{i \geq 0} (-1)^i \gamma_{\mathcal{C}_0}(L_i).$$

One shows that the element of $K(\mathcal{C}_0)$ thus constructed is independent of the resolution L chosen. If one has a second resolution L' , one “caps” L and L' by a third resolution L'' , with surjective homomorphisms from L'' to L and L' ; this is possible by (i) and (ii). One is then reduced to proving that $E_{\mathcal{C}_0}(L) = E_{\mathcal{C}_0}(L'')$. But the difference of the two is $E_{\mathcal{C}_0}(N)$, where N is the kernel of the surjective homomorphism from L'' to L ; this kernel is in $\mathcal{C}_0$ by (i). Since N is an acyclic complex in all dimensions, $E_{\mathcal{C}_0}(N) = 0$, whence the conclusion. Here $E_{\mathcal{C}_0}(L)$, for a finite complex with values in $\mathcal{C}_0$, denotes the Euler–Poincaré characteristic

$$\sum_i (-1)^i \gamma_{\mathcal{C}_0}(L_i).$$

One proves analogously that the function $\ell : \mathcal{C}_1 \rightarrow K(\mathcal{C}_0)$ thus constructed is additive; hence it defines a homomorphism from $K(\mathcal{C}_1)$ to $K(\mathcal{C}_0)$, and it is immediate that this homomorphism is inverse to the canonical homomorphism from $K(\mathcal{C}_0)$ to $K(\mathcal{C}_1)$. QED.

Remark. To verify (ii), it is enough to verify that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is contained in a subclass $\mathcal{C}_2$ of $\mathcal{C}$ satisfying the two conditions

(ii a) every $A \in \mathcal{C}_1$ is isomorphic to a quotient of an $L \in \mathcal{C}_2$;

(ii b) if $u : A \rightarrow B$, with $A, B \in \mathcal{C}_2$, then $\text{Ker } u \in \mathcal{C}_1$.

Corollary. Let X be a quasi-projective algebraic space. Let $\mathcal{F}(X)$ be the category of coherent algebraic sheaves on X , let $\xi(X)$ be the category of coherent locally free algebraic sheaves, equivalently vector bundles on X , and let $\mathcal{F}_0(X)$ be the category of coherent algebraic sheaves F such that, for every $x \in X$, the stalk F_x is an $\mathcal{O}_x$ -module of finite cohomological dimension. Thus $\xi(X) \subset \mathcal{F}_0(X) \subset \mathcal{F}(X)$. Then the canonical homomorphism

$$K(\xi(X)) \longrightarrow K(\mathcal{F}_0(X)) \tag{2.12}$$

is an isomorphism.

We verify the conditions of Theorem 2.3. Conditions (i) and (iii) follow from the definition of cohomological dimension and from the fact that a finite-type projective module over a noetherian local ring $\mathcal{O}_x$ is free. To verify (ii), we shall prove that $\mathcal{C} = \mathcal{F}(X)$ satisfies conditions (ii a) and (ii b) of the remark. The second is trivial; therefore it remains to prove the following result.

Proposition 2.4 (Serre). Let X be a quasi-projective algebraic space. Then every coherent algebraic sheaf on X is isomorphic to the quotient of a locally free algebraic sheaf.

This proposition is true if X is a closed subset of projective space by [2], since, for n large enough, $F(n)$ is generated by its sections, which means that F is a quotient of $\mathcal{O}(-n)^k$. In the general case, X is an open subset of a closed subset of a projective space, and it suffices to use the following result, due to Cartier and Serre in particular cases.

Proposition 2.5. Let F be a coherent algebraic sheaf on an open subset U of an algebraic space X . Then F is isomorphic to the restriction of a coherent algebraic sheaf on X .

By applying Zorn’s lemma to the opens containing U on which one can extend F , one is reduced to the case where X is affine. Let $\bar{F}$ be the algebraic sheaf on X whose sections on an open V are the sections of F on $U \cap V$. One checks easily that $\bar{F}$ is quasi-coherent, i.e. defined on every affine open V —hence here on all of X —by a module, not necessarily of finite type, over the coordinate ring of that open. This is immediate if U itself is affine, since $\bar{F}$ is then defined on the open V by $\Gamma(U \cap V, F)$ considered as a module over $\Gamma(V, \mathcal{O}_X)$. In the general case, U is a finite union of affine opens U_i , hence $\bar{F}$ is the kernel of the evident homomorphism of quasi-coherent sheaves

$$\prod_i \bar{F}|_{U_i} \longrightarrow \prod_{i,j} \bar{F}|_{U_i \cap U_j},$$

and is therefore itself quasi-coherent. Since X is affine, $\overline{F}$ is generated by its sections. Since $\overline{F}|_U = F$ is coherent, there exists a finite number of sections of $\overline{F}$ which generate F on U . These sections generate a coherent subsheaf of $\overline{F}$ whose restriction to U is isomorphic to F . QED.

Now suppose that X is nonsingular and quasi-projective. By the theorem on syzygies, one has, with the notation of the corollary to Theorem 2.3,

$$\mathcal{F}_0(X) = \mathcal{F}(X).$$

In this case, therefore,

$$K(\xi(X)) = K(\mathcal{F}(X)). \quad (2.13)$$

One may express this isomorphism as follows.

Corollary 2 to Theorem 2.3. Let X be a nonsingular quasi-projective variety. For every abelian group A , there is a one-to-one correspondence between additive functions f of vector bundles on X with values in A , and additive functions g of coherent algebraic sheaves on X with values in A . To every f there corresponds the unique g such that

$$f(E) = g(\mathcal{O}_X(E)) \quad (2.14)$$

for every vector bundle E on X , where $\mathcal{O}_X(E)$ denotes the sheaf of germs of regular sections of E on X .

To compute $g(F)$ for an arbitrary coherent algebraic sheaf, one considers a finite resolution of F by sheaves of the form $\mathcal{O}_X(E_i)$, and one then has

$$g(F) = \sum_i (-1)^i f(E_i). \quad (2.14 \text{ bis})$$

In particular, if X is connected, in §1 we considered an additive function $\tilde{C}(E)$ of the vector bundle E , with values in the group $A = \tilde{A}(X)$. We deduce from it an additive function of coherent sheaves, say $\tilde{C}(F)$, and, by passing to components, functions

$$F \longmapsto c^i(F) \in A^i(X).$$

The $c^i(F)$ are called the *Chern classes of the coherent sheaf F* . Theoretically they are computed from the Chern classes of vector bundles by (2.14 bis), with the understanding that in the second member one must pass to multiplicative notation. As for the component of $\tilde{C}(F)$ in $\mathbb{Z}$, it is the rank of the sheaf F , corresponding to the rank of a module over an integral domain: if X is affine, to which one can always reduce, F is defined by a finite-type module over the coordinate ring of X , and one takes the rank of this module.

3. Functorial generalities on $K(X)$

If X is an algebraic space, put, for brevity,

$$K(X) = K(\mathcal{F}(X)).$$

When X is nonsingular and quasi-projective, identify this group with $K(\xi(X))$ by the corollary 2 to Theorem 2.3. Since $K(\xi(X))$ is not only an abelian group but a λ -ring, it follows by transport of structure that $K(X)$ is also a λ -ring, and is therefore provided with a multiplicative structure and operations λ^i . It is important to define these structures directly, without passing through vector bundles; this will be done below.

If E is a vector bundle on X , denote by $\gamma(E)$ its class in $K(X)$. If F is a coherent algebraic sheaf on X , $\gamma(F)$ denotes in the same way its class in $K(X)$. If Y is an irreducible subvariety of

X , put $\gamma(Y) = \gamma(\mathcal{O}_Y)$, where $\mathcal{O}_Y$ denotes the sheaf of local rings of Y , considered as a coherent algebraic sheaf on X . By linearity, one defines the symbol $\gamma(Y)$ when Y is any cycle on X . When there is risk of confusion, one writes γ_X for γ .

Let X be an arbitrary algebraic space. We introduce on $K(X)$ a filtration, denoting by $K(X)^i$ the subgroup of $K(X)$ generated by the $\gamma(F)$ with

$$\dim \text{Supp } F \leq n - i,$$

where n is the dimension of X . From Serre's dévissage lemma, in the form given in [3], follows the following result.

Proposition 2.6. The group $K(X)^i$ is generated by the $\gamma(Y)$, where Y runs through the subvarieties of dimension $n - i$ of X . If X is irreducible, then $\text{Gr}^0(K(X)) = \mathbb{Z}$.

The latter isomorphism is given by the homomorphism from $K(X)$ to $\mathbb{Z}$ defined with the aid of the notion of rank of a coherent algebraic sheaf.

Now suppose that X is nonsingular. Following the developments at the beginning of §2, define a multiplication in $K(X)$ by putting

$$\gamma(F)\gamma(G) = \sum_{i \geq 0} (-1)^i \gamma(\text{Tor}_i(F, G)), \quad (2.15)$$

the Tor_i being taken, of course, with respect to the local rings of X . The exact sequence of the Tor_i shows that formula (2.15) indeed defines a biadditive map from $K(X) \times K(X)$ to $K(X)$; associativity follows from the spectral sequence of multiple Tors. One also verifies in this way that one can compute the product of several factors by the formula

$$\gamma(F_1) \cdots \gamma(F_n) = \sum_{i \geq 0} (-1)^i \gamma(\text{Tor}_i(F_1, \dots, F_n)), \quad (2.16)$$

where, in the second member, the Tor_i are simultaneous Tors, computed by simultaneous projective resolution of the arguments F_i .

If in (2.15) one supposes that G is locally free, one finds

$$\gamma(F)\gamma(G) = \gamma(F \otimes G), \quad (2.15 \text{ bis})$$

which shows in particular that $\gamma(\mathcal{O}_X)$ is the unit element of $K(X)$, and that the canonical homomorphism from $K(\xi(X))$ to $K(X)$ is a homomorphism of rings.

Formula (2.15) is evidently suggested by Serre's "Tor formula" in intersection theory. This formula proves the second part of the following proposition, the first part following immediately from (2.15) and from a local Tor calculation.

Proposition 2.7. Let X be a nonsingular variety, and let Y and Z be two cycles in X . If Y and Z meet everywhere transversely, then

$$\gamma(Y)\gamma(Z) = \gamma(Y \cdot Z). \quad (2.17)$$

If Y and Z are homogeneous and of respective dimensions $n - i$ and $n - j$, and if they meet without an excessive component, then

$$\gamma_X(Y)\gamma_X(Z) = \gamma_X(Y \cdot Z) \mod K(X)^{i+j+1}. \quad (2.18)$$

One must be careful: equality does not in general hold in (2.18). We shall see in §4 that, if X is nonsingular and quasi-projective, the ring structure of $K(X)$ is compatible with its filtration, and

that the associated graded ring $\text{Gr}(K(X))$ is identified with a quotient of $A(X)$ by a subgroup of torsion, perhaps always zero.¹¹

I do not know how to define directly the $\lambda^i(F)$ in terms of sheaves except when the field k has characteristic 0; this is the reason that has prevented us from proving the Riemann–Roch theorem when k is not of characteristic 0. Let F be a coherent algebraic sheaf on X on which the group $\mathfrak{S}_p$ of permutations of p letters operates. Denote by F^{alt} the set of $x \in F$ such that

$$s \cdot x = \varepsilon(s)x$$

for every $s \in \mathfrak{S}_p$, where $\varepsilon(s)$ is the signature of s . It is evidently a coherent algebraic subsheaf of F . This said, one has:

Theorem 2.8. Let X be a nonsingular quasi-projective variety over a field k of characteristic 0. Let F be a coherent algebraic sheaf on X . Then

$$\lambda^p(\gamma(F)) = \sum_{i \geq 0} (-1)^i \gamma \left((\text{Tor}_i(F, F, \dots, F))^{\text{alt}} \right). \quad (2.19)$$

Here it is clear that the group $\mathfrak{S}_p$ operates on the sheaf $\text{Tor}_i(F, \dots, F)$.

Principle of the proof. One considers a finite resolution L of F by locally free sheaves L_i , and uses the following general lemma.

Lemma 2.9. Let $L = (L_i)$ be a graded locally free coherent algebraic sheaf with only finitely many nonzero components. In $K(X)$ one has the formula

$$E \left((\otimes^p L)^{\text{alt}} \right) = \lambda^p(E(L)). \quad (2.20)$$

In this formula, $\otimes^p L$ is considered as a sheaf on which the group $\mathfrak{S}_p$ acts, taking the gradings into account; the gradings therefore introduce signs in the usual way, cf. Cartan–Eilenberg. Moreover, if M is a graded coherent algebraic sheaf on X , put

$$E(M) = \sum_i (-1)^i \gamma(M_i).$$

To prove formula (2.20), one is reduced to proving the analogous formula in $K(G)$, where G is an algebraic group, for instance a product of groups $\text{Gl}(n, k)$, and where L is a finite-dimensional G -module over k (cf. Chapter I, §2, Example 2, for the definition of $K(G)$). In that case, this formula has already been used in Theorem 1.4 to show that the second member of (1.33) satisfies the same functional equation as the first member; the verification is elementary. QED.

Let f be a morphism from X to Y , where Y is an algebraic space. The notion of inverse image of vector bundle defines a homomorphism

$$f^! : K(\xi(Y)) \longrightarrow K(\xi(X))$$

of λ -rings. Identifying vector bundles with locally free coherent algebraic sheaves, the notion of inverse image of vector bundle corresponds to the notion of inverse image of algebraic sheaf, already used in [3, no. 8]. When Y is nonsingular, one defines more generally a homomorphism of groups

$$f^! : K(Y) \longrightarrow K(X) \quad (2.21)$$

¹¹No: for a counterexample see this seminar, XIV 4.7.

by a formula involving an alternating sum of Tors, inspired by the developments at the beginning of §2, and which the reader will spell out. One then has commutativity in the following diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} K(\xi(Y)) & \xrightarrow{f^!} & K(\xi(X)) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ K(Y) & \xrightarrow{f^!} & K(X), \end{array}$$

which shows in particular, when X and Y are both nonsingular and quasi-projective, that the two definitions of $f^!$ coincide under the identifications of $K(X)$ with $K(\xi(X))$ and of $K(Y)$ with $K(\xi(Y))$.

Another case where one can define a homomorphism (2.21), without Y necessarily nonsingular, is the case where the functor $F \mapsto f^!(F)$ from $\mathcal{F}(Y)$ to $\mathcal{F}(X)$ is exact, i.e. where the local rings of X are flat modules over the local rings of Y . It is enough then to put

$$f^!(\gamma_Y(F)) = \gamma_X(f^!(F)).$$

This case occurs in particular when X is a locally trivial fibre space over Y ; to see this, one is reduced to the case of a product $X = Y \times T$. Note that one also verifies that in this case one has $f^!(\mathcal{O}_Z) = \mathcal{O}_{f^{-1}(Z)}$ if Z is an irreducible subvariety of Y , whence

$$f^!(\gamma_Y(Z)) = \gamma_X(f^{-1}(Z)) \quad (2.22)$$

if X is flat over Y . Without this latter condition, formula (2.22) becomes false in general, but one has the following analogue of Proposition 2.7.

Proposition 2.8. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of nonsingular varieties, and let Z be a cycle on Y . If Z is everywhere transverse to f , formula (2.22) is exact. If Z is homogeneous of codimension i and if $f^{-1}(Z)$ has no excessive component, then

$$f^!(\gamma_Y(Z)) = \gamma_X(f^{-1}(Z)) \mod K(X)^{i+1}. \quad (2.23)$$

The proof is analogous to that of Proposition 2.7.

Finally, let X and Y again be arbitrary algebraic spaces, and let f be a proper morphism from X to Y . For every coherent algebraic sheaf F on X , the direct image sheaf $f_*(F)$ is coherent algebraic, and the same holds more generally for the sheaves $R^i f_*(F)$ (cf. [3]). Recall that, by definition, $R^i f_*(F)$ is the sheaf on Y associated with the presheaf which sends an open U to the group $H^i(f^{-1}(U), F)$; in particular

$$R^0 f_*(F) = f_*(F), \quad R^q f_*(F) = 0 \quad (q > \dim X), \quad (2.24)$$

and moreover

$$\Gamma(U, R^q f_*(F)) = H^q(f^{-1}(U), F) \quad (2.25)$$

if the open U is affine. According to §2, one defines a homomorphism from $K(X)$ to $K(Y)$, still denoted f_* , by the formula

$$f_*(\gamma(F)) = \sum_{q=0}^{\infty} (-1)^q \gamma(R^q f_*(F)). \quad (2.26)$$

Thus $K(X)$ becomes a covariant functor in X relative to proper morphisms. The relation $(fg)_* = f_* g_*$, just like the relation $(fg)^! = g^! f^!$ which we forgot to mention in its place, is a

particular case of the transitivity relations alluded to in §2 and which follow from the spectral sequences of composed functors.

Let us note the following formula, valid for Y nonsingular and particularly easy to verify when Y is also quasi-projective by taking for y the class of a vector bundle on Y :

$$f_*(x \cdot f^!(y)) = f_*(x) \cdot y \quad (x \in K(X), y \in K(Y)). \quad (2.27)$$

In the particular case where the inverse images of the points of Y by f are finite and contained in an affine open,¹² one checks that the functor $F \mapsto f_*(F)$ is exact and that $R^q f_*(F) = 0$ for $q > 0$. In this case, therefore, $f_*(\gamma_X(F)) = \gamma_Y(f_*(F))$. In particular, if X is an algebraic subspace of Y and if i is the canonical injection of X into Y , then

$$i_*(\gamma_X(F)) = \gamma_Y(F), \quad (2.28)$$

where, in the second member, F is considered as a sheaf on Y which is zero outside X .

4. Some technical results

Let X be an algebraic space. We have seen in §3 that the projection p from $X \times k$ to X defines a homomorphism

$$p^! : K(X) \longrightarrow K(X \times k). \quad (2.29)$$

Proposition 2.9. The homomorphism (2.29) is surjective.

We argue by induction on $n = \dim X$. The assertion is trivial if $n < 0$; suppose $n \geq 0$. By Proposition 2.6, it is enough to verify that for every irreducible closed subset Y of $X \times k$, $\gamma(Y)$ is in the image of $p^!$. It is enough to continue the reasoning by supposing X irreducible. If $p(Y)$ is not dense in X , our assertion follows from the induction hypothesis. Otherwise, either $Y = X \times k$ and the assertion is trivial, or Y is a hypersurface in $X \times k$. Let U be an affine open of X formed of nonsingular points. If D is the divisor on $U \times k$ induced by Y , one knows by commutative algebra that it is linearly equivalent to a divisor of the form $D' \times k$, where D' is a divisor on U . Then

$$\gamma_{U \times k}(D) - \gamma_{U \times k}(D' \times k)$$

belongs to $K(U \times k)^2$ by the corollary to Proposition 2.10, and by what has already been proved this element is of the form $p^!(x')$ with $x' \in K(U)$. Thus

$$\gamma_{U \times k}(D) = p^!(x' + \gamma_U(D')),$$

but x' is the restriction of an element y of $K(X)$ by Proposition 2.10, and consequently the restriction of $\gamma_{X \times k}(D) - p^!(y)$ to $U \times k$ is zero. By Proposition 2.10, $\gamma_{X \times k}(D) - p^!(y)$ comes from an element of

$$K(X \times k - U \times k) = K(X' \times k), \quad X' = X - U.$$

The proof is finished by applying the induction hypothesis again. QED.

Corollary. Let X be an algebraic space and let p be the projection from $X \times k^n$ to X . Then the homomorphism

$$p^! : K(X) \longrightarrow K(X \times k^n)$$

is surjective; it is even bijective if X is nonsingular.

¹²This latter condition is evidently a consequence of the first, something the author still did not know in 1957!

The first assertion is by induction on n . For the second, put $f(x) = (x, 0)$, whence $pf = 1$ and $f^!p^! = 1$, which proves that $p^!$ is injective.

Proposition 2.10. Let X be an algebraic space, let U be an open subset of X , and let Y be its complement in X . Then the sequence of natural homomorphisms

$$K(Y) \longrightarrow K(X) \longrightarrow K(U) \longrightarrow 0 \quad (2.30)$$

is exact.

N.B. Compare with Proposition 2.3.

The fact that $K(X) \rightarrow K(U)$ is surjective follows at once from Proposition 2.5, or also from Proposition 2.6. It remains to prove that if $x \in K(X)$ has zero restriction in $K(U)$, then it is in the image of $K(Y)$. For this, return to the explicit definition of $K(X)$ and $K(U)$. There are two coherent algebraic sheaves F and G on X with

$$x = \gamma_X(F) - \gamma_X(G)$$

and

$$\gamma_U(F) - \gamma_U(G) = 0.$$

This latter relation means that one can find coherent sheaves P' and Q' on U , provided with filtrations whose factors are pairwise isomorphic on U , and such that one has an isomorphism on U

$$P = F + Q' \longrightarrow Q = G + P'.$$

By Proposition 2.5, the sheaves P' and Q' are restrictions to U of coherent sheaves on X , denoted by the same letters; in the same way, their filtrations come from filtrations on the corresponding sheaves on X , by Lemma 2.11 below. One then has

$$\gamma_X(F) - \gamma_X(G) = (\gamma_X(P) - \gamma_X(Q)) + (\gamma_X(P') - \gamma_X(Q')).$$

Introducing the factors P_i and Q_i of the filtrations of P' and Q' on X , the last term is the sum of terms $\gamma_X(P_i) - \gamma_X(Q_i)$, where $P_i|_U \simeq Q_i|_U$. We are thus reduced to proving the following particular case: if R and S are coherent sheaves on X such that $R|_U \simeq S|_U$, then $\gamma_X(R) - \gamma_X(S)$ is in the image of $K(Y)$. Let T be the graph of the given isomorphism from $R|_U$ to $S|_U$; it is a coherent subsheaf of $(R \times S)|_U$, hence by Lemma 2.11 it is the restriction to U of a coherent subsheaf, again denoted T , of $R \times S$. Then

$$\gamma_X(R) - \gamma_X(S) = (\gamma_X(R) - \gamma_X(T)) - (\gamma_X(S) - \gamma_X(T)),$$

and it is enough to prove, for instance, that the first term of the second member is in the image of $K(Y)$. But the projection $u : T \rightarrow R$ is an isomorphism over U , hence

$$\gamma_X(R) - \gamma_X(T) = \gamma_X(\text{Coker } u) - \gamma_X(\text{Ker } u),$$

and $\text{Ker } u$ and $\text{Coker } u$ have support in Y .

It remains, then, to prove the following lemma.

Lemma 2.11. Let X be an algebraic space, let F be a coherent algebraic sheaf on X , let U be an open subset of X , and let G be a coherent subsheaf of $F|_U$. Then G is the restriction to U of a coherent subsheaf of F .

Let $\overline{G}$ be the subsheaf of F whose sections on an open V of X are the sections of F on V whose restriction to $U \cap V$ is a section of G . Everything amounts to proving that this sheaf $\overline{G}$ is coherent. For this one may suppose X and U affine, because U is a union of affine opens U_i

and $\overline{G}$ is then the intersection of the analogous sheaves $\overline{G|U_i}$. Then the coordinate ring of U is a ring of fractions A_S of the coordinate ring A of X , and one immediately verifies that if F is defined by the A -module M , then $F|_U$ is defined by the A_S -module

$$M_S = A_S \otimes_A M.$$

The subsheaf G of $F|_U$ is then defined by a submodule N' of M_S , and one sees that $\overline{G}$ is precisely defined by the submodule N of M , inverse image of N' under the canonical homomorphism from M to M_S . QED.

Corollary 1 to Proposition 2.10. Let $x \in K(X)$. Then $x \in K(X)^i$ if and only if there exists a closed subset Y of X , of dimension $\leq n - i$, such that the restriction of x to $X - Y$ is zero.

Corollary 2. Suppose X is connected of dimension n , with no singularities in dimension $n - 1$. If D and D' are two linearly equivalent divisors on X , then

$$\gamma(D) = \gamma(D') \mod K(X)^2.$$

By Corollary 1, one may suppose X nonsingular. The corollary then follows from the general formula

$$\gamma(D) = 1 - \gamma(L(-D)) \mod K(X)^2, \quad (2.31)$$

where $L(-D)$ denotes the rank-one vector bundle defined by the divisor $-D$. To verify (2.31), one writes it in the form

$$\gamma(L(-D)) = 1 - \gamma(D) \mod K(X)^2, \quad (2.31 \text{ bis})$$

and notes that the two members are homomorphisms from the group of divisors to the multiplicative group of invertible elements of the ring $K(X)/K(X)^2$. Here $K(X)^1/K(X)^2$ has square zero, which is very easily verified on the explicit formula (2.15), using Corollary 1. Thus one is reduced to the case where D is an irreducible hypersurface. More generally, if D is a hypersurface whose components are disjoint, one has the equality

$$\gamma(D) = 1 - \gamma(L(-D)), \quad (2.32)$$

as follows from the exact sequence of sheaves

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(L(-D)) \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_X \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_D \longrightarrow 0.$$

Theorem 2.12. Let X be a nonsingular quasi-projective variety, and let Z and Z' be two homogeneous cycles of codimension p on X which are linearly equivalent. Then

$$\gamma_X(Z) = \gamma_X(Z') \mod K(X)^{p+1}. \quad (2.33)$$

By hypothesis, one can find a cycle Y of dimension $n - p + 1$ on $X \times k$ (n being the dimension of X), and two points $a, a' \in k$, such that

$$Z = Y \cdot (X \times a), \quad Z' = Y \cdot (X \times a').$$

By formula (2.23), one then has

$$\gamma_X(Z) = i_a^!(\gamma_{X \times k}(Y)) \mod K(X)^{p+1},$$

and an analogous formula for $\gamma_X(Z')$. It is therefore enough to prove that $i_a^! = i_{a'}^!$, which follows at once from Proposition 2.9. QED.

Corollary 1. The filtration of $K(X)$ is compatible with its ring structure, i.e. one has

$$K(X)^i K(X)^j \subset K(X)^{i+j}$$

for all integers $i, j \geq 0$. Moreover there is a natural surjective homomorphism of graded rings

$$\varphi : A(X) \longrightarrow \text{Gr}(K(X)), \quad (2.34)$$

where the second member denotes the graded ring associated with $K(X)$, provided with the filtration $(K(X)^i)_{i \geq 0}$, defined by the condition

$$\varphi(\ell(Z^{n-p})) = \gamma(Z^{n-p}) \mod K(X)^{p+1}.$$

This corollary follows immediately from Theorem 2.12, Propositions 2.6 and 2.7, and Chow's theorem 2.1, by induction on the integer $i + j$.

Corollary 2. Let X and Y be two nonsingular quasi-projective varieties and let f be a morphism from X to Y . Then the homomorphism $f^!$ from $K(Y)$ to $K(X)$ is compatible with the filtrations, and one has a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A(Y) & \xrightarrow{\varphi_Y} & \text{Gr}(K(Y)) \\ f^* \downarrow & & \downarrow \text{Gr}(f^!) \\ A(X) & \xrightarrow{\varphi_X} & \text{Gr}(K(X)). \end{array}$$

Using the graph of f , decompose f as the product of an immersion of X into $X \times Y$ and of a projection of $X \times Y$ onto Y . For the latter the corollary is trivial, and for an immersion one proceeds as for Corollary 1, using Proposition 2.8 in place of Proposition 2.7.

Proposition 2.13 (“cellular decomposition”). Let P be an algebraic space, irreducible or not, provided with an increasing family

$$P^0 \subset P^1 \subset \dots \subset P^n = P$$

of closed subsets, such that for every i with $0 \leq i \leq n$, the connected components of $P^i - P^{i-1}$ are algebraic spaces $V_{i,\alpha}$ isomorphic to k^i ; put $P^{-1} = \emptyset$. Then:

- a) For every algebraic space X , the natural map from $K(X) \otimes K(P)$ to $K(X \times P)$, deduced from the tensor product of sheaves on X and P , is surjective.
- b) The $\gamma_P(V_{i,\alpha})$ form a system of generators of the group $K(P)$.

The proof is by induction on n , using the corollary to Proposition 2.9 and Proposition 2.10. N.B. Unfortunately, I do not know whether the $\gamma_P(V_{i,\alpha})$ form a basis of $K(P)$ or whether the homomorphism considered in a) is bijective. We shall not need to know this below.

Theorem 2.14. Let x_i ($1 \leq i \leq q$) and E_j ($1 \leq j \leq r$) be letters, and let n_j ($1 \leq j \leq r$) be positive integers. Consider the symbols $\lambda^k(x_i)$ with $k \geq 1$ and $\lambda^k(E_j)$ with $1 \leq k \leq n_j$ as indeterminates, and let R be a polynomial with integral coefficients in these indeterminates. Suppose that, for every graded ring A , when one substitutes in R elements ξ_i for the x_i and elements

$$\eta_j = [n_j, 1 + \eta_j^{(1)} + \dots + \eta_j^{(n_j)}]$$

of $\tilde{A}$ for the E_j , subject to the restrictions $\varepsilon(\xi_i) = 0$ and $\eta_j^{(k)} = 0$ for $k > n_j$, one has

$$R((\lambda^k(\xi_i)), (\lambda^k(\eta_j))) \in \tilde{A}^p.$$

Then, if X is an irreducible nonsingular quasi-projective variety, for arbitrary elements x'_i of $K(X)^1$ and vector bundles E'_j of dimension n_j on X ($1 \leq i \leq q$, $1 \leq j \leq r$), one has

$$R((\lambda^k(x'_i)), (\lambda^k(\gamma(E'_j)))) \in K(X)^p. \quad (*)$$

Proof. By §2, the x'_i are themselves differences of elements of the form $\gamma(E)$, with E a vector bundle. On the other hand, assuming X locally closed in a projective space P , it follows from §2 and Proposition 2.5 that, for every $F \in \mathcal{F}(X)$, the sheaf $F(n)$ is generated by its sections for n sufficiently large. If F is defined by a vector bundle E , this proves that $E(n)$ is the inverse image of the canonical vector bundle on a Grassmannian variety G by a morphism from X to G . Considering the corresponding morphism from X to $P \times G$, one sees that F is the inverse image of a vector bundle on $P \times G$. Applying this to all vector bundles which occur, and using Corollary 2 to Theorem 2.12, we are reduced to the case where X is a product of Grassmannians. In this case the conclusion will follow from the following lemma.

Lemma 2.15. Suppose that X is a product of Grassmannians. Then one can find a λ -homomorphism from $K(X)$ to a torsion-free λ -ring of the form $\tilde{A}$, where A is a graded ring, compatible with filtrations, and such that the corresponding homomorphism $\text{Gr}(K(X)) \rightarrow \text{Gr}(A)$ is injective.

To prove the lemma, we shall use Chow's theory of Chern classes. If one could prove the lemma, or Theorem 2.14 directly, one would deduce a purely "sheaf-theoretic" theory of Chern classes; cf. §5.

We shall consider the homomorphism $\tilde{C}$ from $K(X)$ to $\tilde{A}(X)$ and put $A = A(X)$. It remains to prove that the homomorphism $\psi = \text{Gr}(\tilde{C})$ from $\text{Gr}(K(X))$ to $\text{Gr}(A(X)) \simeq A(X)$ is injective. The fact that $\tilde{C}$ is compatible with filtrations is true for every nonsingular quasi-projective variety and follows easily from the corollary to Proposition 2.3. On the other hand, since X is a product of Grassmannians G_j , there are vector bundles E_j on X , inverse images of the canonical bundles on the factors. We shall use the following known facts:

- a) On X , linear equivalence of cycles is equivalent to numerical equivalence, and $A(X)$ is a group of finite rank.
- b) The $c^i(E_j)$ generate the ring $A(X)$.

From a) it follows that

$$\varphi : A(X) \longrightarrow \text{Gr}(K(X))$$

is injective, and hence bijective, by the following lemma.

Lemma 2.15. Let X^n be a nonsingular projective variety and let Z^{n-p} be a cycle on X such that $\varphi(Z) \in \text{Gr}^p(K(X))$ is zero. Then Z^{n-p} is numerically equivalent to zero.

To prove this lemma, it suffices to use the additive function

$$\chi(F) = \sum_{i \geq 0} (-1)^i \dim H^i(X, F)$$

and the fact that this function is equal to 1 for $F = \mathcal{O}_{(x)}$ for every $x \in X$.

Thus, in the case under consideration, $A(X)$ and $\text{Gr}(K(X))$ have the same finite rank in every degree, and $\text{Gr}(K(X))$ is torsion-free, since this is true of $A(X)$. From assertion b) above it follows, in a formal way, that the map $\tilde{C}$ from $K(X)$ to $\tilde{A}(X)$ is surjective modulo finite groups. Since $\text{Gr}(K(X))$ and $A(X)$ have the same finite rank in every degree, it then follows easily that the homomorphism $\text{Gr}(\tilde{C})$ from $\text{Gr}(K(X))$ to $\text{Gr}(\tilde{A}(X))$ is bijective modulo finite

groups in every degree; one uses induction on the degree. Since $\text{Gr}(K(X))$ is torsion-free, this homomorphism $\text{Gr}(\tilde{C})$ is therefore injective. QED.

N.B. The homomorphism $\tilde{C}$ is not surjective in general, even if X is a projective space of dimension 2.

5. Sheaf-theoretic definition of Chern classes. Application to the study of injection morphisms

Theorem 2.16. Let X be a nonsingular quasi-projective variety. Then, for every $x \in K(X)$ and every integer $i \geq 0$, the element $\gamma^i(x - \varepsilon(x))$ is of filtration $\geq i$. Let $c^i(x) \in \text{Gr}^i(K(X))$ be the class of this element modulo $K(X)^{i+1}$. If one puts

$$\tilde{c}(x) = \left[\varepsilon(x), 1 + \sum_{i \geq 0} c^i(x) \right] \in \text{Gr}(\widetilde{K(X)}),$$

then $\tilde{c}$ satisfies conditions analogous to those of Theorem 2.2.

The first assertion follows from Theorem 2.14, as does the fact that $x \mapsto \tilde{c}(x)$ is a homomorphism of λ -rings; formula (1.25) implies $\gamma_t(x + y) = \gamma_t(x)\gamma_t(y)$, which already shows that $\tilde{c}$ is an additive homomorphism. The functoriality of $\tilde{c}$ is verified immediately, and (2.8) follows from (2.31). QED.

Corollary 1. One has

$$c^i(x) = \varphi(c^i(x)).$$

This follows from a uniqueness theorem for Chern classes, proved as in Hirzebruch by passage to flag varieties. One only has to show that, if Y is a flag variety associated with a vector bundle on X , then $\text{Gr}(K(X)) \rightarrow \text{Gr}(K(Y))$ is injective; this is verified by the explicit determination of $K(Y)$, with all its structures, from $K(X)$. I shall not give the details here.

Corollary 2. Suppose that for every element $Z \in A(X)$ there exists a morphism f from X to a product X' of Grassmannians such that Z is in the image of f^* . Then the canonical homomorphisms

$$\varphi : A(X) \longrightarrow \text{Gr}(K(X)), \quad \psi : \text{Gr}(K(X)) \longrightarrow A(X)$$

satisfy, in dimension i , the relations

$$\psi\varphi = (-1)^{i-1}(i-1)!1, \quad \varphi\psi = (-1)^{i-1}(i-1)!1. \quad (2.35)$$

Since φ is surjective, it is clearly enough to prove the first formula, and for this one may suppose that X is a product of Grassmannians. Since then φ is injective, it is enough to prove the second formula (2.35), which by Corollary 1 is written

$$\gamma^i(x - \varepsilon(x)) = (-1)^{i-1}(i-1)!x \mod K(X)^{i+1}$$

for every $x \in K(X)^i$. Since ψ is injective, it is enough to prove the analogous relation for $\tilde{C}(x) \in A(X)^i$, and this is then a consequence of (1.22 bis).

Remark. Corollary 2 makes plausible the validity of (2.35) in all cases; there should exist a direct proof of it. In every case one proves easily the second formula (2.35) modulo the torsion subgroup of $\text{Gr}(K(X))$, and in characteristic 0 this same formula is a consequence of the Riemann–Roch theorem. The interest of (2.35), when true, lies in the fact that it shows that φ is injective modulo torsion groups, perhaps always zero. Thus one does not lose much by

defining Chern classes as elements of $\text{Gr}(K(X))$. If one tensors with $\mathbb{Q}$, as will be done later for the Riemann–Roch theorem, the two definitions of Chern classes would then be identical.

Let X still be nonsingular and quasi-projective. Let in addition Y be a nonsingular subvariety of X , and let i be the injection of Y into X . For i_* and $i^!$ one then has the following formulas:

(i) $i^!$ is a homomorphism of λ -rings.

(ii) $i_*(x \cdot i^!(y)) = i_*(x) \cdot y$, whence in particular

$$i_*i^!(y) = \xi y, \quad \text{with } \xi = i_*i^!(1) = \gamma_X(N).$$

(iii) $i^!i_*(x) = x \cdot \lambda_{-1}(N)$, whence in particular

$$i^!(\xi) = i^!i_*(1) = \lambda_{-1}(N).$$

(iv) $i_*(x)i_*(x') = i_*(xx'\lambda_{-1}(N))$.

Here, by definition, N is the class in $K(Y)$ of the conormal bundle of Y in X . Formulas (i) and (ii) are true for arbitrary morphisms, not necessarily injections, and (iii) and (iv) are verified from the definition (2.15) and the analogous formula for inverse images, taking x and x' to be classes of vector bundles and using the fact that

$$\text{Tor}(\mathcal{O}_Y, \mathcal{O}_Y) = \Lambda(N). \quad (2.36)$$

Formula (iv) expresses that i_* is a homomorphism of rings if one introduces on $K(Y)$ a new multiplicative structure, by the definition

$$x \cdot_N x' = xx'\lambda_{-1}(N)$$

(cf. Chapter I, §4). It is completed by the formula

(v) $i_*(\lambda^p(N, x)) = \lambda^p(i_*(x))$ for $p \geq 1$,

which means that i_* defines a λ -homomorphism from $K(Y)_N$ into $K(X)$. This formula (v), certainly true in all cases, is for the moment proved only in characteristic 0, because it follows from the conjunction of Theorems 1.4 and 2.8.

There are analogous formulas for i_* and i^* :

(i bis) i^* is a homomorphism of graded rings.

(ii bis) $i_*(x \cdot i^*(y)) = i_*(x)y$, whence in particular

$$i_*i^*(y) = \xi' y, \quad \text{with } \xi' = i_*(1).$$

(iii bis) $i^*i_*(x) = x \cdot (-1)^q N^q$, whence in particular

$$i^*(\xi') = (-1)^q N^q.$$

(iv bis) $i_*(x)i_*(x') = i_*(xx'(-1)^q N^q)$.

(v bis) i_* increases degrees by q units.

In these formulas, q is the codimension of Y in X , and one puts $N^i = c^i(N)$. Only formulas (iii bis) and (iv bis) require proof. I do not know whether they are well known, or even whether they are true, and I confine myself to noting that they follow by reduction from formulas (ii) and (iv), provided one works in $\text{Gr}(K(Y))$ and $\text{Gr}(K(X))$ and not in $A(Y)$ and $A(X)$. One then uses the fact that i_* and i^* come by passage to the quotient from i_* and $i^!$, noting that i_* shifts the filtration by q units.

All universal formulas relating i_* and $i^!$, respectively i_* and i^* , are formal consequences of the preceding formulas, as one can convince oneself without great difficulty.

Formula (v) gives

$$i_*(\gamma^p(N, x)) = \gamma^p(i_*(x)).$$

The conjunction of Theorem 2.14 and Proposition 1.5 shows that $\gamma^p(N, x)$, for $p = q + j$, is of filtration $\geq j$. If one denotes by $G_{q,j}(N, x)$ its class in $\text{Gr}^j(K(Y))$, Theorem 2.16 shows that

$$i_*(G_{q,j}(N, x)) = c^p(i_*(x)).$$

Finally, Proposition 1.5 joined with Theorem 2.14 permits one to express $G_{q,j}(N, x)$ as a polynomial with integral coefficients in the $c^i(N)$, the $c^i(x)$, and $\varepsilon(x)$. One deduces the following theorem.

Theorem 2.17. Suppose the field k has characteristic 0, and let $i : Y \rightarrow X$ be an injection morphism of nonsingular quasi-projective varieties. Then one has formulas (i) to (v), and moreover, for every integer $j \geq 0$, the formula

$$c^{q+j}(i_*(x)) = i_* \left(\left(\frac{\tilde{c}(x) * \lambda_{-1}(\tilde{c}(N))}{(-1)^q N^q} \right)^{(j)} \right). \quad (2.37)$$

The second member of formula (2.37) is an abbreviated way of denoting the polynomial in the components of $\tilde{c}(x)$ and $\tilde{c}(N)$ described in Proposition 1.5.

Corollary. Under the preceding conditions one has

$$\text{ch}(\tilde{c}(i_*(x))) = i_* \left(\text{ch}(\tilde{c}(x)) \mathfrak{C}(\check{N})^{-1} \right), \quad (2.38)$$

where ch is the Chern homomorphism defined by formula (1.26).

It is enough to use (2.37) written in the form

$$\tilde{c}(i_*(x)) = 1 + i_* \left(\frac{\tilde{c}(x) * \lambda_{-1}(\tilde{c}(N)) - 1}{(-1)^q N^q} \right), \quad (2.37 \text{ bis})$$

the explicit formula (1.29), formula (iv bis), and finally (1.30).

One may write (2.38) in the form

$$\text{ch}_X(F) = i_* \left(\text{ch}_Y(F) \mathfrak{C}(T_{X/Y})^{-1} \right), \quad (2.38 \text{ bis})$$

where F is a coherent algebraic sheaf on Y (considered in the first member as a sheaf on X which is zero outside Y), where ch_X and ch_Y are the Chern homomorphisms taken respectively on X and Y , and where $T_{X/Y}$ is the normal bundle of Y in X .

Remarks. Contrary to (2.38), formula (2.37) is a “formula without denominators”. It has been proved, even in characteristic 0, only by placing oneself in $\text{Gr}(K(X))$ and not in $A(X)$, which may not be the same thing. It is certainly true in every characteristic and in $A(X)$. Let us note that one verifies at once that the images of the two members by i^* are the same; hence, applying i_* , the product of their difference by N^q is zero. This suggests a completely different

method of proof, by trying to obtain Y as a transverse inverse image of a subvariety Y' in a variety X' such that, in dimension $\leq n = \dim X$, the class of Y' in $A(X')$ is not a divisor of 0. Unfortunately one cannot hope for X' to be a Grassmannian or something close to it.

Note that, if torsion elements are neglected, formula (2.38) is equivalent to (2.37).

6. The Riemann–Roch theorem

Its statement is as follows: let f be a proper morphism from a non-singular quasi-projective variety Y into a variety X of the same kind. Then one has

$$f_*(\mathrm{ch}_Y(x) \mathfrak{C}(Y)) = \mathrm{ch}_X(f_!(x)) \mathfrak{C}(X). \quad (2.39)$$

Both sides are in $A(X) \otimes \mathbb{Q}$, and $\mathfrak{C}(X) = \mathfrak{C}(T_X)$.

This formula makes it possible to compute, up to torsion, the Chern classes of $f_!(x)$ from the Chern classes of x , those of T_X and T_Y , and the homomorphism f_* . Or, equivalently, it makes it possible to determine the homomorphism

$$f_! : K(Y) \otimes \mathbb{Q} \longrightarrow K(X) \otimes \mathbb{Q}$$

when these groups are identified, by means of the homomorphisms ch_Y and ch_X , respectively with $A(Y) \otimes \mathbb{Q}$ and $A(X) \otimes \mathbb{Q}$ (provided that formula (2.35) is true), from f_* and the Chern classes of T_X and T_Y .

I can prove formula (2.39) only in characteristic 0, and as an equality in $G(K(X)) \otimes \mathbb{Q}$. For this, since Y is locally closed in a projective space P , f is decomposed as the product of an injection of Y into $P \times X$ and a projection morphism from $P \times X$ to X , and (2.39) is proved for each of these two morphisms.

For an injection morphism, one sees immediately that formulas (2.38) and (2.39) are equivalent. The characteristic 0 hypothesis enters only through Theorem 2.8, which permits one to express the classes $\lambda^i(\gamma(F))$, for a coherent algebraic sheaf F , by local cohomological invariants of F .

For a projection morphism $f : P \times X \rightarrow X$, Proposition 2.13 permits us to suppose that x is of the form $y \otimes z$, with $y \in K(P)$ and $z \in K(X)$. Then the Künneth formula gives

$$f_!(x) = \chi(y) z,$$

where, for a coherent algebraic sheaf F on P , one puts

$$\chi(F) = \sum_{i \geq 0} (-1)^i \dim H^i(P, F).$$

One is therefore at once reduced to proving the formula

$$\chi(F) = \pi_r(\mathrm{ch}_P(F) \mathfrak{C}(P)), \quad (2.40)$$

where π_r denotes the component of degree $r = \dim P$. By Proposition 2.13, one may suppose that $F = \mathcal{O}_Q$, where Q is a linear subvariety of P . Then $\chi(F) = 1$, since this is the arithmetic genus of Q ; it remains only to see that the second member of (2.40) is 1.

Indeed, if V is a hyperplane of P and if one puts

$$\xi = \gamma_P(\mathcal{O}_V), \quad L = \ell(V),$$

then

$$1 - \xi = \gamma_P(E(-L)),$$

where $E(-L)$ is the vector bundle defined by $-L$. Hence

$$C_p(1 - \xi) = [1, 1 - L],$$

and consequently

$$\mathrm{ch}_p(1 - \xi) = e^{-L}, \quad \mathrm{ch}_p(\xi) = 1 - e^{-L},$$

and therefore

$$\mathrm{ch}_p(\xi^p) = (1 - e^{-L})^p.$$

If p is the dimension of Q in P , one has $\xi^p = \gamma_P(Q)$; hence

$$\mathrm{ch}_p(F) \mathfrak{C}(P) = (L/(1 - e^{-L}))^{r+1} (1 - e^{-L})^p.$$

It remains to verify that the coefficient of L^r in this formal series in L is 1. This follows from the characteristic property of the formal series $L/(1 - e^{-L})$, namely that the coefficient of L^q in $(L/(1 - e^{-L}))^{q+1}$ is 1 (put $q = r + 1 - p$).

Bibliographical references

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Proof of the Riemann–Roch theorem

(Grothendieck, 1 November 1957)

Reminder of notation

These are the notations of the “Report on Riemann–Roch,” cited as RRR below.

All varieties considered are non-singular and quasi-projective, that is, isomorphic to a locally closed subvariety of a projective space. The base field is algebraically closed, of arbitrary characteristic.

If X is such a variety, $K(X)$ denotes the abelian group generated by the classes of coherent sheaves on X , modulo the identification coming from an extension into a sum; the alternating sum of Tor makes $K(X)$ a ring. If F is a sheaf, respectively E a vector bundle, respectively Y a subvariety of X , one denotes by $\gamma_X(F)$, respectively $\gamma_X(E)$, respectively $\gamma_X(Y)$, the element of $K(X)$ corresponding to F , respectively to E , respectively to $\mathcal{O}_Y$. In fact, one often writes simply F, E instead of $\gamma_X(F)$.

Let $A(X)$ be the graded ring of classes of cycles on X for rational equivalence (cf. Chow); $A^i(X)$ is formed by the cycles of codimension i . If E is a vector bundle, $C(E) = \sum C^i(E)$, with $C^i(E) \in A^i(X)$, is its Chern class (defined as inverse image of Schubert cycles). By linearity one deduces the classes $C^i(y)$, for all $y \in K(X)$. If

$$C(y) = \prod (1 + a_i),$$

one sets, following Hirzebruch,

$$\mathrm{ch}(y) = \sum e^{a_i}, \quad T(y) = \prod \frac{a_i}{1 - e^{-a_i}}.$$

These are elements of $A(X) \otimes \mathbb{Q}$. When y is the tangent bundle of X , one writes $T(X)$ instead of $T(y)$.

If G is a vector bundle, $\lambda^p G$ denotes its p -th exterior power and

$$\lambda_{-1}(G) = \sum (-1)^p \lambda^p(G);$$

this is an element of $K(X)$.

If f is a proper regular map from a variety Y into a variety X , one defines homomorphisms

$$f^* : A(X) \longrightarrow A(Y), \quad f_* : A(Y) \longrightarrow A(X).$$

The first is homogeneous of degree 0 and multiplicative. The second is homogeneous of degree $\dim X - \dim Y$. One also defines homomorphisms

$$f^* : K(X) \longrightarrow K(Y), \quad f_! : K(Y) \longrightarrow K(X).$$

If F is a coherent sheaf on X , $f^*(F)$ is, by definition, the alternating sum of the $\text{Tor}_p^{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_Y, F)$. For vector bundles, this is simply the inverse-image operation.

If G is a coherent sheaf on Y , $f_*(G)$ is coherent on X . If $R^p f_*$ denotes the p -th derived functor of the functor f_* so defined, one has, by definition,

$$f_!(G) = \sum (-1)^p R^p f_*(G).$$

Riemann–Roch theorem

Let $f : Y \rightarrow X$ be a proper morphism (regular map) from a non-singular quasi-projective variety Y into another such variety X , and let $y \in K(Y)$. Then

$$f_*(\text{ch}(y)T(Y)) = \text{ch}(f_!(y))T(X) \quad \text{in } A(X) \otimes \mathbb{Q}. \quad (1)$$

Proof (abridged).

Lemma 1. Consider proper morphisms of varieties

$$Z \xrightarrow{g} Y \xrightarrow{f} X.$$

If the theorem R.R. is true for f and for g , it is true for fg . If it is true for fg and for g , it is true for f . If f_* is injective, and if the theorem R.R. is true for fg and for f , it is true for g .

This is trivial. In fact, when one supposes R.R. true for fg and g , one must still suppose that $g_!$ is surjective in order to be able to assert that R.R. is true for f .

Since a proper morphism is composed of an injection and a projection $X \times P \rightarrow X$, where P is a projective space, one is reduced to treating these two cases separately. The second, as was seen above, is reduced to the standard calculation, by means of Proposition 2.13 (“cellular decomposition”) of RRR. Thus suppose $Y \subset X$, with injection morphism i . Formula (1) becomes

$$\text{ch}(i_!(y)) = i_*(\text{ch}(y)T(E)^{-1}), \quad (2)$$

where $E = T_{X/Y}$ is the normal bundle of Y in X .

Lemma 2. Suppose that there exists on X a vector bundle G of rank $p = \text{codim}_X Y$, such that

$$\gamma_X(Y) = i_*(1) = \lambda_{-1}(G), \quad i^*(G) = E, \quad (-1)^p C^p(G) = Y. \quad (3)$$

If then

$$y = i^*(x), \quad x \in K(X), \quad (4)$$

formula (2) is valid.

The proof is immediate from the fact that ch is a homomorphism of rings, and that

$$\text{ch}(\lambda_{-1}(G)) = (-1)^p C^p(G) T(G)^{-1}. \quad (5)$$

Corollary. R.R. is true if Y is a hypersurface and if y is of the form $i^*(x)$, with $x \in K(X)$.

Lemma 3. Suppose that $X = Y \times P$, where P is a projective space, and that i is the injection $u \mapsto (u, v_0)$, $v_0 \in P$. Then i_* is injective and R.R. is true.

This is pure standard calculation.

Suppose again that X, Y, y are arbitrary, always with $Y \subset X$. Let X' be the variety obtained by blowing up X along Y , and let Y' be the hypersurface inverse image of Y . One has a diagram of maps

$$\begin{array}{ccc} Y' & \xrightarrow{j} & X' \\ g \downarrow & & \downarrow f \\ Y & \xrightarrow{i} & X. \end{array}$$

The inverse image of E in Y' admits a subbundle of rank 1, whose dual is denoted L . Moreover L^{-1} is also the restriction to Y' of the line bundle $L(Y')$ defined on X' by the divisor Y' . Put $F = E/L^{-1}$. Elementary computations give the following lemma.

Lemma 4. One has the formulas, where $p = \text{codim}_X Y$:

$$f^* i_!(y) = j_*(\lambda_{-1}(\check{F})y), \quad (6)$$

$$\lambda_{-1}(\check{F}) \equiv \gamma^{p-1}(E) \lambda^p(\check{E}) \pmod{1 - L}, \quad (7)$$

$$f_*(1) = 1, \quad \text{hence } f_* f^* = 1, \quad (8)$$

$$f^* i_*(\alpha) \equiv j_*(\alpha C^{p-1}(F)) \pmod{\text{Ker } f_*} \quad \text{for all } \alpha \in A(Y). \quad (9)$$

To simplify notation, $K(Y)$ has been made to operate on $K(Y')$, and $A(Y)$ on $A(Y')$, by the homomorphisms g^* . In formula (7), it seems that $\gamma^{p-1}(E)$ denotes $\lambda^{p-1}(E - 2)$, that is,

$$\sum_{i+j=p-1} (\cdots) \lambda^i(E);$$

the congruence takes place in $K(Y')$.

Formula (6) follows from the equality

$$\text{Tor}_i^{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_Y(v), \mathcal{O}_Y(v')) = \lambda^i \check{F}(v') \quad (v' \in Y', v = g(v')). \quad (6 \text{ bis})$$

Formula (7) follows from the formulas

$$g_*(L^{-i}) = 0 \quad \text{for } 0 < i \leq p-1, \quad g_*(1) = 1, \quad (10)$$

themselves consequences of Künneth and of the cohomology of projective spaces.

Formula (8) is trivial. Finally, (9) follows from $g_*(C^{p-1}(F)) = 1$, which is deduced, for example, from the immediate formulas

$$g_*(\xi^i) = 0 \quad \text{if } 0 \leq i < p-1, \quad g_*(\xi^{p-1}) = 1, \quad (10 \text{ bis})$$

with $\xi = C^1(L) \in A^1(Y')$. In fact, (9) is very likely an identity, and not merely a congruence. The unnecessarily complicated formula (7) may be replaced, for example, by VII 4.1.

From formula (7) it follows at once that $\lambda_{-1}(\check{F}) \in j^*(K(X'))$, provided that

$$y \gamma^{p-1}(E) \lambda^p(\check{E}) \in i^*(K(X)). \quad (11)$$

Suppose this condition (11) satisfied. By the corollary to Lemma 2, R.R. is true for $(Y', X', y \lambda_{-1}(\check{F}))$. On the other hand, to prove (2), formula (8) reduces the matter to proving that

$$f^* \text{ch}(i_!(y)) \equiv f^*(i_*(\text{ch}(y)T(E)^{-1})) \pmod{\text{Ker } f_*}. \quad (12)$$

This last formula is verified immediately, using (6), (9), R.R. for $(Y', X', y \lambda_{-1}(\check{F}))$, and the formula

$$\text{ch}(\lambda_{-1}(\check{F})) = C^{p-1}(F)T(F)^{-1} \quad (13)$$

(cf. formula (5)).

Thus R.R. is proved every time $y \gamma^{p-1}(E) = 0$, in particular every time $p - 1 > \dim Y$, since $\gamma^{p-1}(E)$ is of filtration $\geq p - 1$ in $K(Y)$, filtered by the codimension of supports; that is, every time

$$\dim Y < \frac{\dim X - 1}{2}.$$

One is reduced to this case by combining Lemma 1 and Lemma 3, taking for P a projective space of sufficiently large dimension, for example $r > \dim X + 1$. This proves the assertion.

Remark. We have used the fact that $\gamma^{p-1}(E)$ was of filtration $\geq p - 1$. One can prove this fact directly, without passing through Grassmannians as in RRR, 2.16, by studying the projective bundle associated to E . This method more generally gives Theorem 2.14 of RRR.

Extract from a letter of Grothendieck

“Morally,” the new method rests on the determination of $K(X)$ and $A(X)$ when X is either the projective bundle associated to a vector bundle, or a variety obtained by blowing up a non-singular subvariety. In this second case I have not made the complete determination; a small equality is still missing. With the notation of the short note, one must prove formula (9), but as an equality:

$$f^*(i_*(\alpha)) = j_*(\alpha C^{p-1}(F)), \quad \alpha \in A(Y). \quad (9)$$

One observes that the two members have the same image by f_* , and the same image by j^* , so that the question is equivalent to

$$\text{Ker } f_* \cap \text{Ker } j^* = 0. \quad (9 \text{ bis})$$

In any case, (9) is true after reducing to $G(K(X'))$ (which destroys a little torsion, at most), for it then follows from (6); there is therefore hardly any doubt that it is true.

I also point out that equality (9) follows very easily from (6), without passing through the troublesome (6 bis).

P.C.C.-J.-P.S.

Exposé I. Generalities on finiteness conditions in derived categories

by L. Illusie

0. Introduction

The object of Exposés I to IV is to develop, with the degree of generality appropriate in this Seminar, the formalism of finiteness conditions in derived categories of ringed topoi.

As was said in Exposé 0, the need to define, on arbitrary schemes, “Grothendieck groups” possessing good variance properties forced one to generalize and to soften the finiteness notions used up to now.

A classical notion such as that of a coherent sheaf on a ringed space $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ makes sense only when $\mathcal{O}_X$ is coherent. One might think of replacing it by the notion of finite presentation. But this has the inconvenience that the kernel of an epimorphism of modules of finite presentation is no longer, in general, of finite presentation. A satisfactory notion is reached by observing that, when $\mathcal{O}_X$ is coherent, a coherent sheaf F is not only of finite presentation but of n -finite presentation for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, where n -finite presentation means that locally there exists an exact sequence

$$L_n \longrightarrow L_{n-1} \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow L_0 \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow 0,$$

with the L_i free of finite type. When $\mathcal{O}_X$ is no longer assumed coherent, say that an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module F is *pseudo-coherent* if it satisfies the preceding condition, that is, if it is of n -finite presentation for every n . Then the notion of pseudo-coherence has, with respect to short exact sequences, the same stability property as coherence: if two terms of a short exact sequence of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules are pseudo-coherent, then so is the third.

The preceding notion is easily generalized to complexes of sheaves. A complex F of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules is said to be *pseudo-coherent* if it is n -pseudo-coherent for every $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, where n -pseudo-coherent means that there locally exists a quasi-isomorphism $L \rightarrow F$, with L a complex bounded above and with components free of finite type in degrees $> n$. For a complex F reduced to degree 0, this is the same as saying that F is pseudo-coherent as a complex or as a module.

The notion of pseudo-coherent complex has excellent stability properties, described in Exposé I, §§1 and 2. First of all it is stable under isomorphism in the derived category $D(X)$ of the category of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules; better still, if two objects of a distinguished triangle of $D(X)$ are pseudo-coherent, then so is the third. In other words, the full subcategory $D(X)_{\text{coh}}$ of $D(X)$ formed by pseudo-coherent complexes is a triangulated subcategory. Moreover, pseudo-coherence is preserved under inverse image and derived tensor product. In the case where $\mathcal{O}_X$ is coherent, to say that a complex F is pseudo-coherent simply means that F has locally bounded-above cohomology and that all the $H^i(F)$ are coherent.

If $\mathcal{O}_X$ is a sheaf of regular local rings, every coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module F admits locally a finite resolution to the left by finite-type free modules, that is, there exists locally an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow L_n \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow L_0 \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow 0,$$

where the L_i are free of finite type. It is therefore natural, when $\mathcal{O}_X$ is an arbitrary sheaf of local rings, to study the modules which have the preceding property. Such modules are called *perfect*. More generally, a complex F of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules is said to be *perfect* if there exists locally a quasi-isomorphism $L \rightarrow F$, where L is a bounded complex with components free of finite type. It is shown in Exposé I, §3, that the full subcategory $D(X)_{\text{parf}}$ of $D(X)$ formed by perfect

complexes is, like $D(X)_{\text{coh}}$, a triangulated subcategory, stable under inverse image and derived tensor product. One obviously has

$$D(X)_{\text{parf}} \subset D(X)_{\text{coh}},$$

but the inclusion is strict in general. Pseudo-coherence can be redefined “by passage to the limit” from perfection: a complex F is pseudo-coherent if and only if, for every $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, F can be locally approximated to order n by a perfect complex, meaning that there exists locally a distinguished triangle

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L & \xrightarrow{\quad} & F \\ & \swarrow \quad \searrow & \\ & R & \end{array}$$

with L perfect and R acyclic in degrees $> n$. Conversely, perfection is recovered from pseudo-coherence by means of an additional regularity condition: a complex is perfect if and only if it is pseudo-coherent and locally of finite Tor-dimension (Exposé I, §5). Thus one recovers the fact that, if the local rings are regular, every coherent sheaf is perfect, and more generally every pseudo-coherent complex with locally bounded cohomology is perfect.

Pseudo-coherence and perfection are the two fundamental finiteness notions with which we shall work in this Seminar. Sections 1 to 5 of Exposé I are devoted to their definition and to establishing their elementary stability properties. For this purpose, only two or three local properties of the category of finite-type free modules, relative to the category of all modules, are used. It is therefore convenient and useful, notably in Exposé II, to axiomatize the situation by introducing a notion of pseudo-coherence (respectively of perfection) in a category fibered over a site, relative to a fibered subcategory satisfying suitable conditions.

Sections 6 to 8 of Exposé I generalize to perfect complexes a certain number of notions well known for finite-type locally free sheaves: rank, duality, and the trace of an endomorphism.

In Exposé II, one examines the problem of the existence of “global resolutions”: under what conditions, on a ringed topos $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$, is a pseudo-coherent (respectively perfect) complex globally isomorphic in $D(X)$ to a complex of locally free modules of finite type? The importance of this question lies essentially in the fact that at present one does not know how to generalize to perfect complexes certain usual constructions on locally free modules, such as exterior and symmetric powers or Chern classes. That is why it is useful to have workable sufficient criteria for the existence of global resolutions, which reduce certain questions about pseudo-coherent (respectively perfect) complexes to analogous questions about locally free sheaves of finite type. Such criteria are given in Exposé II.

In particular, one shows that global resolutions exist in the following cases: X is the Zariski topos of an affine scheme, or more generally of a quasi-compact scheme possessing an ample invertible sheaf, or even an ample family of invertible sheaves in the sense of Kleiman, for example a regular scheme; or again X is the topos of sheaves of sets on a compact topological space and $\mathcal{O}_X$ is the sheaf of continuous functions with complex values. By way of illustration, and to show the flexibility of the notions introduced, the appendix gives a “purely sheaf-theoretic” definition of the index of a family of elliptic operators.

Exposé III studies the stability of finiteness conditions under derived direct image. To obtain reasonable statements, one must relativize the notions of pseudo-coherence and perfection. We place ourselves here in the framework of ordinary schemes, which is sufficient for the Seminar, but there is no doubt that one will sooner or later need to develop an analogous theory for relative analytic schemes or spaces. Let $p : X \rightarrow S$ be an S -scheme locally of finite type, and let F be a complex of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules. One says that F is pseudo-coherent (respectively perfect) relative to p if one can locally extend X , by a closed immersion, into a smooth S -scheme X' ,

so that F , extended by zero to X' , is pseudo-coherent (respectively perfect). The notion of pseudo-coherence relative to p is especially interesting when S is not locally noetherian; in the opposite case it coincides with the ordinary notion of pseudo-coherence. Moreover, as expected, to say that F is perfect relative to p is equivalent to saying that F is pseudo-coherent relative to p and locally of finite Tor-dimension relative to p (i.e. relative to the sheaf of rings $p^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_S)$).

The central theorem of Exposé III is the following finiteness theorem, stated below in a slightly more precise form: if $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is a proper morphism of S -schemes locally of finite type, the functor Rf_* transforms complexes pseudo-coherent relative to S into complexes pseudo-coherent relative to S . This theorem is in fact a conjecture, but it is nevertheless proved in the two particular cases S locally noetherian and f projective. It seems likely, unfortunately, that the extension to the general case is of the same order of difficulty as the analogous theorem in analytic geometry, Grauert's theorem. Combining the finiteness theorem with an essentially trivial formula called the projection formula, one obtains workable criteria for the stability of relative perfection under direct image. As a corollary one recovers Grauert's continuity and semicontinuity theorems (EGA III 7.6).

Exposé IV translates the results of Exposés I to III into the language of “Grothendieck groups.” On a ringed topos $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$, write $K^*(X)$ (respectively $K_\bullet(X)$) for the Grothendieck group of the category of perfect complexes and complexes of finite Tor-dimension (respectively pseudo-coherent complexes with bounded homology). The group $K^*(X)$ is a ring, and $K_\bullet(X)$ is a module over $K^*(X)$. The functor K^* is contravariant, as suggested above, while $K_\bullet$ is covariant for proper pseudo-coherent morphisms of schemes, or of analytic spaces, subject to the availability of the finiteness theorem. There are also unusual variants: covariance of K^* , contravariance of $K_\bullet$, for morphisms satisfying suitable regularity hypotheses. Finally, the globalization criteria of Exposé II make it possible to link these groups with the “Grothendieck groups” defined naïvely from coherent sheaves or finite-type locally free sheaves.

1. Preliminary definitions

1.1. Fibered categories with additive fibers (respectively abelian, respectively triangulated fibers)

1.1.1. Let S be a category, and let $\mathcal{C}$ be an S -category fibered in categories with additive (respectively triangulated) fibers (SGA 1 VI 6.1). We shall say that $\mathcal{C}$ is an *additive* (respectively *triangulated*) S -category, or that $\mathcal{C}$ is additive (respectively triangulated) over S , if, for every arrow $f : X \rightarrow Y$ of S , the inverse-image functor

$$f^* : \mathcal{C}_Y \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}_X$$

(determined up to unique isomorphism) is additive (respectively exact). We shall say that $\mathcal{C}$ is an *abelian* S -category if $\mathcal{C}$ is an additive S -category with abelian fibers, and that $\mathcal{C}$ is a *flat abelian* S -category if, moreover, the inverse-image functors are exact.

1.1.2. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a triangulated S -category. One defines, for example with the aid of a cleavage of $\mathcal{C}$ (SGA 1 VI 7.1), a fibered S -category $\mathrm{Tr}(\mathcal{C})$ whose fiber over each $X \in \mathrm{ob}(S)$ is the category $\mathrm{Tr}(\mathcal{C}_X)$ of distinguished triangles of $\mathcal{C}_X$.

1.1.3. Let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{C}'$ be additive (respectively triangulated) S -categories, and let $F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}'$ be a functor. We say that F is an additive (respectively exact) S -functor if F is a Cartesian S -functor that is additive (respectively exact) on each fiber.

1.1.3 (continued). If $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{C}'$ are triangulated S -categories and if F is an exact S -functor,

then F defines a Cartesian S -functor

$$\mathrm{Tr}(\mathcal{C}) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Tr}(\mathcal{C}').$$

1.1.4. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a triangulated S -category, and let $\mathcal{C}'$ be a full fibered sub- S -category of $\mathcal{C}$. We say that $\mathcal{C}'$ is a *triangulated sub- S -category* of $\mathcal{C}$ if, for every $X \in \mathrm{ob} S$, $\mathcal{C}'_X$ is a triangulated subcategory of $\mathcal{C}_X$ [V], Chap. I, §1, 2.3.

1.1.5. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an additive S -category. One defines (SGA 4 XVII 2.2, 2.4) an additive (respectively triangulated) S -category

$$\mathcal{C}(\mathcal{C}) \quad \text{respectively} \quad \mathcal{K}(\mathcal{C}),$$

whose fiber over $X \in \mathrm{ob} S$ is the category $\mathcal{C}(\mathcal{C}_X)$ of complexes with differential of degree $+1$ (respectively the category $\mathcal{K}(\mathcal{C}_X)$ of complexes of $\mathcal{C}_X$ “up to homotopy”). If $\mathcal{C}$ is a flat abelian S -category, one defines, loc. cit., a triangulated S -category $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{C})$, whose fiber over $X \in \mathrm{ob} S$ is the derived category $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{C}_X)$; if $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is an arrow of S , we shall write

$$f^* : \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{C}_Y) \longrightarrow \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{C}_X)$$

for the inverse-image functor, obtained from

$$f^* : \mathcal{K}(\mathcal{C}_Y) \longrightarrow \mathcal{K}(\mathcal{C}_X)$$

by passage to the quotient. One defines full triangulated sub- S -categories

$$\mathcal{K}^*(\mathcal{C}) \quad \text{respectively} \quad \mathcal{D}^*(\mathcal{C}) \quad (* = +, -, b)$$

by the usual degree conditions.

1.2. Terminology

Let S be a site, let $\mathcal{C}$ be a flat abelian S -category (1.1), and let $\mathcal{C}_0$ be a strictly full fibered sub- S -category.

Let $F \in \mathrm{ob} \mathcal{C}_X$, for $X \in \mathrm{ob} S$. The set of arrows $f : U \rightarrow X$ in S/X such that there exists an epimorphism

$$E \longrightarrow f^*F, \quad E \in \mathrm{ob} \mathcal{C}_{0,U},$$

is a sieve on X . If this sieve is covering, we shall say that F is of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type (or simply of finite type when no confusion is to be feared).

We shall say that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is *locally stable under kernels of epimorphisms* if the following condition is satisfied: for every $X \in \mathrm{ob} S$ and every epimorphism

$$u : E \longrightarrow F$$

of $\mathcal{C}_X$, with $E, F \in \mathrm{ob} \mathcal{C}_{0,X}$, the kernel of u is locally in $\mathcal{C}_0$; in other words the set of $f : U \rightarrow X$ in S/X such that

$$f^* \mathrm{Ker}(u) \in \mathrm{ob} \mathcal{C}_{0,U}$$

is a refinement of X .

By the standard process of decomposing a long exact sequence into short exact sequences, one sees that the preceding condition is equivalent to the following apparently stronger one: for every $X \in \mathrm{ob} S$ and every exact sequence in $\mathcal{C}_X$

$$0 \longrightarrow E^0 \longrightarrow E^1 \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow E^n \longrightarrow 0 \quad (*)$$

with $E^i \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0,X}$ for $1 \leq i \leq n$, the object E^0 is locally in $\mathcal{C}_0$.

We shall say that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is *locally quasi-stable under kernels of epimorphisms* if, for every exact sequence such as $(*)$, E^0 is of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type.

On the other hand, we shall say that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is *locally liftable in $\mathcal{C}$* if, for every $X \in \text{ob } S$, every epimorphism

$$u : E \longrightarrow F$$

of $\mathcal{C}_X$ with $F \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0,X}$ locally admits a section. Equivalently, for $\mathcal{C}_0$ to be locally liftable in $\mathcal{C}$, it is necessary and sufficient that, for every diagram of $\mathcal{C}_X$, $X \in \text{ob } S$,

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & H & \\ & \downarrow & \\ E & \xrightarrow{u} & F \end{array}$$

where u is an epimorphism and $H \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_0$, the set of U over X for which there exists a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & H_U & \\ & \downarrow & \\ E_U & \xrightarrow{u_U} & F_U \end{array}$$

is a refinement of X .

We shall say that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is *locally quasi-liftable in $\mathcal{C}$* if the following weaker condition is satisfied: for every $X \in \text{ob } S$, and every epimorphism

$$u : E \longrightarrow F$$

of $\mathcal{C}_X$, with $F \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0,X}$, the set of arrows $f : U \rightarrow X$ of S/X for which there exists

$$v : F' \longrightarrow f^*E, \quad F' \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0,U},$$

such that $f^*(u)v$ is an epimorphism, is a refinement of X . This condition is equivalent to the following: for every diagram in $\mathcal{C}_X$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & H & \\ & \downarrow & \\ E & \xrightarrow{u} & F, \end{array}$$

where u is an epimorphism and $H \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_0$, the set of U over X such that there exists a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} G & \xrightarrow{v} & H_U \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ E_U & \xrightarrow{u_U} & F_U \end{array}$$

with $G \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_0$ and v an epimorphism, is a refinement of X .

If S is a chaotic site, for example the punctual site (one object, one morphism), we shall omit the adverb “locally” in the preceding definitions.

1.3. Examples

a) Let S be the punctual site, let A be a ring, and let $\mathcal{C}$ be the category of left A -modules. The full subcategory $\mathcal{C}_0$ of $\mathcal{C}$ formed by the projective A -modules of finite type is stable under kernels

of epimorphisms and is liftable in $\mathcal{C}$; an A -module is of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type if and only if it is of finite type in the ordinary sense. The full subcategory $\mathcal{C}_1$ of $\mathcal{C}$ formed by the A -modules of finite type is quasi-liftable in $\mathcal{C}$, but is not liftable in general; if A is noetherian, $\mathcal{C}_1$ is stable under kernels of epimorphisms. The full subcategory $\mathcal{C}'_0$ of $\mathcal{C}$ formed by the free A -modules of finite type is liftable in $\mathcal{C}$ and quasi-stable, though not stable in general, under kernels of epimorphisms.

b) Let $(S, \mathcal{O}_S)$ be a space ringed by local rings, let S be the site of open subsets of S , and let $\mathcal{C}$ be the fibered S -category, even split (SGA 1 VI 9), defined by the functor

$$U \longmapsto \{\text{category of left } \mathcal{O}_U\text{-modules}\}.$$

Then $\mathcal{C}$ is a flat abelian S -category (1.1). Let $\mathcal{C}_0$ be the strictly full additive sub- S -category of $\mathcal{C}$ defined by

$$U \longmapsto \{\text{category of finite-type free } \mathcal{O}_U\text{-modules}\}.$$

An $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module M is locally of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type if and only if M is of finite type in the ordinary sense (EGA 0_I, 5.2). From EGA 0_I, 5.2.7 and 5.4.9, it follows that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is locally stable under kernels of epimorphisms and locally liftable in $\mathcal{C}$.

c) Let G be a group, let S be the topos of G -sets (SGA 4 V 3.11), and let k be a field, regarded as the constant ring on S . Let $\mathcal{C}$ be the split S -category defined by

$$U \longmapsto \{\text{category of left } k_U\text{-modules}\};$$

then $\mathcal{C}$ is a flat abelian S -category. Let $\mathcal{C}_0$ be the strictly full additive sub- S -category of $\mathcal{C}$ defined by

$$U \longmapsto \{\text{category of finite-type free } k_U\text{-modules}\}.$$

Since localization in S is equivalent to forgetting the operations of G , it is clear that a G - k -module M is locally of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type if and only if M is finite-dimensional as a vector space over k , and that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is locally stable under kernels of epimorphisms and locally liftable in $\mathcal{C}$.

The reader is left to look at the ‘‘Galois’’ variant of c), where G is a profinite group and S is the topos of sets on which G operates continuously.

In fact, examples b) and c) are particular cases of the following example.

d) Let $(S, \mathcal{O}_S)$ be a ringed topos (cf. SGA 4 IV 2.10), and let $\mathcal{C}$ be the split S -category defined by

$$U \longmapsto \{\text{category of left } \mathcal{O}_U\text{-modules}\};$$

then $\mathcal{C}$ is a flat abelian S -category. Let $\mathcal{C}_0$ be the strictly full additive sub- S -category of $\mathcal{C}$ defined by

$$U \longmapsto \{\text{category of finite-type free } \mathcal{O}_U\text{-modules}\}.$$

An $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module locally of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type will simply be called *of finite type*. The category $\mathcal{C}_0$ is locally quasi-stable under kernels of epimorphisms and locally liftable in $\mathcal{C}$, as follows from:

Lemma 1.3.1. Let P be an $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module. The following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) P is of finite type and the functor $\text{Hom}(P, \cdot)$ is exact;
- (ii) P is of finite type and every epimorphism $M \rightarrow P$ locally admits a section;
- (iii) P is locally a direct factor of a free module of finite type.

The proof is immediate and is left as an exercise to the reader.

1.4. An “extension” lemma (cf. EGA 0_{III}, 11.9.1)

Proposition 1.4.1. Let S be a site, let $\mathcal{C}$ be a flat abelian S -category (1.1), and let $\mathcal{C}_0$ be a strictly full additive sub- S -category of $\mathcal{C}$. Assume that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is locally quasi-liftable in $\mathcal{C}$ (1.2). Let $S \in \text{ob } S$, let

$$u : E \longrightarrow F$$

be a morphism, of degree 0, of complexes of $\mathcal{C}_S$ (differentials of degree +1), let G be the cone of u (cf. [V], Chap. I, §1, 2.1), let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, and assume that $H^n(G)$ is of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type (1.2). Then the set of $X \in \text{ob}(S/S)$ satisfying property (P) below is a refinement of S .

(P): there exist an object $M \in \mathcal{C}_{0,X}$ and arrows of $\mathcal{C}_X$

$$r : M \longrightarrow Z^{n+1}(E_X) = \text{Ker}\left(E_X^{n+1} \xrightarrow{d^{n+1}} E_X^{n+2}\right), \quad s : M \longrightarrow F_X^n$$

such that the following diagram of $\mathcal{C}_X$

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} \cdots & \longrightarrow & E_X^{n-1} & \xrightarrow{(d_{E_0}^{n-1})} & E_X^n \oplus M & \xrightarrow{(d_E^n, r)} & E_X^{n+1} \longrightarrow \cdots \\ & & \downarrow u_X^{n-1} & & \downarrow (u_X^n, s) & & \downarrow u_X^{n+1} \\ \cdots & \longrightarrow & F_X^{n-1} & \xrightarrow{d_F^{n-1}} & F_X^n & \xrightarrow{d_F^n} & F_X^{n+1} \longrightarrow \cdots \end{array}$$

is a morphism of complexes $u' : E' \rightarrow F_X$, that is,

$$d_F^n s = u_X^{n+1} r,$$

and such that

(i) $H^{n+1}(u')$ is a monomorphism, with

$$\Im H^{n+1}(u') = \Im H^{n+1}(u_X);$$

(ii) $H^n(u')$ is an epimorphism.

In pictorial terms, one may say that, after modifying E and u locally in degree n only by adding, in degree n , an object of $\mathcal{C}_0$, one can locally make $H^{n+1}(u)$ injective, without changing its image, and $H^n(u)$ surjective.

Proof. The procedure is as follows: first one shows that r and s may be chosen locally so as to make $H^{n+1}(u)$ injective; one verifies that the finiteness hypothesis on $H^n(G)$ is preserved; a new local correction in degree n then makes it possible to obtain $H^n(u)$ surjective.

The exact cohomology sequence

$$\cdots \longrightarrow H^n(G) \longrightarrow H^{n+1}(E) \longrightarrow H^{n+1}(F) \longrightarrow \cdots$$

shows that the kernel of $H^{n+1}(u)$ is of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type. In other words, the set of X over S for which there is an exact sequence

$$M \longrightarrow H^{n+1}(E_X) \xrightarrow{H^{n+1}(u)} H^{n+1}(F_X), \quad M \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0,X},$$

is a refinement of S . Since $\mathcal{C}_0$ is locally quasi-liftable in $\mathcal{C}$, one may moreover impose that the arrow

$$M \longrightarrow H^{n+1}(E_X)$$

factor through $Z^{n+1}(E_X)$:

$$M \xrightarrow{r} Z^{n+1}(E_X) \longrightarrow H^{n+1}(E_X).$$

The composite

$$M \xrightarrow{u_X^{n+1}r} Z^{n+1}(F_X) \longrightarrow H^{n+1}(F_X)$$

is zero by construction, so $u_X^{n+1}r$ factors through

$$B^{n+1}(F_X) = \Im \left(F_X^n \xrightarrow{d_F^n} F_X^{n+1} \right).$$

Applying quasi-liftability once more, one may impose that $u_X^{n+1}r$ factor through F_X^n :

$$M \xrightarrow{s} F_X^n \longrightarrow B^{n+1}(F_X) \longrightarrow Z^{n+1}(F_X).$$

Then u' , defined as in (1.4.1), is plainly a morphism of complexes satisfying (i).

Let G' be the cone of $u' : E' \rightarrow F_X$. We show that $H^n(G')$ is of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type. By construction there is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow E_X \xrightarrow{v} E' \longrightarrow M[-n] \longrightarrow 0,$$

with $u'v = u_X$. To compare G_X and G' , one may, for instance, form the octahedron in $K(\mathcal{C}_X)$:

The diagram is an octahedron in the homotopy category $K(\mathcal{C}_X)$. It consists of the following objects and morphisms:

- Top vertex:** G_X
- Bottom-left vertex:** E_X
- Bottom-middle vertex:** E'
- Bottom-right vertex:** F_X
- Inner vertex (above E'):** $M[-n]$
- Inner vertex (above E' and F_X):** G'

Morphisms are as follows:

- $E_X \xrightarrow{v} E' \xrightarrow{u'} F_X$ (bottom row)
- $E_X \xrightarrow{+1} M[-n] \xrightarrow{+1} E'$ (left inner triangle)
- $E' \xrightarrow{+1} M[-n] \xrightarrow{+1} G'$ (middle inner triangle)
- $E' \xrightarrow{+1} G'$ (right inner triangle)
- $E_X \xrightarrow{+1} G_X$ (left outer triangle)
- $E' \xrightarrow{+1} G_X$ (middle outer triangle)
- $F_X \xrightarrow{+1} G_X$ (right outer triangle)
- $G_X \xrightarrow{(*)} G'$ (top outer triangle)

The exact cohomology sequence of the distinguished triangle marked by the octahedron shows that

$$H^n(G_X) \longrightarrow H^n(G')$$

is an epimorphism; hence $H^n(G')$ is indeed of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type.

The preceding correction therefore reduces us to the case where $H^{n+1}(u)$ is a monomorphism. We suppose this from now on. The exact cohomology sequence of $E \rightarrow F \rightarrow G$ then gives an exact sequence

$$H^n(E) \xrightarrow{H^n(u)} H^n(F) \longrightarrow H^n(G) \longrightarrow 0.$$

Since $H^n(G)$ is of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type, the set of X over S for which there exists an epimorphism

$$M \longrightarrow H^n(G_X), \quad M \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0,X},$$

is, by definition, a refinement of S . Using the quasi-liftability of $\mathcal{C}_0$ in $\mathcal{C}$, one may impose that this epimorphism factor through $Z^n(F_X)$:

$$M \xrightarrow{s} Z^n(F_X) \longrightarrow H^n(F_X) \longrightarrow H^n(G_X).$$

It is clear that u' , defined as in (1.4.1) with $r = 0$, is a morphism of complexes and that

$$H^n(u') : H^n(E_X) \oplus M \longrightarrow H^n(F_X)$$

is an epimorphism. This completes the proof of (1.4.1).

Lemma 1.4.2. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an abelian category, let $u : E \rightarrow F$ be a morphism of complexes of $\mathcal{C}$ (respectively an arrow of $D(\mathcal{C})$), and let G be the cone of u . For a given $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, the following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) $H^i(G) = 0$ for $i \geq n$;
- (ii) $H^i(u)$ is an isomorphism for $i > n$ and an epimorphism for $i = n$.

The proof is immediate from the exact cohomology sequence.

Definition 1.4.3. We shall say that u is an n -quasi-isomorphism (respectively an n -isomorphism) if u satisfies the equivalent conditions of (1.4.2).

That being so, one deduces at once from (1.4.1) the following:

Corollary 1.4.4. Let $S, \mathcal{S}, \mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0$ be as in (1.4.1). Let $u : E \rightarrow F$ be an $(n+1)$ -quasi-isomorphism of complexes of $\mathcal{C}_S$, with $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ fixed, such that $H^n(G)$ is of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type. Then the set of X over S for which there exist (M, r, s) as in (1.4.1) such that u' is an n -quasi-isomorphism is a refinement of S .

In pictorial terms, one may, using the finiteness condition on $H^n(G)$, locally “gain one notch,” that is, locally modify u in degree n by adding to E^n an object of $\mathcal{C}_0$ in such a way as to make u an n -quasi-isomorphism.

Corollary 1.4.5. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an abelian category, let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, and let $u : E \rightarrow F$ be an n -quasi-isomorphism of complexes of $\mathcal{C}$. There exists a commutative diagram in $\mathbf{C}(\mathcal{C})$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} E & \xrightarrow{v} & E' \\ u \downarrow & \swarrow u' & \\ F & & \end{array}$$

where u' is a quasi-isomorphism and v is a monomorphism inducing the identity in degrees $\geq n$, that is,

$$E^i = E'^i, \quad v^i = \text{Id}(E^i) \quad \text{for } i \geq n.$$

Proof. Applying (1.4.4) in the case where S is the punctual site and $\mathcal{C}_0 = \mathcal{C}$, one obtains a commutative triangle in $\mathbf{C}(\mathcal{C})$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} E & \xrightarrow{v_{n-1}} & E'_{n-1} \\ u \downarrow & \swarrow u'_{n-1} & \\ F & & \end{array}$$

where u'_{n-1} is an $(n-1)$ -quasi-isomorphism and v_{n-1} is a monomorphism inducing the identity in degrees $\geq n$. Iterating the process, one finds, for $i \leq n-1$, a sequence of commutative triangles in $\mathbf{C}(\mathcal{C})$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} E'_i & \xrightarrow{v_{i-1}} & E'_{i-1} \\ u'_i \downarrow & \swarrow u'_{i-1} & \\ F & & \end{array}$$

where u'_i is an i -quasi-isomorphism and v_{i-1} is a monomorphism inducing the identity in degrees $\geq i$. The corollary follows by passing to the limit. More precisely, writing d'_i for the differential of E'_i , define E' by

$$E'^i = E^i, \quad d'^i = d^i \quad (i \geq n),$$

and

$$E'^i = (E'_i)^i, \quad d'^i = (d'_i)^i \quad (i < n),$$

and then define v and u' by

$$v^j = (v_i)^j, \quad u'^j = (u'_i)^j \quad (i \leq j).$$

One immediately verifies that E' , v , and u' , so defined, answer the question.

In abbreviated form: one can extend an n -quasi-isomorphism into a quasi-isomorphism “without changing anything given in degree $> n$.”

2. Pseudo-coherent complexes

2.0. In this section, S denotes a site, $\mathcal{S}$ an object of S , $\mathcal{C}$ a flat abelian S -category (1.1), and $\mathcal{C}_0$ a strictly full additive sub- S -category of $\mathcal{C}$. We assume that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is locally quasi-stable under kernels of epimorphisms (1.2) and locally quasi-liftable in $\mathcal{C}$ (1.2).

Definition 2.1. Let $X \in \text{ob } S$, let E be a complex of $\mathcal{C}_X$, and let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. We shall say that E is *strictly $\mathcal{C}_0$ - n -pseudo-coherent* (respectively $\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent, respectively $\mathcal{C}_0$ -perfect) if $E^i = 0$ for i sufficiently large and $E^i \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0,S}$ for $i \geq n$ (respectively for every i , respectively for every i and $E^i = 0$ for almost all i).

When no confusion is to be feared, we shall sometimes say “strictly n -pseudo-coherent” (respectively, and so on) instead of “strictly $\mathcal{C}_0$ - n -pseudo-coherent”.

Lemma 2.1.1. Let $E \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}(\mathcal{C}_S)$ and $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. If E is strictly n -pseudo-coherent and if $H^i(E) = 0$ for $i > n$, then $H^n(E)$ is of finite type.

Proof. The sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow Z^n(E) \longrightarrow E^n \longrightarrow E^{n+1} \longrightarrow \dots \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact, and $E^i \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_0$ for $i \geq n$. Since $\mathcal{C}_0$ is locally quasi-stable under kernels of epimorphisms, it follows that $Z^n(E)$ is of finite type, hence so is $H^n(E)$, which is a quotient of it.

Proposition 2.2. Let $F \in \text{ob } \mathcal{D}(\mathcal{C}_S)$ and $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then:

a) If F is strictly n -pseudo-coherent (relative to $\mathcal{C}_0$) and if

$$u : E \longrightarrow F$$

is a quasi-isomorphism, then the set of X over S such that there exists a quasi-isomorphism

$$v : F' \longrightarrow E_X$$

with F' strictly n -pseudo-coherent is a refinement of S .

b) The following conditions are equivalent:

(i) the set of X over S such that there exists a quasi-isomorphism

$$u : E \longrightarrow F_X$$

of $\mathcal{C}(\mathcal{C}_X)$, with E strictly n -pseudo-coherent, is a refinement of S ;

(i') the same condition as (i), but with u an isomorphism of $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{C}_X)$;

(ii) the set of X over S such that there exists an n -quasi-isomorphism

$$u : E \longrightarrow F_X$$

of $\mathcal{C}(\mathcal{C}_X)$, with E strictly perfect, is a refinement of S ;

(ii') the same condition as (ii), but with u an n -isomorphism of $\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{C}_X)$.

Proof. For a), there exists, for i sufficiently large, an i -quasi-isomorphism

$$v_i : F'_i \longrightarrow E$$

with F'_i strictly n -pseudo-coherent (take $F'_i = 0$). We show that, if $i > n$, there exists, after refining S , an $(i - 1)$ -quasi-isomorphism

$$v_{i-1} : F'_{i-1} \longrightarrow E$$

with F'_{i-1} strictly n -pseudo-coherent. By (1.4.4), it is enough to show that $H^{i-1}(M')$, where M' is the cone of v_i , is of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type. Now if M'' denotes the cone of uv_i , the hypothesis that u is a quasi-isomorphism and (1.4.2) imply that

$$H^j(M') \xrightarrow{\sim} H^j(M'') \quad \text{for all } j,$$

and

$$H^j(M') = 0 \quad \text{for } j \geq i.$$

The cone formula

$$M''^j = F_i'^{j+1} \oplus F^j$$

shows, on the other hand, that M'' is strictly $(i - 1)$ -pseudo-coherent. Hence, by (2.1.1),

$$H^{i-1}(M'') = H^{i-1}(M')$$

is of finite type, whence the assertion. It follows, by iteration and after refining S , that there is an n -quasi-isomorphism

$$v_n : F'_n \longrightarrow E$$

where F'_n is strictly n -pseudo-coherent. But, by (1.4.5), one can extend v_n into a quasi-isomorphism

$$v : F' \longrightarrow E$$

without changing anything in degrees $\geq n$; in particular F' is strictly n -pseudo-coherent. This proves a).

For b), the equivalence of (i) and (i') follows at once from a) and from the definition of isomorphisms of $D^-(\mathcal{C}_X)$. If $E \in \text{ob } D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$ is strictly n -pseudo-coherent, there is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow E' \longrightarrow E \longrightarrow E'' \longrightarrow 0$$

where E' is strictly perfect and $E''^i = 0$ for $i \geq n$. Consequently $E' \rightarrow E$ is an n -quasi-isomorphism, which gives the implication (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii). The implication (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (ii') is trivial, so it remains to prove (ii') $\Rightarrow$ (i). Let

$$u : E \longrightarrow F$$

be an n -isomorphism of $D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$, with E strictly perfect. Then u is represented by a diagram in $C^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & E' & \\ s \swarrow & & \searrow u' \\ E & & F, \end{array}$$

where s is a quasi-isomorphism and u' an n -quasi-isomorphism. By a), after refining S , there exists a quasi-isomorphism

$$t : E'' \longrightarrow E',$$

with E'' strictly n -pseudo-coherent. Applying (1.4.5) to $u't : E'' \rightarrow F$, we extend it to a quasi-isomorphism

$$E''' \longrightarrow F$$

with E''' strictly n -pseudo-coherent. This proves (ii') $\Rightarrow$ (i) and completes the proof of (2.2).

Definition 2.3. Under the hypotheses of (2.2), we shall say that $F \in \text{ob } D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$ is $n\text{-}\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent if F satisfies the equivalent conditions b) of (2.2). We shall say that F is $\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent if F is $n\text{-}\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent for every n .

When this cannot cause confusion, we shall sometimes allow ourselves to say n -pseudo-coherent, pseudo-coherent, instead of $n\text{-}\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent, $\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent.

Remark 2.3.1. Let $F \in \text{ob } D(\mathcal{C}_S)$ be a pseudo-coherent complex. The set of X over S such that there exists a quasi-isomorphism

$$E \longrightarrow F_X$$

with E strictly pseudo-coherent (2.1) is not in general a refinement of S . However, we shall see later (2.7 a) and Exposé II) important cases in which this is so.

The proof of (2.2 a) gives the following result.

Proposition 2.4. Let $n, i \in \mathbb{Z}$, and let

$$u : E \longrightarrow F$$

be an i -quasi-isomorphism of $C(\mathcal{C}_S)$, with F n -pseudo-coherent and E strictly n -pseudo-coherent. Then, after refining S , there exists a commutative triangle in $C(\mathcal{C}_S)$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} E & \xrightarrow{v} & E' \\ u \downarrow & \swarrow u' & \\ F & & \end{array}$$

where E' is strictly n -pseudo-coherent, u' is a quasi-isomorphism, and v is a monomorphism inducing the identity in degree $\geq i$.

Proposition 2.5. a) If $F \in \text{ob } D(\mathcal{C}_S)$ is n -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent), then $F[m]$ is $(n - m)$ -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent).

b) Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} E & \xrightarrow{\quad} & F \\ & \swarrow \quad \searrow & \\ & +1 \quad G & \end{array} \quad (*)$$

be a distinguished triangle of $D(\mathcal{C}_S)$. If E and G are n -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent), then F is n -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent).

Proof. a) is trivial from the definitions.

b) It is enough, of course, to prove the non-parenthesized assertion. The triangle (*) can also be written

$$\begin{array}{ccc} G[-1] & \xrightarrow{\quad} & E \\ & \swarrow \quad \searrow & \\ & +1 \quad F & \end{array}$$

By a), $G[-1]$ is $(n + 1)$ -pseudo-coherent. Thus we are reduced to proving that, if E is $(n + 1)$ -pseudo-coherent and F is n -pseudo-coherent, then G is n -pseudo-coherent. After localizing, we

may assume E (respectively F) strictly $(n+1)$ -pseudo-coherent (respectively n -pseudo-coherent). The arrow

$$E \xrightarrow{u} F$$

of $D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$ is represented by a pair of arrows of $C^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & E' & \\ s \swarrow & & \searrow u' \\ E & & F, \end{array}$$

where s is a quasi-isomorphism. By (2.2 a)), after localizing, there exists a quasi-isomorphism

$$t : E'' \longrightarrow E',$$

where E'' is strictly $(n+1)$ -pseudo-coherent. We are therefore reduced to the case where u is defined by a true arrow of $C^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$. The assertion then follows from the definitions and from the formula

$$C(u)^i = E^{i+1} \oplus F^i,$$

where $C(u)$ denotes the cone of u .

Scholium 2.6. By rotation of triangles, one sees that pseudo-coherence properties for two of the objects of the triangle $(*)$ imply another such property for the third. The various cases may be summarized in the table below; the lower-case letters denote degrees of pseudo-coherence, and in each row the conclusion is underlined:

E	F	G
$n+1$	n	<u>n</u>
n	<u>n</u>	n
<u>n</u>	n	$n-1$.

We shall write

$$D(\mathcal{C})_{\mathcal{C}_0-n\text{coh}} \quad \text{respectively} \quad D(\mathcal{C})_{\mathcal{C}_0\text{-coh}}$$

for the strictly full fibered subcategory of $D(\mathcal{C})$ whose fiber over each $X \in \text{ob } S$ is formed by the objects of $D(\mathcal{C}_X)$ that are n -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent) relative to $\mathcal{C}_0$. By (2.5), the category

$$D(\mathcal{C})_{\mathcal{C}_0\text{-coh}}$$

is a triangulated sub- S -category of $D(\mathcal{C})$ (1.1).

Proposition 2.7. Suppose that S is the punctual site, so that

$$\mathcal{C} = \mathcal{C}_S, \quad \mathcal{C}_0 = \mathcal{C}_{0,S}.$$

Then:

- a) If $F \in \text{ob } D(\mathcal{C})$ is pseudo-coherent, there exists a quasi-isomorphism

$$E \longrightarrow F$$

with E strictly pseudo-coherent (2.1).

- b) Let $K^{-,\text{ac}}(\mathcal{C}_0)$ denote the full triangulated subcategory of $K^-(\mathcal{C}_0)$ formed by acyclic complexes. The canonical functor

$$K^-(\mathcal{C}_0)/K^{-,\text{ac}}(\mathcal{C}_0) \longrightarrow D(\mathcal{C})$$

is fully faithful and has essential image $D(\mathcal{C})_{\mathcal{C}_0\text{-coh}}$.

Proof. a) Let $F \in \text{ob } D(\mathcal{C})_{\mathcal{C}_0\text{-coh}}$, and suppose constructed an i -quasi-isomorphism

$$u_i : E_i \longrightarrow F$$

of $C(\mathcal{C})$, with E_i strictly pseudo-coherent; this is possible for i sufficiently large, taking $E_i = 0$. Let G_i be the cone of u_i . It follows from (1.4.2) and (2.1.1) that $H^{i-1}(G_i)$ is of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type. Hence, by (1.4.4), there exists a commutative triangle in $C(\mathcal{C})$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} E_i & \xrightarrow{v_{i-1}} & E_{i-1} \\ u_i \downarrow & \swarrow u_{i-1} & \\ F & & \end{array}$$

where E_{i-1} is strictly pseudo-coherent, u_{i-1} an $(i-1)$ -quasi-isomorphism, and v_{i-1} a monomorphism inducing the identity in degrees $\geq i$. Passing to the limit (cf. the proof of (1.4.5)) gives a quasi-isomorphism

$$u : E \longrightarrow F$$

with E strictly pseudo-coherent.

b) Apply the criterion of [V], Chap. I, §2, 4.2 b)(i), together with a).

We note that the proof of a) gives the following more precise result, which generalizes (1.4.5).

Proposition 2.7.1. Under the hypotheses of (2.7), let $u : E \rightarrow F$ be an n -quasi-isomorphism of $C(\mathcal{C})$, with F pseudo-coherent and E strictly pseudo-coherent. Then there exists a commutative triangle in $C(\mathcal{C})$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} E & \xrightarrow{v} & E' \\ u \downarrow & \swarrow u' & \\ F & & \end{array}$$

where E' is strictly pseudo-coherent, u' is a quasi-isomorphism, and v is a monomorphism inducing the identity in degree $\geq n$.

Definition 2.8. Let $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $F \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_S$. We shall say that F is of n - $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite presentation if the set of X over S such that there exists an exact sequence

$$E^{-n} \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow E^0 \longrightarrow F_X \longrightarrow 0, \quad E^i \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0,X} \quad (-n \leq i \leq 0),$$

is a refinement of S . We shall say that F is of ∞ - $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite presentation if F is of n - $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite presentation for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Of course, we shall sometimes simply say n -finite presentation when there is no possible ambiguity about $\mathcal{C}_0$. We shall say “finite presentation” for “1-finite presentation,” and “finite type” for “0-finite presentation,” the latter notion coinciding with the one already introduced in (1.2).

Proposition 2.9. Let $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $F \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_S$. The following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) F is of n -finite presentation (respectively of ∞ -finite presentation);
- (ii) F is $(-n)$ -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent).

In the case where S is the punctual site, F is pseudo-coherent if and only if there exists an exact sequence

$$\cdots \longrightarrow E^i \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow E^0 \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow 0, \quad E^i \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_0 \quad \text{for all } i.$$

Proof. For the equivalence (i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (ii), it is plainly enough to treat the non-parenthesized case. The implication (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii) is immediate from the definitions, and (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i) follows at once from

(2.4): the arrow $0 \rightarrow F$ is a 1-quasi-isomorphism, and from this one deduces, after localizing, a quasi-isomorphism

$$E \longrightarrow F$$

with E strictly $(-n)$ -pseudo-coherent and $E^i = 0$ for $i \geq 1$, that is, an n -finite presentation of F . The second assertion is proved in the same way, using (2.7.1).

Proposition 2.10. a) Let $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$, with $n \leq m$. If $F \in \text{ob } D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$ is n -pseudo-coherent and acyclic in degrees $\geq m$, then there exists locally a quasi-isomorphism

$$E \longrightarrow F$$

with E strictly n -pseudo-coherent and $E^i = 0$ for $i \geq m$. If S is punctual, and if F is pseudo-coherent and acyclic in degrees $\geq m$, there exists a quasi-isomorphism

$$E \longrightarrow F$$

with E strictly pseudo-coherent and $E^i = 0$ for $i \geq m$.

b) Let $F \in \text{ob } D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$ be acyclic in degrees $> n$. For F to be n -pseudo-coherent, it is necessary and sufficient that $H^n(F)$ be of finite type.

Proof. a) Since F is acyclic in degrees $\geq m$, the arrow $0 \rightarrow F$ is an m -quasi-isomorphism. The assertion follows from (2.4) and (2.7.1).

b) There exists a distinguished triangle in $D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} F & \xrightarrow{\quad} & F' \\ & \swarrow \scriptstyle +1 & \searrow \\ & H^n(F)[-n] & \end{array}$$

(to see this, begin by truncating F , replacing F^n by $Z^n(F)$ and F^i by 0 for $i > n$). The exact cohomology sequence implies

$$H^i(F') = 0 \quad \text{for } i \geq n - 1,$$

so F' is $(n - 1)$ -pseudo-coherent. We conclude by (2.5) and (2.6).

Exposé I, continued: pseudo-coherent complexes and perfect complexes

Proposition 2.11. Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$.

a) Let $F \in \text{ob } C^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$. If, for every $i \geq n$ (respectively for every i), F^i is of finite $(i - n)$ -presentation (respectively of finite ∞ -presentation), then F is n -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent).

b) Let $F \in \text{ob } D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$. If, for every $i \geq n$ (respectively for every i), $H^i(F)$ is of finite $(i - n)$ -presentation (respectively of finite ∞ -presentation), then F is pseudo-coherent.

Proof. It is enough to treat the non-parenthesized assertions.

a) We argue by induction on N such that $F^i \neq 0$ only for $i \leq n + N$. If $N = 0$, the assertion follows at once from (2.10 b). Suppose $N \geq 1$. We have an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow F^{n+N}[-n - N] \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow F' \longrightarrow 0.$$

By the induction hypothesis, F' is n -pseudo-coherent; on the other hand $F^{n+N}[-n-N]$ is n -pseudo-coherent by hypothesis, using (2.9 and 2.5 a). Hence, by (2.5 b), F is n -pseudo-coherent.

b) We argue by induction on N such that $H^i(F) = 0$ for $i > n + N$. If $N = 0$, the assertion follows from (2.10 b). Suppose $N \geq 1$. As in the proof of (2.10 b), we have a distinguished triangle in $D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$

$$F' \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow H^{n+N}(F)[-n-N] \longrightarrow F'[1].$$

more plainly, with cone $H^{n+N}(F)[-n-N]$. The exact cohomology sequence implies

$$H^i(F') = 0 \quad \text{for } i > n + N - 1,$$

that is, for $i > (n-1) + (N-1)$, and

$$H^i(F') \xrightarrow{\sim} H^{i+1}(F) \quad \text{for } i < n + N - 1.$$

By the induction hypothesis, applied with $n-1$ in place of n , F' is therefore $(n-1)$ -pseudo-coherent. On the other hand, $H^{n+N}(F)[-n-N]$ is n -pseudo-coherent by (2.9 and 2.5 a). Hence, by (2.6), F is n -pseudo-coherent.

Remark 2.11.1. If F is pseudo-coherent, the F^i (respectively the $H^i(F)$) are not in general pseudo-coherent, nor even of finite type. Nevertheless, in the following paragraph, in the excursions on the notions of coherence, we shall see important examples where pseudo-coherence of F implies that of the $H^i(F)$.

Proposition 2.12. Let $F', F'' \in \text{ob } D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$, and let $F = F' \oplus F''$. For F to be n -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent), it is necessary and sufficient that F' and F'' be n -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent).

Proof. It is enough to prove the non-parenthesized assertion. Sufficiency is obvious; let us prove necessity. By induction we may suppose that it has already been proved that F' and F'' are $(n+1)$ -pseudo-coherent. After localizing, we may even suppose that F' and F'' are strictly $(n+1)$ -pseudo-coherent and that $F = F' \oplus F''$ in $C^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$. Let $F'_{>n}$ (respectively $F'_{\leq n}$) denote the complex obtained from F' by replacing F'^i by 0 for $i \leq n$ (respectively for $i > n$), and define $F''_{>n}$ and $F''_{\leq n}$ similarly. We have an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow F'_{>n} \oplus F''_{>n} \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow F'_{\leq n} \oplus F''_{\leq n} \longrightarrow 0.$$

The complex $F'_{>n} \oplus F''_{>n}$ is strictly perfect; since F is n -pseudo-coherent, (2.6) implies that $F'_{\leq n} \oplus F''_{\leq n}$ is n -pseudo-coherent. This means, by (2.10 b), that

$$H^n(F'_{\leq n} \oplus F''_{\leq n})$$

is of finite type. But

$$H^n(F'_{\leq n} \oplus F''_{\leq n}) = H^n(F'_{\leq n}) \oplus H^n(F''_{\leq n}),$$

so $H^n(F'_{\leq n})$ (respectively $H^n(F''_{\leq n})$) is of finite type, and again by (2.10 b) $F'_{\leq n}$ (respectively $F''_{\leq n}$) is n -pseudo-coherent. Applying (2.5) to the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow F'_{>n} \longrightarrow F' \longrightarrow F'_{\leq n} \longrightarrow 0$$

(and similarly for F''), we deduce that F' and F'' are n -pseudo-coherent.

Proposition 2.13. Let $(S', \mathcal{C}', \mathcal{C}'_0)$ be a triple satisfying the same hypotheses (2.0) as $(S, \mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$. Let $f : S' \rightarrow S$ be a morphism of sites, corresponding to an underlying functor $f^{-1} : S \rightarrow S'$, and let

$$u : D^*(\mathcal{C}) \longrightarrow D^*(\mathcal{C}') \quad (* = +, -, b)$$

be a Cartesian functor above f , exact on each fiber. Suppose that there exist $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that, for every $S \in \text{ob } S$, the following conditions hold:

- (i) if $E \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0,S}$, then $u(E)$ is $a\text{-}\mathcal{C}'_0$ -pseudo-coherent (respectively $\mathcal{C}'_0$ -pseudo-coherent);
- (ii) if $F \in \text{ob } D^*(\mathcal{C}_S)$ is acyclic in degrees > 0 , then $u(F)$ is acyclic in degrees $> b$.

Then, if $F \in \text{ob } D^*(\mathcal{C}_S)$ is m -pseudo-coherent relative to $\mathcal{C}_0$ and acyclic in degrees $> n$, the object

$$u(F) \in \text{ob } D^*(\mathcal{C}'_{S'}), \quad S' = f^{-1}(S),$$

is $\sup(m+b, n+a)$ -pseudo-coherent relative to $\mathcal{C}'_0$ (respectively $(m+b)$ -pseudo-coherent), and is acyclic in degrees $> n+b$. In particular, in the parenthesized case, if $F \in \text{ob } D^*(\mathcal{C}_S)$ is pseudo-coherent relative to $\mathcal{C}_0$, then $u(F)$ is pseudo-coherent relative to $\mathcal{C}'_0$.

Proof. We may restrict to the non-parenthesized case. First suppose that $F \in \text{ob } D^*(\mathcal{C}_S)$ is strictly perfect (2.1), with $F^i = 0$ for $i > n$. Then $u(F)$ is $(n+a)\text{-}\mathcal{C}'_0$ -pseudo-coherent. We argue by induction on the number N of indices i such that $F^i \neq 0$. If $N = 1$, then $F = F^p[-p]$ for some $p \leq n$, so $u(F)$ is $(p+a)\text{-}\mathcal{C}'_0$ -pseudo-coherent, hence a fortiori $(n+a)$ -pseudo-coherent. If $N > 1$, there is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow F' \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow F'' \longrightarrow 0,$$

where F' and F'' are strictly perfect of length $< N-1$, and where $F'^i = F''^i = 0$ for $i > n$. Applying (2.5 b) to the distinguished triangle

$$u(F') \longrightarrow u(F) \longrightarrow u(F'') \longrightarrow u(F')[1].$$

and using the induction hypothesis, we get that $u(F)$ is $(n+a)$ -pseudo-coherent.

Now pass to the general case: F is $m\text{-}\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent and acyclic in degrees $> n$. After localizing, we may, by (2.10 a), suppose F strictly m -pseudo-coherent and such that $F^i = 0$ for $i > n$. There is then an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow F' \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow F'' \longrightarrow 0,$$

where F'' is zero in degrees $\geq m$, and F' is strictly perfect and zero in degrees $> n$. In the distinguished triangle

$$u(F') \longrightarrow u(F) \longrightarrow u(F'') \longrightarrow u(F')[1].$$

the object $u(F'')$ is acyclic in degrees $> m+b$, hence $(m+b)$ -pseudo-coherent, while $u(F')$ is $(n+a)$ -pseudo-coherent by what was just proved. We conclude by (2.5 b).

Corollary 2.14. Let $\mathcal{C}_1$ be a strictly full additive sub- S -category of $\mathcal{C}$ such that

$$\mathcal{C}_0 \subset \mathcal{C}_1 \subset \mathcal{C}.$$

Assume that every object of $\mathcal{C}_1$ is $\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent. Then:

- (i) $\mathcal{C}_1$ is locally quasi-liftable in $\mathcal{C}$ (1.2), and locally quasi-stable under kernels of epimorphisms (1.2);
- (ii) for $S \in \text{ob } S$ and $F \in \text{ob } D(\mathcal{C}_S)$, in order that F be n -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent) relative to $\mathcal{C}_1$, it is necessary and sufficient that it be so relative to $\mathcal{C}_0$.

Proof. For (i), let $E \rightarrow F$ be an epimorphism in $\mathcal{C}_S$, with $F \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{1,S}$. Since F is $\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent, hence a fortiori of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type, there exists, after localizing, an epimorphism $E' \rightarrow F$ with $E' \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0,S}$. Using the quasi-liftability of $\mathcal{C}_0$ in $\mathcal{C}$, we may suppose, after localizing again, that this epimorphism factors through E ; this gives the quasi-liftability of $\mathcal{C}_1$. On the other

hand, if $E \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_S$ admits a finite right resolution by objects of $\mathcal{C}_1$, then E is $\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent by (2.11 a), hence a fortiori of $\mathcal{C}_1$ -finite type.

For (ii), it is enough to prove necessity. For this one may apply, at choice, (2.11 a) or (2.13), with $S' = S$, $\mathcal{C}' = \mathcal{C}$, $f = \text{Id}$, $u = \text{Id}$, and with $\mathcal{C}'_0$ and $\mathcal{C}_0$ replaced respectively by $\mathcal{C}_0$ and $\mathcal{C}_1$.

Scholium 2.14.1. There is therefore a largest strictly full additive sub- S -category of $\mathcal{C}$ giving the same notion of n -pseudo-coherence (respectively pseudo-coherence) as $\mathcal{C}_0$, namely the category formed by the $\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent objects. This latter category is locally stable under kernels of epimorphisms.

Example 2.15. Let (S, A) be a ringed topos, and let $\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0$ be the S -categories considered in (1.3 d). The fibered category $\text{D}(\mathcal{C})$ will often be denoted by $\text{D}(S, A)$, or $\text{D}_A(S)$, when one wants to suggest that the modules are left A -modules, or even simply $\text{D}(S)$ if there is no ambiguity about A . We denote by S the final object of S , and put $\text{D}(\mathcal{C}_S) = \text{D}_A(S)$ (or $\text{D}(S)$). An object of $\text{D}(S)$ will be said to be n -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent) if it is n - $\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent (respectively $\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent), and similarly for the strict notions. The category fibered in $\text{D}(\mathcal{C})$, denoted $\text{D}(\mathcal{C})_{n-\mathcal{C}_0-\text{coh}}$ (respectively $\text{D}(\mathcal{C})_{\mathcal{C}_0-\text{coh}}$) in (2.6), will be denoted $\text{D}_A(S)_{n-\text{coh}}$ (respectively $\text{D}_A(S)_{\text{coh}}$). One observes that, by (2.14), the same notion of pseudo-coherence is obtained if $\mathcal{C}_0$ is replaced by the S -category $\mathcal{C}_1$ defined by

$U \mapsto$ the category of left A_U -modules locally direct summands of free finite-type modules.

If an A -module M is a direct summand of a free finite-type A -module, it does not follow in general that M is locally free of finite type. One does, however, have the following result.

Lemma 2.15.1. Suppose that S satisfies one of the following two hypotheses:

- (i) S has enough points (SGA 4 IV 6.4), and for every point s of S , the left A_s -modules which are projective of finite type are free; this last condition is satisfied, for example, if $A_s/\text{rad}(A_s)$ is a field or if $\text{rad}(A_s)$ is nilpotent;
- (ii) (S, A) is a “locally ringed” topos in the sense of [1], which means that A is commutative and that, for every $X \in \text{ob } S$ and every $f \in \Gamma(X, A)$, one has

$$X = X_f \cup X_{1-f},$$

where X_f (respectively X_{1-f}) denotes the largest subobject of X on which f (respectively $1 - f$) is invertible.

Then every direct summand of a free finite-type left A -module is locally free of finite type.

Proof. Suppose first that (i) holds. We note that, if E and F are two A -modules and E is of finite presentation, the canonical arrow

$$\text{Hom}(E, F)_s \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(E_s, F_s)$$

is an isomorphism for every point s of S . It follows that, if E and F are both of finite presentation and if $E_s \xrightarrow{\sim} F_s$ at a point s of S , then there is an s -pointed object U of S such that $E|U \xrightarrow{\sim} F|U$. The conclusion follows at once.

Suppose next that (ii) holds. Let $n \in \mathbb{N}$, and let $\mathbb{D}^n$ denote the functor on the category of locally ringed topoi belonging to a fixed universe, defined by

$$T \mapsto \Gamma(T, \mathcal{O}_T)^n.$$

It is known [1] that the functor $\text{End}_{\mathbb{D}}(\mathbb{D}^n)$ is represented by

$$M_n = \text{Spec } \mathbb{Z}[T_{ij}] \quad (1 \leq i \leq n, 1 \leq j \leq n),$$

endowed with the endomorphism U_n of $(\mathcal{O}_{M_n})^n$ defined by the matrix (T_{ij}) . Now let

$$p : A^n \longrightarrow A^n$$

be a projector. We show that $p(A^n)$ is locally free of finite type. From what has just been said, there exists a morphism

$$s : S \longrightarrow M_n$$

of locally ringed topoi such that $s^*(u_n) = p$. We may interpret s as a point of M_n with values in $\Gamma(S, A)$, that is, as a matrix of order n with coefficients in $\Gamma(S, A)$. Since this matrix is a projector, s factors through the closed subscheme

$$i : P_n \hookrightarrow M_n$$

corresponding to projectors; say $S \xrightarrow{s'} P_n \xrightarrow{i} M_n$. Hence

$$p = s'^* i^*(u_n),$$

and we are done, because, by the assertion under hypothesis (i), the image of $i^*(u_n)$ is a locally free finite-type sheaf.

Corollary 2.16. Let

$$f : (S', A') \longrightarrow (S, A)$$

be a morphism of ringed topoi, defined by a functor $f^{-1} : S \rightarrow S'$ and a morphism of sheaves of rings $f^{-1}(A) \rightarrow A'$. Let $D(A'S'_A)$ denote the derived category of A' - A -bimodules, left over A' and right over A , and let

$$\otimes_A^L : D^-(A'S'_A) \times_{S'} D^-(AS) \longrightarrow D^-(A'S')$$

be the derived functor of the tensor product

$$(E', E) \longmapsto E' \otimes_A f^{-1}(E).$$

Let $X \in \text{ob } S$, put $X' = u(X)$, and let $E' \in \text{ob } D^-(A'X'_A)$, $E \in \text{ob } D^-(AX)$. If E' is m' -pseudo-coherent (as an object of $D^-(A'S')$) and acyclic in degrees $> n'$, and if E is m -pseudo-coherent and acyclic in degrees $> n$, then

$$E' \otimes_A^L E$$

is $\sup(m + n', m' + n)$ -pseudo-coherent and acyclic in degrees $> n + n'$.

Proof. After replacing S by S/X , we may suppose $X = S$, and apply (2.13) with

$$u = E' \otimes_A^L : D^-(AS) \longrightarrow D^-(A'S').$$

Let $U \in \text{ob } S$, let $U' = f^{-1}(U)$, and let E be a complex of left A_U -modules. If E is acyclic in degrees $> n$, then $E' \otimes_A^L E$ is acyclic in degrees $> n + n'$, by the definition of $\otimes_A^L$. On the other hand, if $E = (A_U)^p$, then

$$E' \otimes_A^L E = (E'|U')^p,$$

which is m' -pseudo-coherent by hypothesis and (2.12). The conditions of (2.13) are therefore satisfied, with $a = m'$ and $b = n'$, whence the conclusion.

In particular:

Corollary 2.16.1. Under the hypotheses of (2.16), one has:

a) The functor

$$Lf^* : D^-(AS) \longrightarrow D^-(A'S')$$

(which is none other than the functor $A' \otimes_A^L$) induces a functor

$$Lf^* : D^-(A S)_{\text{coh}} \longrightarrow D^-(A' S')_{\text{coh}}$$

(with the notation of (2.6)).

b) If A is commutative, the functor

$$\otimes_A^L : D^-(S) \times_S D^-(S) \longrightarrow D^-(S)$$

induces a functor

$$\otimes_A^L : D^-(S)_{\text{coh}} \times_S D^-(S)_{\text{coh}} \longrightarrow D^-(S)_{\text{coh}}.$$

Exercise 2.16.2. Let S be a topos, and let $A \rightarrow A'$ be a morphism of rings of S . Assume one of the following hypotheses:

- (i) $A \rightarrow A'$ is surjective, with nilpotent ideal as kernel;
- (ii) the functor $A' \otimes_A -$, on the category of left A -modules, is exact and faithful.

Show that $E \in \text{ob } D^-(A S)$ is n -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent) if and only if

$$A' \otimes_A E \in \text{ob } D^-(A' S)$$

is n -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent).

Hints: first show that a left A -module L is of finite type if and only if $A' \otimes_A L$ is of finite type (cf. Bourbaki, Commutative Algebra, Chap. I, §3, Prop. 11 and Chap. II, §3, Prop. 4), and then reduce to this case by truncation, using (2.5) and (2.10 b).

3. Link with the classical notion of coherence

3.0. The hypotheses and notation are those of (2.0), except that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is no longer assumed locally quasi-stable under kernels of epimorphisms.

Definition 3.1. Let $F \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_S$. We shall say that F is *precoherent* relative to $\mathcal{C}_0$ if, for every U over S and every morphism

$$u : E \longrightarrow F|_U,$$

where $E \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0,U}$, $\text{Ker}(u)$ is of $\mathcal{C}_0$ -finite type (1.2). We shall say that F is *coherent* relative to $\mathcal{C}_0$ if F is precoherent and of finite type.

Technical note. We introduce this notion here only as a technical intermediary; the only notion to retain is that of coherence.

Remark 3.2. Let $F \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_S$. It is clear from the definitions that, if F is precoherent (respectively of finite type), then every subobject (respectively quotient) of F is precoherent (respectively of finite type).

Lemma 3.3.

a) Let

$$0 \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow G \longrightarrow H$$

be an exact sequence of $\mathcal{C}_S$. If G is of finite type and H is precoherent, then F is of finite type.

b) Let

$$F \longrightarrow G \longrightarrow H \longrightarrow 0$$

be an exact sequence of $\mathcal{C}_S$. If F is of finite type and G is precoherent, then H is precoherent.

c) Let

$$0 \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow G \longrightarrow H \longrightarrow 0$$

be an exact sequence of $\mathcal{C}_S$. If F and H are precoherent (respectively of finite type), then so is G .

Proof. a) After localizing, there is an epimorphism $G' \rightarrow G$ with $G' \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_0$. Hence there is a commutative diagram with exact rows

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & F' & \longrightarrow & G' & \longrightarrow & H \\ & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \text{Id} \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & F & \longrightarrow & G & \longrightarrow & H. \end{array}$$

Since H is precoherent, F' is of finite type; but $F' \rightarrow F$ is an epimorphism, so F is of finite type.

b) Let U be over S , and let $H' \xrightarrow{f} H|_U$ be a morphism of $\mathcal{C}_U$, with $H' \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0,U}$. After a change of notation, we may suppose $U = S$. By the quasi-liftability of $\mathcal{C}_0$ in $\mathcal{C}$, there exists, after localizing, a commutative square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} G' & \xrightarrow{p} & H' \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow f \\ G & \longrightarrow & H, \end{array}$$

where the horizontal arrows are epimorphisms and $G' \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_0$. Since $\text{Ker}(f)$ is a quotient of $\text{Ker}(fp)$, it is enough to show that $\text{Ker}(fp)$ is of finite type; hence we may suppose $H' = G'$. The arrows $F \rightarrow G$ and $H' \rightarrow G$ define

$$g : F \oplus H' \longrightarrow G.$$

Putting $K = \text{Ker}(G \rightarrow H)$, we have a commutative diagram, with exact rows and with q an epimorphism,

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & F & \longrightarrow & F \oplus H' & \longrightarrow & H' & \longrightarrow & 0 \\ & & \downarrow q & & \downarrow g & & \downarrow f & & \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & K & \longrightarrow & G & \longrightarrow & H & \longrightarrow & 0. \end{array}$$

The snake diagram shows that $\text{Ker}(g) \rightarrow \text{Ker}(f)$ is an epimorphism. But, since $F \oplus H'$ is of finite type and G is precoherent, $\text{Ker}(g)$ is of finite type by a); hence we are done.

c) First prove the non-parenthesized assertion. Up to a change of notation, it is a matter of showing that, if $g : G' \rightarrow G$ is a morphism of $\mathcal{C}_S$, with $G' \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_0$, then $\text{Ker}(g)$ is of finite type. Let H' be the image of the composed arrow $G' \rightarrow H$. We have a commutative diagram with exact rows

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & F' & \longrightarrow & G' & \longrightarrow & H' & \longrightarrow & 0 \\ & & \downarrow f & & \downarrow g & & \downarrow h & & \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & F & \longrightarrow & G & \longrightarrow & H & \longrightarrow & 0. \end{array}$$

Since h is a monomorphism, the snake diagram gives an isomorphism $\text{Ker}(f) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Ker}(g)$. But F' is of finite type by a), hence $\text{Ker}(f)$ is of finite type, again by a). This proves the non-parenthesized assertion. For the parenthesized assertion, strictly speaking one cannot invoke (2.5 b), since $\mathcal{C}_0$ is not assumed locally quasi-stable under kernels of epimorphisms. After localizing, there are epimorphisms

$$F' \xrightarrow{u} F, \quad H' \xrightarrow{v} H,$$

with $F', H' \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_0$. After localizing further, we may suppose that v factors through G , whence a commutative diagram with exact rows

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & F' & \longrightarrow & F' \oplus H' & \longrightarrow & H' & \longrightarrow & 0 \\ & & \downarrow u & & \downarrow w & & \downarrow v & & \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & F & \longrightarrow & G & \longrightarrow & H & \longrightarrow & 0. \end{array}$$

Since u and v are epimorphisms, so is w , and this proves the assertion. The proof of (3.3) is complete.

It follows immediately that:

Corollary 3.4. The full (respectively strictly full) subcategory of $\mathcal{C}_S$ formed by coherent objects is stable under finite projective (respectively inductive) limits. In particular, the kernel, cokernel, and image of an arrow between two coherent objects are coherent. Let

$$E^0 \longrightarrow E^1 \longrightarrow E^2 \longrightarrow E^3 \longrightarrow E^4$$

be an exact sequence of $\mathcal{C}_S$. If E^0, E^1, E^3, E^4 are coherent, then E^2 is coherent as well.

Corollary 3.5. Suppose that the objects of $\mathcal{C}_0$ are $\mathcal{C}_0$ -coherent (which in particular implies that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is locally quasi-stable under kernels of epimorphisms, that is, that we are under the conditions of (2.0)).

a) For $F \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_S$, the following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) F is of finite presentation;
- (ii) F is coherent;
- (iii) F is of finite ∞ -presentation (2.8).

b) Let $F \in \text{ob } D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$, and let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then

$$F \text{ is } n\text{-pseudo-coherent} \iff \begin{array}{l} H^i(F) \text{ is coherent for } i \geq n+1, \\ \text{and } H^n(F) \text{ is of finite type.} \end{array}$$

In particular, for F to be pseudo-coherent it is necessary and sufficient that $H^n(F)$ be coherent for every n .

Proof. Assertion a) and the implication $\Rightarrow$ in b) follow trivially from (3.4). The implication $\Leftarrow$ in b) follows at once from a) and (2.11 b).

Examples 3.6. Let (S, A) be a ringed topos, and let $\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0$ be the S -categories of (1.3 d), also as in (2.15). In order that the objects of $\mathcal{C}_0$ be coherent, it is necessary and sufficient that A be coherent, that is, precoherent. Here are examples where this is the case:

- A is constant with value a left noetherian ring (SGA 4 IX 2.1);
- S is the topos of sheaves of sets, for the Zariski topology, on a locally noetherian scheme S , and $A = \mathcal{O}_S$;
- S is the topos of sheaves of sets on a complex analytic space S , and $A = \mathcal{O}_S$.

On the other hand, the sheaf of continuous complex-valued functions on a topological space is not coherent in general.

Of course, if (S, A) is defined by a ringed space, the notion of coherence considered here coincides with the usual notion of Serre (EGA 0_I, 5.3.1).

Proposition 3.7. a) Let

$$f : (S', A') \longrightarrow (S, A)$$

be a morphism of ringed topoi. Assume that f is flat on the right, that is, that the functor $f^* = A' \otimes_A -$ is exact. There is, for $F \in \text{ob } D_A^-(S)$ and $G \in \text{ob } D_A^+(S)$, a functorial canonical arrow

$$f^* \text{RHom}(F, G) \longrightarrow \text{RHom}(f^*(F), f^*(G)).$$

This arrow is an isomorphism when F is pseudo-coherent.

b) Suppose A is commutative and coherent, and let $F \in \text{ob } D^-(S)$, $G \in \text{ob } D^+(S)$. If $H^i(F)$ and $H^i(G)$ are coherent for all i , then the same is true of $\text{Ext}^i(F, G)$.

Proof. a) To define the arrow (cf. SGA 4 XVII), one may suppose that G has injective components, and one takes the composite arrow

$$f^* \text{Hom}(F, G) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(f^*F, f^*G) \longrightarrow \text{RHom}(f^*F, f^*G).$$

Let us show that it is an isomorphism for F pseudo-coherent. For brevity write T (respectively T') for the functor $f^* \text{RHom}(\cdot, G)$ (respectively $\text{RHom}(f^*\cdot, f^*G)$), and let $a \in \mathbb{Z}$ be such that $H^i(G) = 0$ for $i < a$. It is clear that one has $TA \xrightarrow{\sim} T'A$, hence by dévissage $TF \xrightarrow{\sim} T'F$ for F strictly perfect (2.1). On the other hand, if F is acyclic in degrees $> n$, then TF and $T'F$ are acyclic in degrees $< a - n$. To verify that $TF \xrightarrow{\sim} T'F$ for F pseudo-coherent, the question being local, one may suppose F strictly n -pseudo-coherent; that is, there is a distinguished triangle

$$F' \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow F'' \longrightarrow F'[1].$$

with F' strictly perfect and F'' acyclic in degrees $> n - 1$. From this one obtains a morphism of distinguished triangles

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} TF'' & \longrightarrow & TF & \longrightarrow & TF' \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ T'F'' & \longrightarrow & T'F & \longrightarrow & T'F'. \end{array}$$

Now $TF' \xrightarrow{\sim} T'F'$, since F' is strictly perfect, and TF'' and $T'F''$ are acyclic in degrees $\leq a - n$. Writing the induced morphism on the exact cohomology sequences of the preceding triangles, one deduces that $TF \rightarrow T'F$ induces an isomorphism

$$H^i(TF) \xrightarrow{\sim} H^i(T'F)$$

for $i \leq a - n$. Since n may be chosen arbitrarily negative, this proves the assertion.

b) The proof is left as an exercise to the reader; see, for example, [H] II 3.3.

Remark 3.7.1. We shall see below (7.1.2) another case of compatibility of RHom with Lf^* .

Corollary 3.7.2. (cf. EGA 0_I, 5.2.7.) Let (S, A) be a ringed topoi, let s be a point of S (SGA 4 VIII 7.8), and let

$$E, F \in \text{ob } D_{A, \text{coh}}^b(S).$$

If $E_s \xrightarrow{\sim} F_s$, then there exists an s -pointed object U of S such that

$$E|U \xrightarrow{\sim} F|U.$$

Proof. Let $\alpha : E_s \rightarrow F_s$ and $\beta : F_s \rightarrow E_s$ be reciprocal isomorphisms. By (2.22 a), one has

$$\text{Hom}(E, F)_s \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}(E_s, F_s), \quad \text{Hom}(F, E)_s \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}(F_s, E_s).$$

There are therefore a neighbourhood U of s and a section u (respectively v) of $\text{Hom}(E, F)$ (respectively of $\text{Hom}(F, E)$) over U such that $u_s = \alpha$ (respectively $v_s = \beta$). The morphisms $vu : E|U \rightarrow E|U$ and $uv : F|U \rightarrow F|U$ induce the identity at s ; hence on a suitable V over U , as required.

4. Perfect complexes

4.0. In this section, S denotes a site, S an object of S , $\mathcal{C}$ a flat abelian S -category, and $\mathcal{C}_0$ a strictly full additive sub- S -category of $\mathcal{C}$ (1.1). Unless otherwise mentioned, we suppose that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is locally liftable in $\mathcal{C}$ and locally stable under kernels of epimorphisms (1.2).

Lemma 4.1. Let

$$u : E \longrightarrow F$$

be an arrow of $\mathcal{C}(C_S)$. If E is strictly $\mathcal{C}_0$ -perfect (2.1) and F is acyclic, then u is locally homotopic to zero.

Proof. One has to construct locally a homotopy k such that

$$u = dk + kd.$$

Since E is strictly perfect, there are $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$, with $a \leq b$, such that $E^i = 0$ for $i \notin [a, b]$. Thus one may take $k^i = 0$ for $i \notin [a, b]$. We construct the k^i , for $i > a$, by descending induction on i . Suppose $k^i : E^i \rightarrow F^{i-1}$ has been constructed so that

$$u^i = k^{i+1}d_E^i + d_F^{i-1}k^i$$

for $i > n > a$. We show that, after localizing, there exists

$$k^{n-1} : E^{n-1} \longrightarrow F^{n-2}$$

such that

$$u^{n-1} = k^n d_E^{n-1} + d_F^{n-2} k^{n-1}.$$

By the induction hypothesis, the arrow

$$v^{n-1} = u^{n-1} - k^n d_E^{n-1} : E^{n-1} \longrightarrow F^{n-1}$$

factors through $Z^{n-1}(F)$. But $Z^{n-1}(F) = B^{n-1}(F)$, since F is acyclic. Since $\mathcal{C}_0$ is locally liftable in $\mathcal{C}$, it follows, after localizing, that there exists $k^{n-1} : E^{n-1} \rightarrow F^{n-2}$ such that $v^{n-1} = d_F^{n-2} k^{n-1}$, as required.

Corollary 4.2. Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} P & & \\ v \downarrow & & \\ F & \xleftarrow{f} & E \end{array}$$

be a diagram of $\mathcal{C}(C_S)$, where P is strictly $\mathcal{C}_0$ -perfect and f is a quasi-isomorphism. The set of X over S for which there exists an arrow

$$u : P_X \longrightarrow E_X$$

of $\mathcal{C}(C_X)$ such that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & & P_X \\ & \nearrow u & \downarrow v_X \\ E_X & \xrightarrow{f_X} & F_X \end{array}$$

is commutative in $K(\mathcal{C}_X)$, is a refinement of S .

Proof. Let G be the cone of f . There is an exact sequence

$$\longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_{K(\mathcal{C}_S)}(P, E) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_{K(\mathcal{C}_S)}(P, F) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_{K(\mathcal{C}_S)}(P, G) \longrightarrow .$$

Since G is acyclic, the image of v in $\mathrm{Hom}_{K(\mathcal{C}_S)}(P, G)$ is locally zero by (4.1). Therefore, after localizing, there exists $u : P \rightarrow E$ such that $v = fu$ in $K(\mathcal{C}_S)$, as required.

Corollary 4.3. Let $f : E \rightarrow F$ be a quasi-isomorphism of $C(\mathcal{C}_S)$, with F strictly perfect relative to $\mathcal{C}_0$. The set of X over S for which there exists a quasi-isomorphism

$$g : F_X \longrightarrow E_X$$

such that $f_X g$ is homotopic to Id_{F_X} , is a refinement of S .

Proof. This is a special case of (4.2).

Scholium 4.4. Let $F \in \mathrm{ob} K(\mathcal{C}_S)$. One may define, for example with the aid of a cleavage of $\mathcal{C}$ (SGA 1 VI 7.1), a category (Qis/F) fibered over S/S , whose fiber over X over S is the category $(\mathrm{Qis}/F_X)^\circ$, opposite to the category of quasi-isomorphisms with target F_X . One may then express (4.3) by saying that, if F is strictly perfect, the arrow Id_F is locally cofinal in (Qis/F) .

Notation 4.5. Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a fibered S -category. Let $X \in \mathrm{ob} S$, and let $E, F \in \mathrm{ob} \mathcal{M}_X$. We shall denote by

$$\underline{\mathrm{Hom}}_{\mathcal{M}}(E, F)$$

the sheaf on S/X associated to the presheaf of S -morphisms from E to F in $\mathcal{M}$. For the definition of this presheaf, see [G] I 2.6. One must be careful that, even if $\mathcal{C}$ is a stack ([G]), the corresponding presheaf for $\mathcal{M} = K(\mathcal{C})$ or $D(\mathcal{C})$ is not in general a sheaf.

Corollary 4.6. Let $E, F \in \mathrm{ob} C(\mathcal{C}_S)$, with E strictly perfect. The canonical arrow

$$\underline{\mathrm{Hom}}_{K(\mathcal{C})}(E, F) \longrightarrow \underline{\mathrm{Hom}}_{D(\mathcal{C})}(E, F)$$

is an isomorphism.

Proof. This is an immediate consequence of (4.4) and of the formula

$$\underline{\mathrm{Hom}}_{D(\mathcal{C}_X)}(E_X, F_X) = \lim_{(\mathrm{Qis}/E_X)^\circ} \underline{\mathrm{Hom}}_{K(\mathcal{C}_X)}(\cdot, F_X)$$

for X over S .

Definition 4.7. Let $F \in \mathrm{ob} D(\mathcal{C}_S)$, and let $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$, with $a \leq b$. We shall say that F has $\mathcal{C}_0$ -perfect amplitude contained in the interval $[a, b]$, and we shall write

$$\mathcal{C}_0\text{-Parf-amp}(F) \subset [a, b],$$

if the set of X over S for which there exists a quasi-isomorphism

$$F' \longrightarrow F$$

in $C(\mathcal{C}_X)$, with F' strictly $\mathcal{C}_0$ -perfect (2.1) and such that $F'^i = 0$ for $i \notin [a, b]$, is a refinement of S . By (4.3), this condition is equivalent to the one obtained by replacing “quasi-isomorphism in $C(\mathcal{C}_X)$ ” by “isomorphism in $D(\mathcal{C}_X)$.” We shall say that F has finite $\mathcal{C}_0$ -perfect amplitude if there are integers a and b such that $\mathcal{C}_0\text{-Parf-amp}(F) \subset [a, b]$. We shall say that F is $\mathcal{C}_0$ -perfect if F is locally of finite $\mathcal{C}_0$ -perfect amplitude.

Example 4.8. Let (S, A) be a ringed topos, let $\mathcal{C}$ be the S -category defined by

$$U \longmapsto \text{the category of left } A_U\text{-modules,}$$

and let $\mathcal{C}_0$ be the sub- S -category defined by

$U \mapsto$ the category of left A_U -modules which are direct summands of free finite-type modules.

The pair $(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$ satisfies the hypotheses (4.0) by (1.3.1). An object F of $D_A(S)$ (cf. (2.15)) will be said to have perfect amplitude contained in $[a, b]$ (respectively finite perfect amplitude, respectively to be perfect) if F has $\mathcal{C}_0$ -perfect amplitude contained in $[a, b]$ (respectively the corresponding property). When the direct summands of free finite-type modules are locally free (cf. (2.15.1)), to say that F is perfect means that F is locally isomorphic, in $D(S)$, to a bounded complex whose components are free of finite type.

Notation 4.9. We shall denote by $D(\mathcal{C})_{\mathcal{C}_0\text{-Parf}}$, or $\text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$, the strictly full sub- S -category of $D(\mathcal{C})$ formed by the $\mathcal{C}_0$ -perfect objects. In the case of Example (4.8), we shall write $D_A(S)_{\text{Parf}}$, or $\text{Parf}_A(S)$, or simply $\text{Parf}(S)$ if no ambiguity about A is possible.

Proposition 4.10. The category $\text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$ is a triangulated sub- S -category of $D(\mathcal{C})$ (1.1.4). The canonical functor

$$K^b(\mathcal{C}_0) \longrightarrow \text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$$

(respectively

$$\text{Tr}(K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)) \longrightarrow \text{Tr}(\text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0))$$

(1.1.3)) induces an S -equivalence on the associated stacks ([G] II 2.2.4), which means:

- (i) for every $X \in \text{ob } S$ and all $E, F \in \text{ob } K^b(\mathcal{C}_{0,X})$ (respectively $\text{Tr}(K^b(\mathcal{C}_{0,X}))$), the canonical arrow

$$\text{Hom}_{K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)}(E, F) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}_{D(\mathcal{C})}(E, F)$$

(respectively

$$\text{Hom}_{\text{Tr}(K^b(\mathcal{C}_0))}(E, F) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}_{\text{Tr}(D(\mathcal{C}))}(E, F)$$

) is an isomorphism; and

- (ii) every object of $\text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$ (respectively of $\text{Tr}(\text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0))$) is locally isomorphic in $D(\mathcal{C})$ (respectively in $\text{Tr}(D(\mathcal{C}))$) to an object of $K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)$ (respectively of $\text{Tr}(K^b(\mathcal{C}_0))$).

Proof. The non-parenthesized assertion (i) is a special case of (4.6), and the non-parenthesized assertion (ii) is true by the definition (4.7) and (4.9). It is clear, moreover, that $\text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$ is stable under translation of degrees. To prove that $\text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$ is a triangulated sub- S -category of $D(\mathcal{C})$, it remains to show that, if

$$E \xrightarrow{u} F \longrightarrow G \longrightarrow E[1]. \quad (*)$$

is a distinguished triangle of $D(\mathcal{C})$ with E and F perfect, then G is perfect. After localizing, we may suppose that E and F are objects of $K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)$. After localizing further, we may suppose, by the non-parenthesized assertion (i), that u is an arrow of $K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)$; then G is perfect, since it is isomorphic to the cone of u , which is strictly perfect. Hence $\text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$ is indeed a triangulated sub- S -category of $D(\mathcal{C})$. The preceding argument also proves the parenthesized assertion (ii). It remains to prove the parenthesized assertion (i). Let $X \in \text{ob } S$, and let

$$E = (E_1 \xrightarrow{a_1} E_2 \xrightarrow{a_2} E_3 \xrightarrow{a_3} E_1[+1]), \quad F = (F_1 \xrightarrow{b_1} F_2 \xrightarrow{b_2} F_3 \xrightarrow{b_3} F_1[+1])$$

be distinguished triangles of $K^b(\mathcal{C}_{0,X})$. We must show that

$$\text{Hom}_{\text{Tr}(K^b(\mathcal{C}_0))}(E, F) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}_{\text{Tr}(D(\mathcal{C}))}(E, F) \quad (**)$$

is an isomorphism. By the non-parenthesized assertion (i), we already know that $(**)$ is injective. Let $(u_i) : E \rightarrow F$ be a morphism of triangles in $D(\mathcal{C})$. After localizing, the non-parenthesized assertion (i) permits us to suppose that u_i , for $1 \leq i \leq 3$, is an arrow of $K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)$. The arrow

$$u_{i+1}a_i - b_i u_i,$$

for $1 \leq i \leq 3$ (with the convention $u_4 = u_1$), is zero in $D(\mathcal{C})$, hence locally zero in $K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)$ by the non-parenthesized assertion (i). In other words, (u_i) locally defines a morphism of triangles in $K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)$. This proves that $(**)$ is surjective and completes the proof of (4.10).

Remark 4.10.1. In (4.10), one may replace $\text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$ by

$$D^*(\mathcal{C})_{\mathcal{C}_0\text{-Parf}} = D^*(\mathcal{C}) \cap \text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0) \quad (* = - \text{ or } b),$$

and nothing changes in the proof.

Complement 4.11. The triangulated structure of $\text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$ can be made more precise in terms of perfect amplitude (4.7). If $E \in \text{ob } D(\mathcal{C})$ has perfect amplitude contained in $[a, b]$, then $E[n]$ has perfect amplitude contained in $[a - n, b - n]$.

Let

$$E \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow G \longrightarrow E[1].$$

be a distinguished triangle of $D(\mathcal{C})$. One may draw up a table analogous to (2.6), where the entries indicate perfect amplitudes and each row corresponds to an implication whose target is underlined:

E	F	G
$[a + 1, b + 1]$	$[a, b]$	<u>$[a, b]$</u>
<u>$[a, b]$</u>	<u>$[a, b]$</u>	<u>$[a, b]$</u>
<u>$[a, b]$</u>	<u>$[a, b]$</u>	$[a - 1, b - 1]$.

From (4.10) one immediately deduces:

Corollary 4.12. Suppose that S is a punctual site. For $F \in \text{ob } D(\mathcal{C})$ to have perfect amplitude relative to $\mathcal{C}_0$ contained in $[a, b]$, it is necessary and sufficient that there exist a quasi-isomorphism $F' \rightarrow F$, with F' strictly perfect and such that $F'^i = 0$ for $i \notin [a, b]$. The canonical functors

$$K^b(\mathcal{C}_0) \longrightarrow \text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$$

and

$$\text{Tr}(K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)) \longrightarrow \text{Tr}(\text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0))$$

are equivalences of categories.

Remark 4.12.1. When S is a punctual site, the objects of $\mathcal{C}_0$ are projective. When $\mathcal{C}_0$ contains all the projective objects of $\mathcal{C}$, one says “projective amplitude” instead of “ $\mathcal{C}_0$ -perfect amplitude.”

Exposé I, continued: perfect amplitude, finite Tor-dimension, and rank

Remark 4.12.2. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an abelian category (which may be regarded as fibered over a punctual site), and let $\mathcal{C}_0$ be a strictly full additive subcategory. Suppose that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is stable under kernels of epimorphisms and is quasi-liftable in $\mathcal{C}$. Then an acyclic object of $K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)$ is not in general zero; hence there is no hope that the functor

$$K^b(\mathcal{C}_0) \longrightarrow D(\mathcal{C})$$

should be faithful. However, if $K^{b,ac}(\mathcal{C}_0)$ denotes the thick subcategory of $K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)$ formed by the objects which are acyclic in $\mathcal{C}$, the canonical functor

$$K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)/K^{b,ac}(\mathcal{C}_0) \longrightarrow D(\mathcal{C})$$

is fully faithful.

Indications: one already knows from (2.7) that the functor

$$K^-(\mathcal{C}_0)/K^{-,ac}(\mathcal{C}_0) \longrightarrow D^-(\mathcal{C})$$

is fully faithful. Show, for example with the aid of the criterion of [V], 4.2 b)(ii), that the functor

$$K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)/K^{b,ac}(\mathcal{C}_0) \longrightarrow K^-(\mathcal{C}_0)/K^{-,ac}(\mathcal{C}_0)$$

is fully faithful.

Lemma 4.13. Let $F \in \text{ob } D(\mathcal{C}_S)$, and let $a, b, c \in \mathbb{Z}$ be such that $a \leq b$ and $a \leq c$. If F is of perfect amplitude contained in $[a, c]$ (4.7), and if $H^i(F) = 0$ for $i > b$, then F is of perfect amplitude contained in $[a, d]$, where $d = \inf(b, c)$.

Proof. We may suppose $b \leq c$, and F strictly perfect with $F^i = 0$ for $i \notin [a, c]$. Then F is isomorphic to its truncation F' defined by

$$F'^i = F^i \quad (i < b), \quad F'^b = Z^b(F), \quad F'^i = 0 \quad (i > b).$$

But $Z^b(F)$ admits a finite right resolution by objects of $\mathcal{C}_0$, hence is locally an object of $\mathcal{C}_0$, whence the assertion.

Corollary 4.14. Let $F \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_S$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$. The following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) $\text{perf. amp}(F) \subset [-n, 0]$;
- (ii) F locally admits a left resolution of length n by objects of $\mathcal{C}_0$, that is, the set of objects X over S such that there exists an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow L^{-n} \longrightarrow L^{-n+1} \longrightarrow \dots \longrightarrow L^0 \longrightarrow F_X \longrightarrow 0,$$

with $L^i \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0,X}$ for all i , is a refinement of S .

Proof. This is an immediate consequence of (4.7) and (4.13).

Definition 4.14.1. We shall say that F is of perfect dimension $\leq n$, and shall write $\text{perf. dim}(F) \leq n$, if F satisfies the equivalent conditions of (4.14). We shall call the perfect dimension of F the smallest integer n such that $\text{perf. dim}(F) \leq n$; if there is no such integer, we shall say that F is of infinite perfect dimension.

When S is the punctual site and $\mathcal{C}_0$ is the full subcategory of $\mathcal{C}$ formed by the projective objects, the perfect dimension is just the usual projective dimension.

Proposition 4.15. Let $a, b, n \in \mathbb{Z}$, with $a \leq b$ and $n \geq 0$, and let $F \in \text{ob } D(\mathcal{C})$ be such that $F^i = 0$ (respectively $H^i(F) = 0$) for $i \notin [a, b]$. If, for every $i \in [a, b]$, F^i (respectively $H^i(F)$) is of perfect dimension $\leq n + (i - a)$, then F is of perfect amplitude contained in $[a - n, b]$. Consequently, if for every $i \in [a, b]$, F^i (respectively $H^i(F)$) is perfect, then F is perfect.

Proof. Proceed by induction on b (with a and n fixed), by truncating F and applying (4.11), cf. the proof of (2.11).

Lemma 4.16. Let $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$, $a \leq b$, and let $F \in \text{ob } D(\mathcal{C})$ be such that $F^i = 0$ for $i \notin [a, b]$. Suppose that $\text{perf. amp}(F) \subset [a, b]$, and that $F^i \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_0$ for $i > a$. Then F^a is locally an object of $\mathcal{C}_0$.

Proof. There is an exact sequence, obtained by truncating F ,

$$0 \longrightarrow F' \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow F^a[-a] \longrightarrow 0,$$

with $\text{perf. amp}(F') \subset [a+1, b+1]$. From (4.11) and (4.13) one deduces that $\text{perf. dim}(F^a) = 0$, i.e. that F^a is locally an object of $\mathcal{C}_0$.

Proposition 4.17. Let $F', F'' \in \text{ob } D(\mathcal{C}_S)$, and let $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$, with $a \leq b$. Consider the conditions:

- (i) $\text{perf. amp}(F') \subset [a, b]$ and $\text{perf. amp}(F'') \subset [a, b]$;
- (ii) $\text{perf. amp}(F' \oplus F'') \subset [a, b]$.

Then (i) implies (ii). If $\mathcal{C}_0$ is locally stable under direct factors, i.e. if the relation $E' \oplus E'' \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_0$, for $E', E'' \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_X$ and $X \in \text{ob } S$, implies that locally E' and E'' are objects of $\mathcal{C}_0$, then (i) and (ii) are equivalent.

Proof. The implication (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii) is a particular case of (4.11). Let us prove the converse. Put $F = F' \oplus F''$. Since F is pseudo-coherent, F' and F'' are also pseudo-coherent (2.12). On the other hand, the relation $H^i(F) = 0$ for $i \notin [a, b]$ implies $H^i(F') = H^i(F'') = 0$ for $i \notin [a, b]$. By (2.10 a), we may therefore suppose, after localizing, that F'^i and F''^i are in $\text{ob } \mathcal{C}_0$ for $i \geq a+1$, and that $F'^i = F''^i = 0$ for $i > b$. Then, by truncating, we get $F'^i = F''^i = 0$ for $i < a$. Since $\text{perf. amp}(F) \subset [a, b]$, it follows from (4.16) that F^a is locally an object of $\mathcal{C}_0$. But $F^a = F'^a \oplus F''^a$, hence F'^a and F''^a are locally objects of $\mathcal{C}_0$, since $\mathcal{C}_0$ is locally stable under direct factors.

Proposition 4.18. Let $(S', \mathcal{C}', \mathcal{C}'_0)$ be a triple satisfying the same hypotheses (4.0) as $(S, \mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$. Let $f : S' \rightarrow S$ be a morphism of sites, defined by $f^{-1} : S \rightarrow S'$, and let

$$u : D^*(\mathcal{C}) \longrightarrow D^*(\mathcal{C}') \quad (* = -, +, b)$$

be a functor over f (cf. (2.13)). If u sends objects of $\mathcal{C}_0$ to $\mathcal{C}'_0$ -perfect complexes, then u defines a functor

$$D^*(\mathcal{C})_{\mathcal{C}_0\text{-parf}} \longrightarrow D^*(\mathcal{C}')_{\mathcal{C}'_0\text{-parf}}.$$

Proof. Let $F \in \text{ob } D^*(\mathcal{C})_{\mathcal{C}_0\text{-parf}}$. We show that $u(F) \in \text{ob } D^*(\mathcal{C}')_{\mathcal{C}'_0\text{-parf}}$. Since the question is local, one may suppose F strictly perfect. It remains only to use dévissage, taking into account the fact that $D^*(\mathcal{C}')_{\mathcal{C}'_0\text{-parf}}$ is a triangulated subcategory of $D^*(\mathcal{C}')$ (4.10).

Remark 4.18.1. Suppose that there exist $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$, $m \leq n$, such that $F \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_0$ implies

$$\mathcal{C}'_0\text{-perf. amp}(u(F)) \subset [m, n].$$

Then, if $F \in \text{ob } D^*(\mathcal{C})$, one has

$$\mathcal{C}_0\text{-perf. amp}(F) \subset [a, b] \quad \Rightarrow \quad \mathcal{C}'_0\text{-perf. amp}(u(F)) \subset [a+m, b+n].$$

The proof is left as an exercise to the reader (use (4.11)).

Corollary 4.19. Under the hypotheses of (2.16), if $E' \in \text{ob } D^-(A, S')$ is perfect as an object of $D^-(A, S')$, and $E \in \text{ob } D^-(A, S)$ is perfect, then

$$E' \overset{\text{L}}{\otimes}_A E$$

is perfect.

Proof. We may suppose that $E' \in \text{ob } D^-(A, S'_A)$, where S' is the final object of S' , and apply (4.18) to

$$u = E' \otimes_A^L : D^-(A, S) \longrightarrow D^-(A, S').$$

In particular:

Corollary 4.19.1. a) The functor

$$Lf^* : D^-(A, S) \longrightarrow D^-(A, S')$$

induces a functor

$$Lf^* : D^-(A, S)_{\text{parf}} \longrightarrow D^-(A, S')_{\text{parf}}.$$

b) If A is commutative, the functor

$$\otimes_A^L : D^-(S) \times_S D^-(S) \longrightarrow D^-(S)$$

induces a functor

$$\otimes_A^L : D^-(S)_{\text{parf}} \times_S D^-(S)_{\text{parf}} \longrightarrow D^-(S)_{\text{parf}}.$$

Remark 4.19.2. One can refine (4.19) in terms of perfect amplitude:

$$\text{perf. amp}(E) \subset [a, b], \quad \text{perf. amp}(E') \subset [a', b'] \quad \Rightarrow \quad \text{perf. amp}(E' \otimes_A^L E) \subset [a + a', b + b'].$$

In particular,

$$\text{perf. amp}(E) \subset [a, b] \quad \Rightarrow \quad \text{perf. amp}(Lf^*(E)) \subset [a, b].$$

5. Finite Tor-dimension and perfection

5.0. The reader will surely have asked the question: what is missing from a pseudo-coherent complex E in order that it be perfect? Is it enough, for example, that E have bounded cohomology? The answer is no. Indeed, take for $\mathcal{C}$ the category of modules over a commutative noetherian ring A , and for $\mathcal{C}_0$ the full subcategory of projective A -modules of finite type. Any A -module of finite type E is pseudo-coherent and has bounded cohomology, but E is perfect only if, in addition, it is of finite projective dimension (or, equivalently, of finite Tor-dimension). This example suggests that the difference between a pseudo-coherent complex and a perfect complex lies in a question of cohomological dimension. This is what we shall now examine in the case of the category of modules of a ringed topos (cf. (3.3)). We shall need a few preliminary sorties on the notion of finite Tor-dimension. We shall be brief, since this question already appears in the literature: cf. [H] II 4 and SGA 4 XVII 4.1.9.

Proposition 5.1. Let (S, A) be a ringed topos, $X \in \text{ob } S$, $F \in \text{ob } D^-(A, X)$, and let $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$, with $m \leq n$. The following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) F is isomorphic, in $D^-(A, X)$, to a complex F' such that F'^i is flat for every i , and zero for $i \notin [m, n]$;
- (ii) for every right A_X -module E , one has

$$H^i(E \otimes_A^L F) = 0 \quad \text{for } i \notin [m, n].$$

Proof. The implication (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii) is trivial; the implication (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i) follows, by truncation, from the following lemma.

Lemma 5.1.1. (cf. (4.16)). Let $F \in \text{ob } D^-(A, X)$. Suppose that F satisfies hypothesis (ii) of (5.1), that $F^i = 0$ for $i \notin [m, n]$, and that F^i is flat for $i \neq m$. Then F^m is flat.

Proof. There is a distinguished triangle

$$\begin{array}{ccc} F' & \xrightarrow{\quad} & F \\ & \nwarrow \quad \nearrow & \\ & F^m[-m] & \end{array}$$

+1

where F' has flat components and is zero outside the interval $[m+1, n]$ (suppose $m < n$). Apply the functor $E \overset{\text{L}}{\otimes}_A \cdot$, for an arbitrary right A_X -module E , and write the exact cohomology sequence.

Definition 5.2. An object F of $D^-(A, S)$ satisfying the equivalent conditions of (5.1) will be said to be of flat amplitude contained in the interval $[m, n]$, and we shall write

$$\text{tor. amp}(F) \subset [m, n].$$

We shall say that F is of finite flat amplitude, or of finite Tor-dimension, if there exist integers m and n such that the preceding condition is satisfied.

5.3. Let $X \in \text{ob } S$. We shall write $D^-(A, X)_{\text{torf}}$ for the full subcategory of $D^-(A, X)$ formed by the objects of finite Tor-dimension. By criterion (ii) of (5.1), this is a triangulated subcategory of $D^-(A, X)$. As X varies, the categories $D^-(A, X)_{\text{torf}}$ form a triangulated sub- S -category (1.1.4) of $D^-(A, S)$, which we shall denote by $D^-(S)_{A\text{-torf}}$. The functor $\overset{\text{L}}{\otimes}_A$ induces an exact S -functor

$$\overset{\text{L}}{\otimes}_A : D^b(S_A) \times_S D(A/S)_{\text{torf}} \longrightarrow D^b(S_{\mathbb{Z}}).$$

5.4. In order that a left A -module F be of flat amplitude contained in $[-n, 0]$, $n \in \mathbb{N}$, it is necessary and sufficient that F be of Tor-dimension $\leq n$ in the ordinary sense, that is, that F admit a left resolution of length n by flat A -modules.

5.5. Let $X \in \text{ob } S$, and let $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$, with $m \leq n$. In order that $F \in \text{ob } D^-(A, X)$ be of flat amplitude contained in $[m, n]$, it is necessary and sufficient that there exist a covering family $(X_i \rightarrow X)$ such that $F|_{X_i}$ is of flat amplitude contained in $[m, n]$. In particular, if S/X is of finite type (SGA 4 VI 1.7), and if F is locally of finite Tor-dimension, then F is of finite Tor-dimension.

Proposition 5.6. Under the hypotheses of (2.16), if E' is of flat amplitude contained in $[m', n']$ as an object of $D^-(A, S')$, and if E is of flat amplitude contained in $[m, n]$, then

$$E' \overset{\text{L}}{\otimes}_A E$$

is of flat amplitude contained in $[m+m', n+n']$.

Proof. This is immediate: use form (5.1 (i)) of the notion of finite Tor-dimension and the fact that, if E is a flat left A -module, then $f^{-1}(E)$ is a flat left $f^{-1}(A)$ -module (SGA 4 IV, App.).

In particular:

Corollary 5.6.1. a) The functor

$$Lf^* : D^-(A, S) \longrightarrow D^-(A, S')$$

induces a functor

$$Lf^* : D(A, S)_{\text{torf}} \longrightarrow D(A, S')_{\text{torf}}.$$

b) If A is commutative, the functor

$$\overset{L}{\otimes}_A : D^-(S) \times_S D^-(S) \longrightarrow D^-(S)$$

induces a functor

$$\overset{L}{\otimes}_A : D(S)_{\text{torf}} \times_S D(S)_{\text{torf}} \longrightarrow D(S)_{\text{torf}}.$$

Remark 5.6.2. Let $E \in \text{ob } D^-(A, S)$, where S is the final object of S , and let $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$, with $m \leq n$. If E is of flat amplitude contained in $[m, n]$, then so is E_s , for every point s of S . The converse is true if S has enough points; use form (5.1(ii)) of the notion of flat amplitude and the fact that $\overset{L}{\otimes}_A$ commutes with passage to the fibers.

Exercises 5.7. **a)** Suppose that A is commutative and that (S', A') is faithfully flat over (S, A) (cf. (2.16.2)). In order that $E \in \text{ob } D^-(A, S)$ be of flat amplitude contained in $[m, n]$, it is necessary and sufficient that $f^*(E)$ have that property.

b) Let $F \in \text{ob } D^+(A, S)$. Show the equivalence of the following conditions:

- (i) F is isomorphic, in $D^+(A, S)$, to a complex F' such that F'^i is injective for every i and zero for $i \notin [m, n]$;
- (ii) for every left A_S -module E , one has $\text{Ext}^i(E, F) = 0$ for $i \notin [m, n]$.

If F satisfies the preceding conditions, one says that F is of injective amplitude contained in $[m, n]$. The full subcategory of $D^+(A, S)$ formed by the objects of finite injective amplitude is a triangulated subcategory, denoted $D^+(A, S)_{\text{inj}}$. Show that, if A is commutative, the functor

$$\text{R Hom} : D(S)^\circ \times D^+(S) \longrightarrow D(S)$$

induces a functor

$$\text{R Hom} : D(S)_{\text{torf}}^\circ \times D(S)_{\text{inj}} \longrightarrow D(S)_{\text{inj}}.$$

We can now answer the question of (5.0) and state the main result of this section.

Theorem 5.8. Let (S, A) be a ringed topos, $E \in \text{ob } D(A, S)$, and let $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$, with $m \leq n$. The following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) $\text{perf. amp}(E) \subset [m, n]$ (4.8);
- (ii) E is $(m-1)$ -pseudo-coherent (2.15) and $\text{tor. amp}(E) \subset [m, n]$ (5.2).

Since “perfect” plainly implies “pseudo-coherent”, one deduces:

Corollary 5.8.1. In order that E be perfect (4.8), it is necessary and sufficient that E be pseudo-coherent (2.15) and locally of finite Tor-dimension (5.2).

For the proof, we shall need a few lemmas.

Lemma 5.8.2. Let B be a ring of S . If E is a left A -module, G a right B -module, and F an A - B -bimodule (left over A , right over B), there is a canonical functorial homomorphism

$$\text{Hom}_B(F, G) \otimes_A E \longrightarrow \text{Hom}_B(\text{Hom}_A(E, F), G). \quad (5.8.2.1)$$

It is an isomorphism for G injective and E of finite presentation.

Proof. First define the arrow. By the adjunction formula dear to Cartan, it amounts to defining a homomorphism of B -modules:

$$\mathrm{Hom}_B(F, G) \otimes_A E \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}_S} \mathrm{Hom}_A(E, F) \longrightarrow G. \quad (*)$$

There is a canonical homomorphism of A - B -bimodules

$$E \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}_S} \mathrm{Hom}_A(E, F) \longrightarrow F \quad (**)$$

coming, by adjunction, from the identity arrow of $\mathrm{Hom}_A(E, F)$. Similarly, there is a canonical homomorphism of B -modules

$$\mathrm{Hom}_B(F, G) \otimes_A F \longrightarrow G. \quad (***)$$

We then define $(*)$ as the composite of $(**)$ and $(***)$. To see that the arrow (5.8.2.1) is an isomorphism when G is injective and E is of finite presentation, it is enough to note that, if G is injective, the source and the target of the arrow are right-exact functors in E , and that the arrow induces the identity for $E = A$.

Here is now a particular case of (5.8).

Lemma 5.8.3. Let E be a left A -module. The following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) E is locally a direct factor of a free module of finite type;
- (ii) E is flat and of finite presentation.

Proof (after Bourbaki, Alg. comm., Chap. I, §2, Exer. 15). It is clear that (i) implies (ii). Let us prove (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i). By (1.3.1), it is enough to show that the functor $\mathrm{Hom}_A(E, \cdot)$ is exact. Let

$$F \longrightarrow F'' \longrightarrow 0$$

be an exact sequence of left A -modules. We must show that the sequence

$$\mathrm{Hom}_A(E, F) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_A(E, F'') \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact. For this it is enough to prove that, for every injective $\mathbb{Z}_S$ -module I , the sequence obtained by applying the functor $\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}_S}(\cdot, I)$ is exact. But there is a commutative diagram, where the vertical arrows are the canonical arrows of (5.8.2):

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 0 & \rightarrow & \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}_S}(F'', I) \otimes_A E & \rightarrow & \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}_S}(F, I) \otimes_A E & & \\ & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \\ 0 & \rightarrow & \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}_S}(\mathrm{Hom}_A(E, F''), I) & \rightarrow & \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}_S}(\mathrm{Hom}_A(E, F), I) & & \end{array}$$

The vertical arrows are isomorphisms by (5.8.2). The top row is exact because E is flat. Hence the bottom row is exact, q.e.d.

Proof of (5.8). The implication (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii) follows trivially from the definitions. Let us prove (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i). Since the question is local, one may suppose E strictly $(m-1)$ -pseudo-coherent. Since, on the other hand, E is acyclic in degrees $< m$, the truncation arrow

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} \cdots & \rightarrow & E^{m-1} & \rightarrow & E^m & \rightarrow & E^{m+1} \rightarrow \cdots \\ & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \cdots & \rightarrow & 0 & \rightarrow & E^m/B^m & \rightarrow & E^{m+1} \rightarrow \cdots \end{array}$$

is a quasi-isomorphism. Let E' be the truncated complex. By construction, E' is of flat amplitude contained in $[m, n]$, and E'^i is free of finite type for $i > m$. Therefore, by (5.1.1), E'^m is flat. On the other hand there is a distinguished triangle

$$\begin{array}{ccc} E'' & \xrightarrow{\quad} & E' \\ & \swarrow \scriptstyle +1 \quad \searrow & \\ & E'^m[-m] & \end{array}$$

where E'' is strictly perfect. By (2.6), $E'^m[-m]$ is $(m-1)$ -pseudo-coherent; i.e. by (2.9), E'^m is of finite presentation. We conclude from (5.8.3) that E'^m is locally a direct factor of a free module of finite type, hence that $\text{perf. amp}(E) \subset [m, n]$.

Remarks 5.8.4. a) Using (2.5), one recovers the fact that perfect complexes form a triangulated subcategory of $D(A, S)$.

b) A perfect complex, even with bounded cohomology, is not necessarily of finite Tor-dimension. It is so, however, if S is of finite type (5.5). Write $D(A, S)_{\text{parf}}$ for the full sub- S -category of $D^b(A, S)$ formed by perfect complexes of finite Tor-dimension. It follows at once from (2.16.1 b) and (5.3) that, if A is commutative, the functor $\overset{\text{L}}{\otimes}_A$ induces a functor

$$\overset{\text{L}}{\otimes}_A : D(S)_{\text{parf}} \times_S D^b(S)_{\text{coh}} \longrightarrow D^b(S)_{\text{coh}}.$$

This formula is the starting point for the theory of intersections on schemes. Note, on the other hand, that the derived tensor product of two pseudo-coherent complexes with bounded cohomology is not, in general, of bounded cohomology.

Corollary 5.9. Suppose that $S = (\text{Ens})$, so that A is an ordinary ring, and that every left A -module is of finite Tor-dimension; this is the case, for example, if A is of finite global cohomological dimension, cf. (MULT VI 2.6) and (EGA 0_{IV} 17.2.8). Then

$$(i) \quad D^b(A, S) = D(A, S)_{\text{torf}}, \quad \text{and} \quad (ii) \quad D^b(A, S)_{\text{coh}} = D(A, S)_{\text{parf}}.$$

In other words, in order that $E \in \text{ob } D(A, S)$ be of finite Tor-dimension (respectively finite Tor-dimension and perfect), it is necessary and sufficient that E have bounded cohomology (respectively bounded and pseudo-coherent cohomology).

Proof. By (5.8), it is enough to prove (i). Let $E \in \text{ob } D^b(A, S)$. We may suppose, after extending E by 0, that $E \in \text{ob } D^b(A, S)$, where S is the final object of S . By induction on the number of non-zero cohomology objects of E , one is reduced, by dévissage, to the case where E is an ordinary A -module; then one wins.

More generally, one may state:

Corollary 5.10. Let $X \in \text{ob } S$. Suppose that S/X has enough points (SGA 4 IV 6.4.1) and that, for every point s of S/X , every left A_s -module is of finite Tor-dimension. Then

$$D^b(A, X)_{\text{coh}} = D^b(A, X)_{\text{parf}}.$$

Equivalently, in order that $E \in \text{ob } D^b(A, X)$ be pseudo-coherent, it is necessary and sufficient that E be perfect.

Proof. Let $E \in \text{ob } D^b(A, X)_{\text{coh}}$ and let s be a point of S/X . One must show that E is perfect in a neighbourhood of s , that is, that there exists an s -pointed object U of S over X such that $E|U$ is perfect. Now, since the functor s^* is exact, (2.16.1 a) gives $E_s \in \text{ob } D^b(A_s)_{\text{coh}}$. Hence, by (5.9), E_s is perfect. The assertion is therefore a consequence of (3.7.2) and of the following lemma.

Lemma 5.10.1. Let s be a point of S , and let $F \in \text{ob } \mathbf{D}(A_s)_{\text{parf}}$. There exist an s -pointed object U of S and $F' \in \text{ob } \mathbf{D}(A_U)_{\text{parf}}$ such that $F'_s = F$.

Proof. This is evident if F is a free A_s -module of finite type. Suppose now that F is projective of finite type, hence the image of a projector

$$p : L \longrightarrow L,$$

where L is free of finite type. There is then a neighbourhood U of s , a free A_U -module L' , and a homomorphism $p' : L' \rightarrow L'$ such that $p'_s = p$. Since $p_s^2 = p_s$, we may suppose, after shrinking U , that $p'^2 = p'$. Thus $F' = \mathfrak{S}(p')$ is a direct factor of L' and satisfies $F'_s = F$. The case where F is strictly perfect, that is, a bounded complex made up of projective modules of finite type, follows immediately.

Examples 5.11. Corollary (5.10) applies in particular when (S, A) is defined by a locally ringed space in regular local rings, for example a regular scheme or a smooth complex analytic space over $\mathbb{C}$.

6. Rank of a perfect complex

6.0. Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space in local rings. It is well known that one can attach, to every locally free sheaf of finite type L on an open set U of X , a function $\text{rg}_U(L)$, locally constant on U and with integral values, called the rank of L . The family of functions $\text{rg}_U(L)$ is characterized by the following properties:

- (i) if $V \subset U$ is an inclusion of open sets, then $\text{rg}_V(L|_V) = \text{rg}_U(L)|_V$;
- (ii) for every exact sequence of locally free $\mathcal{O}_U$ -modules of finite type

$$0 \longrightarrow L' \longrightarrow L \longrightarrow L'' \longrightarrow 0,$$

one has $\text{rg}_U(L) = \text{rg}_U(L') + \text{rg}_U(L'')$;

- (iii) $\text{rg}_X(\mathcal{O}_X) = 1$.

We propose in this section to extend the notion of rank to perfect complexes.

Definition 6.1 (cf. SGA 5 VIII 2). Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an additive (respectively triangulated) category, and let F be an abelian group. A function

$$f : \text{ob}(\mathcal{C}) \longrightarrow F$$

is said to be an additive function from $\mathcal{C}$ to F if, for all $L, L', L'' \in \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$ such that $L \simeq L' \oplus L''$ (respectively such that there is a distinguished triangle

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L' & \xrightarrow{\quad} & L \\ & \nwarrow \quad \nearrow & \\ & L'' & \end{array}$$

), one has

$$f(L) = f(L') + f(L'').$$

The additive functions from $\mathcal{C}$ to F form an abelian group, denoted $\text{Add}(\mathcal{C}, F)$.

6.2. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a triangulated category, and let f be an additive function from $\mathcal{C}$ to an abelian group F . Then f induces an additive function on the underlying additive category $\mathcal{C}^{\text{ad}}$ of $\mathcal{C}$; hence an inclusion

$$\text{Add}(\mathcal{C}, F) \subset \text{Add}(\mathcal{C}^{\text{ad}}, F).$$

In particular, $f(0) = 0$ and $f(L) = f(M)$ if $L \simeq M$. On the other hand,

$$f(L[n]) = (-1)^n f(L)$$

for all $L \in \text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$ and $n \in \mathbb{Z}$.

6.3. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an additive (respectively triangulated) category. The group $\text{Add}(\mathcal{C}, F)$ depends functorially on F . The functor $\text{Add}(\mathcal{C}, \cdot)$ is representable (cf. SGA 5 VIII 2) by an abelian group, denoted $k(\mathcal{C})$, endowed with an additive application

$$\text{cl}_{\mathcal{C}} : \text{ob}(\mathcal{C}) \longrightarrow k(\mathcal{C}).$$

If $\mathcal{C}$ is additive, one takes for $k(\mathcal{C})$ the symmetrized monoid of isomorphism classes of objects of $\mathcal{C}$. If $\mathcal{C}$ is triangulated, one takes for $k(\mathcal{C})$ the quotient of the free abelian group generated by $\text{ob}(\mathcal{C})$ by the relations identifying L with $L' + L''$ whenever there is a distinguished triangle

$$L' \longrightarrow L \longrightarrow L'' \longrightarrow L'[1].$$

The group $k(\mathcal{C})$ depends functorially on $\mathcal{C}$, with respect to additive (respectively exact) functors. If $u, u' : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$ are isomorphic additive (respectively exact) functors, then $k(u) = k(u')$.

If $\mathcal{C}$ is a triangulated category, one has a canonical epimorphism

$$k(\mathcal{C}^{\text{ad}}) \longrightarrow k(\mathcal{C})$$

(cf. (6.2)).

Lemma 6.4. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an additive category. The canonical functor

$$\mathcal{C} \longrightarrow K^b(\mathcal{C})$$

induces an isomorphism, functorial in $\mathcal{C}$,

$$k(\mathcal{C}) \xrightarrow{\sim} k(K^b(\mathcal{C})).$$

Proof. This is an immediate consequence of the following formula, which follows trivially from (6.2):

$$f(L) = \sum_i (-1)^i f(L^i) \tag{6.4.1}$$

for $L \in \text{ob } K^b(\mathcal{C})$ and f an additive function on $K^b(\mathcal{C})$.

Remark. We shall not use here the usual notation $K(\mathcal{C})$, since $K(\mathcal{C})$ already denotes, when $\mathcal{C}$ is additive, the category of complexes of $\mathcal{C}$ “up to homotopy.”

Definition 6.5. Let S be a category, $\mathcal{C}$ an additive (respectively triangulated) S -category (1.1.1), and F an abelian presheaf on S . A family of functions

$$f_X : \text{ob}(\mathcal{C}_X) \longrightarrow F(X), \quad X \in \text{ob } S,$$

is said to be an additive S -function from $\mathcal{C}$ to F if the following conditions are satisfied:

- (i) for every $X \in \text{ob } S$, f_X is an additive function (6.1);

(ii) for every arrow $u : X \rightarrow Y$ of S , the following diagram is commutative:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_Y & \xrightarrow{f_Y} & F(Y) \\ u^* \downarrow & & \downarrow F(u) \\ \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_X & \xrightarrow{f_X} & F(X). \end{array}$$

The additive S -functions from $\mathcal{C}$ to F form an abelian group, denoted $\text{Add}_S(\mathcal{C}, F)$.

Remarks 6.6. a) Let $\mathcal{C}^{\text{is}}$ denote the fibered S -category whose fiber over $X \in \text{ob } S$ is the category with the same objects as $\mathcal{C}_X$ but whose arrows are the isomorphisms of $\mathcal{C}_X$. Let $\underline{F}$ denote the fibered S -category whose fiber over $X \in \text{ob } S$ is the discrete category (i.e. the only arrows are identities) $F(X)$, the inverse-image functor by $u \in \text{Fl}(S)$ being $F(u)$. Then an additive S -function from $\mathcal{C}$ to F is simply a Cartesian S -functor from $\mathcal{C}^{\text{is}}$ to $\underline{F}$, inducing on each fiber an additive function in the sense of (6.1). It will be convenient for us to interpret additivity as follows. Suppose, for definiteness, that $\mathcal{C}$ is triangulated. The category

$$\text{Cart}_S(\mathcal{C}^{\text{is}}, \underline{F})$$

(respectively $\text{Cart}_S(\text{Tr}(\mathcal{C})^{\text{is}}, \underline{F})$ (1.1.2)) of Cartesian S -functors from $\mathcal{C}^{\text{is}}$ (respectively $\text{Tr}(\mathcal{C})^{\text{is}}$) to $\underline{F}$ is the discrete category associated to an abelian group, and there is a homomorphism

$$\rho : \text{Cart}_S(\mathcal{C}^{\text{is}}, \underline{F}) \longrightarrow \text{Cart}_S(\text{Tr}(\mathcal{C})^{\text{is}}, \underline{F}),$$

defined by

$$\rho(f)(T) = f(L) - f(L') - f(L'')$$

for $f \in \text{Cart}_S(\mathcal{C}^{\text{is}}, \underline{F})$ and $T = (L' \rightarrow L \rightarrow L'' \rightarrow L'[1]) \in \text{ob } \text{Tr}(\mathcal{C})$. To say that $f \in \text{Cart}_S(\mathcal{C}^{\text{is}}, \underline{F})$ is additive means that $\rho(f) = 0$, or equivalently that one has a functorial canonical exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{Add}_S(\mathcal{C}, F) \longrightarrow \text{Cart}_S(\mathcal{C}^{\text{is}}, \underline{F}) \xrightarrow{\rho} \text{Cart}_S(\text{Tr}(\mathcal{C})^{\text{is}}, \underline{F}). \quad (6.6.1)$$

b) Let $u : X \rightarrow Y$ be an arrow of S . The inverse-image functors by u , being all isomorphic to one another, define by (6.3) a unique homomorphism

$$k(Y) \longrightarrow k(X).$$

Consequently, $X \mapsto k(X)$ defines an abelian presheaf on S , denoted $k(\mathcal{C})$. An additive S -function from $\mathcal{C}$ to F is then simply interpreted as a homomorphism of presheaves

$$k(\mathcal{C}) \longrightarrow F,$$

or in other words

$$\text{Add}_S(\mathcal{C}, F) = \text{Hom}(k(\mathcal{C}), F).$$

The presheaf $k(\mathcal{C})$ of course depends functorially on $\mathcal{C}$ with respect to additive (respectively exact) S -functors.

Proposition 6.7. Let S be a site, $\mathcal{C}$ a flat abelian S -category, and $\mathcal{C}_0$ a strictly full additive sub- S -category of $\mathcal{C}$ satisfying the hypotheses (4.0). Then the morphism of abelian presheaves

$$k(\mathcal{C}_0) \longrightarrow k(\text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0))$$

induced by the inclusion of $\mathcal{C}_0$ in $\text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$, defines an isomorphism on the associated sheaves. In other words, for every abelian sheaf F on S , the restriction homomorphism

$$\text{Add}_S(\text{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0), F) \longrightarrow \text{Add}_S(\mathcal{C}_0, F)$$

is an isomorphism.

Proof. Let F be an abelian sheaf on S . We show that the arrow

$$\mathrm{Add}_S(\mathrm{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0), F) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Add}_S(\mathcal{C}_0, F)$$

is an isomorphism. It factors as

$$\mathrm{Add}_S(\mathrm{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0), F) \xrightarrow{a} \mathrm{Add}_S(K^b(\mathcal{C}_0), F) \xrightarrow{b} \mathrm{Add}_S(\mathcal{C}_0, F).$$

By (6.4), the arrow b is an isomorphism. We are reduced to proving that a is an isomorphism.

Consider the following commutative diagram, whose rows are exact by (6.6.1), and whose vertical arrows are the restriction arrows:

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 0 & \rightarrow & \mathrm{Add}_S(\mathrm{Parf}(\mathcal{C}), F) & \rightarrow & \mathrm{Cart}_S(\mathrm{Parf}(\mathcal{C})^{\mathrm{is}}, \underline{F}) & \rightarrow & \mathrm{Cart}_S(\mathrm{Tr}(\mathrm{Parf}(\mathcal{C}))^{\mathrm{is}}, \underline{F}) \\ & & \downarrow a & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ 0 & \rightarrow & \mathrm{Add}_S(K^b(\mathcal{C}_0), F) & \rightarrow & \mathrm{Cart}_S(K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)^{\mathrm{is}}, \underline{F}) & \rightarrow & \mathrm{Cart}_S(\mathrm{Tr}(K^b(\mathcal{C}_0))^{\mathrm{is}}, \underline{F}). \end{array}$$

Since F is a sheaf, $\underline{F}$ is a stack (G II 2.2.4); hence, by (4.10), the two right vertical arrows are isomorphisms. The same is therefore true of a , q.e.d.

Remark 6.7.1 (cf. 4.10.1). In (6.7), one may replace $\mathrm{Parf}(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}_0)$ by $D^*(\mathcal{C})_{\mathcal{C}_0\text{-parf}}$ ($*$ = $-$ or b).

6.8. Let (S, A) be a ringed topos, and let $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{C}_0$ be the fibered S -categories considered in (4.8). There are homomorphisms of abelian presheaves

$$k(\mathcal{C}_0) \xrightarrow{\alpha} k(D^-(A, S)_{\mathrm{parf}}) \xrightarrow{\beta} k(\mathrm{Parf}(A, S)),$$

which, by (6.7), induce isomorphisms on the associated sheaves. The homomorphism α is compatible with inverse images: that is, if

$$u : (S', A') \longrightarrow (S, A)$$

is a morphism of ringed topoi, there is a commutative diagram, whose vertical arrows are induced by the functor Lu^* (cf. (4.19.1)):

$$\begin{array}{ccc} k(\mathcal{C}_0) & \longrightarrow & k(D^-(A, S)_{\mathrm{parf}}) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ k(\mathcal{C}'_0) & \longrightarrow & k(D^-(A', S')_{\mathrm{parf}}), \end{array}$$

where $\mathcal{C}'_0$ is defined analogously to $\mathcal{C}_0$. If A is commutative, the derived tensor product endows $k(\mathcal{C}_0)$ and $k(D^-(A, S)_{\mathrm{parf}})$ with structures of presheaves of rings (cf. (4.19.1)), and α is a homomorphism of presheaves of rings.

6.9. In the situation of (6.8), suppose that (S, A) is locally ringed (cf. (2.15.1)). Then, for every $X \in \mathrm{ob} S$, $\mathcal{C}_{0,X}$ is the category of locally free A_X -modules of finite type. Let $\mathcal{C}_1$ be the fibered S -category defined by

$$X \longmapsto \text{the category of free } A_X\text{-modules of finite type.}$$

It is clear that $\mathcal{C}_1$ satisfies the hypotheses (4.0). An object of $D(S)$ is perfect if and only if it is perfect relative to $\mathcal{C}_1$. There are homomorphisms of abelian presheaves

$$k(\mathcal{C}_1) \longrightarrow k(\mathcal{C}_0) \longrightarrow k(D^-(S)_{\mathrm{parf}}) \longrightarrow k(\mathrm{Parf}(S))$$

(the two on the left being homomorphisms of presheaves of rings), which, by (6.7), induce isomorphisms on the associated sheaves. We shall show that the associated sheaves are in fact canonically isomorphic to the constant sheaf $\mathbb{Z}_S$.

Lemma 6.10. Let (S, A) be a locally ringed topos, let U be an object of S distinct from the empty object, and let $p, q \in \mathbb{N}$. If

$$A_U^p \simeq A_U^q,$$

then $p = q$.

Proof. By an argument similar to that given in the proof of (2.15.1), one is reduced to the case where (S, A) is the locally ringed topos defined by a prescheme; in this case the assertion is trivial: take a point in U .

Definition 6.11. The rank, denoted rg , is the additive S -function from $\mathcal{C}_1$ to $\mathbb{Z}_S$ defined by

$$\text{rg}(L) = p \quad \text{if } L \simeq A_X^p, \quad X \neq \emptyset,$$

$$\text{rg}(L) = 0 \quad \text{if } L \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{1,X}, \quad X = \emptyset.$$

By (6.7), the rank function extends uniquely to an additive S -function from $\text{Parf}(S)$ to $\mathbb{Z}_S$, which we shall again call rank and denote by rg .

Proposition 6.12. a) For $L, M \in \text{ob } D^-(X)_{\text{parf}}$, with $X \in \text{ob } S$, one has

$$\text{rg}(L \overset{\text{L}}{\otimes} M) = \text{rg}(L) \text{rg}(M).$$

b) Let

$$u : (S', A') \longrightarrow (S, A)$$

be a morphism of locally ringed topoi. For $M \in \text{ob } D^-(S)_{\text{parf}}$, one has

$$\text{rg}(Lu^*(M)) = u^*(\text{rg}(M)).$$

In other words, the rank homomorphism

$$\text{rg} : k(D^-(S)_{\text{parf}}) \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}_S$$

is a homomorphism of presheaves of rings, compatible with inverse images.

Proof. It is enough to show that the homomorphism induced by rank on the sheaf associated to $k(D^-(S)_{\text{parf}})$ is a homomorphism of sheaves of rings compatible with inverse images. By (6.9), one may replace $k(D^-(S)_{\text{parf}})$ by $k(\mathcal{C}_1)$. We are thus reduced to verifying a) and b) for free modules of finite type, which is trivial.

6.13. With (S, A) still denoting a locally ringed topos, let $X \in \text{ob } S$ and $n \in H^0(X, \mathbb{Z}_S)$. We define an object of $\text{Parf}(X)$, denoted A_X^n , as follows. If n is constant of value an integer $n \geq 0$ (respectively $n < 0$), put $A_X^n = A_X^{\oplus n}$ (respectively $A_X^n = A_X^{-n}[1]$). In the general case, decompose X into disjoint pieces X_i on which $n|_{X_i}$ is constant, and define A_X^n as the unique object of $\text{Parf}(X)$ inducing $A_{X_i}^{n|_{X_i}}$ on each X_i . More generally, for $L \in \text{ob } \text{Parf}(X)$, one may define L^n by putting $L^n = A_X^n \otimes_A L$.

The map

$$i_X : H^0(X, \mathbb{Z}_S) \longrightarrow k(\text{Parf}(X)), \quad i_X(n) = \text{cl}(A_X^n),$$

is a homomorphism of rings, with $i_X(1) = 1$, and defines, as X varies, a homomorphism of presheaves of rings

$$i : \mathbb{Z}_S \longrightarrow k(\text{Parf}(S)).$$

Proposition 6.14. Under the hypotheses of (6.13), one has

$$\mathrm{rg} \circ i = \mathrm{Id}(\mathbb{Z}_S).$$

In other words, $k(\mathrm{Parf}(S))$, considered as a presheaf of $\mathbb{Z}_S$ -algebras by means of i , is augmented toward $\mathbb{Z}_S$ by the rank. Moreover, the rank

$$\mathrm{rg} : k(\mathrm{Parf}(S)) \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}_S$$

defines an isomorphism on the associated sheaves.

Proof. The first assertion follows trivially from the relations

$$\mathrm{cl}(L[1]) = -\mathrm{cl}(L), \quad \mathrm{cl}(L^n) = n \mathrm{cl}(L), \quad L \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{Parf}(S).$$

Let us prove the second. First observe that i factors in the evident way through $k(\mathcal{C}_1)$. Since $\mathrm{rg} \circ i$ is the identity, we are reduced, by (6.9), to proving that the homomorphism

$$i \circ \mathrm{rg} : k(\mathcal{C}_1) \longrightarrow k(\mathcal{C}_1)$$

induces an isomorphism on the associated sheaves; equivalently, for $L \in \mathrm{ob} \mathcal{C}_1$, that $i(\mathrm{rg}(L))$ is locally isomorphic to L . This is immediate.

One deduces, by (6.6 b):

Corollary 6.15. Under the hypotheses of (6.13), for every abelian sheaf F on S , the group of S -additive functions from $\mathrm{Parf}(S)$ to F is canonically identified with $H^0(S, F)$, where S is the final object of S . The rank function corresponds, for $F = \mathbb{Z}_S$, to the unit section of $\mathbb{Z}_S$.

7. Duality of perfect complexes

7.0. In this section, (S, A) denotes a topos ringed in commutative rings, and S also denotes the final object of S . We propose to generalize to perfect complexes the duality notions that are well known for locally free sheaves of finite type.

Proposition 7.1. Let $E \in \mathrm{ob} D^-(S)_{\mathrm{Parf}}$ and $F \in \mathrm{ob} D^+(S)$.

a) If F has locally bounded cohomology, then so does $\mathrm{RHom}(E, F)$. If F is pseudo-coherent (respectively locally of finite Tor-dimension, respectively perfect), then the same is true of $\mathrm{RHom}(E, F)$.

b) Suppose, moreover, that E is of finite Tor-dimension, a condition satisfied if S is of finite type. Then, if F has bounded cohomology (respectively finite Tor-dimension), the same is true of $\mathrm{RHom}(E, F)$. More precisely, let a, b, m, n be integers such that

$$\mathrm{tor.amp}(E) \subset [a, b]$$

(or, equivalently by (5.8), $\mathrm{parf.amp}(E) \subset [a, b]$), and such that $H^i(F) = 0$ for $i \notin [m, n]$ (respectively $\mathrm{tor.amp}(F) \subset [m, n]$). Then

$$H^i(\mathrm{RHom}(E, F)) = 0 \quad (i \notin [m - b, n - a]),$$

respectively

$$\mathrm{tor.amp}(\mathrm{RHom}(E, F)) \subset [m - b, n - a].$$

Proof. Assertion a) is local, so we may suppose E strictly perfect, and then conclude by devissage on E , reducing to $E = A$. For assertion b), we may suppose E strictly perfect with $E^i = 0$ for

$i \notin [a, b]$, and $F^i = 0$ for $i \notin [m, n]$ (respectively F^i flat for every i and $F^i = 0$ for $i \notin [m, n]$). It is then enough to apply the following lemma.

Lemma 7.1.1. Let $E \in \text{ob } D^-(S)$ and $F \in \text{ob } D^+(S)$. If E is strictly pseudo-coherent, that is, in the sense of (2.1), with components direct factors of free finite-type modules, then the canonical arrow of $D^+(S)$

$$\text{Hom}^\bullet(E, F) \longrightarrow \text{RHom}(E, F)$$

is an isomorphism.

Proof. The spectral sequence

$$E_2^{p0} = H^p(\text{Hom}^\bullet(E, F)) \implies \text{Ext}^p(E, F)$$

where $\text{Ext}^q(E^i, F^j) = 0$ for every $q > 0$ by (1.3.1), degenerates. One obtains isomorphisms

$$E_2^{p0} = H^p(\text{Hom}^\bullet(E, F)) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Ext}^p(E, F) = H^p(\text{RHom}(E, F)),$$

which prove the assertion.

Proposition 7.1.2. Let

$$f : (S', A') \longrightarrow (S, A)$$

be a morphism of ringed topoi. Let $E \in \text{ob } D^-(S)$ and $F \in \text{ob } D^b(S)$ be such that $\text{RHom}(E, F) \in \text{ob } D^b(S)$ and $\text{Lf}^*(F) \in \text{ob } D^b(S')$. There is a functorial canonical arrow

$$\text{Lf}^* \text{RHom}(E, F) \longrightarrow \text{RHom}(\text{Lf}^* E, \text{Lf}^* F).$$

This is an isomorphism if E is perfect.

Proof. By the adjunction of Lf^* and Rf_* , it is enough to define an arrow

$$\text{RHom}(E, F) \longrightarrow \text{Rf}_* \text{RHom}(\text{Lf}^* E, \text{Lf}^* F).$$

For this we use the adjunction arrow $F \rightarrow \text{Rf}_* \text{Lf}^* F$ and the duality isomorphism

$$\text{Rf}_* \text{RHom}(\text{Lf}^* E, \text{Lf}^* F) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{RHom}(E, \text{Rf}_* \text{Lf}^* F).$$

To see that the arrow of (7.1.2) is an isomorphism for E perfect, one reduces trivially, by localization and devissage, to the case $E = A$, where it is a tautology.

Proposition 7.2. There exists (cf. SGA 5 I 1.6), for $E \in \text{ob } D(S)$ and $F \in \text{ob } D^+(S)$, a functorial canonical arrow

$$E \longrightarrow \text{RHom}(\text{RHom}(E, F), F).$$

This is an isomorphism if $E \in \text{ob } D(S)_{\text{Parf}}$ and $F = A$.

Proof. Define the arrow by resolving F injectively and using the canonical arrow in $K(S)$

$$E \longrightarrow \text{Hom}^\bullet(\text{Hom}^\bullet(E, F), F).$$

To see that the arrow in question is an isomorphism if E is perfect and $F = A$, one reduces, by localization and devissage, to $E = A$, where it is evident.

Definition 7.3. Let $E \in \text{ob } D(S)$. We shall put

$$\text{RHom}(E, A) = E^\vee,$$

and we shall say that $E^\vee$ is the dual of E .

By (7.1) and (7.2), if $E \in \text{ob } D(S)$ is perfect (respectively perfect and of finite Tor-dimension), then so is $E^\vee$, and the canonical arrow $E \rightarrow E^{\vee\vee}$ is an isomorphism. In other words, the functor

$\mathrm{RHom}(\cdot, A)$ defines an anti-auto-equivalence of the category $\mathrm{D}(S)_{\mathrm{Parf}}$ (respectively $\mathrm{D}(S)_{\mathrm{parf}}$, cf. (5.8.4 b)) with itself.

Lemma 7.4 (Cartan isomorphism) (cf. ([H] II 5.15)). For $E \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}(S)$, $F \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}^-(S)$, and $G \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}^+(S)$, there are functorial canonical isomorphisms

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{RHom}(E \otimes^{\mathrm{L}} F, G) &\xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{RHom}(E, \mathrm{RHom}(F, G)), \\ \mathrm{RHom}(E \otimes F, G) &\xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{RHom}(E, \mathrm{RHom}(F, G)), \\ \mathrm{Hom}(E \otimes F, G) &\xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{Hom}(E, \mathrm{RHom}(F, G)). \end{aligned}$$

Proof. This is standard: resolve G injectively and F flatly.

Lemma 7.5. For $E \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}^-(S)$ and $F \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}^+(S)$, there is a functorial canonical homomorphism

$$E \otimes^{\mathrm{L}} \mathrm{RHom}(E, F) \longrightarrow F.$$

Proposition 7.6 (cf. ([H] II 5.13)). Let $E \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}(S)$, $F \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}^+(S)$, and $G \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}^+(S)$. Under either of the following hypotheses:

- (i) G is of finite Tor-dimension;
- (ii) $E \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}^-(S)$, F is of finite Tor-dimension, and $G \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}^b(S)$,

there is a functorial canonical homomorphism

$$\mathrm{RHom}(E, F) \otimes^{\mathrm{L}} G \longrightarrow \mathrm{RHom}(E, F \otimes^{\mathrm{L}} G).$$

This is an isomorphism when E is perfect.

Proof. Let us define the arrow. Under hypothesis (i), it is enough to resolve F injectively and G flatly. Under hypothesis (ii), by (7.4) it is equivalent to define an arrow

$$E \otimes^{\mathrm{L}} \mathrm{RHom}(E, F) \otimes^{\mathrm{L}} G \longrightarrow F \otimes^{\mathrm{L}} G.$$

Apply the functor $-\otimes^{\mathrm{L}} G$ to the arrow of (7.5).

To see that the arrow is an isomorphism when E is perfect, use the standard method (cf. the proof of (7.2)): reduce, by localization and devissage, to the case $E = A$.

Corollary 7.7. There exists, for $E \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}(S)_{\mathrm{Parf}}$ and $F \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}^+(S)$, a functorial isomorphism

$$E^{\vee} \otimes^{\mathrm{L}} F \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{RHom}(E, F),$$

with the notation of (7.3).

Proof. Apply (7.6), with F and G replaced respectively by A and F , and use the fact (7.1) that $E^{\vee} \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}(S)_{\mathrm{Parf}}$.

Corollary 7.8. Let $E, F \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}(S)_{\mathrm{Parf}}$. There is a natural arrow

$$\mathrm{RHom}(E, F) \otimes^{\mathrm{L}} \mathrm{RHom}(F, E) \longrightarrow A,$$

which is a “perfect duality,” that is, modulo (7.4), it identifies each of the complexes $\mathrm{RHom}(E, F)$ and $\mathrm{RHom}(F, E)$ with the dual of the other, in the sense of (7.3).

Proof. By (7.5), one has natural pairings $E^\vee \otimes^L E \rightarrow A$ and $F^\vee \otimes^L F \rightarrow A$. Hence, by tensor product, one obtains a natural pairing

$$E^\vee \otimes^L F \otimes^L F^\vee \otimes^L E \longrightarrow A,$$

which, in view of (7.7), gives the announced pairing on the RHom 's. Let us show that it is a perfect duality. There are canonical isomorphisms

$$\mathrm{RHom}(F^\vee \otimes^L E, A) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{RHom}(F^\vee, E^\vee) \quad (7.4)$$

$$\xrightarrow{\sim} F^{\vee\vee} \otimes^L E^\vee \quad (7.6)$$

$$\xrightarrow{\sim} F \otimes^L E^\vee \quad (7.2).$$

Thus, up to a compatibility verification, the result follows. One could also localize and devissage to reduce to $E = F = A$.

Exercise 7.9. Let $E, F \in \mathrm{ob} \, \mathrm{D}(S)_{\mathrm{parf}}$. Show that there is a canonical isomorphism

$$E^\vee \otimes^L F^\vee \xrightarrow{\sim} (E \otimes^L F)^\vee.$$

8. Traces and cup-products

8.0. In this section we generalize to perfect complexes the notion of the trace of an endomorphism of a projective module of finite type (see SGA 5 III for applications). The hypotheses and notation are those of (7.0).

8.1. Let $E \in \mathrm{ob} \, \mathrm{D}(S)_{\mathrm{parf}}$ (5.8.4 b). There is a natural arrow

$$\tau : \mathrm{RHom}(E, E) \longrightarrow A,$$

obtained by composing the inverse of the isomorphism (7.7)

$$\mathrm{RHom}(E, E) \xrightarrow{\sim} E^\vee \otimes^L E$$

with the canonical arrow (7.5) $E^\vee \otimes^L E \rightarrow A$.

Let $U \in \mathrm{ob} \, S$. Applying to τ the functor $H^0(U, \cdot)$, and using the fact that $H^0(U, \mathrm{RHom}(E, E))$ identifies with $\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{D}(U)}(E|U, E|U)$, one obtains a homomorphism of $H^0(U, A)$ -modules

$$\mathrm{Tr}_{E|U} : \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{D}(U)}(E|U, E|U) \longrightarrow H^0(U, A),$$

which we shall call the trace homomorphism. The finite Tor-dimension hypothesis on E is in fact superfluous for the definition of $\mathrm{Tr}_{E|U}$; see (8.5).

Before going further, we give some properties of the trace that follow immediately from the definition.

8.1.1. If $E = A$, then

$$\mathrm{Tr}_{A|U} : \mathrm{Hom}(A|U, A|U) \longrightarrow H^0(U, A)$$

is just the well-known isomorphism. If E is a direct factor of a free module of finite type, an endomorphism of E over U is locally defined by

$$e \longmapsto \sum_i \langle e, x_i^\vee \rangle x_i,$$

where x_i (respectively $x_i^\vee$) is a local section of E (respectively $E^\vee$); the corresponding trace is $\sum_i \langle x_i, x_i^\vee \rangle$. It follows easily that, if E and F are direct factors of free modules of finite type, and if

$$u : (E + F)|U \longrightarrow (E + F)|U$$

is defined by a matrix $\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}$, then

$$\mathrm{Tr}_{(E+F)|U}(u) = \mathrm{Tr}_{E|U}(a) + \mathrm{Tr}_{F|U}(d).$$

8.1.2. Let E be a strictly perfect complex, let $U \in \mathrm{ob} S$, and let

$$u : E|U \longrightarrow E|U$$

be a homomorphism of complexes, with components $u^i : E^i|U \rightarrow E^i|U$. Then

$$\mathrm{Tr}_{E|U}(u) = \sum_i (-1)^i \mathrm{Tr}_{E^i|U}(u^i).$$

Indeed, the question being local, one may suppose that u is defined by a section of $H^0(E^\vee \otimes E)$, and even that this section is of the form

$$\sum_{i,j} x_{ij}^\vee \otimes x_{ij},$$

where x_{ij} (respectively $x_{ij}^\vee$) is a section of E^i (respectively $E^{i\vee}$). Making explicit the arrow (7.5) $E^\vee \otimes^L E \rightarrow A$, one finds

$$\mathrm{Tr}_{E|U}(u) = \sum_{i,j} (-1)^i \langle x_{ij}, x_{ij}^\vee \rangle = \sum_i (-1)^i \mathrm{Tr}_{E^i|U}(u^i).$$

8.2. Let $E, F \in \mathrm{ob} D(S)_{\mathrm{Parf}}$. We have seen in (7.8) that there is a canonical homomorphism

$$\chi : \mathrm{RHom}(E, F) \overset{L}{\otimes} \mathrm{RHom}(F, E) \longrightarrow A.$$

Let $U \in \mathrm{ob} S$, and let

$$u \in H^0(U, \mathrm{RHom}(E, F)), \quad v \in H^0(U, \mathrm{RHom}(F, E)).$$

One may interpret u (respectively v) as a homomorphism, in $D(U)$, from $A|U$ to $\mathrm{RHom}(E, F)|U$ (respectively $\mathrm{RHom}(F, E)|U$), and form

$$u \overset{L}{\otimes} v : A|U \longrightarrow (\mathrm{RHom}(E, F) \overset{L}{\otimes} \mathrm{RHom}(F, E))|U.$$

The map $(u, v) \mapsto \langle u, v \rangle = \chi \circ (u \overset{L}{\otimes} v)$ defines an $H^0(U, A)$ -bilinear pairing

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{D(U)}(E|U, F|U) \otimes_{H^0(U, A)} \mathrm{Hom}_{D(U)}(F|U, E|U) \longrightarrow H^0(U, A),$$

which we shall call the cup-product. The same comment as for the definition of $\mathrm{Tr}_{E|U}$ applies here.

The relation between trace and cup-product is expressed in the following proposition.

Proposition 8.3. In the situation of (8.2), for $u \in \mathrm{Hom}(E|U, F|U)$ and $v \in \mathrm{Hom}(F|U, E|U)$, one has

$$\mathrm{Tr}_{E|U}(vu) = \mathrm{Tr}_{F|U}(uv) = \langle u, v \rangle.$$

In particular, if $E = F$, then

$$\mathrm{Tr}_{E|U}(u) = \langle u, \mathrm{Id} \rangle = \langle \mathrm{Id}, u \rangle.$$

Proof. For simplicity we suppose $U = S$. We therefore have two arrows

$$u : A \longrightarrow E^\vee \otimes^L F, \quad v : A \longrightarrow F^\vee \otimes^L E,$$

and hence

$$u \otimes^L v : A \longrightarrow E^\vee \otimes^L F \otimes^L F^\vee \otimes^L E.$$

On the other hand, we have seen that $vu : A \rightarrow E^\vee \otimes^L E$ and $uv : A \rightarrow F^\vee \otimes^L F$. The proposition follows from the commutativity of the following diagrams, whose verification is purely mechanical:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{u \otimes^L v} & E^\vee \otimes^L F \otimes^L F^\vee \otimes^L E \\ & \searrow vu & \downarrow \mathrm{Id} \otimes \tau_F \\ & & E^\vee \otimes^L E \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{u \otimes^L v} & E^\vee \otimes^L F \otimes^L F^\vee \otimes^L E \\ & \searrow uv & \downarrow \tau_E \otimes \mathrm{Id} \\ & & F^\vee \otimes^L F \end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} E^\vee \otimes^L F \otimes^L F^\vee \otimes^L E & \xrightarrow{\mathrm{Id} \otimes \tau_E} & F^\vee \otimes^L F \\ \mathrm{Id} \otimes \tau_F \downarrow & & \downarrow \tau_F \\ E^\vee \otimes^L E & \xrightarrow{\tau_E} & A. \end{array}$$

Corollary 8.4. Let E, F, U be as in (8.2), let $u \in \mathrm{Hom}(E|U, E|U)$, and let $s : E|U \rightarrow F|U$ be an isomorphism. Then $sus^{-1} \in \mathrm{Hom}(F|U, F|U)$, and

$$\mathrm{Tr}_{F|U}(sus^{-1}) = \mathrm{Tr}_{E|U}(u).$$

Proof. Immediate.

Remark 8.5. If $\mathcal{C}$ is a fibered S -category, denote by $\mathcal{E}(\mathcal{C})$ the fibered S -category whose fiber over $U \in \mathrm{ob} S$ is the category whose objects are pairs (L, u) , with $L \in \mathrm{ob} \mathcal{C}_U$ and $u \in \mathrm{End}_S(L)$, and whose arrows from (L, u) to (M, v) are the arrows $f : L \rightarrow M$ such that $fu = vf$. By (8.4) one may regard the trace homomorphism as an S -functor from $\mathcal{E}(\mathrm{D}(S)_{\mathrm{Parf}})^{\mathrm{is}}$ to $\mathcal{A}$, where the exponent is means that only isomorphisms are considered, and where $\mathcal{A}$ is the S -category with discrete fibers defined by A (cf. (6.6 a)). Since every perfect complex is locally of finite Tor-dimension, the forgetful S -functor

$$\mathcal{E}(\mathrm{D}(S)_{\mathrm{Parf}})^{\mathrm{is}} \longrightarrow \mathcal{E}(\mathrm{D}(S)_{\mathrm{parf}})^{\mathrm{is}}$$

induces an isomorphism on the associated stacks. Consequently, the trace homomorphism extends uniquely to an S -functor from $\mathcal{E}(\mathrm{D}(S)_{\mathrm{Parf}})^{\mathrm{is}}$ to $\mathcal{A}$.

For $E \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{Parf}(U)$, $U \in \mathrm{ob} S$, we again write

$$\mathrm{Tr}_E : \mathrm{Hom}(E, E) \longrightarrow H^0(U, A)$$

for the corresponding homomorphism, which is an $H^0(U, A)$ -module homomorphism. One sees in the same way that the definition of the cup-product (8.2), as well as assertions (8.3) and (8.4), generalize to perfect complexes, not necessarily of finite Tor-dimension.

Proposition 8.6. Let $U \in \text{ob } S$, let $E, F \in \text{Parf}(U)$, and let $u \in \text{Hom}(E, E)$, $v \in \text{Hom}(F, F)$; hence $u \otimes^L v \in \text{Hom}(E \otimes^L F, E \otimes^L F)$. Then

$$\text{Tr}_{E \otimes^L F}(u \otimes^L v) = \text{Tr}_E(u) \text{Tr}_F(v).$$

Proof. The question being local, by (8.4) and (4.10) one may suppose that u and v are arrows of $K^b(\mathcal{C}_0)$. Using (8.1.2), one is reduced to the case where u and v are arrows of $\mathcal{C}_0$. One finishes by (8.1.1).

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Exposé II. Existence of global resolutions

by L. Illusie

1. General globalization criteria

1.0

In this section we are given a site S , a flat abelian S -category $\mathcal{C}$ (I 1.1), and a strictly full additive sub- S -category $\mathcal{C}_0$ (I 1.1). We assume that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is locally quasi-liftable in $\mathcal{C}$ (I 1.2) and locally quasi-stable under kernels of epimorphisms (I 1.2).

Proposition 1.1. Let $S \in \text{ob}(S)$, and suppose that:

- (i) $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ is quasi-liftable in $\mathcal{C}_S$ (I 1.2), where $\mathcal{C}_S$ is regarded as a category fibered over a punctual site;
- (ii) every object of $\mathcal{C}_S$ which is of finite $\mathcal{C}_0$ -type (I 1.2), respectively of finite $\mathcal{C}_0$ -presentation (I 2.8), is of finite $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -type.

Then:

- a) $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ is quasi-stable under kernels of epimorphisms (I 1.2), where $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ is regarded as a category fibered over a punctual site.
- b) Let $E \in \text{ob } D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)$ and $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. If E is $n\text{-}\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent (I 2.2), then E is $n\text{-}\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -pseudo-coherent, respectively $(n+1)\text{-}\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -pseudo-coherent. In other words,

$$D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)_{n\text{-}\mathcal{C}_0\text{-coh}} = D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)_{n\text{-}\mathcal{C}_{0S}\text{-coh}},$$

and, respectively,

$$D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)_{n\text{-}\mathcal{C}_0\text{-coh}} \subset D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)_{(n+1)\text{-}\mathcal{C}_{0S}\text{-coh}} \subset D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)_{(n+1)\text{-}\mathcal{C}_0\text{-coh}},$$

inclusions of strictly full subcategories of $D(\mathcal{C}_S)$, the inclusion on the right being trivial.

- c) For an object $E \in \text{ob } D(\mathcal{C}_S)$ to be pseudo-coherent relative to $\mathcal{C}_0$ (I 2.3), it is necessary and sufficient that it be pseudo-coherent relative to $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$; equivalently,

$$D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)_{\mathcal{C}_0\text{-coh}} = D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)_{\mathcal{C}_{0S}\text{-coh}}.$$

Moreover, the canonical functor

$$K^-(\mathcal{C}_{0S})/K^{-,\delta}(\mathcal{C}_{0S}) \longrightarrow D(\mathcal{C}_S),$$

where $K^{-,\delta}(\mathcal{C}_{0S})$ denotes the thick subcategory of $K^-(\mathcal{C}_{0S})$ formed by acyclic complexes, is fully faithful and has as essential image $D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)_{\mathcal{C}_0\text{-coh}}$. If $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ is liftable in $\mathcal{C}_S$ (I 1.2), that is, if the objects of $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ are projective, then $K^{-,\delta}(\mathcal{C}_{0S})$ is reduced to zero objects, and consequently the functor

$$K^-(\mathcal{C}_{0S}) \longrightarrow D(\mathcal{C}_S)$$

is fully faithful and has essential image $D^-(\mathcal{C}_S)_{\mathcal{C}_0\text{-coh}}$.

Proof. a) Let

$$0 \longrightarrow L \longrightarrow L^0 \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow L^m \longrightarrow 0$$

be an exact sequence in $\mathcal{C}_S$, with $L^i \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0S}$ for all i . It is enough to prove that L is of finite $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -type. By (I 2.2), L is $\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent, hence, by (I 2.9), of finite $\mathcal{C}_0$ -presentation; the assertion follows from (ii).

b) We prove by descending induction on i that E is $i\text{-}\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -pseudo-coherent for $i \geq n$, respectively for $i \geq n+1$. One may already suppose that E is strictly $(n+1)\text{-}\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -pseudo-coherent, respectively strictly $(n+2)\text{-}\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -pseudo-coherent (I 2.1); the point is then to prove that E is $n\text{-}\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -pseudo-coherent, respectively $(n+1)\text{-}\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -pseudo-coherent. Thus there is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow E' \longrightarrow E \longrightarrow E'' \longrightarrow 0,$$

where E' is strictly $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -perfect (I 2.1) and $E''^i = 0$ for $i > n$, respectively for $i > n+1$. Replacing E by E'' , one may therefore suppose (I 2.6) that $E^i = 0$ for $i > n$, respectively for $i > n+1$. Then, by (I 2.10 a)), $H^n(E)$, respectively $H^{n+1}(E)$, is of finite $\mathcal{C}_0$ -type, respectively of finite $\mathcal{C}_0$ -presentation. Hence, by (ii), $H^n(E)$, respectively $H^{n+1}(E)$, is of finite $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -type. Applying (I 2.10 b)) again, one obtains that E is $n\text{-}\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -pseudo-coherent, respectively $(n+1)\text{-}\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -pseudo-coherent. The hypothesis (i) and part a) have been used implicitly in the references to (I 2.6 and 2.10).

c) The first assertion follows from b), the second from (I 2.7), and the last is evident.

Proposition 1.2. Suppose that $\mathcal{C}_0$ is locally liftable in $\mathcal{C}$ (I 1.2) and locally stable under kernels of epimorphisms (I 1.2), and make the hypotheses (1.1 (i) and (ii), respectively). Let $\mathcal{C}_{1S}$ denote the strictly full subcategory of $\mathcal{C}_S$ formed by the objects which are locally in $\mathcal{C}_0$. Then:

- a) $\mathcal{C}_{1S}$ is stable under kernels of epimorphisms (I 1.2) and is quasi-liftable in $\mathcal{C}_S$ (I 1.2), as a category fibered over a punctual site.
- b) Let $E \in \text{ob } D(\mathcal{C}_S)$ and let $[m, n]$ be an interval of $\mathbb{Z}$. For E to have $\mathcal{C}_0$ -perfect amplitude contained in $[m, n]$, it is necessary and sufficient that E be isomorphic, in $D(\mathcal{C}_S)$, to a complex F such that $F^i = 0$ for $i \notin [m, n]$, $F^i \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0S}$ for $i > m$, and $F^m \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{1S}$.

- c) The canonical functor

$$K^b(\mathcal{C}_{1S})/K^{b,\delta}(\mathcal{C}_{1S}) \longrightarrow D(\mathcal{C}_S)$$

is fully faithful and has as essential image the full subcategory of $D(\mathcal{C}_S)$ formed by complexes of finite $\mathcal{C}_0$ -perfect amplitude.

- d) If $\mathcal{C}_{1S}$ is not merely quasi-liftable but liftable in $\mathcal{C}_S$, one may replace, in b), the expression “ E is isomorphic to F in $D(\mathcal{C}_S)$ ” by “there exists a quasi-isomorphism $F \rightarrow E$ ”; and, in c), $K^{b,\delta}(\mathcal{C}_{1S})$ is reduced to zero objects.

Proof. a) It is clear that $\mathcal{C}_{1S}$ is stable under kernels of epimorphisms. On the other hand, the objects of $\mathcal{C}_{1S}$ are $\mathcal{C}_0$ -pseudo-coherent, hence $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -pseudo-coherent by (1.1 c)); the second assertion follows from (I 2.14), taking S to be the punctual site.

b) It suffices to prove necessity. By (1.1 c)), E is already $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -pseudo-coherent. Since E is acyclic in degree $> n$, one may, after replacing E by an isomorphic complex in $D(\mathcal{C}_S)$, suppose (I 2.10) that E is strictly $(m+1)$ - $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ -pseudo-coherent and that $E^i = 0$ for $i > n$. Since E is acyclic in degree $< m$, one may also replace E by its truncation

$$0 \longrightarrow E^m/B^m \longrightarrow E^{m+1} \longrightarrow \dots \longrightarrow E^n \longrightarrow 0,$$

so that $E^i = 0$ for $i < m$. Then, by (I 4.16), E^m is locally an object of $\mathcal{C}_0$, and therefore an object of $\mathcal{C}_{1S}$.

c) In view of (1.2 a)), the assertion follows from (1.2 b)) and (I 4.12.2). d) The fact that $K^{b,\delta}(\mathcal{C}_{1S})$ is reduced to zero objects is evident. The other assertion follows from (I 4.6), applied over the punctual site.

2. Application to certain categories of modules

2.0. Notation

Let (S, A) be a ringed topos. For $U \in \text{ob } S$, write $\text{Mod}(U)$ for the category of left A_U -modules, and $\text{Lib}(U)$, respectively $\text{Loclib}(U)$, for the full subcategory of $\text{Mod}(U)$ formed by free A_U -modules, respectively modules locally direct factors of free modules, of finite type.

2.1. Lifting lemmas

Lemma 2.1.1 (cf. EGA 0_I, 5.2.3). Let (S, A) be a ringed topos, and let $S \in \text{ob } S$. Suppose that S is quasi-compact, that is, every covering family $(S_i \rightarrow S)$ is dominated by a finite covering family.

- a) Let F be a left A_S -module which is the filtered inductive limit, over a filtered category Λ , of A_S -modules F_λ , and let

$$u = \varinjlim u_\lambda : F \longrightarrow G$$

be an epimorphism, where G is an A_S -module of finite type. Then there exists $\lambda \in \Lambda$ such that u_λ is an epimorphism.

- b) Let F be a left A_S -module generated by its sections, that is, such that there exists an epimorphism $A_S^{(I)} \rightarrow F$ for a suitable set of indices I . If F is of finite type, then there exists an epimorphism $A_S^p \rightarrow F$ for some $p \in \mathbb{N}$.

The proof of a) is analogous to the proof of the cited result and is left to the reader; b) follows immediately from a).

Lemma 2.1.2. Let (S, A) be a ringed topos, let $\mathcal{C}$ be the S -category fibered in left A -modules, let $\mathcal{C}_0$ be the fibered subcategory of free A -modules of finite type (I 1.3 d)), let $S \in \text{ob } S$, and let $\mathcal{C}'_S$ be a strictly full additive subcategory of $\mathcal{C}_S$ containing $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ and stable under kernels, cokernels, and extensions. Suppose that

$$H^1(S, F) = 0 \quad \text{for every } F \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}'_S.$$

Then:

- a) Every exact sequence in $\mathcal{C}_S$

$$0 \longrightarrow E \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow G \longrightarrow 0,$$

such that $\text{Hom}(G, E) \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}'_S$ and such that G is locally a direct factor of a free module of finite type, is split. The category $\mathcal{C}_{0S}$ is liftable in $\mathcal{C}'_S$ (I 2.2).

- b) Let $\text{Mod}(A(S))$ denote the category of $A(S)$ -modules. The functor

$$\Gamma_S : \mathcal{C}'_S \longrightarrow \text{Mod}(A(S))$$

is exact. Moreover:

- (i) if every object F of $\mathcal{C}'_S$ admits a finite global presentation

$$A_S^q \longrightarrow A_S^p \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow 0,$$

then Γ_S is fully faithful and has as essential image the full subcategory of $\text{Mod}(A(S))$ formed by $A(S)$ -modules of finite presentation;

- (ii) if $\mathcal{C}'_S$ contains the free A_S -modules, if every object F of $\mathcal{C}'_S$ admits a global presentation

$$A_S^{(J)} \longrightarrow A_S^{(I)} \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow 0,$$

and if Γ_S commutes with filtered inductive limits, then Γ_S is an equivalence of categories.

Proof. a) Since G is locally a direct factor of a free module of finite type, the spectral sequence

$$E_2^{pq} = H^p(S, \mathcal{E}xt^q(G, E)) \implies \text{Ext}^{p+q}(G, E)$$

degenerates (I 1.3.1) and gives an isomorphism

$$H^1(S, \text{Hom}(G, E)) \simeq \text{Ext}^1(G, E),$$

whence the first assertion. The second is a particular case, since for $G \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}_{0S}$ and $E \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}'_S$ one has $\text{Hom}(G, E) \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}'_S$.

- b) The first assertion is trivial. Let us prove, in case (i) or (ii), the full faithfulness of $\Gamma_S : \mathcal{C}'_S \rightarrow \text{Mod}(A(S))$. Let $F, G \in \text{ob } \mathcal{C}'_S$ and let

$$A_S^{(J)} \longrightarrow A_S^{(I)} \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow 0 \tag{*}$$

be a global presentation of F , with I and J finite in case (i). Applying Γ_S , which is exact on $\mathcal{C}'_S$ and, in case (ii), commutes with filtered inductive limits, one obtains an exact sequence

$$A(S)^{(J)} \longrightarrow A(S)^{(I)} \longrightarrow \Gamma_S(F) \longrightarrow 0. \quad (**)$$

Applying the left exact functors $\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}_S}(-, G)$ and $\text{Hom}_{A(S)}(-, \Gamma_S(G))$ to $(*)$ and $(**)$ gives a commutative diagram with exact rows:

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}_S}(F, G) & \longrightarrow & \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}_S}(A_S^{(I)}, G) & \longrightarrow & \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}_S}(A_S^{(J)}, G) \\ & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \sim & & \downarrow \sim \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & \text{Hom}_{A(S)}(\Gamma_S F, \Gamma_S G) & \longrightarrow & \text{Hom}_{A(S)}(A(S)^{(I)}, \Gamma_S G) & \longrightarrow & \text{Hom}_{A(S)}(A(S)^{(J)}, \Gamma_S G). \end{array}$$

The two vertical arrows on the right are visibly isomorphisms, hence so is the arrow on the left. The description of the essential image in cases (i) and (ii) is immediate and is left to the reader.

Lemma 2.1.3. Let $\mathcal{A}$ and $\mathcal{B}$ be abelian categories, and let $\varphi : \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ be an exact functor.

a) For $M \in \text{ob } \mathcal{A}$, the following conditions are equivalent:

(i) for every $L \in \text{ob } \mathcal{A}$, the canonical map induced by φ

$$\text{Ext}_{\mathcal{A}}^n(L, M) \longrightarrow \text{Ext}_{\mathcal{B}}^n(\varphi L, \varphi M)$$

is an isomorphism for all n ;

(ii) for every $L \in \text{ob } \mathcal{A}$, the canonical map

$$\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{A}}(L, M) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{B}}(\varphi L, \varphi M)$$

is an isomorphism, and for every $n \geq 1$ and every $x \in \text{Ext}_{\mathcal{B}}^n(\varphi L, \varphi M)$ there exists an epimorphism $L' \rightarrow L$ in $\mathcal{A}$ which kills x .

b) The following conditions are equivalent:

(i) for all $L, M \in \text{ob } \mathcal{A}$ and all $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, the canonical map

$$\text{Ext}_{\mathcal{A}}^n(L, M) \longrightarrow \text{Ext}_{\mathcal{B}}^n(\varphi L, \varphi M)$$

is an isomorphism;

(ii) the canonical functor induced by φ

$$\text{D}^b(\mathcal{A}) \longrightarrow \text{D}^b(\mathcal{B})$$

is fully faithful and has as essential image the full subcategory of $\text{D}^b(\mathcal{B})$ formed by complexes F such that $H^i(F)$ is in the essential image of φ for every i .

Proof. For (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii) in a), it is enough to show that, if $n \geq 1$, $L \in \text{ob } \mathcal{A}$, and $y \in \text{Ext}_{\mathcal{A}}^n(L, M)$, then there exists an epimorphism $L' \rightarrow L$ killing y . Using Yoneda's interpretation ([18], III 3.2), y is the class of an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow E_{n-1} \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow E_0 \longrightarrow L \longrightarrow 0,$$

and the epimorphism $E_0 \rightarrow L$ kills y ([18], III 3.2.5 and 3.2.8). Conversely, put

$$F^n(L) = \text{Ext}_{\mathcal{A}}^n(L, M), \quad G^n(L) = \text{Ext}_{\mathcal{B}}^n(\varphi L, \varphi M).$$

The effaceability hypothesis says, for $n \geq 1$ and $L \in \text{ob } \mathcal{A}$, that

$$G^n(L) = \varinjlim \text{Coker } \text{igl}(G^{n-1}(L_0) \rightarrow G^{n-1}(L_1)),$$

the limit being taken over the exact sequences $L_1 \rightarrow L_0 \rightarrow L \rightarrow 0$. As above, one has the same formula for $F^n(L)$. Since $F^0 \rightarrow G^0$ is an isomorphism, induction on n shows that the morphism $F^n \rightarrow G^n$ induced by φ is an isomorphism for every n . The equivalence in b) follows by an immediate dévissage, left to the reader.

Remarks 2.1.3.1. There is of course a dual version of a), which we leave to the reader to state. On the other hand, if $\mathcal{A}$ and $\mathcal{B}$ have enough injectives, the conditions (i) and (ii) of b) are equivalent to:

(iii) for $L \in \text{ob } D^-(\mathcal{A})$ and $M \in \text{ob } D^+(\mathcal{A})$, the canonical map

$$\text{RHom}(L, M) \longrightarrow \text{RHom}(\varphi L, \varphi M)$$

is an isomorphism,

as is seen at once by a spectral sequence argument.

2.2. Noetherian schemes and divisorial schemes

Notation 2.2.1. Let S be a scheme. We write $\text{Qcoh}(S)$, respectively $\text{Coh}(S)$, for the abelian category of quasi-coherent, respectively coherent, $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules. Let $[m, n]$ be an interval of $\mathbb{Z}$. We shall say that an object E of $D(\text{Qcoh}(S))$ is n -pseudo-coherent, respectively pseudo-coherent, respectively of perfect amplitude contained in $[m, n]$, respectively perfect, if it is so relative to the category fibered over the Zariski site of S defined by

$$U \longmapsto \text{Loclib}(U)$$

((I 2.3), (I 4.7), and (2.0)). We denote by $D^-(\text{Qcoh}(S))_{\text{coh}}$, respectively $D(\text{Qcoh}(S))_{\text{parf}}$, the full triangulated subcategory of $D(\text{Qcoh}(S))$ formed by pseudo-coherent, respectively perfect, complexes.

Proposition 2.2.2. Let S be a noetherian scheme. The canonical functor

$$D^-(\text{Coh}(S)) \longrightarrow D(\text{Qcoh}(S))$$

is fully faithful and has as essential image $D^-(\text{Qcoh}(S))_{\text{coh}}$.

Proof. Apply (1.1), taking for the site the Zariski site of S , and for $\mathcal{C}$, respectively $\mathcal{C}_0$, the fibered categories $U \mapsto \text{Qcoh}(U)$, respectively $U \mapsto \text{Coh}(U)$. Since $\mathcal{O}_S$ is coherent, the objects of $\mathcal{C}_0$ are pseudo-coherent (I 3.5); hence an object of $D(\text{Qcoh}(U))$ is pseudo-coherent, in the sense of (2.2.1), if and only if it is pseudo-coherent relative to $\mathcal{C}_0$ (I 2.14.1). By (1.1 c)), it remains to verify conditions (i) and (ii) of (1.1). For (ii) this is trivial, since a quasi-coherent module which is a quotient of a coherent module is coherent, and coherence is local. For (i), one uses (2.1.1 a)) and the fact that every quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module is a filtered inductive limit of coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules (EGA I 9.4.9).

Granting (3.5) and (3.7), which are independent of the present section, one easily deduces the following.

Corollary 2.2.2.1. Let S be a noetherian scheme, respectively a noetherian scheme of finite dimension. The canonical functor

$$D^b(\text{Coh}(S)) \longrightarrow D(S)$$

respectively

$$D^-(\mathrm{Coh}(S)) \longrightarrow D(S)$$

is fully faithful and has as essential image $D^b(S)_{\mathrm{coh}}$, respectively $D^-(S)_{\mathrm{coh}}$ (I 2.15).

Proposition 2.2.3 (cf. EGA II 4.5.2 and 4.5.5). Let S be a quasi-compact and quasi-separated scheme, and let $(L_i)_{i \in I}$ be a family of invertible sheaves on S . For every $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module F and every pair $(i, n) \in I \times \mathbb{Z}$, let $F_{(i,n)}$ denote the sub- $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module of $F \otimes L_i^{\otimes n}$ generated by the sections of $F \otimes L_i^{\otimes n}$ over S . The following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) the open sets S_f , for $f \in \Gamma(S, L_i^{\otimes n})$, $i \in I$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$, form a base for the topology of S ;
- (ii) those of the S_f which are affine cover S ;
- (iii) for every quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module F of finite type, there exists a finite family (i_α, n_α) with $n_\alpha \geq 0$ and an epimorphism

$$\bigoplus_{\alpha} L_{i_\alpha}^{\otimes(-n_\alpha)} \longrightarrow F;$$

- (iv) for every $F \in \mathrm{ob} \, \mathrm{Qcoh}(S)$, one has

$$F = \sum_{(i,n) \in I \times \mathbb{N}} F_{(i,n)} \otimes L_i^{\otimes(-n)},$$

a sum, not necessarily direct, of sub-sheaves of F ;

- (v) same condition as (iv), but with F a quasi-coherent ideal of $\mathcal{O}_S$.

Proof. This is a simple paraphrase of the cited passages; we recall the argument briefly for the reader's convenience. For (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii), choose for $x \in S$ an affine open U containing x . An open S_f with $x \in S_f \subset U$, where $f \in \Gamma(S, L_i^{\otimes n})$ and $n \geq 0$, is necessarily affine, by the following lemma.

Lemma 2.2.3.1 (EGA II 5.5.8). Let X be a scheme, L an invertible $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, and $f \in \Gamma(X, L)$. The canonical immersion $X_f \rightarrow X$ is affine.

Proof. This is trivial: the question is local on X , so one may suppose X affine and $L \simeq \mathcal{O}_X$.

For (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (iii), choose a finite covering of S by affine opens $S_{f_{ij}}$, with $f_{ij} \in \Gamma(S, L_i^{\otimes m_{ij}})$. Replacing the f_{ij} by suitable powers, one may suppose that the m_{ij} with fixed i are all equal to an integer m_i . If F is quasi-coherent of finite type, then, for each i, j , there is an integer $q_i \geq 0$ such that every section of F over $S_{f_{ij}}$ extends to a section of $F \otimes L_i^{\otimes q_i m_i}$ over S . Thus $F \otimes L_i^{\otimes q_i m_i}$ is generated over $S_{f_{ij}}$ by finitely many global sections. Proceeding as in the proof of EGA II 4.5.5, one obtains, for each i , an integer $n_i \geq 0$ such that $F \otimes L_i^{\otimes n_i}$ is generated over the union of the corresponding $S_{f_{ij}}$ by finitely many sections over S . Hence there are integers $r_i \geq 0$ and a morphism

$$L_i^{-n_i r_i} \longrightarrow F$$

which induces an epimorphism over that union; the assertion follows.

For (iii) $\Rightarrow$ (iv), since every quasi-coherent sheaf on S is the inductive limit of its quasi-coherent subsheaves of finite type (EGA I 9.4.9 and IV 1.7.7), it is enough to treat the case where F is of finite type. There exist morphisms

$$u_i : L_i^{-n_i r_i} \longrightarrow F$$

whose sum is an epimorphism. But

$$\mathrm{Im}(u_i) = \mathrm{Im}(u_i \otimes \mathrm{Id}(L_i^{n_i})) \otimes L_i^{-n_i},$$

and $\text{Im}(u_i \otimes \text{Id}(L_i^{n_i}))$ is a subsheaf of $F_{(i,n_i)}$, which gives the assertion. The implication (iv) $\Rightarrow$ (v) is trivial. Finally, for (v) $\Rightarrow$ (i), let $x \in S$, let U be an open containing x , and let F be a quasi-coherent ideal defining $S - U$. By (v), there are $(i, n) \in I \times \mathbb{N}$ and a section f of $F \otimes L_i^{\otimes n}$ over S with $f(x) \neq 0$. Then $x \in S_f \subset U$, proving (i).

Definition 2.2.4. Let S be a quasi-compact and quasi-separated scheme, and let $(L_i)_{i \in I}$ be a family of invertible sheaves on S . We say that the L_i form an *ample family* if the equivalent conditions of (2.2.3) hold. In particular, a family consisting of a single sheaf L is ample if and only if L is ample in the usual sense (EGA II 4.5.3).

Definition 2.2.5. A scheme S is called *divisorial* if S is quasi-compact and quasi-separated and if there exists an ample family (2.2.4) of invertible $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules.

Lemma 2.2.6. Let X be a locally noetherian scheme. Let U be an open of X such that the inclusion $U \rightarrow X$ is affine, for example U affine and X separated. Then $X - U$ is purely of codimension 0 or 1; that is, at every maximal point x of $X - U$ one has $\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} = 0$ or 1. It is purely of codimension 1 if U contains the maximal points of X .

Proof. Put $Y = X - U$. Let x be a maximal point of Y and make the base change $X' = \text{Spec } \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \rightarrow X$; one obtains a cartesian diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U' & \longrightarrow & U \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ X' & \longrightarrow & X. \end{array}$$

Let $Y' = X' - U'$. Since x is a maximal point of Y , Y' is just the closed point of X' . Since X' is affine, U' is an affine open of X' . We show that the dimension d of X' is 0 or 1. Indeed, one knows (SGA 2 V 5.7) that $H_{Y'}^d(X', \mathcal{O}_{X'}) \neq 0$. But if $d \geq 2$, then

$$H_{Y'}^d(X', \mathcal{O}_{X'}) = H^{d-1}(U', \mathcal{O}_{X'}),$$

and the latter group is zero because U' is affine and $d - 1 \geq 1$, a contradiction.

Remark 2.2.6.1. Without the separation hypothesis on X , (2.2.6) would be false for an affine open U of X , as shown by the example of the affine plane with the origin doubled (EGA I 5.5.11).

Proposition 2.2.7. Let S be a noetherian separated locally factorial scheme, that is, a scheme whose local rings are factorial. Then S is divisorial (2.2.5). In particular (EGA IV 21.11.1):

Corollary 2.2.7.1. Every noetherian regular separated scheme is divisorial.

Proof of 2.2.7. One may suppose that S is integral. Let $(S_i)_{i \in I}$ be a finite covering of S by nonempty affine opens. By (2.2.6), $S - S_i$ is purely of codimension 1; hence, by EGA IV 21.7.4, it is the support of a positive divisor. In other words, for each $i \in I$, there is an invertible sheaf L_i and a section $f_i \in \Gamma(S, L_i)$ such that $S_i = S_{f_i}$. The family (L_i) is then ample by (2.2.4), using (2.2.3 (ii)).

Remark 2.2.7.2. As in (2.2.6), the separation hypothesis on S is essential. Let S again be the affine plane with the origin doubled. Recall that S is obtained by gluing two copies of the affine plane $\mathbb{A}_k^2$ along the identity on the complement U of the origin O ; hence there is a canonical projection

$$p : S \longrightarrow \mathbb{A}_k^2$$

which is an isomorphism over U , while $p^{-1}(O)$ consists of two points O_1 and O_2 . An invertible sheaf on S is obtained by gluing two invertible sheaves on $\mathbb{A}_k^2$ by an isomorphism over U . Since every invertible sheaf on $\mathbb{A}_k^2$ is trivial, an invertible sheaf on S is defined by an element

$g \in \Gamma(U, \mathcal{O}_U^*)$. But g is necessarily constant, since the restriction $\Gamma(\mathbb{A}_k^2, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{A}^2}) \rightarrow \Gamma(U, \mathcal{O}_U)$ is an isomorphism, the origin being of depth 2 in the plane. Thus every invertible sheaf on S is trivial. It is immediate, on the other hand, that p induces an isomorphism

$$\Gamma(\mathbb{A}_k^2, \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{A}^2}) \xrightarrow{\sim} \Gamma(S, \mathcal{O}_S).$$

Consequently every global section of $\mathcal{O}_S$ which vanishes at O_1 also vanishes at O_2 , and the opens S_f , for $f \in \Gamma(S, \mathcal{O}_S)$, do not form a base for the topology of S .

Theorem 2.2.8. Let S be a divisorial scheme (2.2.5), and let $(L_i)_{i \in I}$ be an ample family of invertible $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules. Let $L(S)$ be the strictly full additive subcategory of $\text{Qcoh}(S)$ generated by the $L_i^{\otimes(-n)}$, for $(i, n) \in I \times \mathbb{N}$. Let $E \in \text{ob } D(\text{Qcoh}(S))$.

- a) The categories $L(S)$ and $\text{Loclib}(S)$ are quasi-liftable in $\text{Qcoh}(S)$ (I 1.2) and quasi-stable under kernels of epimorphisms (I 1.2).
- b) Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. For E to be n -pseudo-coherent, respectively pseudo-coherent, in the sense of (2.2.1), it is necessary and sufficient that E be so relative to $L(S)$ or to $\text{Loclib}(S)$ (I 2.3). The canonical functors

$$K^-(L(S))/K^{-,\delta}(L(S)) \longrightarrow D(\text{Qcoh}(S)),$$

$$K^-(\text{Loclib}(S))/K^{-,\delta}(\text{Loclib}(S)) \longrightarrow D(\text{Qcoh}(S))$$

are fully faithful and have as essential image $D^-(\text{Qcoh}(S))_{\text{coh}}$.

- c) Let $[m, n]$ be an interval of $\mathbb{Z}$. For E to have perfect amplitude contained in $[m, n]$ (2.2.1), it is necessary and sufficient that E be isomorphic, in $D(\text{Qcoh}(S))$, to a complex F such that $F^i = 0$ for $i \notin [m, n]$, $F^i \in \text{ob } L(S)$ for $i > m$, and F^m is locally free of finite type. The canonical functor

$$K^b(\text{Loclib}(S))/K^{b,\delta}(\text{Loclib}(S)) \longrightarrow D(\text{Qcoh}(S))$$

is fully faithful and has as essential image $D(\text{Qcoh}(S))_{\text{parf}}$.

Proof. Let $F \rightarrow G$ be an epimorphism in $\text{Qcoh}(S)$, with G of finite type. Since F is the inductive limit of its quasi-coherent subsheaves of finite type (EGA I 9.4.9), there exists, by (2.1.1 a)), a quasi-coherent subsheaf F' of finite type in F such that $F' \rightarrow F \rightarrow G$ is an epimorphism. By (2.2.3 (iii)), there is an epimorphism $E \rightarrow F'$, with $E \in \text{ob } L(S)$; hence $E \rightarrow F' \rightarrow F \rightarrow G$ is an epimorphism. This proves that the category of quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules of finite type is quasi-liftable in $\text{Qcoh}(S)$, and a fortiori the same is true for $\text{Loclib}(S)$ and for $L(S)$.

For the second assertion of a), apply (1.1) on the Zariski site of S , with $\mathcal{C}$ the fibered category $U \mapsto \text{Qcoh}(U)$ and $\mathcal{C}_0$ the fibered category $U \mapsto L(U)$. Since every object of L is pseudo-coherent, the notions of n -pseudo-coherence and pseudo-coherence in the fibered category $D(\text{Qcoh})$ coincide with the same notions relative to L (I 2.14). Condition (ii) of (1.1) is satisfied by (2.2.3 (iii)), and thus (1.1 a)) gives the part of a) concerning $L(S)$. The assertion for $\text{Loclib}(S)$ is proved similarly. Part b) follows immediately from (1.1 b), c)), taking into account that, if $E \in \text{ob } D(\text{Qcoh}(S))$ is n -pseudo-coherent, then E lies in $D^-(\text{Qcoh}(S))$, since S is quasi-compact. An object of the fibered category Qcoh is locally in L if and only if it is locally free of finite type; hence L is locally liftable in Qcoh and locally stable under kernels of epimorphisms. Thus c) follows from (1.2), with $\mathcal{C} = \text{Qcoh}$, $\mathcal{C}_0 = L$, and $\mathcal{C}_1 = \text{Loclib}(S)$.

Proposition 2.2.9. The hypotheses and notation are those of (2.2.8), but assume moreover that S is separated or noetherian.

a) The canonical functors

$$K^-(L(S))/K^{-,\delta}(L(S)) \longrightarrow D(S), \quad K^-(\mathrm{Loclib}(S))/K^{-,\delta}(\mathrm{Loclib}(S)) \longrightarrow D(S)$$

are fully faithful and have as essential image $D^-(S)_{\mathrm{coh}}$. Moreover, if S is of finite cohomological dimension in the sense of (3.7), for example if the underlying space of S is noetherian of finite Krull dimension, then the functors

$$K(L(S))/K^\delta(L(S)) \longrightarrow K(\mathrm{Loclib}(S))/K^\delta(\mathrm{Loclib}(S)) \longrightarrow D^-(S)_{\mathrm{coh}}$$

are equivalences of categories.

b) The canonical functor

$$K^b(\mathrm{Loclib}(S))/K^{b,\delta}(\mathrm{Loclib}(S)) \longrightarrow D(S)$$

is fully faithful and has as essential image $D(S)_{\mathrm{parf}}$ (I 4.9). For $E \in \mathrm{ob} D(S)$ to have perfect amplitude contained in $[m, n]$ (I 4.8), it is necessary and sufficient that E be isomorphic, in $D(S)$, to a complex F such that $F^i = 0$ for $i \notin [m, n]$, $F^i \in \mathrm{ob} L(S)$ for $i > m$, and F^m is locally free of finite type.

Proof. In view of (3.5) and (3.7), this is an immediate corollary of (2.2.8). The only point to check, and it follows trivially from (3.5), respectively (3.7), is that for an object E of $D^-(\mathrm{Qcoh}(S))$, respectively of $D(\mathrm{Qcoh}(S))$ when S has finite cohomological dimension in the sense of (3.7), the notions of pseudo-coherence and perfection of (2.2.1) coincide with the usual notions (I 2.15 and 4.9) after regarding E as an object of $D(S)$.

Remark 2.2.10. a) If $S = \mathrm{Spec} A$ is affine, the family consisting of the single sheaf $\mathcal{O}_S$ is ample, and for it $L(S) = \mathrm{Lib}(S)$. It is also clear that the categories $K^{-,\delta}(\mathrm{Lib}(S))$ and $K^{-,\delta}(\mathrm{Loclib}(S))$ are reduced to zero objects. It follows from (2.2.9) that, writing $\mathrm{Mod}(A)$ for the category of A -modules and $D(A) = D(\mathrm{Mod}(A))$, the functor $R\Gamma_S : D(S) \rightarrow D(A)$ induces fully faithful functors

$$D^-(S)_{\mathrm{coh}} \longrightarrow D(A), \quad D(S)_{\mathrm{parf}} \longrightarrow D(A),$$

whose essential images are respectively the triangulated subcategories $D^-(A)_{\mathrm{coh}}$ and $D(A)_{\mathrm{parf}}$, formed by complexes with bounded-above cohomology and pseudo-coherent, respectively perfect, relative to the subcategory $\mathrm{Lib}(A)$, respectively $\mathrm{Loclib}(A)$, of free, respectively projective, modules of finite type. There are commutative diagrams of equivalences of categories

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} K^{-,b}(\mathrm{Lib}(S)) & \longrightarrow & K^{-,b}(\mathrm{Loclib}(S)) & \longrightarrow & D^b(S)_{\mathrm{coh}} \\ \Gamma_S \downarrow & & \Gamma_S \downarrow & & \downarrow R\Gamma_S \\ K^{-,b}(\mathrm{Lib}(A)) & \longrightarrow & K^{-,b}(\mathrm{Loclib}(A)) & \longrightarrow & D^b(A)_{\mathrm{coh}}, \end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} K^b(\mathrm{Loclib}(S)) & \longrightarrow & D(S)_{\mathrm{parf}} \\ \Gamma_S \downarrow & & \downarrow R\Gamma_S \\ K^b(\mathrm{Loclib}(A)) & \longrightarrow & D(A)_{\mathrm{parf}}. \end{array}$$

In the upper diagram, one may replace b by $-$ when S has finite cohomological dimension in the sense of (3.7).

b) For an arbitrary scheme S , it follows from a) that a complex of $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules which is pseudo-coherent and has bounded cohomology is locally isomorphic, in $D(S)$, to a strictly pseudo-coherent complex, which was by no means evident a priori (cf. I 2.3.1).

2.3. Soft sheaves

2.3.1. Recall a few definitions and results from [T.F.]. Let X be a paracompact space. A sheaf of sets F on X is called *soft* if, for every closed subset Y of X , every section of F over Y extends to a section of F over X . Soft abelian sheaves are acyclic: if F is soft, then $H^i(X, F) = 0$ for $i > 0$ (T.F. II 4.4.3).

Let A be a sheaf of rings on X . If F is a soft A -module, then F is generated by its sections (cf. 2.1.1): indeed, the homomorphism $A_X^{(I)} \rightarrow F$ defined by $I = H^0(X, F)$ is an epimorphism. Moreover, if A is soft, every A -module is soft (T.F. II 3.7.1). Examples of soft sheaves of rings include the sheaf of continuous real or complex-valued functions on a paracompact space and the sheaf of C^∞ functions on a C^∞ manifold.

Proposition 2.3.2. Let S be a compact space equipped with a soft sheaf of rings A . Write $\text{Mod}(S)$ for the category of left A -modules and $\text{D}(S) = \text{D}(\text{Mod}(S))$.

- a) The category $\text{Lib}(S)$, respectively $\text{Loclib}(S)$ (2.0), is liftable in $\text{Mod}(S)$ and quasi-stable, respectively stable, under kernels of epimorphisms (I 1.2). This assertion holds more generally for S paracompact.
- b) Let $E \in \text{ob D}(S)$ and $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. For E to be n -pseudo-coherent, respectively pseudo-coherent, it is necessary and sufficient that it be so relative to $\text{Lib}(S)$ or to $\text{Loclib}(S)$. The canonical functors

$$\text{K}^-(\text{Lib}(S)) \longrightarrow \text{D}(S), \quad \text{K}^-(\text{Loclib}(S)) \longrightarrow \text{D}(S)$$

are fully faithful and have as essential image $\text{D}^-(S)_{\text{coh}}$ (I 2.15).

- c) Let $E \in \text{ob D}(S)$ and let $[m, n]$ be an interval of $\mathbb{Z}$. For E to have perfect amplitude contained in $[m, n]$ (I 4.8), it is necessary and sufficient that there exist a quasi-isomorphism $F \rightarrow E$, where F is a complex such that $F^i = 0$ for $i \notin [m, n]$, $F^i \in \text{ob Lib}(S)$ for $i > m$, and $F^m \in \text{ob Loclib}(S)$. The canonical functor

$$\text{K}^b(\text{Loclib}(S)) \longrightarrow \text{D}(S)$$

is fully faithful and has as essential image $\text{D}(S)_{\text{parf}}$ (I 4.9).

- d) Let $\text{Mod}(A(S))$ be the category of left $A(S)$ -modules and $\text{D}(A(S))$ the corresponding derived category. The functor

$$H^0(S, -) : \text{Mod}(S) \longrightarrow \text{Mod}(A(S))$$

is exact and is an equivalence of categories. Moreover it defines equivalences of categories

$$\text{D}(S) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{D}(A(S)), \quad \text{D}^-(S)_{\text{coh}} \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{D}^-(A(S))_{\text{coh}}, \quad \text{D}(S)_{\text{parf}} \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{D}(A(S))_{\text{parf}},$$

where pseudo-coherence, respectively perfection, in $\text{D}(A(S))$ is understood relative to the category of free, respectively projective, modules of finite type. It also gives an equivalence from the full subcategory of $\text{D}(S)$ formed by n -pseudo-coherent objects, respectively by objects of perfect amplitude contained in $[m, n]$, onto the analogous full subcategory of $\text{D}(A(S))$.

Proof. The first assertion of a) follows from (2.1.2 a)), applied with S the topos of sheaves of sets on S and $\mathcal{C}'_S = \text{Mod}(S)$, using (2.3.1). The second follows from (1.1 a)), respectively (1.2 a)), with $\mathcal{C} = \text{Mod}$ and $\mathcal{C}_0 = \text{Lib}$, respectively Loclib ; the condition (ii) of (1.1) is verified by (2.3.1) and (2.1.1 b)). Part b) follows from (1.1 b), c)) with the same $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{C}_0$. Part c) follows from (1.2 b), c), d)), with $\mathcal{C} = \text{Mod}$ and $\mathcal{C}_0 = \text{Lib}$. The first assertion of d) follows, using (2.3.1), from (2.1.2 b) (ii)) with $\mathcal{C}'_S = \mathcal{C}_S = \text{Mod}(S)$. The other assertions in d) follow from it, together with b) and c), and from the fact that Γ_S carries free modules, respectively direct factors of free modules, of finite type to free, respectively projective, modules of finite type.

2.4. Stein spaces

Definition 2.4.1. Let S be a locally ringed topos (I 2.15.1 (ii)), with final object also denoted S . We say that S is *Stein* if the structural sheaf $\mathcal{O}_S$ is coherent (I 3.1) and if the following properties hold:

Theorem A: every coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module (I 3.1) is generated by its sections;

Theorem B: for every coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module F , one has $H^i(S, F) = 0$ for $i > 0$.

Remark 2.4.1.1. If S has enough closed points s such that the ideal $\mathfrak{m}_s$ defined by s is coherent, then the relation $H^1(S, F) = 0$ for every coherent sheaf F implies Theorem A. Indeed, let F be a coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module and let s be a closed point of S . There is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathfrak{m}_s F \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow F/\mathfrak{m}_s F \longrightarrow 0,$$

where $F/\mathfrak{m}_s F$ is a coherent sheaf concentrated at s . Applying $H^0(S, -)$ and writing the cohomology exact sequence, one finds that

$$H^0(S, F) \longrightarrow H^0(S, F/\mathfrak{m}_s F)$$

is an epimorphism. Since

$$H^0(S, F/\mathfrak{m}_s F) = F_s/\mathfrak{m}_s F_s,$$

where $\mathfrak{m}_s$ is the maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O}_s$, Nakayama's lemma gives the conclusion. The editor does not know whether the preceding implication is true in general when one assumes only that $\mathcal{O}_S$ is a coherent sheaf of local rings. The editor also does not know whether the relation $H^1(S, F) = 0$ for every coherent sheaf F implies Theorem B.

Examples 2.4.2. A complex analytic Stein space, a compact convex subset of $\mathbb{C}^n$ equipped with the sheaf induced by the sheaf of holomorphic functions, the spectrum of a noetherian ring, and an affine rigid analytic space define Stein topoi.

Lemma 2.4.3. Let S be a Stein topos (2.4.1). Suppose that the final object S is quasi-compact (2.1.1), and let $\text{Coh}(S)$ be the abelian category of coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules, that is, modules of finite presentation. Then:

- a) $\text{Lib}(S)$, respectively $\text{Loclib}(S)$, is liftable in $\text{Coh}(S)$ and quasi-stable, respectively stable, under kernels of epimorphisms (I 1.2).
- b) The canonical functors

$$\text{K}^-(\text{Lib}(S)) \longrightarrow \text{K}^-(\text{Loclib}(S)) \longrightarrow \text{D}^-(\text{Coh}(S))$$

are equivalences of categories.

- c) Put $A = \Gamma(S, \mathcal{O}_S)$, and write $\text{Mod}(A)$ for the category of A -modules and $\text{D}(A)$ for the corresponding derived category. The functor

$$\Gamma_S : \text{Coh}(S) \longrightarrow \text{Mod}(A)$$

is exact, fully faithful, and has as essential image the strictly full additive subcategory of $\text{Mod}(A)$ formed by A -modules of finite presentation. It induces a fully faithful functor

$$\text{D}^-(\text{Coh}(S)) \longrightarrow \text{D}(A),$$

whose essential image is the full subcategory $\text{D}^-(A)_{\text{coh}}$ formed by complexes pseudo-coherent relative to the subcategory of free modules of finite type.

Here “enough closed points” means enough fiber functors (SGA 4 IV 6.4.1) of the form $i^* : S \rightarrow s$, with i_* the inclusion of a closed subtopos of S ; and $\mathfrak{m}_s$ denotes the sections of $\mathcal{O}_S$ whose fiber at s belongs to the maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O}_s$.

Proof. For the first assertion of a), apply (2.1.2 a)) with $\mathcal{C}'_S = \text{Coh}(S)$; the hypothesis of (2.1.2) is verified by Theorem B, since if E is coherent and G is locally free of finite type, then $\text{Hom}(G, E)$ is coherent. Thus $\text{Loclib}(S)$, and a fortiori $\text{Lib}(S)$, is liftable in $\text{Coh}(S)$. The second assertion of a) follows from (1.1 a)), respectively (1.2 a)), applied with $\mathcal{C}_0 = \text{Lib}$, respectively Loclib ; condition (ii) of (1.1) is verified by Theorem A and (2.1.1 b)). Part b) follows from (1.1 c)), applied successively with $\mathcal{C}_0 = \text{Lib}$ and $\mathcal{C}_0 = \text{Loclib}$. The first assertion of c) follows from (2.1.2 b)(i)), applied with $\mathcal{C}'_S = \text{Coh}(S)$. To prove that $\Gamma_S : D^-(\text{Coh}(S)) \rightarrow D(A)$ is fully faithful, it is enough, by b), to prove that the composite

$$K^-(\text{Lib}(S)) \longrightarrow D^-(\text{Coh}(S)) \longrightarrow D(A)$$

is so. But this composite factors as

$$K^-(\text{Lib}(S)) \xrightarrow{\Gamma_S} K^-(\text{Lib}(A)) \longrightarrow D(A),$$

where $\text{Lib}(A)$ denotes the category of free A -modules of finite type; the first arrow is an equivalence of categories, and the second is fully faithful by (I 2.7 b)), applied with $\mathcal{C} = \text{Mod}(A)$ and $\mathcal{C}_0 = \text{Lib}(A)$, since $K^{-,\delta}(\text{Lib}(A)) = 0$. This proves the last assertion of c).

Lemma 2.4.4. Under the hypotheses of (2.4.3), the canonical functor

$$D^b(\text{Coh}(S)) \longrightarrow D(S)$$

is fully faithful and has as essential image $D^b(S)_{\text{coh}}$ (I 2.15).

Proof. Apply (2.1.3) with $\mathcal{A} = \text{Coh}(S)$, $\mathcal{B} = \text{Mod}(S)$, and $\varphi : \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$ the inclusion functor. Since this functor is fully faithful, it is enough, by (2.1.3 a)(ii)), to check that for fixed $M \in \text{ob Coh}(S)$ and $n > 0$ the functor

$$L \longmapsto \text{Ext}_{\text{Mod}(S)}^n(L, M)$$

is coeffaceable on $L \in \text{ob Coh}(S)$. By Theorem A and (2.1.1 b)), every coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module is a quotient of a free module of finite type; and if L is free of finite type, then $\text{Ext}_{\text{Mod}(S)}^n(L, M) = 0$ by Theorem B. The assertion follows. Hence the functor $D^b(\text{Coh}(S)) \rightarrow D(S)$ is fully faithful and has as essential image the full subcategory of $D(S)$ formed by complexes with bounded coherent cohomology, which is precisely $D^b(S)_{\text{coh}}$ since $\mathcal{O}_S$ is coherent (I 3.5).

Proposition 2.4.5. With the hypotheses and notation of (2.4.3), one has:

a) The canonical functors

$$K^{-,b}(\text{Lib}(S)) \longrightarrow K^{-,b}(\text{Loclib}(S)) \longrightarrow D^b(S)_{\text{coh}}$$

are equivalences of categories. Moreover, the functor $R\Gamma_S : D^b(S) \rightarrow D^b(A)$ induces a fully faithful functor

$$R\Gamma_S : D^b(S)_{\text{coh}} \longrightarrow D^b(A),$$

whose essential image is $D^b(A)_{\text{coh}}$, the triangulated subcategory of $D(A)$ formed by complexes with bounded cohomology and pseudo-coherent relative to the category of free modules of finite type.

b) Let $E \in \text{ob } D(S)$, and let $[m, n]$ be an interval of $\mathbb{Z}$. If E has perfect amplitude contained in $[m, n]$ (I 4.5), then E is isomorphic to a complex F such that $F^i = 0$ for $i \notin [m, n]$, $F^i \in \text{ob Lib}(S)$ for $i > m$, and $F^m \in \text{ob Loclib}(S)$.

c) The canonical functor

$$K^b(\text{Loclib}(S)) \longrightarrow D(S)_{\text{parf}}$$

is an equivalence of categories (I 4.9). Moreover, $R\Gamma_S : D^b(S) \rightarrow D^b(A)$ induces a fully faithful functor

$$R\Gamma_S : D(S)_{\text{parf}} \longrightarrow D^b(A),$$

whose essential image is $D^b(A)_{\text{parf}}$, the triangulated subcategory of $D(A)$ formed by complexes perfect relative to the category of projective modules of finite type.

Proof. a) The functors

$$K^{-,b}(\text{Lib}(S)) \longrightarrow K^{-,b}(\text{Loclib}(S)) \longrightarrow D^b(\text{Coh}(S)) \longrightarrow D^b(A)_{\text{coh}}$$

are equivalences of categories by (2.4.3 b), c). Since the fully faithful functor $\Gamma_S : D^b(\text{Coh}(S)) \rightarrow D(A)$ factors as

$$D^b(\text{Coh}(S)) \longrightarrow D^b(S)_{\text{coh}} \xrightarrow{R\Gamma_S} D(A),$$

the conclusion follows from (2.4.4).

b) Suppose $\text{parf. amp}(E) \subset [m, n]$. In particular E is pseudo-coherent; by a), after replacing E by an isomorphic object, we may assume that $E^i \in \text{ob Lib}(S)$ for $i > m$ and $E^i = 0$ for $i > n$. Truncating, we may also suppose that $E^i = 0$ for $i < m$. By (I 4.16), applied with $\mathcal{C} = \text{Mod}$ and $\mathcal{C}_0 = \text{Lib}$, one then has $E^m \in \text{ob Loclib}(S)$.

c) The hypotheses (1.1 (i)) and, respectively, (1.1 (ii)) are verified for $\mathcal{C} = \text{Coh}(S)$ and $\mathcal{C}_0 = \text{Lib}$, by (2.4.3 a)) and by (2.1.1 b)) together with Theorem A. Hence (1.2 c), d)) shows that the functor

$$K^b(\text{Loclib}(S)) \longrightarrow D^b(\text{Coh}(S))$$

is fully faithful. Therefore, by (2.4.4), the same is true for

$$K^b(\text{Loclib}(S)) \longrightarrow D(S),$$

and its essential image is $D(S)_{\text{parf}}$ by b). By an argument analogous to that used in the proof of (2.4.3 c)), one sees that the functor $K^b(\text{Loclib}(S)) \rightarrow D(S)$ induced by Γ_S is fully faithful and has essential image $D^b(A)_{\text{parf}}$; one finishes the proof as in a).

Remark 2.4.6. The editor does not know whether in (2.4.4) one may replace D^b by D^- , and consequently whether (2.4.5 a)) remains true when one replaces $K^{-,b}$ by K^- and D^b by D^- .

We finish with an interesting complement to (2.4.5). First we give a definition.

Definition 2.4.7. A *complex pseudo-analytic space* is a ringed space locally isomorphic to a ringed space of the form $(Y, \mathcal{O}_X|_Y)$, where X is a complex analytic space and Y is a closed subset of X .

The structural sheaf of a complex pseudo-analytic space is therefore coherent. We say that a complex pseudo-analytic space is Stein if the corresponding topos is Stein (2.4.1).

Exposé II. Global resolutions (continued)

Proposition 2.4.8. Let S be a compact Stein complex pseudo-analytic space (2.4.7). Suppose that, for every open U of S and every reduced closed subspace X of U , the normalization of X is locally connected. This condition is verified, for example, when S is locally defined by real analytic equations or inequalities in a space $\mathbb{R}^n$. Then

$$A = \Gamma(S, \mathcal{O}_S)$$

is a noetherian ring.

Proof. It is enough to show that, if M is an A -module of finite presentation, then the set of submodules of M , or equivalently the set of submodules of finite type of M , satisfies the maximal condition. Indeed, if N is a submodule of finite type of M , then M/N is of finite presentation by I 2.6 and 2.9, so that N is itself of finite presentation by the equivalence (2.4.3 c). Using again the equivalence (2.4.3 c) between the category of coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules and the category of A -modules of finite presentation, together with the compactness of S , one is reduced to proving the following lemma.

Lemma 2.4.8.1. Let S be a complex pseudo-analytic space satisfying the local connectedness condition of (2.4.8). Let F be a coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module, let (E_n) be an increasing sequence of coherent sub- $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules of F , and let s be a point of S . Then there exists an open neighbourhood U of s such that the sequence $(E_n|_U)$ is stationary.

Proof. Since the ring $\mathcal{O}_{S,s}$ is noetherian, there exists an integer n_0 such that $(E_n)_s = (E_{n_0})_s$ for $n \geq n_0$. Replacing the sequence (E_n) by the sequence (E_n/E_{n_0}) , one may therefore suppose that $(E_n)_s = 0$ for every n . On the other hand $F_s = M$ is a finite $\mathcal{O}_{S,s}$ -module; hence it has a finite filtration

$$M = M_0 \supset M_1 \supset \cdots \supset M_q = 0$$

such that

$$M_i/M_{i+1} \simeq \mathcal{O}_s/\mathfrak{p}_i,$$

where $\mathfrak{p}_i$ is a prime ideal of $\mathcal{O}_s$. Since the category of finite-type $\mathcal{O}_s$ -modules is equivalent to the category of germs at s of coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules, after shrinking around s one may suppose that the M_i , respectively the $\mathfrak{p}_i$, are the fibres at s of coherent sub- $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules F_i , respectively coherent ideals $\mathfrak{p}_i$, of F , respectively of $\mathcal{O}_S$, and that one has

$$F = F_0 \supset F_1 \supset \cdots \supset F_q = 0, \quad F_i/F_{i+1} \simeq \mathcal{O}_S/\mathfrak{p}_i.$$

To prove that the sequence (E_n) is stationary in a neighbourhood of s is therefore equivalent to proving the same assertion for the induced sequences on the graded pieces of this filtration. Thus one may suppose that $F = \mathcal{O}_S$ and that $\mathcal{O}_{S,s}$ is an integral domain; the E_n then form an increasing sequence of ideals of $\mathcal{O}_S$ with $(E_n)_s = 0$.

Since $\mathcal{O}_{S,s}$ is an integral domain, hence in particular reduced, one may moreover suppose, by Oka's theorem, after localizing at s , that S is reduced. We have to show that there is an open neighbourhood U of s such that $E_n|_U = 0$ for n large enough. Consider, to do this, the normalization $\tilde{S}$ of S . It is the analytic spectrum of a finite $\mathcal{O}_S$ -algebra $\tilde{\mathcal{O}}_S$ whose fibre at each $t \in S$ is the integral closure of $\mathcal{O}_{S,t}$. Since $E_n \subset E_n \tilde{\mathcal{O}}_S$, it is enough to prove that $E_n \tilde{\mathcal{O}}_S = 0$ for n large. This reduces us to the case where S is normal.

In that case, since $(E_n)_s = 0$, the closed immersion

$$i_n : S_n \longrightarrow S$$

defined by E_n is étale at s . But, S being normal, the set of points at which i_n is étale is both open and closed by the lemma below. Hence its image in S is simultaneously open and closed. The restriction of E_n to the connected component of s in S is therefore zero; this component is open because S is locally connected. The lemma is proved.

Lemma 2.4.8.2 (cf. EGA IV 18.10.3). Let Y be a normal pseudo-analytic space, and let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a non-ramified morphism. The set of points of X at which f is étale is both open and closed.

Proof. It is immediate that the set of points at which f is étale is open. It remains to show that the set of points at which f is not étale is open. Since a non-ramified morphism is locally an

immersion, one may suppose that f is a closed immersion defined by a coherent ideal I . Let x be a point of X such that $I_x \neq 0$. Let $\mathfrak{p}$ be a prime ideal of $\mathcal{O}_{Y,x}$ containing I_x . One has

$$\dim(\mathcal{O}_{Y,x}/\mathfrak{p}) > 0,$$

for otherwise $\mathfrak{p} = 0$, since $\mathcal{O}_{Y,x}$ is integral. Thus Y has positive codimension at x , hence positive codimension in a neighbourhood of x ; the assertion follows.

3. Complements on quasi-coherent sheaves on schemes

3.0. In this section we fix a quasi-compact and quasi-separated scheme S . The canonical, fully faithful inclusion functor

$$\iota : \mathrm{Qcoh}(S) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Mod}(S)$$

extends to a functor, again denoted ι , from $\mathrm{D}(\mathrm{Qcoh}(S))$ to $\mathrm{D}(S) = \mathrm{D}(\mathrm{Mod}(S))$, which we shall study.

Lemma 3.1. The category $\mathrm{Qcoh}(S)$ is an abelian category satisfying AB5, and the quasi-coherent sheaves of finite type form a small family of generators. In particular $\mathrm{Qcoh}(S)$ has enough injectives.

Proof. The assertion about generators follows at once from the fact that every quasi-coherent sheaf on S is the filtered inductive limit of its quasi-coherent subsheaves of finite type (EGA I 9.4.9 and IV 1.7.7). The other assertions are evident.

Remark 3.1.1. The editor does not know whether $\mathrm{Qcoh}(S)$ still has enough injectives when one assumes only that S is quasi-separated.

Lemma 3.2. The functor

$$\iota : \mathrm{Qcoh}(S) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Mod}(S)$$

has a right adjoint

$$Q : \mathrm{Mod}(S) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Qcoh}(S),$$

called the coherer.

Proof. If S is affine, the existence of Q is immediate: one takes $Q = \widetilde{\Gamma}_S$ (EGA I 1.3.7). Let now $f : U \rightarrow S$ be an affine open of S . It is clear that, for $E \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{Qcoh}(S)$ and $F \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{Mod}(U)$, one has a canonical isomorphism

$$\mathrm{Hom}(E, f_* F) \simeq \mathrm{Hom}(E, f_* Q(F)). \quad (1)$$

Let $(f_i : U_i \rightarrow S)$ be a finite covering of S by affine opens, and, for each pair (i, j) , let $(U_{ijk} \rightarrow U_i \cap U_j)_k$ be a finite covering of $U_i \cap U_j$ by affine opens, which is possible since S is quasi-separated. For $F \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{Mod}(S)$ one has an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow \prod_i f_{i*}(F|U_i) \longrightarrow \prod_{i,j,k} f_{ijk*}(F|U_{ijk}), \quad (2)$$

where f_{ijk} denotes the inclusion of U_{ijk} into S . If $g : V \rightarrow U$ is an inclusion of affine opens of S , there is an evident natural arrow

$$Q(F|U) \longrightarrow g_* Q(F|V).$$

Consequently (2) gives an arrow

$$\prod_i f_{i*} Q(F|U_i) \longrightarrow \prod_{i,j,k} f_{ijk*} Q(F|U_{ijk}), \quad (3)$$

whose kernel we denote by QF . If $E \in \text{ob } \text{Qcoh}(S)$, applying the functor $\text{Hom}(E, \cdot)$ to (2), and using (1), one obtains a functorial isomorphism in E ,

$$\text{Hom}(E, F) \simeq \text{Hom}(E, QF).$$

This proves the existence of Q ; its uniqueness is evident, since it is an adjoint.

Lemma 3.3.

- a) The coherer is an additive functor and transforms injectives into injectives.
- b) Let

$$RQ : D^+(S) \longrightarrow D^+(\text{Qcoh}(S))$$

be the right derived functor of the coherer. For $E \in \text{ob } D(\text{Qcoh}(S))$ and $F \in \text{ob } D^+(S)$ there are canonical functorial isomorphisms

$$R\text{Hom}_{\text{Mod}}(E, F) \simeq R\text{Hom}_{\text{Qcoh}}(E, RQ(F)), \quad (\text{i})$$

$$\text{Hom}_{\text{Mod}}(E, F) \simeq \text{Hom}_{\text{Qcoh}}(E, RQ(F)). \quad (\text{ii})$$

Proof. Assertion a) is an immediate consequence of the definition. For b), it is enough to establish the isomorphism (i), since (ii) follows by passing to cohomology. For this purpose one may suppose that F has injective components. Then QF has injective components by a), and the isomorphism (i) follows directly from the definition of Q .

Lemma 3.4. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of quasi-compact and quasi-separated schemes. For $E \in \text{ob } \text{Mod}(X)$ there is a canonical functorial isomorphism

$$Q_Y f_*(E) \simeq f_* Q_X(E).$$

Proof. Since f is quasi-compact and quasi-separated (EGA IV 1.2.3 and 1.2.4), f_* transforms quasi-coherent sheaves into quasi-coherent sheaves (EGA III 1.4.10 and IV 1.7.21). The functors $Q_Y f_*$ and $f_* Q_X$ from $\text{Mod}(X)$ to $\text{Qcoh}(Y)$ are therefore both right adjoints to the functor

$$f^* : \text{Qcoh}(Y) \longrightarrow \text{Mod}(X),$$

and hence are canonically isomorphic.

Proposition 3.5. If S is noetherian, or quasi-compact and separated, the functor

$$\iota : D^+(\text{Qcoh}(S)) \longrightarrow D^+(S)$$

is fully faithful and has as essential image the full subcategory $D^+(S)_{\text{qcoh}}$ of $D^+(S)$ formed by complexes with quasi-coherent cohomology.

Proof. One may restrict to proving the assertion in the case where S is separated, since the noetherian case is already known. It is plainly equivalent to prove the following two assertions.

(3.5.1) For $E \in \text{ob } D^+(\text{Qcoh}(S))$, the adjunction arrow

$$E \longrightarrow RQ(E)$$

is an isomorphism.

(3.5.2) For $E \in \text{ob } D^+(S)_{\text{qcoh}}$, the adjunction arrow

$$RQ(E) \longrightarrow E$$

is an isomorphism.

Proof of (3.5.1). By an immediate dévissage one is reduced to proving that quasi-coherent sheaves are acyclic for the coherer, that is, for $E \in \text{ob } \mathbf{Qcoh}(S)$, one has $R^i Q(E) = 0$ for $i > 0$, and that, moreover, the adjunction arrow $E \rightarrow QE$ is an isomorphism. If S is affine, this follows from the formula $Q = \Gamma_S$ used in the proof of (3.2). In the general case, cover S by a finite number of affine opens U_i . Since S is separated, the inclusions

$$f_{i_0 \dots i_p} : U_{i_0} \cap \dots \cap U_{i_p} \longrightarrow S$$

are affine morphisms. Let $E \in \text{ob } \mathbf{Qcoh}(S)$, and consider the resolution of E defined by this covering,

$$0 \longrightarrow E \longrightarrow \prod_i f_{i*} f_i^* E \longrightarrow \dots \longrightarrow \prod_{i_0 \dots i_p} f_{i_0 \dots i_p*} f_{i_0 \dots i_p}^* E \longrightarrow \dots \quad (*)$$

It gives a spectral sequence

$$E_1^{pq} = \prod_{i_0 \dots i_p} R^q Q(f_{i_0 \dots i_p*} f_{i_0 \dots i_p}^* E) \implies R^{p+q} Q(E). \quad (**)$$

Since $f_{i_0 \dots i_p}$ is affine, (3.4) gives, for every q ,

$$R^q Q(f_{i_0 \dots i_p*} f_{i_0 \dots i_p}^* E) \simeq f_{i_0 \dots i_p*} R^q Q(f_{i_0 \dots i_p}^* E). \quad (***)$$

In particular $E_1^{pq} = 0$ for $q > 0$, by the affine case already treated. From (**) one deduces isomorphisms

$$R^n Q(E) \simeq H^n(QE') \quad (n \geq 0),$$

where E' is the resolution of E defined by the exact sequence (*). But by (***) one has $QE^n \simeq E^n$ for $n \geq 0$; hence finally

$$R^n Q(E) = 0 \quad (n > 0),$$

and $Q(E) \simeq E$. This proves (3.5.1).

Proof of (3.5.2). The spectral sequence

$$R^p Q(H^q(E)) \implies R^{p+q} Q(E)$$

reduces us immediately to the case where $E \in \text{ob } \mathbf{Qcoh}(S)$. The composite

$$E \longrightarrow RQE \longrightarrow E$$

of the adjunction arrows is the identity, and the assertion follows from (3.5.1). This completes the proof of (3.5).

Remark 3.6. The conclusion of (3.5) would be false if one omitted the hypothesis “separated or noetherian”, as is shown by a neat counterexample of J.-L. Verdier; see Appendix I to the present exposé.

Proposition 3.7. Under the hypothesis of (3.5), suppose moreover that there is an integer N such that, for every $F \in \text{ob } \mathbf{Mod}(S)$ and every quasi-compact open U of S , one has

$$H^i(U, F) = 0 \quad \text{for } i > N.$$

Then:

- a) The coherer has finite cohomological dimension.

b) The functor

$$\iota : D(\text{Qcoh}(S)) \longrightarrow D(S)$$

is fully faithful and has as essential image the full subcategory $D(S)_{\text{qcoh}}$ of $D(S)$ formed by complexes with quasi-coherent cohomology.

Proof of a). If S is affine, the formula $Q = \widetilde{\Gamma_S}$ implies that Q is of cohomological dimension $\leq N$. We pass to the general case. Let us show that there is an integer a such that $R^q Q(E) = 0$ for every $E \in \text{ob Mod}(S)$ and every $q > a$. The hypothesis implies that every $E \in \text{ob Mod}(S)$ admits a finite right resolution E' of length N such that the E^i are acyclic, that is, $H^q(U, E^i) = 0$ for every open U of S and every $q > 0$. Thus it is enough to prove that there is an integer b such that

$$R^q Q(E) = 0$$

for every acyclic $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module E and every $q > b$; one may then take $a = b + N$.

Let (U_i) be a finite covering of S by N' affine opens. Let E be an acyclic $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module and let $C'(E)$ be the resolution of E defined by the covering (U_i) . There are two cases.

If S is separated, the components of $C'(E)$ are sums of terms of the form $f_* f^* E$, where $f : U \rightarrow S$ is the inclusion of an affine open, hence an affine morphism. One has

$$RQ(Q_X f_*) f^* E \simeq RQ Rf_* f^* E \simeq RQ f_* f^* E,$$

since $f^* E$ is acyclic. On the other hand, by (3.4),

$$R(Q_X f_*) f^* E \simeq R(f_* Q_X) f^* E \simeq f_* RQ f^* E,$$

since f is affine. Hence

$$R^n Q(f_* f^* E) \simeq f_* R^n Q(f^* E) \quad (n \geq 0).$$

By the affine case,

$$R^n Q(f_* f^* E) = 0 \quad (n > N).$$

Since $C'(E)$ has length N' , it follows that

$$R^n Q(E) = 0 \quad (n > N + N').$$

If S is noetherian, the components of $C'(E)$ are sums of terms of the same form $f_* f^* E$, where now $f : U \rightarrow S$ is the inclusion of a quasi-compact and separated open. As in the first case, one has

$$R(Q_X f_*) f^* E \simeq RQ f_* f^* E.$$

Since U is noetherian, $\text{Qcoh}(U)$ has enough injective objects in $\text{Mod}(U)$, and hence the right derived functor of $f_* : \text{Qcoh}(U) \rightarrow \text{Qcoh}(S)$ is induced by $Rf_* : D^+(U) \rightarrow D^+(S)$ when $D^+(\text{Qcoh}(U))$ and $D^+(\text{Qcoh}(S))$ are identified with full subcategories of $D^+(U)$ and $D^+(S)$ by (3.5). Thus

$$R(f_* Q_X) f^* E \simeq Rf_* RQ f^* E.$$

One deduces a spectral sequence

$$E_2^{pq} = R^p f_* R^q Q(f^* E) \implies R^{p+q} (f_* Q) f^* E.$$

By the first case there is an integer $n(U)$ depending only on U such that Q is of cohomological dimension $< n(U)$ on $\text{Mod}(U)$; hence $E_2^{pq} = 0$ for $q > n(U)$. Also $E_2^{pq} = 0$ for $p > N$, by the cohomological-dimension hypothesis on S . Thus

$$R^n (f_* Q) f^* E = 0 \quad (n > N + N''),$$

where N'' is an integer greater than all the $n(U)$, with U running over the intersections $U_{i_0} \cap \cdots \cap U_{i_p}$. Taking account of the preceding displayed isomorphism, one obtains

$$R^n Q(f_* f^* E) = 0 \quad (n > N + N''),$$

and hence finally

$$R^n Q(E) = 0 \quad (n > N + N' + N'').$$

This proves a).

Proof of b). The coherer, being of finite cohomological dimension by a), admits a right derived functor

$$RQ : D(S) \longrightarrow D(\text{Qcoh}(S))$$

whose restriction to $D^+(S)$ coincides with the functor RQ defined above. For $E \in \text{ob } D(\text{Qcoh}(S))$ there is a canonical functorial isomorphism

$$E \xrightarrow{\sim} RQ(E), \tag{1}$$

since, by (3.5.1), the E^i are acyclic for Q and satisfy $E^i \xrightarrow{\sim} Q(E^i)$. On the other hand, for $E \in \text{ob } D(S)$ one has a canonical functorial homomorphism

$$RQ(E) \longrightarrow E, \tag{2}$$

which, in the case where the E^i are Q -acyclic, comes from the ordinary adjunction homomorphism between ι and Q . It is checked directly that these homomorphisms make

$$RQ : D(S) \longrightarrow D(\text{Qcoh}(S))$$

a right adjoint of

$$\iota : D(\text{Qcoh}(S)) \longrightarrow D(S).$$

The fact that (1) is an isomorphism implies that ι is fully faithful. Finally, using the spectral sequence

$$R^p Q(H^q(E)) \implies R^{p+q} Q(E),$$

which converges since Q has finite cohomological dimension, one sees that (2) is an isomorphism for $E \in \text{ob } D(S)_{\text{qcoh}}$; hence ι has image $D(S)_{\text{qcoh}}$. This proves b) and completes the proof of (3.7).

Appendix I. A counterexample of Verdier

0. Introduction

If S is a scheme, write $\text{Mod}(S)$, respectively $\text{Qcoh}(S)$, for the category of $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules, respectively of quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules. The purpose of this appendix is to draw attention to certain pathological properties of the category $D(\text{Qcoh}(S))$, and in particular to prove the following facts.

0.1. Let X be an affine scheme with ring A , and let I be an injective A -module. We know that, if A is noetherian, the sheaf $\tilde{I}$ is an injective $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. If A is not noetherian, $\tilde{I}$ is not necessarily injective, nor even flasque, even if the underlying space of X is noetherian of finite Krull dimension. Moreover, the restriction of $\tilde{I}$ to an open U of X is not, in general, an injective object of $\text{Qcoh}(U)$.

0.2. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of quasi-compact and quasi-separated schemes. The functor

$$Rf_* : D^+(X) \longrightarrow D^+(Y)$$

does not in general induce, on $D^+(\mathrm{Qcoh}(X))$ and $D^+(\mathrm{Qcoh}(Y))$, the right derived functor of

$$f_* : \mathrm{Qcoh}(X) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Mod}(Y).$$

More precisely, an injective object of $\mathrm{Qcoh}(X)$ is not necessarily acyclic for $f_* : \mathrm{Mod}(X) \rightarrow \mathrm{Mod}(Y)$.

0.3. Let S be a quasi-compact and quasi-separated scheme. An object of $\mathrm{Qcoh}(S)$, even an injective object, is not necessarily acyclic for the coherer (II 3.2). The functor

$$\iota : D^b(\mathrm{Qcoh}(S)) \longrightarrow D^b(S)$$

is not in general fully faithful.

1. The counterexamples

We first recall the following lemma (SGA 2 II 9).

Lemma 1.1. Let A be a ring, $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$, let $\mathbf{f} = (f_\alpha)$ be a finite system of elements of A , and let Y be the closed subset defined by $\mathbf{f}(x) = 0$. For $i > 0$, the following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) for every injective A -module I , one has $H_Y^i(X, \tilde{I}) = 0$;
- (ii) the pro-object $n \mapsto H_i(\mathbf{f}^n, A)$ is zero, that is, for every n there exists $n' \geq n$ such that

$$H_i(\mathbf{f}^{n'}, A) \longrightarrow H_i(\mathbf{f}^n, A)$$

is zero.

1.2. We shall use (1.1) to prove (0.1). Let k be a field,

$$B = k[x, y], \quad \mathbf{f} = (x, y), \quad M = \bigoplus_{n \geq 0} B/(\mathbf{f}^n),$$

and let A be the B -algebra $D_B(M)$ (EGA 0_{IV} 18.2.3). One has trivially

$$H_2^A(\mathbf{f}^n, A) \simeq H_2^B(\mathbf{f}^n, A).$$

On the other hand,

$$H_2^B(\mathbf{f}^n, A) \simeq H_2^B(\mathbf{f}^n, B) \oplus H_2^B(\mathbf{f}^n, M),$$

and

$$H_2^B(\mathbf{f}^n, B) = 0,$$

since $\mathbf{f}$ is a regular sequence. Thus

$$H_2^B(\mathbf{f}^n, A) \simeq H_2^B(\mathbf{f}^n, M).$$

Finally,

$$H_2^B(\mathbf{f}^n, M) \simeq H_B^0(\mathbf{f}^n, M),$$

where $H_B^0(\mathbf{f}^n, M)$ is canonically identified with the submodule $(\mathbf{f}^n, M)$ of M annihilated by $\mathbf{f}^n$. Hence

$$H_2^A(\mathbf{f}^n, A) \simeq (\mathbf{f}^n, M). \tag{*}$$

Since the transition morphism

$$H_2^A(\mathbf{f}^{n'}, A) \longrightarrow H_2^A(\mathbf{f}^n, A)$$

is induced by multiplication by $\mathbf{f}^{n'-n}$, one checks immediately from (*) that the pro-object $n \mapsto H_2^A(\mathbf{f}^n, A)$ is not zero. Hence, by (1.1), there is an injective A -module I such that

$$H_Y^2(X, \tilde{I}) \neq 0,$$

and therefore $\tilde{I}$ is not flasque. Notice also that the projection $\mathrm{Spec}(A) \rightarrow \mathrm{Spec}(B)$ is a homeomorphism, so that the underlying space of X is noetherian of dimension 2. If U denotes the complement of Y in X , then by SGA 2 II 4,

$$H_Y^2(X, I) \simeq H^1(U, I) \neq 0.$$

But, since U is separated, the functor $D^+(\mathrm{Qcoh}(U)) \rightarrow D^+(U)$ is fully faithful by II 3.5, so $\tilde{I}|_U$ is not injective in $\mathrm{Qcoh}(U)$. This proves assertion (0.1).

Let Z be the quasi-compact and quasi-separated scheme obtained by gluing two copies of X along U ; let j_1, j_2 be the two canonical open immersions of X into Z . Thus one has a Cartesian square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U & \xrightarrow{i} & X \\ i \downarrow & & \downarrow j_1 \\ X & \xrightarrow{j_2} & Z. \end{array}$$

One has

$$j_2^* R^1 j_{1*}(\tilde{I}) \simeq R^1 i_*(i^* \tilde{I}),$$

and hence

$$H^0(X, R^1 j_{1*}(\tilde{I})) \simeq H^1(U, \tilde{I}) \neq 0,$$

so that $R^1 j_{1*}(\tilde{I}) \neq 0$, which proves (0.2).

On the other hand, by II 3.4 and 3.5 one has

$$RQ Rj_{1*}(\tilde{I}) \simeq j_{1*}(\tilde{I}).$$

It follows from this a spectral sequence whose exact sequence in low degrees gives the isomorphism

$$R^1 j_{1*}(\tilde{I}) \simeq R^2 Q(j_{1*} \tilde{I}).$$

Since the sheaf $j_{1*} \tilde{I}$ is injective in $\mathrm{Qcoh}(Z)$, the first part of (0.3) is proved.

Finally, let $E \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{Qcoh}(Z)$. We have the duality isomorphism

$$R\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Mod}}(E, Rj_{1*} \tilde{I}) \simeq R\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Mod}}(j_1^* E, \tilde{I}),$$

but, since X is affine, II 3.5 gives

$$R\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Mod}}(j_1^* E, \tilde{I}) \simeq R\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Qcoh}}(j_1^* E, I) \simeq \mathrm{Hom}(j_1^* E, I).$$

Consequently

$$R\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Mod}}(E, Rj_{1*} \tilde{I}) \simeq \mathrm{Hom}(j_1^* E, I).$$

A spectral sequence then gives, in low degree, the isomorphism

$$\mathrm{Ext}_{\mathrm{Mod}}^2(E, j_{1*} \tilde{I}) \simeq \mathrm{Hom}(E, R^1 j_{1*} \tilde{I}).$$

Thus the identity morphism of $E = R^1 j_{1*} \tilde{I}$ supplies a non-zero element of

$$\mathrm{Ext}_{\mathrm{Mod}}^2(E, j_{1*} \tilde{I}).$$

It follows that the functor

$$D^b(\mathrm{Qcoh}(Z)) \longrightarrow D^b(Z)$$

is not fully faithful. This completes the proof of (0.3).

Appendix II. Definition of the analytic index of a relative elliptic complex

In this appendix we propose to show that the notion of a perfect complex leads to a simple and natural definition of the “analytic index” of a continuous family of elliptic differential operators, or more generally of a relative elliptic complex. For the initiated reader, let us say that the definition given here has the advantage, compared with the classical definitions (see for example [2] and [17]), of not requiring any deformation of the elliptic complex under consideration.

Sections 1 and 2 consist of reminders on the classical notion of a “mixed structure”.¹³ We give, of course, only the minimum of definitions and results required in order to state and prove, in Section 3, the central theorem we have in view. It says, more precisely, that the direct image, by the projection (assumed proper) onto the base (assumed locally compact), of a relative elliptic complex is a perfect complex. When the base S is compact, the definition of the analytic index as an element of $K(S)$, the Grothendieck group of complex vector bundles of finite rank on S , then follows from the globalization sorite of II 2.3.2.

Throughout what follows, if S is a topological space, $\mathcal{O}_S$ will denote the sheaf of continuous real-valued functions on S .

1. The sorite of mixed structures

In this section a topological space S is fixed.

1.1. Definition of mixed varieties

Let V be an open subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$. For $r \in \mathbb{N}$ one writes $C^r(V)$ for the Fréchet space of real-valued functions of class C^r on V . Put

$$C^\infty(V) = \lim_r C^r(V).$$

Let U be an open subset of S . For $r \in \mathbb{N} \cup \{\infty\}$, denote by ${}^r\mathcal{O}_{U \times V}$ the sheaf of rings on $U \times V$ defined by

$$\Gamma(U' \times V', {}^r\mathcal{O}_{U \times V}) = C(U', C^r(V')),$$

where U' (respectively V') is an open subset of U (respectively of V), and $C(U', C^r(V'))$ denotes the space of continuous maps from U' into $C^r(V')$. There is a canonical injection

$$\mathrm{pr}_1^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_U) \longrightarrow {}^r\mathcal{O}_{U \times V}$$

which makes $(U \times V, {}^r\mathcal{O}_{U \times V})$ into a ringed space over U .

A ringed space X over S is said to be a *mixed variety of class C^r* ($r \in \mathbb{N} \cup \{\infty\}$) if X is locally isomorphic, as a ringed space over S , to a space of the type just described. If S is reduced to one point, a mixed variety of class C^r over S is just a variety of class C^r in the usual sense.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a mixed variety of class C^r . For $s \in S$, the fiber $X_s = f^{-1}(s)$, endowed with the sheaf $i_s^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_X)/I_s$, where $i_s : X_s \rightarrow X$ is the injection and I_s is the ideal of sections which vanish on X_s , is a variety of class C^r .

¹³The informed reader is advised to skip them.

1.2. Relative differential operators

It is easy, on the model of algebraic geometry (EGA IV 16, SGA 3 VII), to develop an infinitesimal study of mixed varieties. We shall only review rapidly the notions we shall need.

1.2.1. Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a mixed variety of class C^∞ . For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$ one defines the sheaf $P_{X/S}^n$ of principal parts of order n on X . In two different ways, corresponding to the two projections pr_1 and pr_2 of $X \times_S X$ onto X , it is an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -algebra augmented toward $\mathcal{O}_X$, and is locally free of finite type as an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. When the $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module structure on $P_{X/S}^n$ is not specified, it will be understood to be the one coming from pr_1 . One has the canonical identifications

$$P_{X/S}^0 = \mathcal{O}_X, \quad P_{X/S}^1/\mathcal{O}_X = \Omega_{X/S}^1.$$

The sheaf $\Omega_{X/S}^1$ is the sheaf of relative differentials of X over S , or relative cotangent sheaf. Its dual is denoted $T_{X/S}$ and called the relative tangent sheaf. The sheaf $T_{X/S}$, respectively $\Omega_{X/S}^1$, is the sheaf of sections of a vector bundle of finite rank on X , called the relative tangent, respectively cotangent, bundle; these bundles are mixed varieties over X .

The $f^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_S)$ -linear homomorphism, corresponding to the $\mathcal{O}_X$ -algebra structure defined by pr_2 ,

$$d_{X/S}^n : \mathcal{O}_X \longrightarrow P_{X/S}^n,$$

which associates to a section of $\mathcal{O}_X$ its principal part of order n , is called the universal differential operator of order n on X relative to S .

1.2.2. More generally, if E is a locally free $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module of finite type, one may consider the sheaf of principal parts of order n of E ,

$$P_{X/S}^n(E) = P_{X/S}^n \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} E,$$

where the tensor product is defined by means of the second $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module structure on $P_{X/S}^n$. One has a universal differential operator

$$d_{X/S}^n(E) : E \longrightarrow P_{X/S}^n(E).$$

Let E, F be locally free $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules of finite type. By definition, a differential operator from E to F of order $\leq n$ is an $f^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_S)$ -linear homomorphism from E to F which factors through $d_{X/S}^n(E)$ as an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -linear homomorphism $P_{X/S}^n(E) \rightarrow F$; the factorization is then unique. In other words, $d_{X/S}^n(E)$ gives a bijection

$$\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(P_{X/S}^n(E), F) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Diff}^n(E, F), \quad (1.2.2.1)$$

where $\text{Diff}^n(E, F)$ denotes the set of differential operators from E to F of order $\leq n$.

1.2.3. We shall also have to consider differential operators with complex coefficients. Let $\mathcal{O}_X \otimes \mathbb{C}$ (respectively $\mathcal{O}_S \otimes \mathbb{C}$) be the complexification of $\mathcal{O}_X$ (respectively $\mathcal{O}_S$). Let E, F be locally free $(\mathcal{O}_X \otimes \mathbb{C})$ -modules of finite type. By a differential operator from E to F of order $\leq n$ one means an $f^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_S \otimes \mathbb{C})$ -linear homomorphism from E to F which factors through $d_{X/S}^n(E)$ as an $(\mathcal{O}_X \otimes \mathbb{C})$ -linear homomorphism $P_{X/S}^n(E) \rightarrow F$. If $\text{Diff}_{\mathbb{C}}^n(E, F)$ denotes the set of such operators, $d_{X/S}^n(E)$ therefore defines a bijection

$$\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X \otimes \mathbb{C}}(P_{X/S}^n(E), F) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Diff}_{\mathbb{C}}^n(E, F). \quad (1.2.3.1)$$

1.2.4. For $n \geq 1$ there is a canonical exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow S^n(\Omega_{X/S}^1) \longrightarrow P_{X/S}^n \longrightarrow P_{X/S}^{n-1} \longrightarrow 0.$$

Hence, tensoring over $\mathcal{O}_X$ with a locally free $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, respectively $(\mathcal{O}_X \otimes \mathbb{C})$ -module, E of finite type, one obtains an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow S^n(\Omega_{X/S}^1) \otimes E \longrightarrow P_{X/S}^n(E) \longrightarrow P_{X/S}^{n-1}(E) \longrightarrow 0. \quad (1.2.4.1)$$

Here $S^n(\Omega_{X/S}^1)$ denotes the n -th symmetric power.

Let F be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, respectively $(\mathcal{O}_X \otimes \mathbb{C})$ -module, of finite type. Applying $\text{Hom}(_, F)$, respectively $\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X \otimes \mathbb{C}}(_, F)$, to (1.2.4.1), and using (1.2.2.1) and (1.2.3.1), one obtains an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \text{Diff}^{n-1}(E, F) \longrightarrow \text{Diff}^n(E, F) \xrightarrow{\sigma_n} \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(S^n(\Omega_{X/S}^1) \otimes E, F), \quad (1.2.4.2)$$

and analogously in the complex case. If X is paracompact and $\mathcal{O}_X$ is soft, the sequence may be completed on the right by adding a zero. The homomorphism σ_n is called the *symbol*. It associates to a differential operator from E to F of order $\leq n$ a homogeneous polynomial map of degree n from $T_{X/S}^*$ into $\text{Hom}(E, F)$, or equivalently a homomorphism $p^*E \rightarrow p^*F$, where p is the projection of the relative cotangent bundle onto X , satisfying the usual homogeneity condition.

Let E, F, G be locally free $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules of finite type, $u \in \text{Diff}^n(E, F)$ and $v \in \text{Diff}^m(F, G)$. Then $vu \in \text{Diff}^{m+n}(E, G)$ and one checks at once the relation

$$\sigma_{m+n}(vu) = \sigma_m(v)\sigma_n(u). \quad (1.2.4.3)$$

The same relation holds for differential operators with complex coefficients. In particular, if the composite of two differential operators is zero, then the composite of their symbols is zero.

1.2.5. Let $E^\bullet$ be a bounded complex of differential operators with complex coefficients on X relative to S , and let $d^i : E^i \rightarrow E^{i+1}$ be of order n_i . By (1.2.4.3),

$$\sigma_{n_{i+1}}(d^{i+1})\sigma_{n_i}(d^i) = 0.$$

The complex $E^\bullet$ is called an *elliptic complex of order (n_i)* if the symbol complex on the relative cotangent bundle, pulled back to that bundle, is acyclic outside the zero section.

When S is reduced to one point, this notion of elliptic complex on X coincides with the usual one, studied in detail in [4] and [16].

1.2.6. Let $s \in S$, and let i_s be the inclusion of the fiber X_s in X , considered as a monomorphism of ringed spaces (1.1). For $n \in \mathbb{N}$ one has a canonical isomorphism

$$i_s^* P_{X/S}^n \simeq P_{X_s}^n,$$

and hence a restriction homomorphism

$$i_s^* : \text{Diff}^n(E, F) \longrightarrow \text{Diff}^n(i_s^*E, i_s^*F),$$

for E, F locally free $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules of finite type, and similarly for operators with complex coefficients. If $E^\bullet$ is a bounded complex of differential operators with complex coefficients on X , then $E^\bullet$ is elliptic if and only if, for every $s \in S$, $i_s^*(E^\bullet)$ is an elliptic complex. The verification is left to the reader.

2. Rigidity lemmas

2.0. It is “well known” that compact differentiable varieties are rigid, that is, they admit no continuous deformation other than the trivial one. Since this result will be used essentially in

Section 3, and references seem rather scarce, it is perhaps useful to give precise statements and a few proofs.

A topological space S is fixed. The mixed varieties under consideration are assumed to be of class C^r , with $r \gg 1$; possibly $r = \infty$.

2.1. Notation. Let X, Y be mixed S -varieties. We denote by $\text{Hom}(X, Y)$ the set of S -morphisms from X to Y , and by $\mathcal{H}om(X, Y)$ the sheaf on X of germs of S -morphisms from X to Y , defined by

$$\mathcal{H}om(X, Y)(U) = \text{Hom}(U, Y)$$

for U open in X .

Let $s \in S$, and write i_s for the inclusion of X_s in X . There is a canonical induction homomorphism

$$i_s^{-1} \mathcal{H}om(X, Y) \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}om(X_s, Y_s) \quad (2.1.1)$$

which is an epimorphism, as is immediate. In the case $Y = S \times \mathbb{R}$, the sheaf $\mathcal{H}om(X, Y)$ is canonically identified with $\mathcal{O}_X$, and the epimorphism (2.1.1) with the epimorphism

$$i_s^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_X) \longrightarrow i_s^*(\mathcal{O}_X)$$

considered in (1.1).

Proposition 2.2. Let X, Y be mixed S -varieties, and let $s \in S$. Suppose that the fiber X_s is paracompact and that s has a fundamental system of paracompact neighborhoods. Let A be a closed subset of X_s , and let

$$f \in H^0(A, \mathcal{H}om(X_s, Y_s)).$$

The subsheaf $\mathcal{F}$ of $i_s^{-1} \mathcal{H}om(X, Y)$ consisting of the germs which extend f , that is, whose image by (2.1.1) coincides with f over A , is soft.

Proof. Let X' be an open neighborhood in X which is isomorphic, as a mixed variety, to $S' \times U$, where S' is a paracompact neighborhood of s and U is a relatively compact open subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$, and such that the image by f of $X'_s \cap A$ is contained in an open subset of Y isomorphic to $S' \times V$, where V is a convex open subset of $\mathbb{R}^q$ containing the origin. By T.F. II 3.4.1 it is enough to show that every section of $\mathcal{F}$ over a closed subset of X_s contained in X'_s extends to X'_s . Since $X'_s = \{s\} \times U$ is relatively compact, a closed subset of X_s contained in X'_s is compact. Identifying X' with $S' \times U$ and Y' with $S' \times V$, putting $A' = A \cap X'_s$, and using T.F. II 3.3.1, the assertion is reduced to the following elementary lemma.¹⁴

Lemma 2.2.1. Let U be an open subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$, and let V be a convex open subset of $\mathbb{R}^q$ containing 0. Let A_1, A_2 be closed subsets of $\{s\} \times U$. Let U_1 , respectively U_2 , be an open subset of $S \times U$, respectively of $\{s\} \times U$, containing A_1 , respectively A_2 . Let $f_1 : U_1 \rightarrow V$ be a morphism and let $f_2 : U_2 \rightarrow S \times V$ be an S -morphism which, on $U_1 \cap (\{s\} \times U)$, defines the same germ as f_1 near A_1 . Then there exists an open subset U' of $S \times U$ containing $\{s\} \times U$ and an S -morphism

$$F : U' \longrightarrow S \times V$$

such that the germ of F along $\{s\} \times U$ extends the germ defined by f_1 , and the morphism induced by F on $\{s\} \times U$ defines the same germ as f_2 near A_2 .

Proof. Replacing f_1 by af_1 , where a is a C^∞ function on U equal to 1 near A_1 and with support in U_1 , one may suppose $U_1 = U$. Let b be a C^∞ function on U , equal to 1 on A_2 and with support in $U_2 \cap (\{s\} \times U)$. Then

$$U' = U_1 \cup (S \times (U - \text{Supp } b))$$

¹⁴Communicated to the writer by A. Douady. A closed subset of a paracompact space has a fundamental system of paracompact neighborhoods.

is an open subset of $S \times U$ containing $\{s\} \times U$. The morphism $F : U' \rightarrow S \times V$ defined by

$$F(t, x) = (t, b(x) \operatorname{pr}_2 f_2(x) + (1 - b(x)) f_1(t, x))$$

visibly satisfies the required conditions.

Corollary 2.3. Under the hypotheses of (2.2), the sheaves $i_s^{-1} \mathcal{H}om(X, Y)$ and $\mathcal{H}om(X_s, Y_s)$ are soft. In particular, the sheaves $i_s^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_X)$ and $\mathcal{O}_{X_s}$ are soft. For every closed subset A of X_s , the map

$$H^0(X_s, i_s^{-1} \mathcal{H}om(X, Y)) \longrightarrow H^0(A, \mathcal{H}om(X_s, Y_s))$$

deduced from (2.1.1) is surjective.

Proof. The softness of $i_s^{-1} \mathcal{H}om(X, Y)$ follows from (2.2) applied with $A = \emptyset$. Taking $S = \{s\}$, one obtains the softness of $\mathcal{H}om(X_s, Y_s)$. The last assertion follows from (2.2).¹⁵

Corollary 2.4. Under the hypotheses of (2.2), let E be an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. For every closed subset A of X_s , the canonical homomorphism

$$H^0(X_s, i_s^{-1} E) \longrightarrow H^0(A, i_s^* E)$$

deduced from the epimorphism

$$i_s^{-1} E \longrightarrow i_s^* E = i_s^{-1} E \otimes_{i_s^{-1} \mathcal{O}_X} \mathcal{O}_{X_s}$$

is an epimorphism.

Proof. Since $i_s^{-1} \mathcal{O}_X$ is soft by (2.3), the functor $H^0(A, \)$ is exact on the category of $i_s^{-1} \mathcal{O}_X$ -modules (T.F. II 3.7.1, 3.4.2, 4.4.3). Hence

$$H^0(A, i_s^{-1} E) \longrightarrow H^0(A, i_s^* E)$$

is an epimorphism. Since $i_s^{-1} E$ is soft, the homomorphism

$$H^0(X_s, i_s^{-1} E) \longrightarrow H^0(A, i_s^{-1} E)$$

is an epimorphism, and this proves the assertion.

Corollary 2.5. Let $p : X \rightarrow S$ be a mixed variety and let $s \in S$. Suppose that s has a fundamental system of paracompact neighborhoods S' such that the $p^{-1}(S')$ form a fundamental system of paracompact neighborhoods of X_s . This condition is satisfied, for example, if S is locally compact and p is a proper map of topological spaces. Then, for every $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module E ,

$$(R^i p_* E)_s = 0 \quad (i > 0).$$

Proof. By T.F. II 4.17.1,

$$(R^i p_* E)_s = H^i(X_s, i_s^{-1} E).$$

But $i_s^{-1} \mathcal{O}_X$ is soft by (2.3), hence $H^i(X_s, i_s^{-1} E) = 0$ for $i > 0$.

Corollary 2.6. Let X, Y be mixed S -varieties, and let $s \in S$. Suppose that X satisfies the hypotheses of (2.5). For every morphism $f : X_s \rightarrow Y_s$, there exists an open neighborhood S' of s and a morphism

$$F : X|S' \longrightarrow Y|S'$$

such that $F_s = f$.

¹⁵For $\mathcal{O}_{X_s}$ this is very well known. The writer does not know whether $\mathcal{O}_X$ is soft when the hypotheses of (2.2) are satisfied for every $s \in S$ and X is paracompact. This would trivially imply, under those hypotheses, the softness of $i_s^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_X)$ as well as (2.5) below.

Proof. This is an immediate consequence of (2.3), with $A = X_s$, and of the fact that the hypotheses on X give

$$H^0(X_s, i_s^{-1} \mathcal{H}om(X, Y)) = \lim_{S' \ni s} \text{Hom}(X|S', Y|S')$$

for open S' containing s (T.F. II 8.5.5).

Proposition 2.7. Let X, Y be mixed S -varieties, let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism, let $s \in S$, and let $x \in X_s$. If the tangent linear map of

$$f_s : X_s \longrightarrow Y_s$$

is invertible at x , then f is a local isomorphism at x ; that is, there is an open neighborhood U of x in X and an open subset V of Y such that f induces an isomorphism $U \simeq V$.

Proof. This is an easy consequence of the implicit function theorem. The details are left to the reader.

Corollary 2.8. Let X, Y be mixed S -varieties and let $s \in S$. Suppose that s has a fundamental system of neighborhoods S' such that the $X|S'$, respectively $Y|S'$, form a fundamental system of neighborhoods of X_s , respectively Y_s ; this is the case, for example, if S is locally compact and X , respectively Y , is proper over S . Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be an S -morphism such that

$$f_s : X_s \longrightarrow Y_s$$

is an isomorphism. Then there exists a neighborhood S' of s such that

$$f|X|S' : X|S' \longrightarrow Y|S'$$

is an isomorphism.

Proof. By (2.7), there exists an open neighborhood U of X_s in X such that $f|U$ is étale, that is, a local isomorphism. We may suppose that $U = X|S'$ for a neighborhood S' of s ; after shrinking S , we may therefore assume that f is étale. Then the fiber product $Z = X \times_Y X$ is naturally a mixed S -variety, étale over X for each projection, and the diagonal morphism $\Delta : X \rightarrow Z$ is an open immersion. Moreover the sets $Z|S'$ form a fundamental system of neighborhoods of Z_s . Since

$$\Delta_s : X_s \longrightarrow Z_s$$

is an isomorphism, it follows, after shrinking S , that Δ is an isomorphism. Thus f is an open immersion, and after shrinking S again it is an isomorphism.

Corollary 2.9. Let X be a mixed S -variety and let $s \in S$. Suppose that the hypothesis of (2.5) is satisfied. Then there exists a neighborhood S' of s in S such that $X|S'$ is S' -isomorphic to $S' \times X_s$.

Proof. Apply (2.6) and (2.8).

Corollary 2.10. Let $s \in S$ and let V be a paracompact variety. Put $X = S \times V$, and let i_s be the injection of V into X defined by s . Suppose that the hypothesis of (2.5) is satisfied. Let E be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, respectively $\mathcal{O}_X \otimes \mathbb{C}$ -module, of finite type. Then there exists a neighborhood S' of s in S such that $E|X|S'$ is isomorphic to $\text{pr}_2^*(i_s^*E)$, where $\text{pr}_2 : S' \times V \rightarrow V$ is the second projection.

Proof. Put $F = \text{pr}_2^*(i_s^*E)$. By (2.4), applied to $\mathcal{H}om(E, F)$, the induction homomorphism

$$\text{Hom}(i_s^{-1}E, i_s^{-1}F) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(i_s^*E, i_s^*F)$$

is an epimorphism. On the other hand, by T.F. II 3.3.1,

$$\mathrm{Hom}(i_s^{-1}E, i_s^{-1}F) = \lim_{S' \ni s} \mathrm{Hom}(E|X|S', F|X|S').$$

Thus the canonical isomorphism $i_s^*E \simeq i_s^*F$ is induced, after shrinking S , by a homomorphism $f : E \rightarrow F$. Since f_s is an isomorphism, f is an isomorphism near X_s by Nakayama, hence over $X|S'$ for a suitable neighborhood S' of s .

3. The finiteness theorem

3.0. Conventions and notation

3.0.1. Let X and Y be topological spaces. We write $C(X, Y)$ for the set of continuous maps from X to Y , and $\mathcal{C}(X, Y)$ for the sheaf on X defined by $U \mapsto C(U, Y)$.

3.0.2. Let E, F be Banach spaces, real or complex. We write $L(E, F)$ for the Banach space of continuous linear maps from E to F .

3.0.3. The mixed varieties occurring in this section are assumed to be of class C^∞ . If X is a mixed S -variety, we shall often identify a locally free $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, respectively $\mathcal{O}_X \otimes \mathbb{C}$ -module, of finite type with the corresponding real, respectively complex, vector bundle.

3.0.4. Let X be a compact ordinary variety, and let E be a real or complex vector bundle of finite rank on X . Write $C^\infty(X, E)$ for the Fréchet space of C^∞ sections of E on X . For $r \in \mathbb{Z}$, write $C_r(X, E)$ for the Hilbert space of sections of E which are r times differentiable in L^2 ([16] IX). For $s \leq r$, $C_r(X, E)$ maps to $C_s(X, E)$ by a continuous linear injective map with dense image, and

$$C^\infty(X, E) = \lim_r C_r(X, E).$$

3.0.5. Let S be a topological space. We shall need the notion of a Hilbert bundle over S , for which we refer the reader to [12] or [14]. There is an additive functor from the category of real, respectively complex, Hilbert bundles over S to the category of $\mathcal{O}_S$ -, respectively $\mathcal{O}_S \otimes \mathbb{C}$ -, modules: it sends a Hilbert bundle E to the sheaf of continuous sections of E .

3.1. Auxiliary technical results

Lemma 3.1.1. Let X, Y be topological spaces, with X locally compact. Let $\mathcal{C}'(X, Y)$ be the presheaf, on the basis of relatively compact open subsets of X , defined by

$$\mathcal{C}'(X, Y)(U) = C(\overline{U}, Y).$$

The canonical restriction morphism

$$\mathcal{C}'(X, Y) \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}(X, Y)$$

induces an isomorphism on the associated sheaves.

Proof. Immediate.

Lemma 3.1.2. Let E, F be locally convex topological vector spaces over $\mathbb{C}$, and let $u : E \rightarrow F$ be a continuous linear map, respectively a continuous linear map with dense image. Let X be compact. Endow $C(X, E)$ and $C(X, F)$ with the topology of uniform convergence. Then the induced linear map

$$u_X : C(X, E) \longrightarrow C(X, F)$$

is continuous, respectively continuous with dense image.

Proof. It is clear that u_X is continuous. On the other hand, by Bourbaki, *Intégration*, chapter II, §2, lemmas 1 and 2, the subspace $C(X, \mathbb{C}) \otimes E$ of $C(X, E)$, formed by the continuous maps from X to E whose values lie in a finite-dimensional vector subspace, is dense; and similarly $C(X, \mathbb{C}) \otimes F$ is dense in $C(X, F)$. If u has dense image, then $u_X(C(X, E))$ is dense in $C(X, \mathbb{C}) \otimes F$, and taking closures gives the assertion.

3.1.3. Let V be a compact variety, let E and F be complex vector bundles of finite rank on V , and let $n \in \mathbb{N}$. The space $\text{Diff}_{\mathbb{C}}^n(E, F)$, identified by (1.2.3.1) with

$$\text{Hom}(P^n(E), F) \simeq C^\infty(V, \text{Hom}(P^n(E), F)),$$

is naturally a Fréchet space. Let $u \in \text{Diff}_{\mathbb{C}}^n(E, F)$. One checks easily that the linear map $C^\infty(V, E) \rightarrow C^\infty(V, F)$ defined by u is continuous. If $L(C^\infty(V, E), C^\infty(V, F))$ denotes the space of continuous linear maps, one therefore has a linear map

$$\delta : \text{Diff}_{\mathbb{C}}^n(E, F) \longrightarrow L(C^\infty(V, E), C^\infty(V, F)).$$

Moreover, for $r \in \mathbb{Z}$, u acts by extension of scalars on the C_r sections of E and defines a linear map

$$\delta_r : \text{Diff}_{\mathbb{C}}^n(E, F) \longrightarrow L(C_r(V, E), C_{r-n}(V, F)).$$

The maps δ_r are continuous, and for $u \in \text{Diff}_{\mathbb{C}}^n(E, F)$, $\delta(u)$ is the inverse-limit element of the projective system of the $\delta_r(u)$. These assertions follow easily from [16] IX: one reduces immediately to $n = 0$; the statement on the C_r follows directly from the definitions, while the statement for C^∞ follows, after localizing by a partition of unity, from the formula for successive derivatives of a product. The analogous real statements are also valid.

Lemma 3.1.4. Let S be a topological space, let V be a compact variety, let E, F be complex vector bundles of finite rank on V , and let $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Put $X = S \times V$. For

$$u \in \text{Diff}_{\mathbb{C}}^n(\text{pr}_2^* E, \text{pr}_2^* F),$$

the map $s \mapsto i_s^* u$ from S into $\text{Diff}_{\mathbb{C}}^n(E, F)$ is continuous. The linear map

$$\text{Diff}_{\mathbb{C}}^n(\text{pr}_2^* E, \text{pr}_2^* F) \longrightarrow C(S, \text{Diff}_{\mathbb{C}}^n(E, F))$$

so defined is an isomorphism.

Proof. By (1.2.3.1) one may restrict to the case $n = 0$. Putting $G = \text{Hom}(E, F)$, one is reduced to showing that for $u \in \Gamma(X, \text{pr}_2^* G)$, the map $s \mapsto u_s = i_s^* u$ from S into $C^\infty(V, G)$ is continuous and that the resulting map

$$\Gamma(X, \text{pr}_2^* G) \longrightarrow C(S, C^\infty(V, G))$$

is an isomorphism. This follows immediately from the definition of mixed varieties.

3.1.5. Under the hypotheses of (3.1.4), let

$$u \in \text{Diff}_{\mathbb{C}}^n(\text{pr}_2^* E, \text{pr}_2^* F).$$

Identifying u , by (3.1.4), with a continuous map from S into $\text{Diff}^n(E, F)$, one sees that, for U open in S , the morphism

$$\text{pr}_{1*}(u)(U) : C^\infty(U, E) \longrightarrow C^\infty(U, F)$$

is canonically identified with the linear map

$$C(U, C^\infty(V, E)) \longrightarrow C(U, C^\infty(V, F))$$

deduced from

$$\delta u : U \longrightarrow L(C^\infty(V, E), C^\infty(V, F)).$$

Suppose S locally compact. By (3.1.1), the morphism of sheaves

$$\mathrm{pr}_{1*}(u) : \mathrm{pr}_{1*} \mathrm{pr}_2^* E \longrightarrow \mathrm{pr}_{1*} \mathrm{pr}_2^* F$$

is the morphism associated to the morphism of presheaves

$$\mathcal{C}'(S, C^\infty(V, E)) \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}'(S, C^\infty(V, F))$$

defined by δu . On the other hand, for $r \in \mathbb{Z}$,

$$\delta_r u : S \longrightarrow L(C_r(V, E), C_{r-n}(V, F))$$

defines a morphism of presheaves

$$u_r : \mathcal{C}'(S, C_r(V, E)) \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}'(S, C_{r-n}(V, F)).$$

By (3.1.3), the u_r form a projective system whose limit is the previous morphism. It will be convenient to interpret $\delta_r u$ as a morphism of trivial Hilbert bundles

$$S \times C_r(V, E) \longrightarrow S \times C_{r-n}(V, F),$$

inducing on sheaves of sections the sheaf morphism associated to u_r .

3.2. Definition of the index

Theorem 3.2.1. Let S be a locally compact space, let $p : X \rightarrow S$ be a proper mixed variety, and let $E^\bullet$ be an elliptic complex of order (n_i) of complex vector bundles on X (1.2.5). Then the complex $Rp_*(E^\bullet)$, which by (2.5) is isomorphic to $p_*(E^\bullet)$ in the derived category of $\mathcal{O}_S \otimes \mathbb{C}$ -modules, is perfect.

Proof. The question being local on S , one may suppose by (2.9) that $X = S \times V$, where V is a compact variety, and that $p = \mathrm{pr}_1$. Moreover, by (2.10), one may suppose that for all i ,

$$E^i = \mathrm{pr}_2^*(F^i),$$

where F^i is a complex vector bundle of finite rank on V . By (3.1.5), $p_*(E^\bullet)$ is associated to the complex of presheaves

$$\mathcal{C}'(S, C^\infty(V, F^\bullet)),$$

where the differentials are induced by the given differential operators. Put, for each $i \in \mathbb{Z}$,

$$m_i = \sum_{j < i} n_j,$$

with the convention $n_i = 0$ if $E^i = 0$. For each $r \in \mathbb{Z}$ one has, again by (3.1.5), a complex of presheaves

$$\mathcal{C}'(S, C_{r-m_i}(V, F^i)),$$

which we denote by $\mathcal{C}'(S, C_r(V, F^\bullet))$. These complexes form a projective system, and

$$\mathcal{C}'(S, C^\infty(V, F^\bullet)) = \lim_r \mathcal{C}'(S, C_r(V, F^\bullet)). \quad (3.2.1.1)$$

Finally, denote by $F_r^\bullet$ the complex of trivial Hilbert bundles over S defined by the corresponding $\delta_r(d^i)$, and by $\mathcal{F}_r^\bullet$ the complex of sheaves of sections; by (3.1.5), it is just the complex of

sheaves associated to $\mathcal{C}'(S, C_r(V, F^\bullet))$. To prove the theorem it is enough to prove the following assertions:

(a) For $r \in \mathbb{Z}$, the canonical morphism

$$\mathcal{C}'(S, C^\infty(V, F^\bullet)) \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}'(S, C_r(V, F^\bullet))$$

is a quasi-isomorphism of complexes of presheaves, that is, it induces isomorphisms on the presheaves of cohomology.

(b) For $r \in \mathbb{Z}$, the complex $\mathcal{F}_r^\bullet$ is perfect.

Proof of (b). The ellipticity of $E^\bullet$ implies ([16] XI, theorem 6) that, for every $s \in S$, the differential of $(F_r^\bullet)_s$ has closed image and the spaces $H^i((F_r^\bullet)_s)$ are finite-dimensional vector spaces. In the terminology of [11], $F_r^\bullet$ is a direct quasi-acyclic complex of Hilbert bundles. Hence, by [12] 2.3, $F_r^\bullet$ is locally homotopically equivalent to a bounded complex of vector bundles of finite rank. Since the sheaf-of-sections functor is additive (3.0.5), $\mathcal{F}_r^\bullet$ is locally homotopically equivalent to a bounded complex of locally free sheaves of finite type; hence it is perfect.

For the proof of (a) we shall need the following intermediate assertion:

(a') For $p \gg q$, the canonical morphism

$$F_p^\bullet \longrightarrow F_q^\bullet$$

is a quasi-isomorphism.

Proof of (a'). Let $M_{pq}^\bullet$ be the complex of Hilbert bundles which is the cone of the morphism $F_p^\bullet \rightarrow F_q^\bullet$. The ellipticity of $E^\bullet$ implies that, for every $s \in S$, the morphism $(F_p^\bullet)_s \rightarrow (F_q^\bullet)_s$ is a quasi-isomorphism ([16] XI, corollary 2 and theorem 6). In other words, $(M_{pq}^\bullet)_s$ is a direct acyclic complex. By [11] 2.3, $M_{pq}^\bullet$ is locally homotopically trivial; hence its sheaf complex, the cone of $\mathcal{F}_p^\bullet \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_q^\bullet$, is acyclic.

Proof of (a). It is enough to show that, for every relatively compact open subset U of S , the morphism

$$C^\infty(U, C^\infty(V, F^\bullet)) \longrightarrow C^\infty(U, C_r(V, F^\bullet))$$

is a quasi-isomorphism. Replacing S by $\bar{U}$ and $E^\bullet$ by the induced complex over $\bar{U}$, one is reduced to proving that

$$C(S, C^\infty(V, F^\bullet)) \longrightarrow C(S, C_r(V, F^\bullet))$$

is a quasi-isomorphism, with S compact. By (3.2.1.1),

$$C(S, C^\infty(V, F^\bullet)) = \lim_i C(S, C_i(V, F^\bullet)).$$

For each i , $C(S, C_i(V, F^j))$ is a Banach space for the topology of uniform convergence, and the transition morphisms

$$C(S, C_i(V, F^j)) \longrightarrow C(S, C_{i-1}(V, F^j))$$

are continuous linear maps with dense image by (3.0.4) and (3.1.2). On the other hand, applying to the quasi-isomorphisms (a') the functor “sections”, which is exact since $\mathcal{O}_S$ is soft, one sees that the transition morphisms are quasi-isomorphisms. Assertion (a) follows from EGA 0_I 13.2.3, topological variant. This completes the proof of (3.2.1).

3.2.2. If S is a topological space, we denote by $\text{Parf}(S)$ the triangulated category of perfect complexes of $(\mathcal{O}_S \otimes \mathbb{C})$ -modules, and by $K^0(S)$ the corresponding Grothendieck group.¹⁶

¹⁶See I 6.3. For a general review of K -functors, see Exposé IV.

Let $S, X, E^\bullet$ be as in (3.2.1). The *analytic index* of $E^\bullet$ is the element

$$\text{ind}_{\text{an}}(E^\bullet) = [Rp_*(E^\bullet)] \in K^0(S).$$

If S is compact, $\text{ind}_{\text{an}}(E^\bullet)$ canonically defines an element in the usual group $K(S)$ of topologists. Indeed, in general, for every topological space S , let $\text{Loclib}(S)$ be the additive category of locally free $(\mathcal{O}_S \otimes \mathbb{C})$ -modules of finite type, and let $K(S)$ be the Grothendieck group of the triangulated category

$$K^b(\text{Loclib}(S))/K_{\text{ac}}^b(\text{Loclib}(S)).$$

This category is in fact identified with $K^b(\text{Loclib}(S))$ when S is paracompact (II 2.2.2(a)), so in this case, by I 6.4, $K(S)$ is canonically isomorphic to the Grothendieck group of the additive category $\text{Loclib}(S)$. There is a natural homomorphism

$$K(S) \longrightarrow K^0(S).$$

By II 2.3.2 this is an isomorphism for compact S , proving the assertion. More generally, $\text{ind}_{\text{an}}(E^\bullet)$ defines an element in the completed group

$$\widehat{K}(S) = \lim_A K(A),$$

the projective limit being taken over the compact subsets A of S .

3.2.3. The writer does not know whether the finiteness theorem (3.2.1) remains valid if, instead of assuming S locally compact, one merely assumes that each point of S has a fundamental system of paracompact neighborhoods. Moreover, the local compactness hypothesis on S does not seem very natural. The space of “universal local parameters” for elliptic complexes of fixed order is in fact a subspace of infinite dimension in a Fréchet space. More precisely, let V be a compact variety, let $F = (F^i)$ be a sequence of complex vector bundles of finite rank on V , zero except for finitely many indices, and let $n = (n_i)$ be a sequence of integers ≥ 0 . Let $\text{Comp. diff}_n(F)$ be the space of complexes of differential operators of base F and order n , that is, the closed subspace of

$$\prod_i \text{Diff}^{n_i}(F^i, F^{i+1})$$

defined by the equations $d^{i+1}d^i = 0$. This product is a Fréchet space. The subset $\text{Ell}_n(F)$ formed by the elliptic complexes of order n is open. It is this space, in general not locally compact, which plays the role of a space of universal local parameters.

3.2.4. Nevertheless, even if the generalization of (3.2.1) just mentioned is impossible, one can always associate to $E^\bullet$, under the sole hypothesis that the fibration p is proper and locally trivial, an element of $K^0(S)$ deserving the name analytic index of $E^\bullet$. Indeed, suppose, for simplicity, that we are in the local situation where $X = S \times V$ with V compact, and $E^\bullet$ is given by a continuous map from S into $\text{Ell}_n(F)$ (3.2.3). Assertions (a') and (b) in the proof of (3.2.1) are in fact valid without any hypothesis on S ; it is therefore reasonable to put, with the notation of that proof,

$$\text{ind}_{\text{an}}(E^\bullet) = [\mathcal{F}_r^\bullet] \in K^0(S),$$

this element being independent of r .

3.2.5. Suppose S paracompact. Let H be a complex Hilbert space of infinite Hilbert dimension, and let $I(H)$ be the subspace of $L(H, H)$ formed by the Fredholm operators. The complexes $F_r^\bullet$ define [12] a canonical element in the group $[S, I(H)]$ of homotopy classes of continuous maps from S to $I(H)$. But the writer does not know, for non-compact S (even when S is locally compact), what the relations are between $[S, I(H)]$ and $K^0(S)$: is there a natural arrow from

one to the other? are they isomorphic? A fortiori, the relation between the two indices thus defined remains unclear.

For a generalization, under the hypotheses of (3.2.1), of the Atiyah–Singer index theorem, we refer to the recent work of Shih [17], or to work in preparation of M. F. Atiyah and I. M. Singer.¹⁷

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¹⁷For the general case, use the notion of “weak Hilbert bundle”, or continuous field of Hilbert spaces, of [12].

Exposé III. Relative finiteness conditions

by L. Illusie

1. Relative pseudo-coherence

Theorem 1.1. Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. For each locally finite type morphism of schemes

$$f : X \longrightarrow Y$$

there exists one and only one full subcategory $D(f)_{n\text{-coh}}$ of $D(X)$ such that the following conditions are satisfied:

- (i) If $E \in \text{ob } D(f)_{n\text{-coh}}$, then $i^*(E) \in \text{ob } D(fi)_{n\text{-coh}}$ for every open immersion $i : U \rightarrow X$.
- (ii) If $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$, and if there exists an open covering $(i_\alpha : U_\alpha \rightarrow X)_{\alpha \in A}$ such that $i_\alpha^*(E) \in \text{ob } D(fi_\alpha)_{n\text{-coh}}$ for every $\alpha \in A$, then $E \in \text{ob } D(f)_{n\text{-coh}}$.
- (iii) If

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{f} & Y \\ & \searrow h & \downarrow g \\ & & Z \end{array}$$

is a commutative triangle of locally finite type morphisms, where f is a closed immersion and g is smooth, then one has

$$E \in \text{ob } D(h)_{n\text{-coh}} \iff f_*(E) \in D(Y)_{n\text{-coh}}.$$

Here $D(X)$ denotes the derived category of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules, and $D(Y)_{n\text{-coh}}$ denotes the full subcategory of $D(Y)$ formed by the n -pseudo-coherent objects.

Proof. Uniqueness is evident. Let indeed $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a locally finite type morphism. Choose an open covering $(i_\alpha : X_\alpha \rightarrow X)_{\alpha \in A}$ such that, for every α , fi_α factors as

$$X_\alpha \xrightarrow{i'_\alpha} Y_\alpha \xrightarrow{f'_\alpha} Y,$$

where i'_α is a closed immersion and f'_α is smooth. It follows at once from (i), (ii), (iii) that the objects of $D(f)_{n\text{-coh}}$ are precisely the objects $E \in D(X)$ such that

$$i'_{\alpha*} i_\alpha^*(E) \in \text{ob } D(Y_\alpha)_{n\text{-coh}};$$

therefore $D(f)_{n\text{-coh}}$ is well determined, since it is a full subcategory of $D(X)$. To prove existence we shall need several lemmas.

Lemma 1.1.1. Let $i : X \rightarrow Y$ be a closed immersion of schemes such that $i_*(\mathcal{O}_X)$ is pseudo-coherent, and let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$. In order that E be n -pseudo-coherent, it is necessary and sufficient that $i_*(E)$ be so.

Proof. The necessity follows from the general stability criterion for pseudo-coherence under application of a functor. Conversely, suppose that $i_*(E)$ is n -pseudo-coherent, and prove that the same is true of E . Since $i_*(E)$ has locally bounded-above cohomology, the same is true of E . The question being local, one may suppose that E is m -pseudo-coherent for m sufficiently large. We prove by descending induction on m , with E assumed m -pseudo-coherent for some

$m \geq n$. Suppose already proved that E is $(n+1)$ -pseudo-coherent. After localization, there is a distinguished triangle

$$E' \longrightarrow E \longrightarrow E'' \longrightarrow E'[1]$$

where E' is perfect and $H^i(E'') = 0$ for $i > n$. By Exposé I, Proposition 2.6, it remains to show that E'' is n -pseudo-coherent. Applying i_* to the preceding triangle, we get a distinguished triangle

$$i_*(E') \longrightarrow i_*(E) \longrightarrow i_*(E'') \longrightarrow i_*(E')[1]$$

and, by the first part of the proof, $i_*(E')$ is pseudo-coherent. Hence, again by Exposé I, Proposition 2.6, $i_*(E'')$ is n -pseudo-coherent. Since $i_*(E'')$ is zero in degrees $> n$, this means, by Exposé I, Proposition 2.10 b), that $H^n(i_*(E''))$ is of finite type. But

$$H^n(i_*(E'')) = i_*H^n(E''),$$

so the assertion is reduced to showing, by Exposé I, Proposition 2.10 b), that if M is an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module such that $i_*(M)$ is of finite type, then M is of finite type. This is immediate and independent of the hypothesis on $i_*(\mathcal{O}_X)$.

Remark 1.1.2. The preceding lemma applies in particular to the case where i is a regular immersion. Indeed, by means of the Koszul complex, $i_*(\mathcal{O}_X)$ has locally a finite left resolution by finite-type free $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -modules; hence $i_*(\mathcal{O}_X)$ is perfect, and a fortiori pseudo-coherent.

Lemma 1.1.3. Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X' & \xrightarrow{f} & X \\ i' \downarrow & & \downarrow i \\ Y' & \xrightarrow{g} & Y \end{array}$$

be a Cartesian square of schemes, where i is a closed immersion, and let E be a complex of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules. Then the canonical base-change arrow

$$g^*i_*(E) \longrightarrow i'_*f^*(E)$$

is an isomorphism.

If $E' = f^*(E)$, if g is flat and $i_*(E)$ is n -pseudo-coherent, then $i'_*(E')$ is n -pseudo-coherent. Conversely, if g is faithfully flat and $i'_*(E')$ is n -pseudo-coherent, then $i_*(E)$ is n -pseudo-coherent.

Proof. The assertion is verified trivially on the fibers.

Lemma 1.1.4. Let

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} X' & \xleftarrow{i'} & X & \xrightarrow{i''} & X'' \\ & \swarrow f' & & \searrow f'' & \\ & & Y & & \end{array}$$

be a commutative diagram of schemes, where i' (respectively i'') is a closed immersion and f' (respectively f'') is smooth, and let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$. Then

$$i'^*(E) \text{ is } n\text{-pseudo-coherent} \iff i''^*(E) \text{ is } n\text{-pseudo-coherent}.$$

Proof. Following a device due to Lichtenbaum, send X diagonally into $X' \times_Y X''$. One is at once reduced to proving the assertion in the case where one of the morphisms f' , f'' is the identity. Changing notation, one has a commutative triangle

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & & Y \\ & \nearrow j & \downarrow f \\ X & \xrightarrow{i} & Z \end{array}$$

where i and j are closed immersions and f is smooth, and one must show that $i_*(E)$ is n -pseudo-coherent if and only if $j_*(E)$ is n -pseudo-coherent. The question being local on Y and on Z in a neighborhood of a point of X , one may suppose that X, Y, Z are affine and that there is a factorization

$$\begin{array}{ccc} Y & \xrightarrow{i'} & Z[T_1, \dots, T_r] \\ f \downarrow & \swarrow & \\ Z & & \end{array}$$

where i' is a closed immersion and the oblique arrow is the canonical projection. Then, by Exposé VII, 1.10, i' is a regular immersion; hence by Lemma 1.1.1 an object F of $D(Y)$ is n -pseudo-coherent if and only if $i'_*(F)$ is so.

Thus one may suppose that $Y = Z[T_1, \dots, T_r]$, f being the canonical projection. The preceding diagram then corresponds to a diagram of rings

$$A \xleftarrow{v} C \xrightarrow{u} B = C[T_1, \dots, T_r]$$

where u and v are epimorphisms and $c : C \rightarrow B$ is the canonical inclusion. For $1 \leq i \leq r$, put $u(T_i) = x_i$, and let $z_i \in C$ be such that $v(z_i) = x_i$. The retraction

$$\sigma : B \longrightarrow C, \quad \sigma(T_i) = z_i,$$

is defined by $c(T_i) = z_i$, is such that $v\sigma = u$. Geometrically, it corresponds to a section s of f such that $i = sj$. By Exposé VII, 1.10, s is a regular immersion; the assertion therefore follows from Lemma 1.1.1.

End of the proof of Theorem 1.1. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a locally finite type morphism. There exists an open covering (X_α) of X such that each X_α embeds by a closed immersion into a scheme Y_α smooth over Y . Put $\coprod X_\alpha = X'$, $\coprod Y_\alpha = Y'$. We have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X' & \xrightarrow{i'} & Y' \\ p' \downarrow & \swarrow f' & \\ X & & \\ f \downarrow & & \\ Y & & \end{array}$$

where p' is the morphism which is the sum of a surjective family of open immersions (we shall say *special*, for short), i' is a closed immersion, and f' is smooth. We define $D(f)_{n\text{-coh}}$ as the full subcategory of $D(X)$ formed by the objects E such that $i'_*p'^*(E)$ is n -pseudo-coherent. First we show that this definition makes sense, that is, that $D(f)_{n\text{-coh}}$ is independent of the choice of i' , p' , f' . Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X'' & \xrightarrow{i''} & Y'' \\ p'' \downarrow & \swarrow f'' & \\ X & & \\ f \downarrow & & \\ Y & & \end{array}$$

be an analogous commutative diagram, with p'' special, i'' a closed immersion, and f'' smooth.

From the two diagrams one deduces a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
X' \times_X X'' & \longrightarrow & Y' \times_Y Y'' \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow \\
X' & \xrightarrow{i'} & Y' \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow f' \\
X'' & \xrightarrow{i''} & Y'' \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow f'' \\
X & \xrightarrow{f} & Y
\end{array}$$

where the horizontal arrows, except for f , are closed immersions, and the arrows of the left (respectively right) Cartesian square are special morphisms (respectively smooth morphisms). Thus one is reduced to proving the following assertion.

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
X_1 & \xrightarrow{i_1} & Y_1 \\
p \downarrow & & \downarrow q \\
X_2 & \xrightarrow{i_2} & Y_2
\end{array}$$

Let this be a commutative square of schemes, where p is special, q is smooth, i_1 and i_2 are closed immersions, and let $E \in \text{ob } D(X_2)$. Then $i_{2*}(E)$ is n -pseudo-coherent if and only if $i_{1*}p^*(E)$ is so.

Proof of the assertion. By definition, p is the sum of a family of opens U_α of X_2 covering X_2 . Each U_α is induced by an open V_α of Y_2 , and the V_α cover an open neighborhood X'_2 of X_2 in Y_2 . There is therefore a Cartesian commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
X_1 & \xrightarrow{i'_1} & X'_1 & & \\
p \downarrow & & \downarrow p' & & \\
X_2 & \xrightarrow{i'_2} & X'_2 & \xrightarrow{j} & Y_2
\end{array}$$

where i'_1 and i'_2 are closed immersions, p and p' are special morphisms, and j is an open immersion. The condition that $i_{2*}(E)$ be n -pseudo-coherent is plainly equivalent to the condition that $i'_{2*}(E)$ be n -pseudo-coherent. On the other hand, by Lemma 1.1.3, the condition that $i'_{2*}(E)$ be n -pseudo-coherent is equivalent to the condition that $i'_{1*}p^*(E)$ be n -pseudo-coherent. Applying Lemma 1.1.4 to the factorizations $(jp')i'_1$ and qi_1 of i_2p , and to $p^*(E) \in \text{ob } D(X_1)$, one finally concludes that $i'_{2*}(E)$ is n -pseudo-coherent if and only if $i_{1*}p^*(E)$ is n -pseudo-coherent, as required.

We have thus shown that the category $D(f)_{n\text{-coh}}$ defined above by means of a diagram as above depends in fact only on f . Moreover it is trivial from the definition that it satisfies (i) to (iii). This proves Theorem 1.1.

Definition 1.2. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a locally finite type morphism, let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$, and let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. We say that E is n -pseudo-coherent relative to f if $E \in \text{ob } D(f)_{n\text{-coh}}$ (cf. 1.1). We say that E is pseudo-coherent, or $(-\infty)$ -pseudo-coherent, relative to f if E is n -pseudo-coherent relative to f for every $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. We write $D(f)_{\text{coh}}$ for the full subcategory of $D(X)$ formed by the objects pseudo-coherent relative to f .

We shall say that f is n -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent) if $\mathcal{O}_X$ is n -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent) relative to f . When this cannot lead to confusion, we

shall sometimes say “ n -pseudo-coherent (respectively pseudo-coherent) relative to Y ” instead of “relative to f ,” and we shall also write

$$D(X)_{Y, n\text{-coh}} \quad (\text{respectively } D(X)_{Y, \text{coh}})$$

instead of

$$D(f)_{n\text{-coh}} \quad (\text{respectively } D(f)_{\text{coh}}).$$

Finally, for $* = +, -, b$, put

$$D^*(f)_{n\text{-coh}} = D^*(X) \cap D(f)_{n\text{-coh}}, \quad D^*(f)_{\text{coh}} = D^*(X) \cap D(f)_{\text{coh}}.$$

Remarks 1.2.1.

- a) The categories $D(f)_{n\text{-coh}}$, $D(f)_{\text{coh}}$ are not in general contained in $D^-(X)$. This is the case, however, if X is quasi-compact, since an object of $D(X)$ with locally bounded-above cohomology then has bounded-above cohomology.
- b) The objects of $D(f)_{\text{coh}}$ have quasi-coherent cohomology. Indeed, if $E \in \text{ob } D(f)_{\text{coh}}$, the question being local, one may suppose that f is a closed immersion; then $f_*(E)$ is pseudo-coherent, hence has quasi-coherent cohomology, and one uses the fact that an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module M is quasi-coherent if and only if $f_*(M)$ is.
- c) When it is a matter of an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, we shall use the terminology “of finite presentation relative to f ” in preference to “ (-1) -pseudo-coherent relative to f .” For an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module E to be of finite presentation relative to f , it is necessary and sufficient, by Exposé I, Proposition 2.9, that there exist locally a closed immersion $i : X \rightarrow X'$, with X' smooth over Y , such that $i_*(E)$ is of finite presentation in the ordinary sense. In particular, to say that f is (-1) -pseudo-coherent is equivalent to saying that f is locally of finite presentation in the sense of EGA IV 1.4.

Examples 1.3. A smooth morphism and a regular immersion are pseudo-coherent morphisms. The same is true of an arbitrary locally finite type morphism $f : X \rightarrow Y$ if Y is locally noetherian.

Proposition 1.4. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a locally finite type morphism and let

$$E \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow G \longrightarrow E[1]$$

be a distinguished triangle of $D(X)$. The following table, where $n \in \mathbb{Z} \cup \{-\infty\}$ indicates a degree of pseudo-coherence relative to f , has the property that each line represents an implication whose conclusion is underlined:

E	F	G
$n+1$	n	<u>n</u>
n	<u>n</u>	n
<u>n</u>	n	$n-1$.

In particular, $D(f)_{\text{coh}}$ is a triangulated subcategory of $D(X)$.

Proof. By the properties (i) to (iii) of Theorem 1.1, one may suppose that f is a closed immersion. We then have a distinguished triangle

$$f_*(E) \longrightarrow f_*(F) \longrightarrow f_*(G) \longrightarrow f_*(E)[1]$$

and the assertion follows from Exposé I, Proposition 2.6.

Definition 1.5. Let X and Y be two S -schemes. We shall say that X and Y are *Tor-independent over S* if

$$\text{Tor}_i^S(\mathcal{O}_X, \mathcal{O}_Y) = 0 \quad \text{for } i \neq 0,$$

where the Tor_i^S are the local hyper-Tor sheaves defined in EGA III 6.5. This is a condition of local nature. If X, Y, S are affine, with respective rings B, C, A , it means that the canonical map

$$B \otimes_A^{\mathbf{L}} C \longrightarrow B \otimes_A C$$

is an isomorphism. It is therefore satisfied in particular if X or Y is flat over S .

Lemma 1.5.1. Let

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} X & \longleftarrow & X' & \longleftarrow & X'' \\ \uparrow & & \uparrow & & \uparrow \\ Y & \longleftarrow & Y' & \longleftarrow & Y'' \end{array}$$

be Cartesian squares of schemes. If X and Y' are Tor-independent over Y , and if X' and Y'' are Tor-independent over Y' , then X and Y'' are Tor-independent over Y .

Proof. This is an easy exercise on associativity of the tensor product.

Notation 1.6. Let X and Y be two S -schemes, $E \in \mathrm{ob} D^-(X)$, $F \in \mathrm{ob} D^-(Y)$. We put

$$E \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} F = L \mathrm{pr}_1^*(E) \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} L \mathrm{pr}_2^*(F),$$

where $\mathrm{pr}_1, \mathrm{pr}_2$ are the two projections from $X \times_S Y$.

Lemma 1.7. Let S be a scheme, and for $i = 1, 2$ let

$$f_i : X_i \longrightarrow Y_i$$

be a closed S -immersion. Suppose that X_1 and X_2 , and also Y_1 and Y_2 , are Tor-independent over S . Then, for $E_i \in \mathrm{ob} D^-(X_i)_{\mathrm{qcoh}}$, there is a canonical isomorphism

$$f_{1*}(E_1) \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} f_{2*}(E_2) \xrightarrow{\sim} (f_1 \times_S f_2)_*(E_1 \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} E_2).$$

Proof. Put $f_1 \times_S f_2 = f$. One easily defines, by adjunction, a canonical arrow

$$f_{1*}(E_1) \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} f_{2*}(E_2) \longrightarrow f_*(E_1 \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} E_2).$$

We show that it is an isomorphism. The question being local, one may suppose S, X_i, Y_i affine with respective rings C, A_i, B_i . By dévissage, one is reduced to $E_i = \mathcal{O}_{X_i}$. One must then verify that

$$A_1 \otimes_{B_1}^{\mathbf{L}} B \otimes_{B_2}^{\mathbf{L}} A_2 \longrightarrow A$$

is an isomorphism, where $A = A_1 \otimes_C A_2$, $B = B_1 \otimes_C B_2$. In view of the Tor-independence hypotheses, this follows at once from associativity of the tensor product.

Proposition 1.8. Let S be a scheme, and for $i = 1, 2$ let

$$f_i : X_i \longrightarrow Y_i$$

be a locally finite type S -morphism. Suppose that X_1 and X_2 , and also Y_1 and Y_2 , are Tor-independent over S . Let $[a_i, b_i]$ be intervals of $\mathbb{Z}$, and let

$$E_i \in \mathrm{ob} D^-(X_i)_{\mathrm{qcoh}}$$

be a complex which is a_i -pseudo-coherent relative to f_i and acyclic in degree $> b_i$. Then

$$E_1 \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} E_2$$

is a -pseudo-coherent relative to $f = f_1 \times_S f_2$ and acyclic in degree $> b$, where

$$a = \sup(a_1 + b_2, a_2 + b_1), \quad b = b_1 + b_2.$$

Proof. The question being local on $X_1 \times_S X_2$, one may suppose that f_i factors as

$$X_i \xrightarrow{i_i} Y'_i \xrightarrow{p_i} Y_i,$$

where i_i is a closed immersion and p_i a smooth morphism. Put $f' = f'_1 \times_S f'_2$. We must show that $f'_*(E_1 \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} E_2)$ is a -pseudo-coherent and acyclic in degree $> b$. By Lemma 1.5.1, Y'_1 and Y'_2 are Tor-independent over S . After changing notation, one may suppose that $f_i = f'_i$, in other words that the f_i are closed immersions. By hypothesis, $f_{i*}(E_i)$ is a_i -pseudo-coherent and acyclic in degree $> b_i$; hence by Exposé I, Proposition 2.16,

$$f_{1*}(E_1) \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} f_{2*}(E_2)$$

is a -pseudo-coherent and acyclic in degree $> b$. One concludes by Lemma 1.7.

Corollary 1.9. Under the hypotheses of Proposition 1.8, the functor

$$\otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} : D^-(X_1) \times D^-(X_2) \longrightarrow D^-(X)$$

induces a functor

$$\otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} : D^-(f_1)_{\text{coh}} \times D^-(f_2)_{\text{coh}} \longrightarrow D^-(f)_{\text{coh}}.$$

In particular, if f_1 and f_2 are pseudo-coherent, then so is f .

Corollary 1.10. Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X' & \xrightarrow{g} & X \\ f' \downarrow & & \downarrow f \\ Y' & \xrightarrow{h} & Y \end{array}$$

be a Cartesian square, with f locally of finite type. Then:

- a) Suppose that X and Y' are Tor-independent over Y . For $n \in \mathbb{Z} \cup \{-\infty\}$, the functor $Lg^* : D^-(X) \rightarrow D^-(X')$ induces a functor

$$Lg^* : D^-(f)_{n\text{-coh}} \longrightarrow D^-(f')_{n\text{-coh}}.$$

In particular, if f is n -pseudo-coherent, then so is f' .

- b) Suppose that h is faithfully flat. Let $n \in \mathbb{Z} \cup \{-\infty\}$, and let $E \in \text{ob } D^-(X)$ be a complex with quasi-coherent cohomology. In order that E be n -pseudo-coherent relative to f , it is necessary and sufficient that $g^*(E)$ be n -pseudo-coherent relative to f' . In particular, in order that f be n -pseudo-coherent, it is necessary and sufficient that f' be so.

Proof. Taking Remark 1.2.1 b) into account, all assertions of Corollaries 1.9 and 1.10 follow trivially from Proposition 1.8, except the necessity in 1.10 b). For this one may, the question being local on X , suppose that f factors as a closed immersion followed by a smooth morphism. One is then reduced by Lemma 1.1.3 to the case where f (respectively f') is the identity of X (respectively X'). The assertion then follows, by a standard dévissage, from the fact that a quasi-coherent sheaf L on X is of finite type if and only if g^*L is of finite type.

Proposition 1.11. Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{f} & Y \\ & \searrow h & \downarrow g \\ & & Z \end{array}$$

be a commutative triangle of locally finite type morphisms. Let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$, $F \in \text{ob } D(Y)$, and let $[a, b]$, $[c, d]$ be intervals of $\mathbb{Z}$.

- a) If E is a -pseudo-coherent relative to f and acyclic in degree $> b$, and if F is c -pseudo-coherent relative to g and acyclic in degree $> d$, then

$$E \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_Y}^{\mathbf{L}} F$$

is m -pseudo-coherent relative to h and acyclic in degree $> n$, where

$$m = \sup(a + d, b + c), \quad n = b + d.$$

- b) If E is a -pseudo-coherent relative to h and acyclic in degree $> b$, and if g is $(a + 1 - b)$ -pseudo-coherent, then E is a -pseudo-coherent relative to f .

Proof. The question being local on X , one may suppose that there is a Cartesian commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} X & \xrightarrow{i} & E_Y^r & \xrightarrow{j} & E_Z^{r+s} \\ f \downarrow & & \downarrow p & & \downarrow q \\ Y & \xrightarrow{k} & E_Z^s & \longrightarrow & Z \end{array}$$

where i, j, k are closed immersions and p, q are the canonical projections of affine spaces. If F is c -pseudo-coherent relative to Z , then $k_*(F)$ is c -pseudo-coherent by Theorem 1.1 (iii), and $j_*p^*(F)$ is c -pseudo-coherent by Lemma 1.1.3. Similarly, if g is x -pseudo-coherent, then $j_*(\mathcal{O}_{E_Y^r})$ is x -pseudo-coherent. By the definition of relative pseudo-coherence, one is thus reduced to proving a) and b) when f and g are closed immersions.

Proof of a). By Theorem 1.1 (iii), one has to show the following. Suppose $f_*(E)$ is a -pseudo-coherent and acyclic in degree $> b$, and $g_*(F)$ is c -pseudo-coherent and acyclic in degree $> d$. Then

$$h_*(E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} F)$$

is m -pseudo-coherent and acyclic in degree $> n$. There is a canonical isomorphism

$$f_*(E) \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} F \xrightarrow{\sim} f_*(E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} F),$$

a special case of the isomorphism used in the proof of Proposition 1.8. Since the functor $g_*(- \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} F)$ takes finite-type locally free sheaves to c -pseudo-coherent complexes, and complexes acyclic in degree > 0 to complexes acyclic in degree $> d$, the assertion follows from Exposé I, Proposition 2.13.

Proof of b). One must prove the following assertion: suppose $f_*(E)$ is a -pseudo-coherent and acyclic in degree $> b$, and $g_*(\mathcal{O}_Y)$ is $(a + 1 - b)$ -pseudo-coherent. Then $f_*(E)$ is a -pseudo-coherent. Since the assertion concerns $f_*(E)$, one may suppose $X = Y$ and $f = \text{Id}_X$. One then proceeds as in the proof of Lemma 1.1.1, proving by descending induction that E is pseudo-coherent in degree a . Suppose already proved that E is $(a + 1)$ -pseudo-coherent. By Exposé I, Proposition 2.10, after localizing there is a distinguished triangle

$$E' \longrightarrow E \longrightarrow E'' \longrightarrow E'[1]$$

where E'^i is locally free for $i \in [a + 1, b]$, $E'^i = 0$ for $i \notin [a + 1, b]$, and $E''^i = 0$ for $i > a$. The hypothesis that $g_*(\mathcal{O}_Y)$ is $(a + 1 - b)$ -pseudo-coherent implies, by Exposé I, Proposition 2.11 a), that $g_*(E')$ is $(a + 1)$ -pseudo-coherent. Since $g_*(E)$ is a -pseudo-coherent, it follows from Exposé I, Proposition 2.6, that $g_*(E'')$ is a -pseudo-coherent. We conclude by Exposé I, Proposition 2.10 b), and by the fact that an $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -module M is of finite type if and only if $g_*(M)$ is. Corollaries 1.12–1.14 follow immediately.

Corollary 1.12. In the situation of Proposition 1.11, if g is pseudo-coherent, then, for $r \in \mathbb{Z} \cup \{-\infty\}$,

$$D(f)_{r\text{-coh}} = D(h)_{r\text{-coh}}.$$

In particular, taking $X = Y$, the notions of r -pseudo-coherence over Y , in the absolute sense or relative to g , coincide.

Corollary 1.13. In the situation of Proposition 1.11, if f is pseudo-coherent, the functor

$$\mathcal{O}_X \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} - = Lf^* : D^-(Y) \longrightarrow D^-(X)$$

induces, for $r \in \mathbb{Z} \cup \{-\infty\}$, a functor

$$Lf^* : D^-(g)_{r\text{-coh}} \longrightarrow D^-(h)_{r\text{-coh}}.$$

Corollary 1.14. In the situation of Proposition 1.11, if f is r -pseudo-coherent and g is s -pseudo-coherent, with $r, s \in \mathbb{Z} \cup \{-\infty\}$, then h is $\sup(r, s)$ -pseudo-coherent. If h is r -pseudo-coherent and g is $(r + 1)$ -pseudo-coherent, then f is r -pseudo-coherent.

Remark 1.14.1. In particular, for $r = s = -1$, one recovers the assertions (ii) and (v) of EGA IV 1.4.3.

2. The finiteness theorem

Conjecture 2.1. Let S be a scheme, let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a proper S -morphism of schemes locally of finite type over S , and let $E \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$. If E is pseudo-coherent relative to S , then the same is true of $\mathbf{R}f_*(E)$.

Theorem 2.2. The preceding conjecture is true in the following cases:

- (i) S is locally noetherian; (ii) f is projective.

Proof in case (i). Since S is locally noetherian, the projection of X (respectively Y) onto S is a pseudo-coherent morphism, and the notions of pseudo-coherence over X (respectively Y) and relative to S coincide (Corollary 1.12). On the other hand, since X (respectively Y) is locally noetherian, hence $\mathcal{O}_X$ (respectively $\mathcal{O}_Y$) coherent, an object M of $D(X)$ (respectively $D(Y)$) is pseudo-coherent if and only if its $H^i(M)$ are coherent and M is locally in D^- (Exposé I, 3.5). The theorem therefore follows from:

Theorem 2.2.1. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a proper morphism of locally noetherian schemes, and let $E \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$. If the $H^i(E)$ are coherent, then the same is true of $R^i f_*(E)$. If moreover E is locally in D^- , then the same is true of $\mathbf{R}f_*(E)$.

Proof. The first assertion follows from the spectral sequence

$$R^p f_*(H^q(E)) \Longrightarrow R^{p+q} f_*(E)$$

and from the finiteness theorem EGA III 3.2.1. For the second, one may suppose Y affine. Then X is quasi-compact and separated; suppose it covered by r affine opens. One knows (EGA III 1.4.12) that under these conditions, for a quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module M , one has $R^i f_*(M) = 0$ for every $i > r$. If E is locally in D^- , then $E \in D^-$, since X is quasi-compact; say $H^i(E) = 0$ for $i > N$. The preceding spectral sequence then gives $R^i f_*(E) = 0$ for $i > N + r$, which proves the assertion.

Proof in case (ii). The question being local on Y , one may suppose S and Y affine. There is then a Cartesian commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} X & \xrightarrow{i} & \mathbb{P}_Y^r & \xrightarrow{j} & \mathbb{P}_{Y'}^r \\ f \downarrow & & \downarrow p & & \downarrow p' \\ Y & \longrightarrow & Y' & \xrightarrow{g} & S \end{array}$$

where i, j, j' are closed immersions, g' is smooth and affine, and p, p' are projections of projective spaces. Suppose that E is pseudo-coherent relative to S . By Theorem 1.1 (iii), this means that $(ji)_*(E)$ is pseudo-coherent. We must show that $\mathbf{R}f_*(E)$ is pseudo-coherent relative to S , that is, by Theorem 1.1 (iii), that

$$j'_* \mathbf{R}f_*(E)$$

is pseudo-coherent. But

$$j'_* \mathbf{R}f_*(E) \simeq \mathbf{R}p'_*((ji)_*(E)),$$

so the assertion is a consequence of the following more precise result.

Theorem 2.2.2. Let Y be an affine scheme, let

$$f : X = \mathbb{P}_Y^r \longrightarrow Y$$

be the projection of a projective space of finite type, and let $E \in \text{ob } D^b(X)_{\text{coh}}$. Then $\mathbf{R}f_*(E)$ is pseudo-coherent. Moreover, if E is acyclic in degree $> a$, then $\mathbf{R}f_*(E)$ is acyclic in degree $> a + r$, and there exists an integer N such that, for all $n \geq N$,

$$\mathbf{R}f_*(E(n)), \quad E(n) = E \otimes \mathcal{O}_X(n),$$

is acyclic in degree $> a$.

Proof. Since Y is affine, X is quasi-compact and separated. By Exposé II, 2.2.9 a), E is isomorphic, in $D(X)$, to a complex F bounded above such that, for every i , $F^i \in \text{ob } L(X)$, that is, F^i is a finite direct sum of sheaves of the type $\mathcal{O}_X(-n)$, $n \geq 0$. If E is acyclic in degree $> a$, F may be chosen so that $F^i = 0$ for $i > a$; this follows formally from the preceding assertion, taking account of Exposé I, 2.10 a), and Exposé II, 2.2.8 a). Replacing E by F , one may suppose that $E^i \in \text{ob } L(X)$ for every i , and that $E^i = 0$ for $i > a$. Since X is covered by $r + 1$ affine opens, EGA III 1.4.10 and the hypercohomology spectral sequence give

$$R^i f_*(E) = 0 \quad \text{for } i > a + r.$$

Let $t \leq a$ be an integer and put

$$E' = (0 \rightarrow E^t \rightarrow \cdots \rightarrow E^a \rightarrow 0).$$

There is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow E' \longrightarrow E \longrightarrow E'' \longrightarrow 0,$$

where E'' satisfies the same conditions as E , but with a replaced by $t - 1$. Applying $\mathbf{R}f_*$, one obtains a distinguished triangle

$$\mathbf{R}f_*(E') \longrightarrow \mathbf{R}f_*(E) \longrightarrow \mathbf{R}f_*(E'') \longrightarrow \mathbf{R}f_*(E')[1]$$

Since t can be chosen arbitrarily negative, it is enough, for the first assertion, to prove that $\mathbf{R}f_*(E')$ is $(t + r)$ -pseudo-coherent. But $\mathbf{R}f_*(E'')$ is acyclic in degree $\geq t + r$, hence $(t + r)$ -pseudo-coherent. Thus one wins by Exposé I, Proposition 2.6, if one proves that $\mathbf{R}f_*(E')$ is perfect.

For this one is reduced by dévissage to the case where E' is concentrated in degree 0 and equal to $\mathcal{O}_X(-n)$, $n > 0$. Then, by EGA III 2.1.16,

$$\mathbf{R}f_*(\mathcal{O}_X(-n)) \simeq R^r f_*(\mathcal{O}_X(-n))[-r].$$

Therefore $\mathbf{R}f_*(\mathcal{O}_X(-n))$ is perfect, and this ends the proof of the first assertion of Theorem 2.2.2. We have already seen that $\mathbf{R}f_*(E)$ is acyclic in degree $> a + r$. It remains to prove the last assertion. For $t < -r + a$, $\mathbf{R}f_*(E'')$ is acyclic in degree $> a$. Taking account of the preceding triangle, one is reduced to doing the proof for E' instead of for E . Since E' is bounded above and has components in $L(X)$, there is an integer N such that, for all $n \geq N$, the components of $E'(n)$ are finite direct sums of sheaves of type $\mathcal{O}_X(p)$ with $p \geq 0$. Then, by EGA III 2.1.16 and the hypercohomology spectral sequence, $\mathbf{R}f_*(E'(n))$ is acyclic in degree $> a$ for all $n \geq N$, which completes the proof of Theorem 2.2.2 and hence of Theorem 2.2.

We also have the following classical complement to 2.2 (ii), which will be given for later reference.

Corollary 2.3 (EGA III 2.2.1). Let S be a quasi-compact scheme, $f : X \rightarrow Y$ a projective S -morphism of finite type schemes over S , and let

$$L = i^* \mathcal{O}_P(1)$$

be the invertible sheaf defined by an extension $i : X \rightarrow P = P(F)$, where F is a quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -module of finite type. For $M \in \text{ob } D(X)$ and $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, put

$$M(n) = M \otimes L^{\otimes n}.$$

If $E \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$ is pseudo-coherent relative to S and acyclic in degree $> a$, then there exists an integer N such that, for all $n \geq N$, $\mathbf{R}f_*(E(n))$ has the same properties.

Proof. One reduces trivially, as in the proof of Theorem 2.2 (ii), to the situation of Theorem 2.2.2: $Y = S$, $f : X = \mathbb{P}_Y^r \rightarrow Y$ the canonical projection, $L = \mathcal{O}_X(1)$ the canonical sheaf, $E \in \text{ob } D^b(X)$ a pseudo-coherent complex acyclic in degree $> a$. The conclusion then follows from Theorem 2.2.2.

Corollary 2.4. Let S be a quasi-compact scheme and let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a proper S -morphism of schemes of finite type over S . If S is noetherian, or if f is projective, the functor

$$\mathbf{R}f_* : D^+(X) \longrightarrow D^+(Y)$$

induces a functor

$$\mathbf{R}f_* : D^b(X)_{S\text{-coh}} \longrightarrow D^b(Y)_{S\text{-coh}}.$$

Proof. Consequence of Theorem 2.2 and of the fact that there is then an integer N such that, for every quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module E , $R^i f_*(E) = 0$ for all $i > N$.

Corollary 2.5. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a proper and pseudo-coherent morphism, and let $E \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$. Suppose Y locally noetherian or f projective. If E is pseudo-coherent in the absolute sense, then the same is true of $\mathbf{R}f_*(E)$. If Y is quasi-compact, the functor $\mathbf{R}f_*$ induces a functor

$$\mathbf{R}f_* : D^b(X)_{\text{coh}} \longrightarrow D^b(Y)_{\text{coh}}.$$

Proof. Consequence of Theorem 2.2, Corollary 2.4, and Corollary 1.12.

Scholie 2.6. To prove Conjecture 2.1 in general, new techniques will surely have to be introduced. One may hope that they will one day make it possible to prove the analogous conjecture in analytic geometry, for a proper morphism of analytic spaces over a suitably topologized locally ringed topos in $\mathbb{C}$ -algebras. For the present this conjecture has been proved only over a complex analytic space, by Grauert's theorem.¹⁸

¹⁸Added in April 1971: see a forthcoming article of R. Kiehl and J.-L. Verdier, where the finiteness theorem is proved by different, simpler techniques and under more general hypotheses.

3. Relative finite Tor-dimension

Definition 3.1. Let

$$f : (X, \mathcal{O}_X) \longrightarrow (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$$

be a morphism of ringed topoi, let $E \in \text{ob } D^-(X)$, and let $[m, n]$ be an interval of $\mathbb{Z}$. We say that E is of flat amplitude relative to f (or to Y , if there is no possible confusion) contained in $[m, n]$, and write

$$\text{tor. amp}_f(E) \subset [m, n] \quad (\text{or } \text{tor. amp}_Y(E) \subset [m, n]),$$

if E , considered as a complex of $f^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_Y)$ -modules, is of flat amplitude contained in $[m, n]$ in the sense of Exposé I, 5.2. We say that f is of flat amplitude contained in $[-a, 0]$, or of Tor-dimension $\leq a$, if $\mathcal{O}_X$ is of flat amplitude relative to f contained in $[-a, 0]$. We say that E is of finite flat amplitude relative to f if there exists an interval $[m, n]$ such that $\text{tor. amp}_f(E) \subset [m, n]$.

Notation 3.2. We write

$$D(f)_{\text{torf}}, \quad D(X)_{f\text{-torf}}, \quad D(X)_{Y\text{-torf}}$$

if no confusion is possible, for the full subcategory of $D^-(X)$ formed by complexes of finite flat amplitude relative to f . By Exposé I, 5.3, this is a triangulated subcategory of $D^b(X)$.

Proposition 3.3. With the notation of Definition 3.1, suppose that X has enough points (SGA 4 XVII IV 6.4). The following conditions are then equivalent:

- (i) $\text{tor. amp}_f(E) \subset [m, n]$.
- (ii) For every point x of X , one has

$$\text{tor. amp}_y(E_x) \subset [m, n],$$

where $y = f(x)$, ringed by $\mathcal{O}_{Y,y}$.

- (iii) For every object V of Y and every $\mathcal{O}_V$ -module M , one has

$$H^i(E|_{f^{-1}(V)} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_V}^{\mathbf{L}} M) = 0 \quad \text{for } i \notin [m, n].$$

Equivalently, for every $\mathcal{O}_V$ -module M ,

$$E|_{f^{-1}(V)} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_V}^{\mathbf{L}} M \simeq E|_{f^{-1}(V)} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_V}^{\mathbf{L}} L_! f^*(M).$$

- (iv) The same condition as (iii), but with M the cokernel of a homomorphism

$$\mathcal{O}_V^q \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_V^p, \quad p, q \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Proof. The equivalence (i) $\iff$ (ii) follows from Exposé I, 5.6.2, and the implications (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (iii) $\Rightarrow$ (iv) are trivial. We prove (iv) $\Rightarrow$ (ii). Let x be a point of X , $y = f(x)$. One has to show that

$$H^i(E_x \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{Y,y}}^{\mathbf{L}} M) = 0$$

for every $\mathcal{O}_{Y,y}$ -module M and every $i \notin [m, n]$. Since every $\mathcal{O}_{Y,y}$ -module is an inductive filtered limit of modules of finite presentation, one may restrict to M of finite presentation. If M is a finitely presented $\mathcal{O}_{Y,y}$ -module, the same argument as for ordinary ringed spaces (EGA I, 5.3.9) shows that there exists a y -pointed object V of Y and an $\mathcal{O}_V$ -module P , cokernel of a homomorphism

$$\mathcal{O}_V^q \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_V^p, \quad p, q \in \mathbb{N},$$

such that $P_y \simeq M$. One then has

$$(E|_{f^{-1}(V)} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_V}^{\mathbf{L}} P)_x \simeq E_x \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{Y,y}}^{\mathbf{L}} M,$$

by the commutation of tensor product with passage to fibers, and hypothesis (iv) implies the desired vanishing.

Remark 3.3.1. The editor does not know whether the equivalences (i) $\iff$ (iii) $\iff$ (iv) are true without the hypothesis that X has enough points.

Corollary 3.4. Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{f} & Y \\ & \searrow h & \downarrow g \\ & & Z \end{array}$$

be a commutative triangle of ringed topoi, where X is assumed to have enough points. Let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$, $F \in \text{ob } D(Y)$, and let $[a, b]$, $[c, d]$ be intervals of $\mathbb{Z}$. Then

$$\text{tor. amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b] \quad \text{and} \quad \text{tor. amp}_g(F) \subset [c, d]$$

imply

$$\text{tor. amp}_h(E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} F) \subset [a + c, b + d].$$

Proof. By Proposition 3.3, one must show that the relation on the left implies

$$H^i \left(((E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} F)|_{h^{-1}(Z')}) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{Z'}}^{\mathbf{L}} M \right) = 0$$

for every $i \notin [a + c, b + d]$ and every $\mathcal{O}_{Z'}$ -module M , where Z' is an object of Z . Put $Y' = g^{-1}(Z')$, $X' = f^{-1}(Y') = h^{-1}(Z')$. Then

$$((E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} F)|_{X'}) \otimes_{Z'}^{\mathbf{L}} M \simeq (E|_{X'}) \otimes_{Y'}^{\mathbf{L}} ((F|_{Y'}) \otimes_{Z'}^{\mathbf{L}} M),$$

and the assertion follows at once from the hypotheses.

In particular:

Corollary 3.4.1. Under the hypotheses of Corollary 3.4:

a) If g is of Tor-dimension $\leq n$, then

$$\text{tor. amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b] \implies \text{tor. amp}_h(E) \subset [a - n, b].$$

b) If f is of Tor-dimension $\leq m$, then

$$\text{tor. amp}_g(F) \subset [c, d] \implies \text{tor. amp}_h(Lf^*(F)) \subset [c - m, d].$$

Remark 3.4.2. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of finite Tor-dimension and $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$. By Corollary 3.4.1 a), if E is of finite flat amplitude in the absolute sense, then E is of finite flat amplitude relative to f . But the converse is false, even if f is flat, as is shown by the example of a singularity of a scheme over a field.

Proposition 3.5. Let S be a scheme, and for $i = 1, 2$ let

$$f_i : X_i \longrightarrow Y_i$$

be an S -morphism, with $E_i \in \text{ob } D^-(X_i)$, and let $[a_i, b_i]$ be an interval of $\mathbb{Z}$. Suppose that X_1 and X_2 , and also Y_1 and Y_2 , are Tor-independent over S . Put

$$a = a_1 + a_2, \quad b = b_1 + b_2, \quad f = f_1 \times_S f_2 : X \rightarrow Y.$$

Then:

a) If $\text{tor. amp}_{f_1}(E_1) \subset [a_1, b_1]$, and if E_2 is acyclic outside $[a_2, b_2]$, then

$$E_1 \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} E_2$$

is acyclic outside $[a, b]$.

b) If $\text{tor. amp}_{f_i}(E_i) \subset [a_i, b_i]$ for $i = 1, 2$, then

$$\text{tor. amp}_f(E_1 \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} E_2) \subset [a, b].$$

Proof. By Proposition 3.3, it is enough to verify the assertion on the fibers. Let s be a point of S , x a point of X above s , $y = f(x)$, and let x_i (respectively y_i) be the canonical projection of x (respectively y) onto X_i (respectively Y_i). Put

$$(E_i)_{x_i} = M_i, \quad \mathcal{O}_{X_i, x_i} = A_i, \quad \mathcal{O}_{Y_i, y_i} = B_i, \quad \mathcal{O}_{S, s} = C,$$

and

$$\mathcal{O}_{X, x} = A = A_1 \otimes_C A_2, \quad \mathcal{O}_{Y, y} = B = B_1 \otimes_C B_2.$$

Then

$$(E_1 \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} E_2)_x \simeq M_1 \otimes_{A_1}^{\mathbf{L}} A \otimes_{A_2}^{\mathbf{L}} M_2.$$

The Tor-independence hypotheses imply on the other hand that

$$A \simeq A_1 \otimes_{B_1}^{\mathbf{L}} B \otimes_{B_2}^{\mathbf{L}} A_2.$$

Consequently, the second member of the displayed isomorphism is canonically isomorphic, in the derived category $D(B)$ of B -modules, to

$$M_1 \otimes_{B_1}^{\mathbf{L}} B \otimes_{B_2}^{\mathbf{L}} M_2.$$

The relations $\text{tor. amp}_{f_i}(E_i) \subset [a_i, b_i]$, $i = 1, 2$, imply

$$\text{tor. amp}_{B_i}(M_i) \subset [a_i, b_i],$$

hence, by Exposé I, 5.5,

$$\text{tor. amp}_B(M_1 \otimes_{B_1}^{\mathbf{L}} B \otimes_{B_2}^{\mathbf{L}} M_2) \subset [a, b],$$

which proves b). If, on the other hand, $\text{tor. amp}_{f_1}(E_1) \subset [a_1, b_1]$, M_1 is isomorphic to a complex of flat B_1 -modules, zero outside $[a_1, b_1]$, and if E_2 , hence M_2 , is acyclic outside $[a_2, b_2]$, then

$$M_1 \otimes_{B_1}^{\mathbf{L}} B \otimes_{B_2}^{\mathbf{L}} M_2$$

is acyclic outside $[a, b]$. This proves a) and completes the proof.

Corollary 3.5.1. Under the hypotheses of Proposition 3.5, if f_1 and f_2 are of finite Tor-dimension, then so is f .

Corollary 3.5.2. Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X' & \xrightarrow{g} & X \\ f' \downarrow & & \downarrow f \\ Y' & \xrightarrow{h} & Y \end{array}$$

be a Cartesian square of schemes, where X and Y' are assumed Tor-independent over Y , and let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$. Then one has

$$\text{tor. amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b] \implies \text{tor. amp}_{f'}(Lg^*(E)) \subset [a, b],$$

and consequently the functor $Lg^* : D^-(X) \rightarrow D^-(X')$ induces a functor

$$Lg^* : D(f)_{\text{torf}} \longrightarrow D(f')_{\text{torf}}.$$

Proposition 3.6. Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{i} & X' \\ f \downarrow & \swarrow f' & \\ Y & & \end{array}$$

be a commutative triangle of schemes, where i is a closed immersion and f' is smooth, and let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$. For E to be locally of finite flat amplitude relative to f , it is necessary and sufficient that $i_*(E)$ be locally of finite flat amplitude in the absolute sense. More precisely, if f' is of relative dimension $\leq d$, then

- (i) $\text{tor. amp}(i_*E) \subset [a, b] \implies \text{tor. amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b],$
- (ii) $\text{tor. amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b] \implies \text{tor. amp}(i_*E) \subset [a - d, b].$

Proof. If $[m, n]$ is an interval in $\mathbb{Z}$, one has evidently

$$\text{tor. amp}(E) \subset [m, n] \iff \text{tor. amp}(i_*E) \subset [m, n]$$

in the reduction in which one tests by modules after the closed immersion. Thus it remains to treat the case $X = X'$, $i = \text{Id}_X$, $f = f'$. Assertion (i) is immediate from (3.4.1 a). For (ii), consider the diagonal section

$$s : X \longrightarrow X \times_Y X$$

of the two projections. If f is smooth of relative dimension d , then, by VII 1.10, s is a regular immersion of codimension $\leq d$, hence of Tor-dimension $\leq d$ (as is seen from the Koszul complex). By (3.5.2),

$$\text{tor. amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b] \iff \text{tor. amp}_{\text{pr}_2}(\text{pr}_1^* E) \subset [a, b].$$

By (3.4.1 b) it follows that

$$\text{tor. amp}(s^* \text{pr}_1^* E) \subset [a - d, b],$$

and the implication follows because $s^* \text{pr}_1^* \simeq \text{Id}$.

Remark 3.6.1. The statement (3.6) would be false if one supposed only that f' were flat; see (3.4.2).

Proposition 3.7 (projection formula). Let S be a quasi-compact scheme, let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a quasi-compact and quasi-separated S -morphism of quasi-compact schemes over S , let $E \in \text{ob } D^-(X)_{\text{qcoh}}$, and let $M \in \text{ob } D^b(S)_{\text{qcoh}}$. If M has finite flat amplitude, or if E has finite flat amplitude relative to S , there is a functorial canonical isomorphism in $D(Y)_{\text{qcoh}}$

$$Rf_*(E) \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} M \xrightarrow{\sim} Rf_*(E \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} M).$$

Proof. First, by EGA III 1.4.12 and IV 1.7.21, there is an integer N such that $R^i f_*(F) = 0$ for $i > N$ and for every quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module F . Hence Rf_* sends $D^-(X)_{\text{qcoh}}$ into $D^-(Y)_{\text{qcoh}}$. The adjunction arrow

$$Lf^* Rf_*(E) \longrightarrow E$$

yields, after tensoring with M , an arrow

$$Lf^*(Rf_*(E) \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} M) \longrightarrow E \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} M,$$

and therefore, by adjunction, the canonical arrow

$$Rf_*(E) \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} M \longrightarrow Rf_*(E \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} M). \quad (*)$$

Both sides have quasi-coherent cohomology. The assertion is local on Y , so assume S and Y affine. If M has finite flat amplitude, devissage and the way-out property of the two functors in $(*)$ reduce successively to M an ordinary quasi-coherent module, then to M free, then to M free of finite type, and finally to $M = \mathcal{O}_S$, where $(*)$ is tautological. If instead E has finite flat amplitude relative to S , devissage reduces to the case $M = P$, with P a flat A -module and $S = \operatorname{Spec} A$. Put $A' = D_A(P)$ (EGA 0_{IV}, 18.2.3) and $S' = \operatorname{Spec} A'$. Then the assertion is the flat base-change assertion that

$$q^* Rf_*(E) \longrightarrow Rf'_* p^*(E)$$

is an isomorphism for the base change to S' , which is EGA III 1.4.15 together with IV 1.7.21.

Corollary 3.7.1. Let S be a scheme, let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a quasi-compact and quasi-separated S -morphism of quasi-compact schemes over S , and let $E \in \operatorname{ob} D^-(X)_{\text{qcoh}}$. If E is locally of finite flat amplitude relative to S , then the same is true of $Rf_*(E)$. More precisely, if S is quasi-compact and if N is an integer such that $R^i f_*(F) = 0$ for $i > N$ and every quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module F , then

$$\operatorname{tor.amp}_S(E) \subset [a, b] \implies \operatorname{tor.amp}_S(Rf_* E) \subset [a, b + N].$$

Proof. By (3.3 (1) (iv)), and using that Rf_* commutes with restriction to an open of S , it suffices to prove that the hypothesis implies

$$H^i(Rf_* E \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} M) = 0$$

for $i \notin [a, b + N]$ and every quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module M . But the hypothesis says that $H^i(E \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} M) = 0$ for $i \notin [a, b]$, and (3.7) gives the result.

Corollary 3.7.2. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be quasi-compact, quasi-separated, and locally of finite Tor-dimension, and let $E \in \operatorname{ob} D^-(X)_{\text{qcoh}}$. If E is locally of finite flat amplitude in the absolute sense, then so is $Rf_*(E)$.

Proof. Combine (3.4.1 a) and (3.7.1).

4. Relative perfection

Definition 4.1. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism locally of finite type of schemes, let $E \in \operatorname{ob} D(X)$, and let $[a, b]$ be an interval of $\mathbb{Z}$. We say that E is of perfect amplitude relative to f (or to Y , if there is no ambiguity), contained in $[a, b]$, and write

$$\operatorname{parf.amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b]$$

if E , relative to f , is pseudo-coherent (1.2) and of flat amplitude contained in $[a, b]$ (3.1). We say that f is of perfect amplitude contained in $[-n, 0]$, or of perfect dimension $\leq n$, if $\mathcal{O}_X$ has perfect amplitude contained in $[-n, 0]$. We say that E is of finite perfect amplitude relative to f if such an interval $[a, b]$ exists. We say that E is perfect relative to f if it is locally of finite perfect amplitude relative to f . We say that f is perfect if $\mathcal{O}_X$ is locally of finite perfect amplitude relative to f .

Example 4.1.1. A regular immersion of codimension d (VII 1.4) is of perfect dimension $\leq d$, as follows from the Koszul complex. A morphism locally a complete intersection, i.e. locally the composite of a regular immersion and a smooth morphism, is a perfect morphism.

Notation 4.2. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be locally of finite type. We write

$$D(f)_{\text{parf}}, \quad D(f)_{\text{parf}}, \quad D(f)_{\text{parf}}^-$$

when no confusion is possible, for the full subcategories of $D(X)$ formed by complexes perfect, respectively of finite perfect amplitude, relative to f . By (I 5.3) and (1.4), these are triangulated subcategories of $D(X)$. If X is quasi-compact, the two finite-amplitude/perfect notations coincide in the evident bounded sense.

Proposition 4.3 (cf. I 5.8). Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be locally of finite type, let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$, let $[a, b]$ be an interval of $\mathbb{Z}$, and let $x \in X$, $y = f(x)$. The following conditions are equivalent:

- i) $\text{parf. amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b]$ in a neighbourhood of x ;
- ii) in a neighbourhood of x , E is $(a - 1)$ -pseudo-coherent relative to f , is acyclic outside $[a, b]$, and

$$\text{tor. amp}_{\mathcal{O}_{Y,y}}(E_x) \subset [a, b].$$

Proof. The implication i) $\Rightarrow$ ii) is immediate. For the converse, the question is local around x , and by the definitions one reduces to the case where f is smooth. Then E is $(a - 1)$ -pseudo-coherent near x ; after localizing, one may assume that E is strictly $(a - 1)$ -pseudo-coherent and zero in degrees $> b$. After truncating, one may represent it by a complex with E^i free of finite type for $i > a$, E^a of finite presentation, and zero outside $[a, b]$. By (I 5.1.1), the term in degree a modulo boundaries is flat relative to f near x . Since f is smooth, one embeds locally into an affine space over Y and descends finite presentation and flatness from a noetherian approximation; pseudo-coherence follows from (1.10 a), and the desired perfect-amplitude assertion follows.

Corollary 4.3.1. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be locally of finite type and let E be an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. One has $\text{parf. amp}_f(E) \subset [0, 0]$ if and only if E is flat and of finite presentation relative to f (1.2.1 c). In particular, f is of perfect dimension zero if and only if f is flat and locally of finite presentation.

Corollary 4.3.2. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be locally of finite type, let E be a complex of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules flat and of finite presentation relative to f , and let $[a, b]$ be an interval. If $E^i = 0$ for $i \notin [a, b]$, then $\text{parf. amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b]$. If E is bounded above, then E is pseudo-coherent relative to f .

Proof. This follows from (4.3.1) and from I 4.15 and I 4.8.

Proposition 4.4. Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{i} & X' \\ f \downarrow & \swarrow g & \\ Y & & \end{array}$$

be a commutative triangle of schemes, where i is a closed immersion and g is smooth, and let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$. Then E is perfect relative to f if and only if $i_*(E)$ is perfect in the absolute sense. More precisely, if g has relative dimension $\leq d$, then

$$\begin{aligned} \text{parf. amp}(i_*E) \subset [a, b] &\implies \text{parf. amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b], \\ \text{parf. amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b] &\implies \text{parf. amp}(i_*E) \subset [a - d, b]. \end{aligned}$$

Proof. This is an immediate consequence of (3.6).

Proposition 4.5. Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{f} & Y \\ & \searrow h & \downarrow g \\ & & S \end{array}$$

be a commutative triangle of morphisms locally of finite type, let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$, $F \in \text{ob } D(Y)$, and let $[a, b]$, $[c, d]$ be intervals of $\mathbb{Z}$. Then

$$\text{parf. amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b], \quad \text{parf. amp}_g(F) \subset [c, d] \implies \text{parf. amp}_h(E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} F) \subset [a + c, b + d].$$

In particular, if E is perfect relative to f and F is perfect relative to g , then $E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} F$ is perfect relative to h .

Proof. Combine (1.1) and (3.4).

Corollary 4.5.1. Under the hypotheses of (4.5):

a) if g is of perfect dimension $\leq n$, then

$$\text{parf. amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b] \implies \text{parf. amp}_h(E) \subset [a - n, b];$$

therefore, if g is perfect, E perfect relative to f implies E perfect relative to h ;

b) if f is of perfect dimension $\leq m$, then

$$\text{parf. amp}_g(F) \subset [c, d] \implies \text{parf. amp}_h(Lf^*F) \subset [c - m, d];$$

therefore, if f is perfect, F perfect relative to g implies Lf^*F perfect relative to h .

Remark 4.5.2. With the preceding notation, if g is perfect, E perfect relative to h does not necessarily imply that E is perfect relative to f ; the usual example of a singular point of a scheme over a field already shows this. The following criterion is available.

Proposition 4.6 (criterion of perfection by fibers). Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{f} & Y \\ & \searrow h & \downarrow g \\ & & S \end{array}$$

be a commutative triangle of morphisms of schemes. Suppose that f and h are locally of finite type, and that g is locally of finite presentation and flat. Let $x \in X$, $y = f(x)$, $s = h(x) = g(y)$, and let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$. Let $[a, b]$ be an interval of $\mathbb{Z}$, and let $f_s : X_s \rightarrow Y_s$ be the fiber of f over s , i.e. the morphism obtained from f by the base change $\text{Spec } k(s) \rightarrow S$. Then the following conditions are equivalent:

i) $\text{parf. amp}_h(E) \subset [a, b]$ near x , and

$$\text{tor. amp}_{\mathcal{O}_{Y_s, y}}(E_x \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{Y, y}}^{\mathbf{L}} \mathcal{O}_{Y_s, y}) \subset [a, b];$$

ii) $\text{parf. amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b]$ near x .

Proof. The implication ii) $\Rightarrow$ i) follows because g has perfect dimension zero by (4.3.1), hence (4.5.1 a) gives $\text{parf. amp}_h(E) \subset [a, b]$ near x ; the asserted Tor-amplitude condition follows from (4.3). Conversely, the question is local around x . We may factor f as a closed immersion followed by a smooth morphism. Replacing E by its direct image under the immersion and replacing the smooth factor accordingly does not change the conditions; hence one may suppose f smooth. Since g is perfect of dimension zero and h is perfect by hypothesis, E is pseudo-coherent. After localizing, use (II 2.2.10 b) and (I 2.10 a) to suppose that E is strictly pseudo-coherent, zero in degrees $> b$, and quasi-isomorphic to the truncation

$$t : E \longrightarrow (0 \rightarrow E^a/B^a \rightarrow E^{a+1} \rightarrow \cdots \rightarrow E^b \rightarrow 0).$$

It remains to prove that E^a/B^a is f -flat near x . Let $i : X_s \rightarrow X$ be the canonical map. One has

$$E_x \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{Y,y}}^{\mathbf{L}} \mathcal{O}_{Y_s,y} \simeq i^*(E)_x.$$

Using (3.5.2), the Tor-amplitude hypothesis on the fiber shows that the truncated complex $i^*(t)$ is a quasi-isomorphism, so $i^*(E^a/B^a)_x$ is flat over $\mathcal{O}_{Y_s,y}$. On the other hand, the Tor-amplitude of E relative to h implies that E^a/B^a is h -flat. The usual criterion of flatness by fibers (EGA IV 11.3.10) then gives that E^a/B^a is f -flat near x .

Corollary 4.6.1. Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be locally of finite presentation and flat, let $x \in X$, $s = f(x)$, let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$, and let $[a, b]$ be an interval. If $i_s : X_s = X \times_S \text{Spec } k(s) \rightarrow X$ is the canonical projection and $E_s = Li_s^*E$, then

$$\text{parf. amp}_S(E) \subset [a, b] \text{ near } x, \quad \text{tor. amp}(E_s) \subset [a, b]$$

if and only if

$$\text{parf. amp}(E) \subset [a, b] \text{ near } x.$$

Consequently E is perfect if and only if E is perfect relative to f and E_s is perfect for every $s \in S$.

Proof. Apply (4.6) with $X = Y$ and $f = \text{Id}_X$.

Remark 4.6.2. From (4.6.1) and I 5.10 it follows that, if f is locally of finite presentation, flat, and has regular schemes as fibers, then E perfect relative to f is equivalent to E perfect. This equivalence was already obtained in (4.4) when f is smooth.

Proposition 4.7. Let S be a scheme, and for $i = 1, 2$ let

$$f_i : X_i \longrightarrow Y_i$$

be an S -morphism locally of finite type, with $E_i \in \text{ob } D(X_i)$ and intervals $[a_i, b_i]$. Suppose that X_1 and X_2 , and also Y_1 and Y_2 , are Tor-independent over S . Put $a = a_1 + a_2$, $b = b_1 + b_2$, and $f = f_1 \times_S f_2$. Then:

- a) if $\text{parf. amp}_{f_1}(E_1) \subset [a_1, b_1]$, and if E_2 is pseudo-coherent relative to f_2 and acyclic outside $[a_2, b_2]$, then $E_1 \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} E_2$ is pseudo-coherent relative to f and acyclic outside $[a, b]$;
- b) if $\text{parf. amp}_{f_i}(E_i) \subset [a_i, b_i]$ for $i = 1, 2$, then

$$\text{parf. amp}_f(E_1 \otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}} E_2) \subset [a, b].$$

Proof. Combine (1.9) and (3.5).

Corollary 4.7.1. Under the hypotheses of (4.7), if f_i has perfect dimension $\leq n_i$ for $i = 1, 2$, then f has perfect dimension $\leq n_1 + n_2$. Consequently, if f_1 and f_2 are perfect, then so is f .

Corollary 4.7.2. In a Cartesian square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X' & \xrightarrow{g} & X \\ f' \downarrow & & \downarrow f \\ Y' & \xrightarrow{h} & Y, \end{array}$$

where f is locally of finite type and X and Y' are Tor-independent over Y , one has

$$\text{parf. amp}_f(E) \subset [a, b] \implies \text{parf. amp}_{f'}(Lg^*E) \subset [a, b].$$

Consequently $Lg^* : D^-(X) \rightarrow D^-(X')$ sends $D(f)_{\text{parf}}$, respectively $D(f)_{\text{parf}}$, into the corresponding categories for f' .

Proposition 4.8. Let S be a scheme, let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a proper S -morphism of S -schemes locally of finite type, and let $E \in \text{ob } D^-(X)$. Under the proviso that (2.1) is valid for f (hence at least if S is locally noetherian or if f is projective):

- a) if E is perfect relative to S , then so is $Rf_*(E)$;
- b) if S is quasi-compact, X and Y are of finite type over S , $[a, b]$ is an interval, and N is such that $R^i f_*(M) = 0$ for $i > N$ and every quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module M , then

$$\text{parf. amp}_S(E) \subset [a, b] \implies \text{parf. amp}_S(Rf_* E) \subset [a, b + N].$$

Consequently Rf_* sends perfect complexes relative to S to perfect complexes relative to S .

Proof. Assertion a) follows from b), and b) is obtained by combining (2.1) and (3.7).

Corollary 4.8.1. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be proper and perfect, and let $E \in \text{ob } D^-(X)$. Under the proviso that (2.1) holds for f , if E is perfect then $Rf_*(E)$ is perfect. If moreover Y is quasi-compact, Rf_* sends $D(X)_{\text{parf}}$ to $D(Y)_{\text{parf}}$.

Proof. If E is perfect, then E is perfect relative to f by (4.5.1 a).

Proposition 4.9. Let S be noetherian, let X and Y be S -schemes of finite type, let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a compactifiable S -morphism, i.e. the composite of an open immersion and a proper morphism, and let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$, $F \in \text{ob } D^-(Y)$. If E is perfect relative to f and F is perfect relative to S , then

$$\text{RHom}(E, f^! F)$$

is perfect relative to S .

Proof. The question is local on X . One may suppose that f factors as

$$X \xrightarrow{i} X' \xrightarrow{f'} Y,$$

where i is a closed immersion and f' is smooth. If E is perfect relative to f , then it is perfect relative to i by (4.4); if F is perfect relative to S , then $f'^! F$ is perfect relative to S by (4.5.1 b), since $f'^! F$ is locally isomorphic to $f'^* F$ up to translation. As $f^! = i^! f'^!$, it remains to prove the assertion when f is a closed immersion. Then $f_* E$ is perfect and, by global duality ([H] III 6.7),

$$f_* \text{RHom}(E, f^! F) \simeq \text{RHom}(f_* E, F).$$

Since $f_* E$ is perfect, (I 7.7) gives

$$\text{RHom}(f_* E, F) \simeq (f_* E)^\vee \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} F,$$

and the result follows from (4.5) with the identity morphism on Y .

Corollary 4.9.1. Under the hypotheses of (4.8), if f is perfect, then $f^!$ sends $D(Y)_{\text{parf}}$ into $D(X)_{\text{parf}}$.

Proof. Take $E = \mathcal{O}_X$ in (4.9).

Corollary 4.9.2. Let S be noetherian and let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be compactifiable. Put $K_X = f^!(\mathcal{O}_S)$, and $D_X(\cdot) = \text{RHom}(\cdot, K_X)$. For $E \in \text{ob } D(f)_{\text{parf}}$, one has $D_X(E) \in \text{ob } D(f)_{\text{parf}}$, and the canonical arrow

$$E \longrightarrow D_X D_X(E)$$

is an isomorphism.

Proof. For the first assertion, apply (4.9) with $Y = S$ and $F = \mathcal{O}_S$. For the second, one reduces easily to the case where f is a closed immersion. It is enough then to apply f_* to the canonical arrow. By global duality one has $f_* D_X = D_S f_*$, and one is reduced to ordinary biduality for perfect complexes (I 7.2).

5. Applications: exchange and semi-continuity theorems

Lemma 5.1. Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a commutatively ringed topos, let $\text{Mod}(X)$ be the category of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules, and write $D(X) = D(\text{Mod}(X))$. Let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$ and let $p \in \mathbb{Z}$. Consider the following conditions:

a) the functor $M \mapsto H^p(E \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} M)$ from $\text{Mod}(X)$ to $\text{Mod}(X)$ is right exact;

a' the canonical map

$$H^p(E) \otimes M \longrightarrow H^p(E \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} M)$$

is an isomorphism for all $M \in \text{ob } \text{Mod}(X)$;

b the functor $M \mapsto H^{p+1}(E \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} M)$ is left exact;

b' the canonical map defined below

$$H^{p+1}(E \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} M) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(H^{-p-1}(E^\vee), M)$$

is an isomorphism for all $M \in \text{ob } \text{Mod}(X)$.

Then

$$a \iff a' \iff b \iff b'.$$

If E is pseudo-coherent, then a), a'), b), and b') are equivalent.

The map in b') is obtained as follows. The canonical evaluation arrow $E^\vee \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} E \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X$, tensorized with M , gives an arrow

$$E \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} M \longrightarrow \text{RHom}(E^\vee, M).$$

On H^{p+1} , and then by the canonical map

$$\text{Ext}^{p+1}(E^\vee, M) \rightarrow \text{Hom}(H^{-p-1}(E^\vee), M),$$

one obtains the arrow b').

Proof. The implications $a' \Rightarrow a \Leftrightarrow b \Leftarrow b'$ are formal. To prove $a \Rightarrow a'$, present M by a sequence $M^0 \rightarrow M^1 \rightarrow M \rightarrow 0$ in which M^0 and M^1 are direct sums of sheaves of the form $\mathcal{O}_{U,X}$, with U an object of X . Right exactness and compatibility with direct sums reduce the assertion to $M = \mathcal{O}_{U,X}$. Then both sides are identified with extension by zero from U , and exactness of that extension gives the result.

Assume now that E is pseudo-coherent and prove $b \Rightarrow b'$. It is enough to show that the preceding comparison arrow

$$E \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} M \longrightarrow \text{RHom}(E^\vee, M)$$

is an isomorphism when M is injective. Let $T(F) = F \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} M$ and $T'(F) = \text{RHom}(F^\vee, M)$. Both functors have the same boundedness behaviour under truncation; the arrow is local and is compatible with restriction to opens, and an injective remains injective after such a restriction. After localizing and truncating, one may suppose E strictly perfect. A devissage then reduces to $E = \mathcal{O}_X$, where the assertion is immediate.

Remarks 5.2.

- i) Conditions a), a'), b), and b') are local on the topos: if (X_α) is an open covering of the final object and the condition holds for each X_α and $E|_{X_\alpha}$, then it holds on X .
- ii) If x is a point of X , write a_x, a'_x, b_x , etc. for the corresponding conditions for E_x and $\text{Mod}(\mathcal{O}_{X,x})$. If X has enough points, condition a), respectively a'), b), is equivalent to the corresponding stalkwise condition for every x ; if E is pseudo-coherent, this is also equivalent to b') stalkwise. Moreover, a') may be tested on quotients of modules of the form $\mathcal{O}_{U,x}^{(I)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{U,x}$.
- iii) The criterion EGA III 7.4.2 extends word for word: if E is represented by flat terms, condition a) says that $\text{Coker}(E^p \rightarrow E^{p+1})$ is flat, hence locally a direct factor of a free module of finite type when E^p and E^{p+1} are of finite presentation. In particular, for E perfect, condition a) for degree p is equivalent to the corresponding condition for $E^\vee$ in degree $-p-1$.
- iv) Let X be a quasi-separated scheme and let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$ have locally bounded quasi-coherent cohomology. Let $a_{\text{qcoh}}, a'_{\text{qcoh}}$, etc. be the analogous conditions with $\text{Mod}(X)$ replaced by $\text{Qcoh}(X)$. Then

$$a \Rightarrow a_{\text{qcoh}}, \quad a' \Rightarrow a'_{\text{qcoh}}, \quad b \Rightarrow b_{\text{qcoh}},$$

and these conditions are all equivalent when E is pseudo-coherent. This follows by reducing to affine opens, using II 3.5 and II 2.2.10 a), and the fact that quasi-coherent sheaves extend from affine opens on a quasi-separated scheme.

Proposition 5.3 (exchange property; EGA III 7.7.5 II). Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of quasi-compact and quasi-separated schemes, let $E \in \text{ob } D^-(X)$ have quasi-coherent cohomology and finite flat amplitude relative to f , and let $p \in \mathbb{Z}$. Consider:

a) $M \mapsto R^p f_*(E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} M)$, from $\text{Qcoh}(Y)$ to $\text{Qcoh}(Y)$, is right exact;

a' the canonical arrow

$$R^p f_*(E) \otimes M \longrightarrow R^p f_*(E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} M)$$

is an isomorphism for every $M \in \text{ob } \text{Qcoh}(Y)$;

b) $M \mapsto R^{p+1} f_*(E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} M)$ is left exact;

b' the canonical arrow

$$R^{p+1} f_*(E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} M) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(H^{-p-1}((Rf_*E)^\vee), M)$$

is an isomorphism for every $M \in \text{ob } \text{Qcoh}(Y)$;

c for every base change $Y' \rightarrow Y$, the canonical arrow

$$R^p f_*(E) \otimes_Y \mathcal{O}_{Y'} \longrightarrow H^p(Rf_*E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} \mathcal{O}_{Y'})$$

is an isomorphism.

Then

$$a \Longleftrightarrow a' \Longleftrightarrow c \Longleftrightarrow b \Longleftarrow b'.$$

If, moreover, f is proper, E is pseudo-coherent relative to f (hence perfect relative to f), and (2.1) is valid for f , for instance if f is projective or Y is noetherian, then the preceding conditions are all equivalent.

Proof. The implications among a), a'), b), and b') follow at once from (3.7), (5.1), and (5.2 iv); the implication $b \Rightarrow b'$ in the proper pseudo-coherent case follows from (2.1). It remains to compare a') and c). This is supplied by the following lemma.

Lemma 5.3.1. Let X be a quasi-separated scheme, and let $E \in \text{ob } D^-(X)$ have locally bounded quasi-coherent cohomology. Then condition (5.1 a) is equivalent to:

c) for every $X' \rightarrow X$, the canonical map

$$H^p(E) \otimes_X \mathcal{O}_{X'} \longrightarrow H^p(E \otimes_X^{\mathbf{L}} \mathcal{O}_{X'})$$

is an isomorphism.

If E is pseudo-coherent, condition (5.1 a) also implies that, for every $X' \rightarrow X$, the map

$$H^{-p-1}(E^\vee) \otimes_X \mathcal{O}_{X'} \longrightarrow H^{-p-1}((E \otimes_X^{\mathbf{L}} \mathcal{O}_{X'})^\vee) \quad (5.3.1.1)$$

is an isomorphism.

Proof of the lemma. For $a \Rightarrow c$, localize on X' , and assume $X = \text{Spec } A$, $X' = \text{Spec } A'$, and $E = \tilde{F}$. By the affine case the hypothesis gives

$$H^p(F) \otimes_A A' \longrightarrow H^p(F \otimes_A^{\mathbf{L}} A')$$

an isomorphism, which is exactly c). Conversely, by (5.2 iv) it suffices to prove $c \Rightarrow a'_{\text{qcoh}}$. Again localizing, write $X = \text{Spec } A$, $E = \tilde{F}$, and let $M = \tilde{N}$ be quasi-coherent. Taking $A' = D_A(N)$ and applying c) to $\text{Spec } A' \rightarrow X$ gives the required map

$$H^p(F) \otimes_A N \longrightarrow H^p(F \otimes_A^{\mathbf{L}} N)$$

as an isomorphism.

For the last assertion, the question is local on X' . By (II 2.2.10 b) and truncation, one may suppose E strictly perfect. Then $(E \otimes_X^{\mathbf{L}} \mathcal{O}_{X'})^\vee$ identifies canonically with $E^\vee \otimes_X^{\mathbf{L}} \mathcal{O}_{X'}$, and (5.3.1.1) is the canonical map

$$H^{-p-1}(E^\vee) \otimes_X \mathcal{O}_{X'} \longrightarrow H^{-p-1}(E^\vee \otimes_X^{\mathbf{L}} \mathcal{O}_{X'}). \quad (*)$$

If E satisfies (5.1 a) for p , then by (5.2 iii) $E^\vee$ satisfies the same condition for $-p-1$, and $(*)$ is an isomorphism by the first part of the lemma. The lemma, and therefore (5.3), follow.

Remark 5.3.2. Proposition (5.3) applies in particular when E is a bounded complex of quasi-coherent flat $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules of finite presentation relative to f : by (4.3.2), such a complex has finite perfect amplitude relative to f .

Definition 5.4. Let X be a topos, let $\text{Pt}(X)$ be its set of points (SGA 4 IV 6.1), let M be an ordered set, and let $\varphi : \text{Pt}(X) \rightarrow M$ be a function. We say that φ is upper semi-continuous at x (respectively lower semi-continuous, respectively locally constant) if there exists an x -pointed object U of X such that for every point y of U , one has $\varphi(y) \leq \varphi(x)$ (respectively $\varphi(y) \geq \varphi(x)$, respectively $\varphi(y) = \varphi(x)$). We say that φ is upper semi-continuous (respectively lower semi-continuous, respectively locally constant) if it is so at every point.

Examples 5.4.1.

- a) If $\underline{M}$ is the constant sheaf with value M and $s \in H^0(X, \underline{M})$, then $x \mapsto x^*s$ is locally constant. In particular, if X is locally ringed and E is a perfect complex on X , the rank of E (I 6.11) defines a locally constant function on $\text{Pt}(X)$ with values in $\mathbb{Z}$.

- b) If X is locally ringed and P is an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module of finite type, then for $x \in \text{Pt}(X)$, $P_x \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{X,x}} k(x)$ is a finite-dimensional vector space over $k(x)$, and

$$x \longmapsto \dim_{k(x)}(P_x \otimes k(x))$$

is upper semi-continuous. This is the usual Nakayama argument: an epimorphism $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}^n \rightarrow P_x$ lifts over a pointed neighbourhood.

Lemma 5.5. Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a locally ringed topos, let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$, and let $p \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then:

- i) If E is perfect, the vector spaces

$$H^i(E_x \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{X,x}}^{\mathbf{L}} k(x))$$

are finite-dimensional over $k(x)$, zero except for finitely many i , and the function

$$x \longmapsto \sum_i (-1)^i \dim_{k(x)} H^i(E_x \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{X,x}}^{\mathbf{L}} k(x))$$

is locally constant on $\text{Pt}(X)$.

- ii) If E is $(p-1)$ -pseudo-coherent, then

$$H^p(E_x \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{X,x}}^{\mathbf{L}} k(x))$$

is finite-dimensional over $k(x)$, and its dimension is upper semi-continuous on $\text{Pt}(X)$. If moreover $M \mapsto H^p(E \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} M)$ is exact on $\text{Mod}(X)$, then $H^p(E)$ is locally free of finite type and the preceding function is locally constant.

- iii) If E is p -pseudo-coherent (respectively $(p-1)$ -pseudo-coherent), and if for a point x the functor

$$M \longmapsto H^p(E_x \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{X,x}}^{\mathbf{L}} M)$$

is right exact (respectively left exact) on $\text{Mod}(\mathcal{O}_{X,x})$, then there exists an x -pointed object U such that

$$M \longmapsto H^p(E|_U \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} M)$$

is right exact (respectively left exact) on $\text{Mod}(U)$.

Proof. For i), by I 4.19.1 the complex $E_x \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} k(x)$ is a perfect complex of $k(x)$ -modules; hence its cohomology spaces have finite rank and vanish except for finitely many degrees. The identity

$$\text{rank}(E_x \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} k(x)) = \sum_i (-1)^i \dim_{k(x)} H^i(E_x \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} k(x))$$

follows by devissage from the additivity of rank. The assertion follows from the compatibility of the rank with inverse images (I 6.12).

For ii), after truncation and translation, one may assume for the first assertion that E is strictly perfect, $p = 0$, and $E^i = 0$ for $i \notin [-1, 1]$. Put $E(x) = E_x \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} k(x)$. Then

$$0 = \text{rank}(E(x)) = \dim H^{-1}(E(x)) - \dim H^0(E(x)) + \dim H^1(E(x))$$

up to the corresponding alternating-rank convention; hence upper semi-continuity of $\dim H^0(E(x))$ follows from that of the neighbouring cohomology dimensions and from local constancy of the rank of the terms. For H^1 this is immediate from (5.4.1 b). For H^{-1} , replacing E by the truncated complex $(0 \rightarrow E^{-1} \rightarrow E^0 \rightarrow 0)$ reduces to the same argument.

For the second assertion in ii), after truncating one may suppose E strictly perfect and $E^i = 0$ for $i < p - 1$. Then $Z^{p+1}(E) = \text{Coker}(E^p \rightarrow E^{p+1})$ is of finite presentation and one has an exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow H^p(E) \rightarrow Z^p(E) \rightarrow E^{p+1} \rightarrow Z^{p+1}(E) \rightarrow 0.$$

Exactness of $M \mapsto H^p(E \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} M)$ implies, by (5.2 iii), that $Z^p(E)$ and $Z^{p+1}(E)$ are flat, hence locally free of finite type by I 5.8.3. The exact sequence then shows that $H^p(E)$ is locally free of finite type, and the function $x \mapsto \dim_{k(x)} H^p(E)_x$ is locally constant.

For iii), assume E strictly perfect and zero outside the relevant degrees. Saying that the stalk functor is right exact (respectively left exact) is equivalent, by (5.2 iii), to saying that the corresponding module of cycles $Z^{p+1}(E_x)$ (respectively $Z^p(E_x)$) is flat, hence free of finite type since it is of finite presentation. Because these modules are the stalks of $Z^{p+1}(E)$ and $Z^p(E)$, the usual openness argument (EGA 0_I, 5.2.7) gives an x -pointed object U on which the required cycle module is locally free of finite type. This proves the exactness assertion.

Corollary 5.6 (EGA III 7.6.9). Let X be a scheme, let $p \in \mathbb{Z}$, and let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$ be $(p - 1)$ -pseudo-coherent. Then:

- i) For $x \in X$, $H^p(E \otimes_X^{\mathbf{L}} k(x))$ has finite rank over $k(x)$, and

$$x \longmapsto \dim_{k(x)} H^p(E \otimes_X^{\mathbf{L}} k(x))$$

is constructible and upper semi-continuous on X .

- ii) Suppose X is quasi-separated and E has locally bounded quasi-coherent cohomology. If $M \mapsto H^p(E \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} M)$ is exact on the category of quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules, then the preceding function is locally constant and $H^p(E)$ is locally free of finite type. Conversely, if X is locally noetherian and reduced and that function is locally constant, then the same functor is exact on quasi-coherent modules.

Proof. If X is integral with generic point x , the functor $M \mapsto H^p(E_x \otimes M)$ is exact on $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ -modules, since $\mathcal{O}_{X,x} = k(x)$. By (5.5 iii) there is a non-empty open neighbourhood U of x on which the corresponding functor is exact, and by (5.5 ii) the rank function is locally constant on U . This gives constructibility. The other assertions follow from (5.5 ii, iii) and (5.2 iv), except for the converse in ii), for which one reduces locally and by truncation to the strictly perfect case and applies EGA III 7.6.2 and 7.6.5 to the functor $T_M = H^p(E \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} M)$.

Proposition 5.7 (EGA III 7.7.5 and 7.9.4). Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a proper morphism of quasi-compact schemes, let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)_{\text{parf}}$, and let $p \in \mathbb{Z}$. Assuming (2.1) is valid for f , for instance if f is projective or if Y is noetherian, the following hold:

- i) For $y \in Y$, the vector spaces $H^i(Rf_* E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} k(y))$ are finite-dimensional over $k(y)$, zero except for finitely many i , and their alternating rank is locally constant on Y .

- ii) The function

$$y \longmapsto \dim_{k(y)} H^p(Rf_* E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} k(y))$$

is constructible and upper semi-continuous on Y .

- iii) Suppose Y is quasi-separated. If $M \mapsto R^p f_*(E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} M)$ is exact on the category of quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -modules, then $R^p f_*(E)$ is locally free of finite type and the function in ii) is locally constant. Conversely, if Y is noetherian and reduced and the function in ii) is locally constant, then the same functor is exact on quasi-coherent modules.

Proof. By (4.8), $Rf_*(E)$ is a perfect complex. Assertion i), respectively ii), follows from (5.5 i), respectively (5.6 i). If M is quasi-coherent on Y , the canonical arrow

$$Rf_*(E) \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} M \xrightarrow{\sim} Rf_*(E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} M)$$

is an isomorphism by (3.7), and iii) follows from (5.6 ii).

Remarks 5.8.

- a) In the situation of (5.7), let $i_y : X_y \rightarrow X$ be the inclusion of the fiber over a point $y \in Y$. One may show, under the usual flatness hypotheses, the Künneth formula

$$H^i(Rf_*E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} k(y)) \simeq H^i(X_y, E_y),$$

where $E_y = Li_y^*E$, or $E_y = i_y^*E$ in the flat case.

- b) One can develop for complex analytic spaces a theory analogous to that of this section: exchange, semi-continuity, and continuity properties. Its essential inputs are Grauert's finiteness theorem for proper morphisms and the analytic analogue of the projection formula. More precisely, for a morphism $f : X \rightarrow Y$ of analytic spaces, with X of bounded dimension, and for $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$, $M \in \text{ob } D(Y)_{\text{coh}}$, the canonical arrow

$$Rf_*(E) \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} M \longrightarrow Rf_*(E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} M)$$

is an isomorphism. Unlike Grauert's theorem, this assertion is essentially formal; it follows by the same devissage as in the proof of (3.7), and requires no hypothesis on E beyond belonging to the appropriate derived category.

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Exposé IV. Grothendieck groups of ringed topoi

by L. Illusie

1. Reminders and generalities on Grothendieck groups

1.1. Let C be a triangulated category. Recall that a map f from $\text{ob } C$ to an abelian group G is called *additive* if

$$f(E) = f(E') + f(E'')$$

for every distinguished triangle

$$E' \longrightarrow E \longrightarrow E'' \longrightarrow E'[1].$$

The additive maps from $\text{ob } C$ to G form an abelian group, depending functorially on G . The functor so obtained is represented by an abelian group $k(C)$ and a universal additive map

$$\text{cl}_C : \text{ob } C \longrightarrow k(C),$$

which we shall write simply as cl when no confusion is possible.

The group $k(C)$ depends functorially on C with respect to exact functors. If C, C' are triangulated categories, two isomorphic exact functors from C to C' induce the same homomorphism $k(C) \rightarrow k(C')$; in particular, if $u : C \rightarrow C'$ is an exact equivalence of categories, then $k(u) : k(C) \rightarrow k(C')$ is an isomorphism.

Lemma 1.2. Let C be a triangulated category and let $L \in \text{ob } C$.

a) For every $n \in \mathbb{Z}$,

$$\text{cl}(L[n]) = (-1)^n \text{cl}(L).$$

If L', L'' are objects of C such that $L \simeq L' \oplus L''$, then

$$\text{cl}(L) = \text{cl}(L') + \text{cl}(L'').$$

b) Suppose that there exists $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$\coprod_{i \geq 0} L[2ni]$$

is representable. Then $\text{cl}(L) = 0$.

Proof. Assertion a) follows directly from the definitions. For b), it is enough to observe that

$$\coprod_{i \geq 0} L[2ni] \simeq L \oplus \left(\coprod_{i \geq 0} L[2ni] \right) [2n],$$

and to apply a).

Lemma 1.3. Let C be a triangulated category and let A be a thick subcategory of C ([V] I 2.1). The inclusion and quotient functors define an exact sequence

$$k(A) \longrightarrow k(C) \longrightarrow k(C/A) \longrightarrow 0.$$

Proof. See SGA 5 VIII 3.1.

Lemma 1.4. Let A be an additive category, respectively an abelian category, and let f be an additive function on $\text{ob } K^b(A)$, respectively on $\text{ob } D^b(A)$. For $E \in \text{ob } K^b(A)$, respectively $E \in \text{ob } D^b(A)$, one has

$$f(E) = \sum_i (-1)^i f(E^i),$$

respectively

$$f(E) = \sum_i (-1)^i f(H^i(E)).$$

Proof. Left as an exercise to the reader.

1.5. Let C be an abelian category and let A be a full subcategory of C , stable under finite sums. A map f from $\text{ob } A$ to an abelian group G is called *additive* if

$$\sum_i (-1)^i f(E^i) = 0$$

for every acyclic bounded complex E of C whose components belong to A . When A is stable under kernels of epimorphisms (I 1.2), this amounts to saying that

$$f(L) = f(L') + f(L'')$$

for every exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow L' \longrightarrow L \longrightarrow L'' \longrightarrow 0$$

in C whose terms belong to A . The additive maps from $\text{ob } A$ to G form an abelian group depending functorially on G . Denote by $K^{b,\emptyset}(A)$ the thick subcategory of $K^b(A)$ consisting of acyclic complexes. It follows easily from (1.3) and (1.4) that the map

$$\text{cl}_A : \text{ob } A \longrightarrow k(K^b(A)/K^{b,\emptyset}(A)) \quad (1.5.1)$$

induced by $\text{cl}_{K^b(A)/K^{b,\emptyset}(A)}$ is a universal additive map, i.e. that the pair

$$(k(K^b(A)/K^{b,\emptyset}(A)), \text{cl}_A)$$

represents the functor which associates to each abelian group G the abelian group of additive maps from $\text{ob } A$ to G . We put

$$k(K^b(A)/K^{b,\emptyset}(A)) = k(A), \quad (1.5.2)$$

and write $k(A, C)$ instead of $k(A)$ when it is necessary to avoid ambiguity about the ambient abelian category.¹⁹ In particular, for $A = C$, one has

$$k(D^b(C)) = k(C). \quad (1.5.3)$$

Lemma 1.6. Let C be an abelian category and let A be a thick abelian subcategory, i.e. a full subcategory stable under kernels, cokernels, and extensions. Let $D_A(C)$ be the full subcategory of $D(C)$ formed by the objects E such that $H^i(E) \in \text{ob } A$ for every i . Then $D_A(C)$ is a triangulated subcategory ([V] I 2.3) of $D(C)$, and the canonical functor

$$D^b(A) \longrightarrow D_A^b(C) = D^b(C) \cap D_A(C)$$

induces an isomorphism

$$k(A) \xrightarrow{\sim} k(D_A^b(C)),$$

where $k(A)$ is defined by (1.5.2).

Proof. The first assertion is an immediate consequence of the long exact cohomology sequence. For the second, consider the map

$$f : \text{ob } D_A^b(C) \longrightarrow k(A)$$

defined by

$$f(E) = \sum_i (-1)^i \text{cl}_A(H^i(E)).$$

By the long exact cohomology sequence, f is additive in the sense of (1.1), hence defines a homomorphism

$$\varphi : k(D_A^b(C)) \longrightarrow k(A).$$

It follows at once from (1.4) that φ is inverse to the canonical homomorphism $k(A) \rightarrow k(D_A^b(C))$.

Remark 1.6.1. In the situation of (1.6), the canonical functor

$$D^b(A) \longrightarrow D_A^b(C)$$

¹⁹The notation $k(A)$ had been introduced in I 6.3 for the group $k(K^b(A))$, which is not in general isomorphic to the group defined by (1.5.2). We therefore change convention here: in this exposé the notation $k(A)$ will mean only the group defined by (1.5.2).

is not in general an equivalence of categories. This is shown by the example where S is a scheme, C is the category of $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules, and A is the category of quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules (II App. I 0.3). See, however, the criterion (II 2.1.3).

Definition 1.7. Let C be a triangulated category, respectively an abelian category, and let C' be a subset of $\text{ob } C$. We shall say that C' is an *exact subset* if, for every distinguished triangle

$$E' \longrightarrow E \longrightarrow E'' \longrightarrow E'[1],$$

respectively for every exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow E' \longrightarrow E \longrightarrow E'' \longrightarrow 0,$$

such that two of the terms E', E, E'' belong to C' , the third also belongs to C' . We shall say that C' is *dense* in $\text{ob } C$ if $\text{ob } C$ is the smallest exact subset of $\text{ob } C$ containing C' .

Lemma 1.8. Let C be a triangulated category, respectively an abelian category, and let C' be a dense subset of $\text{ob } C$. Then the elements $\text{cl}_C(E)$, for $E \in C'$, generate $k(C)$.

Proof. Put $C' = C_0$, and for $i \geq 1$ define C_i recursively as the set of objects of C occurring in a distinguished triangle, respectively a short exact sequence, two of whose terms belong to C_{i-1} . The C_i form an increasing filtration of $\text{ob } C$, which is exhaustive by hypothesis. For $i \geq 0$, let $k(C)_i$ be the subgroup of $k(C)$ generated by the elements $\text{cl}_C(E)$, $E \in C_i$. It is immediate from the definitions that $k(C)_i = k(C)_{i+1}$ for every $i \geq 0$, hence $k(C)_i = k(C)_0$. If $x \in k(C)$, one can write $x = \text{cl}(E') - \text{cl}(E'')$ for $E', E'' \in \text{ob } C$ (in the non-respectable case one may even arrange $E'' = 0$). Since the filtration (C_i) is exhaustive, there exists $i \geq 0$ such that E' and E'' belong to C_i ; hence $x \in k(C)_i = k(C)_0$, as required.

Exercise 1.9. Let C be an abelian category and A a full subcategory stable under finite sums, subobjects, and quotients, such that $\text{ob } A$ is dense in $\text{ob } C$. Then the homomorphism

$$k(A, C) \longrightarrow k(C)$$

defined by the additive function $E \mapsto \text{cl}_C(E)$ on $\text{ob } A$ (cf. (1.5)) is an isomorphism.

Hint. Put $A = A_0$, and define A_i , for $i \geq 1$, as the full subcategory of C consisting of objects of C which are extensions of two objects of A_{i-1} . Prove that A_i satisfies the same hypotheses as A , and then prove that the canonical homomorphism

$$\varinjlim_i k(A_i, C) \longrightarrow k(C)$$

is an isomorphism. The desired conclusion follows at once.

2. The functors $K_\bullet$ and K' of a ringed topos

2.1. Let (X, A) be a ringed topos. Recall the following notation:

$$D^b(A_X)_{\text{coh}}$$

is the category of pseudo-coherent complexes with bounded cohomology of left A -modules (I 2.15);

$$D(A_X)_{\text{parf}}$$

is the category of complexes of left A -modules of finite perfect amplitude (I 5.8.4);

$$\text{Loclib}(A_X)$$

is the category of left A -modules locally direct factors of finite free modules (II 2.0);

$$\mathrm{Coh}(A_X)$$

is the category of coherent left A -modules, relative to the category of finite-type free A -modules (I 3.1).

The last two categories are full subcategories of the category $\mathrm{Mod}(A_X)$ of left A -modules, and the first two are full triangulated subcategories of

$$D(A_X) = D(\mathrm{Mod}(A_X)).$$

Definition 2.2. Let (X, A) be a ringed topos. Unless otherwise stated, we shall put

$$K_\bullet(A_X) = k(D^b(A_X)_{\mathrm{coh}}), \quad K'(A_X) = k(D(A_X)_{\mathrm{parf}}),$$

where $k(\)$ is defined in (1.1), and

$$K_\bullet(A_X)_{\mathrm{naif}} = k(\mathrm{Coh}(A_X)), \quad K'(A_X)_{\mathrm{naif}} = k(\mathrm{Loclib}(A_X)),$$

where $k(\)$ is defined by (1.5.2), the ambient abelian category being $\mathrm{Mod}(A_X)$. We say that $K_\bullet(A_X)$, respectively $K'(A_X)$, is the Grothendieck group of pseudo-coherent, respectively perfect, A -module complexes on X , and that $K_\bullet(A_X)_{\mathrm{naif}}$, respectively $K'(A_X)_{\mathrm{naif}}$, is the Grothendieck group of coherent, respectively locally free, left A -modules.

Remarks 2.3.

- a) One can define variants of $K_\bullet(\)$ and $K'(\)$ by putting

$$K_\bullet^{\mathrm{loc}}(A_X) = k(D^{\mathrm{loc}b}(A_X)_{\mathrm{coh}}),$$

where “loc b ” means “with locally bounded cohomology”, and

$$K'_{\mathrm{loc}}(A_X) = k(D(A_X)_{\mathrm{parf}}).$$

These groups coincide with those defined in (2.2) when the final object of X is quasi-compact, but in general they lend themselves less well to computations in intersection theory.

- b) The group $K_\bullet(A_X)_{\mathrm{naif}}$ has practically no interest unless A is coherent as a left A -module; otherwise there is a strong risk that very few coherent sheaves exist.
- c) Considering the k of triangulated categories which are “too large” is of no interest. Thus, from (1.2 b), one immediately deduces the relations

$$k(D(A_X)) = k(D^-(A_X)) = k(D^+(A_X)) = k(D^b(A_X)) = k(D^-(A_X)_{\mathrm{coh}}) = 0,$$

for the last equality observing that $L \in \mathrm{ob} D^-(A_X)_{\mathrm{coh}}$ implies

$$\coprod_{i \geq 0} L[2i] \in \mathrm{ob} D^-(A_X)_{\mathrm{coh}}.$$

2.4. Case of a coherent sheaf of rings. Let (X, A) be a ringed topos, with A assumed coherent as a left A -module (I 3.1 and 3.6). Every coherent left A -module is a pseudo-coherent complex (I 3.5), and one has a fully faithful functor

$$\mathrm{Coh}(A_X) \longrightarrow D^b(A_X)_{\mathrm{coh}}. \quad (2.4.1)$$

Moreover $\text{Coh}(A_X)$ is a thick subcategory of $\text{Mod}(A_X)$ (I 3.4), and, by (I 3.5), $D^b(A_X)_{\text{coh}}$ is the full subcategory of $D^b(A_X)$ formed by the objects L such that $H^i(L) \in \text{ob Coh}(A_X)$ for all i . Consequently, it follows from (1.6) that the homomorphism

$$K_{\bullet}(A_X)_{\text{naif}} \longrightarrow K_{\bullet}(A_X) \quad (2.4.2)$$

defined by (2.4.1) is an isomorphism.

2.5. The homomorphism $K' \rightarrow K_{\bullet}$. Let (X, A) be a ringed topos. The inclusion functor

$$D(A_X)_{\text{parf}} \longrightarrow D^b(A_X)_{\text{coh}}$$

defines a homomorphism

$$K'(A_X) \longrightarrow K_{\bullet}(A_X). \quad (2.5.1)$$

It is not in general injective or surjective. However, assume the following hypotheses:

- (i) the final object of X is quasi-compact;
- (ii) X has enough points, and for every point x of X , every left A_x -module has finite Tor-dimension.

Then, by (I 5.10),

$$D(A_X)_{\text{parf}} = D^b(A_X)_{\text{coh}},$$

and (2.5.1) is an isomorphism. The hypotheses (i) and (ii) are satisfied, for example, by a compact space ringed by regular local rings.

2.6. Pairings between K' and K' in the non-commutative case. Let

$$f : (X', A') \longrightarrow (X, A)$$

be a morphism of ringed topoi, and denote by $\text{Mod}(A', X', A)$ the category of bimodules which are left A' -modules and right $f^{-1}(A)$ -modules. Let

$$\text{Loclib}_A^b(A', X', A)$$

be the full subcategory formed by the objects which belong, as objects over A' , to $\text{Loclib}(A', X')$. By analogy with (2.2), put

$$K'_{\text{naif}}(A', X', A)_{A'} = k(\text{Loclib}_A^b(A', X', A)).$$

Tensor product

$$\otimes_A : \text{Mod}(A', X', A) \times \text{Mod}(A_X) \longrightarrow \text{Mod}(A', X')$$

sends

$$(E', E) \longmapsto E' \otimes_{f^{-1}(A)} f^{-1}(E),$$

and induces a functor

$$\text{Loclib}_A^b(A', X', A) \times \text{Loclib}(A_X) \longrightarrow \text{Loclib}(A', X'). \quad (2.6.1)$$

The map $(E', E) \mapsto \text{cl}(E' \otimes_A E)$ deduced from (2.6.1) is biadditive in the sense of (1.5), and therefore defines a homomorphism

$$K'_{\text{naif}}(A', X', A)_{A'} \otimes K'_{\text{naif}}(A_X) \longrightarrow K'_{\text{naif}}(A', X'). \quad (2.6.2)$$

Let $D^-(A', X', A)$ be the derived category of $\text{Mod}(A', X', A)$, and let

$$D^-(A', X', A)_{A'\text{-parf}}$$

be the full subcategory formed by the complexes of finite perfect amplitude relative to A' , i.e. as objects of $D^-(A', X')$. Put, as in (2.2),

$$K'(A', X', A)_{A'} = k(D^-(A', X', A)_{A'\text{-parf}}).$$

The inclusion functors define evident homomorphisms

$$K'_{\text{naif}}(A', X', A)_{A'} \longrightarrow K'(A', X', A)_{A'}, \quad (2.6.3.1)$$

$$K'_{\text{naif}}(A_X) \longrightarrow K'(A_X), \quad (2.6.3.2)$$

$$K'_{\text{naif}}(A', X') \longrightarrow K'(A', X'). \quad (2.6.3.3)$$

On the other hand, one knows (I 4.18, 4.19) that the derived tensor functor

$$\otimes_A^{\mathbf{L}} : D^-(A', X', A) \times D^-(A_X) \longrightarrow D^-(A', X')$$

induces an exact functor

$$D^-(A', X', A)_{A'\text{-parf}} \times D(A_X)_{\text{parf}} \longrightarrow D(A', X')_{\text{parf}}. \quad (2.6.4)$$

The latter defines a homomorphism

$$K'(A', X', A)_{A'} \otimes K'(A_X) \longrightarrow K'(A', X'). \quad (2.6.5)$$

Since (2.6.1) is induced by (2.6.4), the homomorphisms (2.6.2) and (2.6.5) are compatible with the homomorphisms (2.6.3.1), (2.6.3.2), and (2.6.3.3), in other words one has a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} K'_{\text{naif}}(A', X', A)_{A'} \otimes K'_{\text{naif}}(A_X) & \longrightarrow & K'_{\text{naif}}(A', X') \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ K'(A', X', A)_{A'} \otimes K'(A_X) & \longrightarrow & K'(A', X'), \end{array} \quad (2.6.6)$$

where the upper and lower horizontal arrows are respectively (2.6.2) and (2.6.5), and the vertical arrows are defined by (2.6.3.1), (2.6.3.2), and (2.6.3.3).

2.7. Contravariant law and ring structure on K' . We spell out some important particular cases of the pairings (2.6), although their direct study is immediate.

a) Let

$$f : (X', A') \longrightarrow (X, A)$$

be a morphism of ringed topoi. The functor

$$Lf^* : D^-(A_X) \longrightarrow D^-(A', X')$$

sends $D(A_X)_{\text{parf}}$ to $D(A', X')_{\text{parf}}$ (I 4.19.1), and likewise sends $\text{Loclib}(A_X)$ to $\text{Loclib}(A', X')$. Thus it defines a homomorphism

$$f^* : K'(A_X) \longrightarrow K'(A', X') \quad (2.7.1)$$

and, respectively,

$$f^* : K'(A_X)_{\text{naif}} \longrightarrow K'(A', X')_{\text{naif}}. \quad (2.7.2)$$

This can also be interpreted as multiplication by $\text{cl}(A')$ in (2.6.2), respectively (2.6.5). One has a commutative diagram, a special case of (2.6.6),

$$\begin{array}{ccc} K'(A_X)_{\text{naif}} & \xrightarrow{f^*} & K'(A', X')_{\text{naif}} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ K'(A_X) & \xrightarrow{f^*} & K'(A', X'), \end{array}$$

where the left and right vertical arrows are respectively (2.6.3.2) and (2.6.3.3).

Let $g : (X, A) \rightarrow (X'', A'')$ be a morphism of ringed topoi. The transitivity of inverse-image functors implies that the homomorphisms of type (2.7.1), respectively (2.7.2), satisfy

$$(gf)^* = f^* g^*. \quad (2.7.3)$$

Thus $K'(A_X)$, respectively $K'(A_X)_{\text{naif}}$, is a contravariant functor of (X, A) .

- b) Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a commutatively ringed topos. Thanks to the associativity and commutativity of tensor product, (2.6.5), respectively (2.6.2), with $A = \mathcal{O}_X$, $(X', A') = (X, A)$, and $f = \text{Id}$, endows $K'(X)$, respectively $K'(X)_{\text{naif}}$, with the structure of a commutative ring with unit

$$1 = \text{cl}(\mathcal{O}_X).$$

The canonical homomorphism

$$K'(X)_{\text{naif}} \longrightarrow K'(X)$$

is a homomorphism of unital rings.

If $f : (X, \mathcal{O}_X) \rightarrow (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ is a morphism of commutatively ringed topoi, compatibility of tensor product with inverse image shows that

$$f^* : K'(Y) \longrightarrow K'(X),$$

respectively

$$f^* : K'(Y)_{\text{naif}} \longrightarrow K'(X)_{\text{naif}},$$

is a homomorphism of unital rings.

2.8. Augmentation of K' toward $H^0(\cdot, \mathbb{Z})$. Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a locally ringed topos (I 2.15.1). Recall that one has defined (I 6.11 to 6.14) a homomorphism of unital rings

$$i : H^0(X, \mathbb{Z}) \longrightarrow K'(X)_{\text{naif}},$$

thereby endowing $K'(X)_{\text{naif}}$, and then $K'(X)$ through the canonical homomorphism $K'(X)_{\text{naif}} \rightarrow K'(X)$, with the structure of a unital algebra over $H^0(X, \mathbb{Z})$. Moreover, $K'(X)_{\text{naif}}$, respectively $K'(X)$, is augmented toward $H^0(X, \mathbb{Z})$ by the rank, and the canonical homomorphism $K'(X)_{\text{naif}} \rightarrow K'(X)$ is a homomorphism of augmented algebras.

If $f : (X, \mathcal{O}_X) \rightarrow (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$ is a morphism of locally ringed topoi, the homomorphisms

$$f^* : K'(Y) \longrightarrow K'(X), \quad f^* : K'(Y)_{\text{naif}} \longrightarrow K'(X)_{\text{naif}}$$

are compatible (I 6.12, 6.13) with the preceding augmented-algebra structures; this is expressed by the commutativity of the diagram, where rg denotes the rank,

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} H^0(Y, \mathbb{Z}) & \xrightarrow{i} & K'(Y)_{\text{naif}} & \longrightarrow & K'(Y) & \xrightarrow{\text{rg}} & H^0(Y, \mathbb{Z}) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ H^0(X, \mathbb{Z}) & \xrightarrow{i} & K'(X)_{\text{naif}} & \longrightarrow & K'(X) & \xrightarrow{\text{rg}} & H^0(X, \mathbb{Z}). \end{array}$$

Later in the Seminar (V 3.9.1 and VI) one will see that $K'(X)_{\text{naif}}$ can be endowed with a structure richer than that of an algebra augmented toward $H^0(X, \mathbb{Z})$, namely with a structure of a λ -algebra augmented toward $H^0(X, \mathbb{Z})$, viewed as a binomial ring (V 2.8), this structure being compatible with inverse-image homomorphisms. Deligne has recently proved that $K'(X)$ can be endowed with an analogous structure, at least when X is of characteristic $p \geq 0$, and that the canonical homomorphism

$$K'(X)_{\text{naif}} \longrightarrow K'(X)$$

is a homomorphism of augmented λ -algebras, thereby answering affirmatively a conjecture of Grothendieck (XIV 1).

2.9. Comparison of K' and K'_{naif} . Let (X, A) be a ringed topos. There is in general no reason for the canonical homomorphism

$$K'(X)_{\text{naif}} \longrightarrow K'(X)$$

to be injective or surjective. However, the “global resolution existence criteria” of Exposé II show that it is an isomorphism in the following cases:

- (i) X is the Zariski topos of a separated or noetherian divisorial scheme, and $A = \mathcal{O}_X$ (II 2.2.9);
- (ii) X is the topos defined by a compact space and A is a soft sheaf (II 2.3.2);
- (iii) X is a Stein topos whose final object is quasi-compact and $A = \mathcal{O}_X$ (II 2.4.5).

2.10. Pairing between K' and $K_\bullet$. Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a commutatively ringed topos. One knows (I 5.8.4 b) that there is a pairing

$$\otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X}^{\mathbf{L}} : D(X)_{\text{parf}} \times D^b(X)_{\text{coh}} \longrightarrow D^b(X)_{\text{coh}}.$$

It defines a homomorphism

$$K'(X) \otimes K_\bullet(X) \longrightarrow K_\bullet(X). \quad (2.10.1)$$

Thanks to associativity of tensor product, (2.10.1) endows $K_\bullet(X)$ with the structure of a $K'(X)$ -module. More generally, if

$$f : (X, \mathcal{O}_X) \longrightarrow (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y)$$

is a morphism of commutatively ringed topoi, $K_\bullet(X)$ may be regarded as a $K'(Y)$ -module through the homomorphism

$$f^* : K'(Y) \longrightarrow K'(X).$$

2.11. Covariant law on $K_\bullet$ and projection formula. Let (X, A) be a ringed topos. In contrast with $K'(A_X)$, the group $K_\bullet(A_X)$ has no natural variance with respect to (X, A) . Nevertheless, in algebraic geometry and analytic geometry, $K_\bullet(X)$ tends to be covariant in X for proper morphisms. We now make this precise.

2.11.1. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a proper and pseudo-coherent morphism (III 1.2) of quasi-compact schemes. Then, subject to the validity of the finiteness conjecture for f (III 2.1), hence in particular if Y is noetherian (in which case the pseudo-coherence hypothesis on f is automatically verified (III 1.3)) or if f is projective, the functor Rf_* induces, by (III 2.6), a functor

$$Rf_* : D^b(X)_{\text{coh}} \longrightarrow D^b(Y)_{\text{coh}}.$$

It therefore defines a homomorphism

$$f_* : K_\bullet(X) \longrightarrow K_\bullet(Y). \quad (2.11.1.1)$$

This homomorphism is $K'(Y)$ -linear (cf. (2.10)); in other words, for $y \in K'(Y)$ and $x \in K_\bullet(X)$, one has the *projection formula*

$$f_*(yx) = yf_*(x). \quad (2.11.1.2)$$

Indeed, if $x = \text{cl}(E)$ for $E \in \text{ob } D^b(X)_{\text{coh}}$ and $y = \text{cl}(M)$ for $M \in \text{ob } D(Y)_{\text{parf}}$, then by (III 3.7) one has

$$Rf_*(E) \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} M \simeq Rf_*(E \otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}} M).$$

Finally, if $g : Y \rightarrow Z$ is a proper morphism satisfying the same hypotheses as f , and for which the finiteness conjecture (III 2.1) is true, the transitivity of direct-image functors gives, for the homomorphisms (2.11.1.1), the formula

$$g_*f_* = (gf)_*. \quad (2.11.1.3)$$

2.11.2. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a proper morphism of finite-dimensional analytic spaces. Then, by Grauert's finiteness theorem [2], Rf_* sends $D^b(X)_{\text{coh}}$ into $D^b(Y)_{\text{coh}}$, and hence defines a homomorphism

$$f_* : K_\bullet(X) \longrightarrow K_\bullet(Y). \quad (2.11.2.1)$$

Like its algebraic analogue (2.11.1.1), this homomorphism is $K'(Y)$ -linear; equivalently, formula (2.11.1.2) is valid, as follows from the projection formula at the level of derived categories (III 5.9 b). One also has the transitivity formula (2.11.1.3).

2.11.3. Outside the algebraic or analytic framework, this covariance of $K_\bullet$ for proper morphisms disappears. For instance, let

$$f : X \rightarrow Y$$

be a proper morphism of topological spaces ringed by the sheaves of complex continuous functions. Then, if $E \in \text{ob } D^b(X)_{\text{coh}}$, in general $Rf_*(E)$ need not belong to $D^b(Y)_{\text{coh}}$, as is already evident for $E = \mathcal{O}_X$ and Y reduced to a point. In fact, the definition (2.2) of $K_\bullet$ is especially adapted to the needs of algebraic and analytic geometry, and a good definition of $K_\bullet$ for a topological space remains to be found. It seems, moreover, that one will have to leave the framework of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -linear complexes, and define, for a morphism $f : X \rightarrow Y$ of topological spaces, or of mixed varieties (II App. II), a suitable class of complexes of topological vector-sheaves on X , meant to contain, when f is the structural morphism of a mixed variety, the elliptic complexes on X relative to Y . This is suggested by the finiteness theorem (II App. II), as well as by the analogous theorem, where Y is assumed reduced to a point, proved by Grothendieck in [3].

2.12. Unusual variances of K' and $K_\bullet$. Let

$$f : (X, A) \longrightarrow (Y, B)$$

be a morphism of finite Tor-dimension of ringed topoi (III 3.1). The functor

$$Lf^* : D^-(B_Y) \longrightarrow D^-(A_X)$$

sends $D^b(B_Y)_{\text{coh}}$ into $D^b(A_X)_{\text{coh}}$ (I 2.16.1), and therefore defines a homomorphism

$$f^* : K_\bullet(B_Y) \longrightarrow K_\bullet(A_X). \quad (2.12.1)$$

If A and B are commutative, commutation of inverse image with tensor product shows that (2.12.1) is compatible with the module structures of $K_\bullet(Y)$ and $K_\bullet(X)$ over $K'(Y)$ and $K'(X)$ respectively (2.10). In other words, for $a \in K'(Y)$ and $y \in K_\bullet(Y)$, one has

$$f^*(ay) = af^*(y). \quad (2.12.2)$$

If $g : (Y, B) \rightarrow (Z, C)$ is a morphism of finite Tor-dimension of ringed topoi, transitivity of inverse-image functors implies that the homomorphisms (2.12.1) satisfy

$$f^* g^* = (gf)^*. \quad (2.12.1.1)$$

Now suppose that we are in the situation of (2.11.1), respectively (2.11.2), with f of finite Tor-dimension. Then by (III 4.8.1 and 5.9 b), the functor Rf_* sends $D(X)_{\text{parf}}$ into $D(Y)_{\text{parf}}$, and hence defines a homomorphism

$$f_* : K'(X) \longrightarrow K'(Y). \quad (2.12.3)$$

This is not generally a ring homomorphism. Nevertheless, for $y \in K_\bullet(Y)$, respectively $K'(Y)$, and $x \in K'(X)$, one has

$$f_*(f^*(y)x) = yf_*(x), \quad (2.12.4)$$

where f^* is the homomorphism (2.12.1), respectively (2.7.1). The proof is analogous to that of (2.11.1.2). If $g : Y \rightarrow Z$ is a morphism satisfying the same hypotheses as f , the homomorphisms (2.12.3) satisfy the transitivity formula

$$g_* f_* = (gf)_*. \quad (2.12.3.1)$$

The homomorphism (2.12.3) is one of the essential ingredients of the Riemann–Roch theorem, both in algebraic geometry and in analytic geometry, for the indications in the analytic case see Exposé 0, 5.

Suppose that X and Y are separated and divisorial schemes (II 2.2.5), for example schemes possessing ample invertible sheaves. Then (2.9 (i)) identifies $K'(X)$, respectively $K'(Y)$, with $K'(X)_{\text{naif}}$, respectively $K'(Y)_{\text{naif}}$, and (2.12.3) therefore defines a homomorphism

$$f_* : K'(X)_{\text{naif}} \longrightarrow K'(Y)_{\text{naif}}. \quad (2.12.3')$$

As was already explained in Exposé 0, 3.1, the definition of (2.12.3') was far from evident a priori. In practice, it is precisely one of the main motivations of this Seminar, from Exposé I through Exposé IV.

3. Complements on Grothendieck groups of schemes

The results of this section will not be used in Exposés V to VIII.

Proposition 3.1.0. Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X' & \xrightarrow{g} & X \\ f' \downarrow & & \downarrow f \\ Y' & \xrightarrow{h} & Y \end{array}$$

be a cartesian square of schemes, where Y is quasi-compact and f is quasi-compact and quasi-separated. Let $E \in \text{ob } D^b(X)$ be a complex with quasi-coherent cohomology. Suppose that X and Y' are Tor-independent over Y (III 1.5). Suppose also either that h has finite Tor-dimension, or that E has finite flat amplitude relative to f . Under these conditions, the base-change arrow

$$Lh^* Rf_* E \longrightarrow Rf'_* Lg^* E$$

is defined and is an isomorphism.

Proof. To define the arrow, one uses the trivial duality formula (SGA 4 XVII 2.3) for h , which says that there is a canonical functorial isomorphism

$$\mathrm{Hom}(Lh^*L, M) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{Hom}(L, Rh_*M)$$

for $L \in \mathrm{ob} D^-(Y)$ and $M \in \mathrm{ob} D^+(Y')$. Using (III 3.5.2) and (III 3.7.1), one easily verifies that one may take $L = Rf_*E$ and $M = Rf'_*Lg^*E$, so that applying this formula reduces the problem to defining an arrow

$$Rf_*E \longrightarrow Rf_*Rg_*Lg^*E.$$

For this arrow we take the image under Rf_* of the adjunction map

$$E \longrightarrow Rg_*Lg^*E,$$

which comes from the trivial duality formula for g . The base-change arrow is therefore defined.

It remains to show that it is an isomorphism. For this, one may first suppose that Y and Y' are affine. Then, by the Leray spectral sequence of an open covering of X , one is reduced to the case where X and X' are affine. One thus has a cartesian square of rings

$$\begin{array}{ccc} B & \longrightarrow & B' \\ \uparrow & & \uparrow \\ A & \longrightarrow & A', \end{array}$$

and one may suppose that E is defined by a bounded-above complex of B -modules. The Tor-independence of A' and B over A , written

$$B \otimes_A^{\mathbf{L}} A' \xrightarrow{\sim} B',$$

then implies, in $D(A')$,

$$E \otimes_A^{\mathbf{L}} A' \xrightarrow{\sim} E \otimes_B^{\mathbf{L}} B',$$

which proves the proposition.

Translating (3.1.0) into terms of Grothendieck groups gives:

Proposition 3.1.1. In the cartesian square of schemes

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X' & \xrightarrow{g} & X \\ f' \downarrow & & \downarrow f \\ Y' & \xrightarrow{h} & Y, \end{array}$$

suppose that Y and Y' are quasi-compact, that X and Y' are Tor-independent over Y (III 1.5), that f is proper and pseudo-coherent, and that the finiteness conjecture (III 2.1) is valid for f and f' , for example if Y and Y' are noetherian, or if f is projective. Then, if f is perfect, respectively if h has finite Tor-dimension, for $x \in K'(X)$, respectively $x \in K_\bullet(X)$, one has

$$h^*f_*(x) = f'_*g^*(x),$$

where h^*, g^* are defined by (2.7.1), respectively (2.12.1), and f_*, f'_* by (2.12.3), respectively (2.11.1.1). Notice that by (III 4.7.1) f' is perfect if f is, and by (III 3.5.1) g has finite Tor-dimension if h does.

3.2. Passage to the limit on K'_{naif} and $K_\bullet$. Let $(X_i, f_{ij})_{i \in I}$ be a filtered projective system of quasi-compact and quasi-separated schemes whose transition morphisms are affine (cf. EGA IV 8.2.2). Put

$$X = \varprojlim_i X_i,$$

and let $f_i : X \rightarrow X_i$ denote the canonical morphism.

3.2.1. The homomorphisms (2.7.2)

$$f_i^* : K'(X_i)_{\text{naif}} \longrightarrow K'(X)_{\text{naif}}$$

define, by the transitivity formula (2.7.3), a homomorphism

$$\varinjlim_i K'(X_i)_{\text{naif}} \longrightarrow K'(X)_{\text{naif}}. \quad (3.2.1.1)$$

I say that this homomorphism is an isomorphism. Indeed, let E be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module of finite type. By EGA IV 8.5.2 and 8.5.5, there exists an index i and a locally free $\mathcal{O}_{X_i}$ -module of finite type E_i such that

$$E \simeq f_i^*(E_i).$$

By EGA IV 8.5.2.5, the image of $\text{cl}(E_i)$ in $\varinjlim_i K'(X_i)_{\text{naif}}$ does not depend on the choice of E_i ; denote it by $u(E)$. By EGA IV 8.5.2 and 8.5.6, the map

$$u : \text{ob Loclib}(X) \longrightarrow \varinjlim_i K'(X_i)_{\text{naif}}$$

so defined is additive in the sense of (1.5). It therefore defines a homomorphism

$$K'(X)_{\text{naif}} \longrightarrow \varinjlim_i K'(X_i)_{\text{naif}},$$

and one verifies immediately, using EGA IV 8.5.2, that it is inverse to (3.2.1.1). This proves the assertion.

3.2.2. Likewise one defines a canonical homomorphism

$$\varinjlim_i K'(X_i) \longrightarrow K'(X). \quad (3.2.2.1)$$

Using Deligne's localization technique (SGA 4 XVII), which implies that the category of perfect complexes on X is equivalent to the category

$$\varinjlim_i \text{Parf}(X_i)$$

of the analogous categories of perfect complexes on the X_i , one proves again that (3.2.2.1) is an isomorphism.

3.2.3. Suppose that the X_i , and X , are noetherian, and that the morphisms f_i are flat (then so are the f_{ij}). Then the homomorphisms (2.12.1)

$$f_i^* : K_{\bullet}(X_i) \longrightarrow K_{\bullet}(X)$$

define an isomorphism

$$\varinjlim_i K_{\bullet}(X_i) \xrightarrow{\sim} K_{\bullet}(X).$$

The proof is analogous to that of (3.2.1), using the fact (2.4) that $K_{\bullet}(X) \simeq K_{\bullet}(X)_{\text{naif}}$ is computed in terms of coherent sheaves on X .

Moreover, the module structures of the $K_{\bullet}(X_i)$ over the $K'(X_i)_{\text{naif}}$ are compatible with the inverse images f_{ij}^* by (2.7.1) and (2.12.2). Passing to the limit, one finds that $\varinjlim_i K_{\bullet}(X_i)$ is a module over $\varinjlim_i K'(X_i)_{\text{naif}}$; this is compatible, through the isomorphisms (3.2.1.1) and (3.2.2.1),

with the module structure of $K_\bullet(X)$ over $K'(X)_{\text{naif}}$. In other words, one has a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \varinjlim K'(X_i)_{\text{naif}} \otimes \varinjlim K_\bullet(X_i) & \longrightarrow & \varinjlim K_\bullet(X_i) \\ \sim \downarrow & & \downarrow \sim \\ K'(X)_{\text{naif}} \otimes K_\bullet(X) & \longrightarrow & K_\bullet(X). \end{array}$$

3.3. Relative Grothendieck groups.

3.3.1. Let

$$f : X \longrightarrow Y$$

be a morphism of schemes locally of finite type. Put

$$K'(f) = k(D(f)_{\text{parf}}), \quad K_\bullet(f) = k(D^b(f)_{\text{coh}}),$$

where $D^b(f)_{\text{coh}}$ denotes the category of complexes which are pseudo-coherent relative to f and have bounded cohomology (III 1.2), and $D(f)_{\text{parf}}$ the category of complexes of finite perfect amplitude relative to f (III 4.2). When there is no possible ambiguity, we shall sometimes write $K'(X/Y)$, respectively $K_\bullet(X/Y)$, instead of $K'(f)$, respectively $K_\bullet(f)$.

The groups $K'(f)$ and $K_\bullet(f)$ do not possess the rich structure of their absolute analogues $K'(X)$ and $K_\bullet(X)$, for tensor product does not in general define homomorphisms

$$K'(f) \otimes K'(f) \longrightarrow K'(f), \quad K'(f) \otimes K_\bullet(f) \longrightarrow K_\bullet(f).$$

On the other hand, they satisfy interesting variance properties, which we now review.

3.3.2. Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{f} & Y \\ & \searrow h & \swarrow g \\ & S & \end{array}$$

be a commutative triangle of morphisms locally of finite type of schemes.

3.3.2.1. If g is pseudo-coherent, one has

$$K_\bullet(f) = K_\bullet(h)$$

(III 1.12). If g is smooth and X quasi-compact, one has

$$K'(f) = K'(h)$$

(III 4.4.1).

3.3.2.2. By (III 1.11 and 4.5), the functor $\otimes_Y^{\mathbf{L}}$ defines pairings

$$D(f)_{\text{parf}} \times D^b(g)_{\text{coh}} \longrightarrow D^b(h)_{\text{coh}},$$

$$D(f)_{\text{parf}} \times D(g)_{\text{parf}} \longrightarrow D(h)_{\text{parf}},$$

which induce homomorphisms

$$K'(f) \otimes K_\bullet(g) \longrightarrow K_\bullet(h),$$

$$K'(f) \otimes K'(g) \longrightarrow K'(h).$$

In particular, taking $X = Y$ and $f = \text{Id}$, one deduces that $K_\bullet(g)$ is a $K'(Y)$ -module. On the other hand, if f is perfect, product by

$$\text{cl}(\mathcal{O}_X) \in K'(f)$$

defines $K'(Y)$ -linear homomorphisms

$$f^* : K_\bullet(Y/S) \longrightarrow K_\bullet(X/S),$$

and

$$f^* : K'(Y/S) \longrightarrow K'(X/S).$$

3.3.2.3. Suppose S quasi-compact, X and Y of finite type over S , and f proper. Then, subject to the validity of the finiteness conjecture (III 2.1), in particular if Y is noetherian or if f is projective, the functor Rf_* sends $D^b(h)_{\text{coh}}$ into $D^b(g)_{\text{coh}}$, and therefore defines a homomorphism

$$f_* : K_\bullet(X/S) \longrightarrow K_\bullet(Y/S).$$

If in addition f is perfect, Rf_* sends $D(h)_{\text{parf}}$ into $D(g)_{\text{parf}}$ (III 4.8), and defines a homomorphism

$$f_* : K'(X/S) \longrightarrow K'(Y/S).$$

From the projection formula (III 3.7) one deduces

$$f_*(ax) = af_*(x),$$

for f proper, $a \in K'(S)$, $x \in K_\bullet(X)$, respectively for f proper and perfect, $a \in K_\bullet(S)$, $x \in K'(X/S)$.

3.3.2.4. Suppose S noetherian, X and Y of finite type over S , and f compactifiable and perfect. Then by (III 4.9.1), the functor $f^!$ sends $D(g)_{\text{parf}}$ into $D(h)_{\text{parf}}$, and defines a homomorphism

$$f^! : K'(Y/S) \longrightarrow K'(X/S).$$

3.3.3. Under the hypotheses of (III 4.7), the functor $\otimes_S^{\mathbf{L}}$ defines pairings

$$D(f_1)_{\text{parf}} \times D^b(f_2)_{\text{coh}} \longrightarrow D^b(f)_{\text{coh}},$$

$$D(f_1)_{\text{parf}} \times D(f_2)_{\text{parf}} \longrightarrow D(f)_{\text{parf}},$$

which induce homomorphisms

$$K'(f_1) \otimes K_\bullet(f_2) \longrightarrow K_\bullet(f),$$

$$K'(f_1) \otimes K'(f_2) \longrightarrow K'(f).$$

Of course, for $X_i = Y_i = S$, one recovers the $K'(S)$ -module structure on $K_\bullet(S)$.

If X is flat over S , one deduces, for $n \geq 1$, homomorphisms

$$K'(X/S)^{\otimes n} \longrightarrow K'((X/S)^n),$$

which should, in a sense, replace the absent ring structure on $K'(X/S)$.

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Exposé V. Generalities on λ -rings

by P. Berthelot

The theory of λ -rings is useful whenever one uses rings such as the ring of classes of vector bundles on a ringed site, the representation ring of a group, and so on, for which the exterior-power operations define maps λ^i . We shall use it abundantly later in the Seminar. It is therefore necessary first to develop the general formalism. This exposé is accordingly entirely independent of the rest of the Seminar, and may be useful to users of λ -rings outside algebraic geometry.

The first paragraph essentially gives the theory of Hirzebruch’s “multiplicative sequences of polynomials” (cf. [2]). Besides its generality, the functorial viewpoint adopted here has the advantage of considerably reducing the calculations. The following paragraphs will show how, to every augmented λ -ring, one can associate a “Chern ring” which permits the development of a theory of Chern classes. This is the theory which will allow us to state the Riemann–Roch theorem in the general form of Exposé VIII.

1. Universal polynomials

1.1. Let K be a commutative ring with unit, fixed throughout this paragraph. Let $\mathcal{C}$ denote the category of filtered commutative K -algebras with unit, whose filtration is decreasing and such that the group of elements of filtration zero is the whole algebra. We define on $\mathcal{C}$ a functor with values in the category of abelian groups as follows. If $A \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, associate to A the set of formal series $\psi \in A[[t]]$ satisfying the following conditions: if

$$\psi = a_0 + a_1 t + \cdots + a_n t^n + \cdots ,$$

then

$$a_0 = 1, \quad \forall i \geq 1, \quad a_i \in \text{Fil}^i A. \tag{1.1.1}$$

This set will be denoted $\widehat{G}_K(A)$, or $\widehat{G}(A)$ when no confusion is possible. It is clearly an abelian group for multiplication of formal series, and this defines a functor

$$\widehat{G}_K : K\text{-Alg.fil.} \longrightarrow \text{Ab.}$$

If A has the gross filtration, then $\widehat{G}(A)$ is the group of formal series with augmentation 1, which will also be denoted

$$1 + A[[t]]^+.$$

Lemma 1.2. The functor $\widehat{G}_K$ is representable.

Let $(X_i)_{i \in \mathbb{N}, i \geq 1}$ be a family of indeterminates. Assign to X_i the weight i , and filter the ring $K[X_i]_{i \geq 1}$ by weights with respect to the X_i . One then obtains a bijection

$$\widehat{G}_K(A) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}_{K\text{-Alg.fil.}}(K[X_i]_{i \geq 1}, A)$$

by associating to every series

$$\psi = 1 + a_1 t + \cdots + a_n t^n + \cdots \in \widehat{G}_K(A)$$

the morphism f_ψ determined by $f_\psi(X_i) = a_i$. This homomorphism is compatible with the filtrations, and one thus obtains an isomorphism of functors.

Put

$$\varphi = 1 + X_1 t + \cdots + X_n t^n + \cdots .$$

For every filtered K -algebra A and every series $\psi \in \widehat{G}(A)$, there exists a unique homomorphism

$$f_\psi \in K[X_i]_{i \geq 1} \longrightarrow A$$

such that

$$\widehat{G}(f_\psi)(\varphi) = \psi.$$

1.3. For every $A \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$ we define a filtration on $\widehat{G}(A)$ as follows: a series

$$\psi = 1 + a_1 t + \cdots$$

is said to be of filtration $\geq k$ if $a_i = 0$ for $1 \leq i < k$. Let $F^k \widehat{G}(A)$ be the subgroup so obtained. This is a functor on $\mathcal{C}$, and from now on we shall regard $\widehat{G}$ as a functor with values in the category Abfil of filtered abelian groups by means of this filtration, with $F^0 \widehat{G} = \widehat{G}$.

Let H be a functor on $\mathcal{C}$ with values in Abfil . We shall suppose that H satisfies the following two conditions:

- i) $\forall A \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, $H(A)$ is separated and complete,
- ii) if $A \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$ is a graded K -algebra, with the filtration associated to its grading, and if a finite group G acts on A by graded morphisms, then $H(A^G) \simeq H(A)^G$.

Here $H(A)^G$ denotes the invariants under G .

In fact we shall need these conditions only when A is a polynomial ring and G is a finite product of symmetric groups acting by permutation of the indeterminates.

Examples.

- 1) $H(A) = \widehat{G}(A)$,
- 2) $H(A) = 1 + A[[t]]^+$.

The latter functor will be denoted $\widehat{G}_g$, with g standing for “gross”. Finally,

$$3) \quad H(A) = \widehat{G}_a(A),$$

where $\widehat{G}_a(A)$ denotes the group, for addition, of formal series

$$a = a_0 + a_1 t + \cdots$$

such that $a_0 = 0$ and $a_i \in \text{Fil}^i A$ for $i \geq 1$, endowed with the filtration analogous to that on $\widehat{G}$.

1.4. For every n , denote by f_n the endomorphism of $K[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ defined by

$$f_n(X_i) = X_i \quad (i < n), \quad f_n(X_n) = 0.$$

It factors through the inclusion of $K[X_1, \dots, X_{n-1}]$ in $K[X_1, \dots, X_n]$. Hence the homomorphism

$$H(K[X_1, \dots, X_{n-1}]) \longrightarrow H(K[X_1, \dots, X_n])$$

is injective. This will allow us to identify the first group with a subgroup of the second; similarly, we shall regard $H(K[X_1, \dots, X_n])$ as contained in $H(K[X_i]_{i \geq 1})$.

One should note that f_1 is none other than the augmentation of $K[X]$.

1.5. Embed $K[X_1, \dots, X_n]$ in $K[T_1, \dots, T_n]$ by sending X_i to the i -th elementary symmetric function in the T_j . Let the symmetric group $\mathfrak{S}_n$ act by permutation of the T_j . Using the theorem on symmetric polynomials and (1.3.ii), one sees that the induced homomorphism

$$H(K[X_1, \dots, X_n]) \longrightarrow H(K[T_1, \dots, T_n])$$

is injective, which again permits us to identify the former with a subgroup of the latter:

$$H(K[X_1, \dots, X_n]) \simeq H(K[T_1, \dots, T_n])^{\mathfrak{S}_n} \subset H(K[T_1, \dots, T_n]).$$

Let

$$u_i^n : K[X] \longrightarrow K[T_1, \dots, T_n]$$

be the homomorphism defined by $u_i^n(X) = T_i$, and put

$$u_H^n = \sum_{i=1}^n H(u_i^n) : H(K[X]) \longrightarrow H(K[T_1, \dots, T_n]).$$

The symmetric group permutes the morphisms $H(u_i^n)$, and so leaves u_H^n invariant; thus u_H^n takes its values in

$$H(K[T_1, \dots, T_n])^{\mathfrak{S}_n} \simeq H(K[X_1, \dots, X_n])$$

by (1.3.ii). Notice, finally, that if $H = \widehat{G}$, then

$$u_H^n(1 + Xt) = \prod_{i=1}^n (1 + T_i t) = 1 + X_1 t + \dots + X_n t^n.$$

Theorem 1.6. The map from $\text{Hom}_{\text{Ab fil}}(\widehat{G}, H)$ to $H(K[X])$ which, to a morphism of functors, associates its value on the element $1 + Xt$ of $\widehat{G}(K[X])$, is injective. Its image is the subgroup of $H(K[X])$ formed by the elements θ such that, with the notation of 1.4 for the f_n ,

- i) $H(f_1)(\theta) = 0$,
- ii) $\forall n > 1, \quad H(f_n)(u_H^n(\theta)) \equiv u_H^n(\theta) \pmod{F^n H(K[X_1, \dots, X_n])}$.

First prove injectivity. By Lemma 1.2 it is enough to see that a morphism of functors ξ which is zero on $1 + Xt$ is zero on

$$\varphi = 1 + X_1 t + \dots + X_n t^n + \dots.$$

The commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \widehat{G}(K[X]) & \xrightarrow{u_H^n} & \widehat{G}(K[X_1, \dots, X_n]) \\ \xi \downarrow & & \downarrow \xi \\ H(K[X]) & \xrightarrow{u_H^n} & H(K[X_1, \dots, X_n]) \end{array} \quad (1.6.1)$$

shows that, for every n ,

$$\xi(1 + X_1t + \cdots + X_nt^n) = 0.$$

But

$$\varphi \equiv 1 + X_1t + \cdots + X_nt^n \pmod{F^{n+1}\widehat{G}},$$

hence

$$\xi(\varphi) \equiv \xi(1 + X_1t + \cdots + X_nt^n) \pmod{F^{n+1}H};$$

therefore $\xi(\varphi) \equiv 0 \pmod{F^{n+1}H}$ for every n . Since $H(K[X_i]_{i \geq 1})$ is separated and complete, $\xi(\varphi) = 0$.

Now let ξ be any element of $\text{Hom}(\widehat{G}, H)$, and set

$$\theta = \xi(1 + Xt).$$

We show that θ satisfies conditions i) and ii). First,

$$H(f_1)(\theta) = H(f_1)\xi(1 + Xt) = \xi\widehat{G}(f_1)(1 + Xt) = \xi(1) = 0.$$

Second,

$$u_H^n(\theta) = \xi(1 + \cdots + X_nt^n)$$

by (1.6.1), while

$$1 + \cdots + X_nt^n \equiv 1 + \cdots + X_{n-1}t^{n-1} \pmod{F^n\widehat{G}},$$

and

$$1 + \cdots + X_{n-1}t^{n-1} = \widehat{G}(f_n)(1 + \cdots + X_nt^n).$$

Since $H \circ \widehat{G}(f_n) = H(f_n) \circ \xi$, and since ξ is a morphism of filtered functors, condition ii) follows.

It remains to show that if $\theta \in H(K[X])$ satisfies i) and ii), then there exists $\xi \in \text{Hom}(\widehat{G}, H)$ with

$$\theta = \xi(1 + Xt).$$

First determine the value of ξ on the element $1 + \cdots + X_nt^n$ of $\widehat{G}(K[X_1, \dots, X_n])$. In view of (1.6.1), it must be, by definition,

$$\xi(1 + \cdots + X_nt^n) = \sum_{i=1}^n \xi(1 + T_it),$$

where the $\xi(1 + T_it)$ are known by functoriality from the morphisms u_i^n .

One then glues the $\xi(1 + \cdots + X_nt^n)$, for variable n , by means of the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} K[X_1, \dots, X_n] & \xrightarrow{f_n} & K[X_1, \dots, X_n] \\ \sigma_n \downarrow & & \downarrow \sigma'_n \\ K[T_1, \dots, T_n] & \xrightarrow{f'_n} & K[T_1, \dots, T_n], \end{array} \quad (1.6.2)$$

where f'_n is determined by $f'_n(T_i) = T_i$ if $i < n$, and $f'_n(T_n) = 0$; where σ_n sends X_i to the i -th elementary symmetric function in $T_1, \dots, T_n$; and where σ'_n sends X_i to the i -th elementary symmetric function in $T_1, \dots, T_{n-1}$ for $i < n$, and sends X_n to 0.

Indeed one obtains from this

$$\begin{aligned} H(f_n)(\xi(1 + \cdots + X_nt^n)) &= H(f'_n) \left(\sum_{i=1}^n \xi(1 + T_it) \right) \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^{n-1} \xi(1 + T_it) = \xi(1 + \cdots + X_{n-1}t^{n-1}), \end{aligned}$$

inside $H(K[T_1, \dots, T_{n-1}])$ by the identifications of 1.4. By 1.6.ii the elements $\xi(1 + \dots + X_n t^n)$ define an element ψ of $H(K[X_i]_{i \geq 1})$, since this is a separated complete group. Put

$$\xi(\varphi) = \psi.$$

Finally, if $A \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$ and $x \in \widehat{G}(A)$, define

$$\xi_A(x) = H(f_x)(\psi),$$

where $f_x : K[X_i]_{i \geq 1} \rightarrow A$ is the homomorphism defined in 1.2. Since ξ has already been defined on the elements $1 + \dots + X_n t^n = \varphi_n$, one must verify that the two definitions give the same result, i.e.

$$H(f_{\varphi_n})(\psi) = \xi(1 + \dots + X_n t^n).$$

But for every p one has

$$\psi \equiv \xi(1 + \dots + X_p t^p) \pmod{F^{p+1}H(K[X_i]_{i \geq 1})}.$$

Thus, for $p \geq n$,

$$H(f_{\varphi_n})(\psi) \equiv H(f_{\varphi_n})(\xi(1 + \dots + X_p t^p)) \pmod{F^{p+1}H(K[X_i]_{i \geq 1})}.$$

Using the identifications of 1.4 and the gluing of the $\xi(\varphi_m)$ for variable m , one obtains

$$H(f_{\varphi_n})(\xi(\varphi_p)) = \xi(\varphi_n).$$

Hence finally

$$\forall p \geq n, \quad H(f_{\varphi_n})(\psi) \equiv \xi(1 + \dots + X_n t^n) \pmod{F^p H(K[X_1, \dots, X_n])}.$$

Since H is separated, the required equality follows.

We have thus defined a system of maps

$$\xi_A : \widehat{G}(A) \longrightarrow H(A).$$

To verify that they constitute a morphism of functors with values in groups, one must prove first that, for every morphism $h : A \rightarrow A'$, the square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \widehat{G}(A) & \xrightarrow{\widehat{G}(h)} & \widehat{G}(A') \\ \xi_A \downarrow & & \downarrow \xi_{A'} \\ H(A) & \xrightarrow{H(h)} & H(A') \end{array}$$

is commutative. If $x \in \widehat{G}(A)$, then $h \circ f_x = f_{\widehat{G}(h)(x)}$, whence

$$H(h)(\xi_A(x)) = H(h)H(f_x)(\psi) = H(f_{\widehat{G}(h)(x)})(\psi) = \xi_{A'}(\widehat{G}(h)(x)).$$

It remains only to show that the morphism of functors so constructed is compatible with the structures of filtered groups.

Suppose $x \in F^n \widehat{G}(A)$. To say that x is of filtration $> n$ is to say that $f_x : K[X_i]_{i \geq 1} \rightarrow A$ factors through the endomorphism g_n of $K[X_i]_{i \geq 1}$ defined by

$$g_n(X_i) = 0 \quad (1 \leq i \leq n-1), \quad g_n(X_i) = X_i \quad (i \geq n).$$

To show that ξ is compatible with filtrations, it is enough to show that

$$H(g_n)(\xi(\varphi)) \in F^n H.$$

But by construction

$$\xi(\varphi) \equiv \xi(1 + \cdots + X_{n-1}t^{n-1}) \pmod{F^n H}.$$

Therefore

$$H(g_n)(\xi(\varphi)) = H(g_n)(\xi(1 + \cdots + X_{n-1}t^{n-1})) \equiv 0 \pmod{F^n H}.$$

To verify the additivity of ξ , it suffices to do this for the elements of finite degree of $\widehat{G}(A)$, and then pass to the limit. Let X_1, X_2 be two elements of degree n of $\widehat{G}(A)$, and let X be their product. Consider the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} K[X_1, \dots, X_{2n}] & \xrightarrow{f_X} & A \\ \downarrow & \searrow f'_X & \\ (K[T_1, \dots, T_{2n}])^{\mathfrak{S}_n \times \mathfrak{S}_n} & & \end{array}$$

where the first factor of $\mathfrak{S}_n \times \mathfrak{S}_n$ permutes $T_1, \dots, T_n$ and the second permutes $T_{n+1}, \dots, T_{2n}$. The ring $K[X_1, \dots, X_{2n}]$ is embedded into the ring of invariants by sending X_j to the j -th elementary symmetric function of the T_i ; f' sends the i -th elementary symmetric function of $T_1, \dots, T_n$, respectively of $T_{n+1}, \dots, T_{2n}$, to the i -th coefficient of X_1 , respectively X_2 . Then

$$\begin{aligned} \xi(X) &= H(f'_X) \left(\xi \left(\prod_{i=1}^{2n} (1 + T_i t) \right) \right), \\ \xi(X_1) &= H(f'_X) \left(\xi \left(\prod_{i=1}^n (1 + T_i t) \right) \right), \end{aligned}$$

and similarly for X_2 , using $i = n + 1, \dots, 2n$. Since $H(f'_X)$ is a homomorphism of groups, we are reduced to the case

$$X = \prod_{i=1}^{2n} (1 + T_i t),$$

and in this case the additivity of ξ follows from the definition of the $\xi(1 + X_1 t + \cdots + X_k t^k)$.

1.7. One can generalize the preceding considerations to the case of a product of functors $\widehat{G}$. The functor $(\widehat{G})^k$ is representable by the ring

$$K[X_i^{(j)}]_{j=1, \dots, k; i \geq 1},$$

where $X_i^{(j)}$ has weight i . We denote by $\varphi^{(j)}$ the series

$$1 + X_1^{(j)} t + \cdots + X_n^{(j)} t^n + \cdots.$$

The element $(\varphi^{(j)})_j$ of

$$(\widehat{G}(K[X_i^{(j)}]))^k$$

has the universal property analogous to that of φ (cf. 1.2).

One can introduce the morphisms $f_n^{(j)}$ and $u_H^{n, (j)}$ as above, by repeating the construction for each family $(X_i^{(j)})_{i \geq 1}$ separately. One obtains a result analogous to Theorem 1.6 by considering

morphisms of functors from $(\widehat{G})^k$ to H which are $\mathbb{Z}$ -multilinear and compatible with the filtrations in each of the k arguments separately. They are determined by their value on

$$(1 + X^{(j)}t)_{j=1,\dots,k} \in (\widehat{G}(K[X^{(j)}]_j))^k.$$

An element

$$\theta \in H(K[X^{(j)}]_j)$$

determines such a morphism of functors if and only if it satisfies

$$\begin{aligned} \text{i)} \quad & \forall j, \quad H(f_1^{(j)})(\theta) = 0, \\ \text{ii)} \quad & \forall n, j, \quad H(f_n^{(j)})(u_H^{n,(j)}(\theta)) \equiv u_H^{n,(j)}(\theta) \pmod{F^n H}. \end{aligned}$$

The reader will easily convince himself that, apart from notational complications, it is enough to copy the proof of 1.6.

1.8. Let $\mathcal{C}_0$ be the category of K -algebras, and let

$$i : \mathcal{C}_0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}$$

be the functor which assigns to a K -algebra A the K -algebra A endowed with the gross filtration. Let

$$g : \mathcal{C} \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}_0$$

be the forgetful functor which forgets the filtration. These functors satisfy the following relations:

$$g \circ i = \text{Id}_{\mathcal{C}_0}, \quad \widehat{G} \circ i \circ g = \widehat{G}_g, \quad \widehat{G}_g \circ i \circ g = \widehat{G}_g$$

(cf. 1.3, example 2).

Lemma 1.9. Let $H : \mathcal{C}_0 \rightarrow \text{Ab fil}$ be a functor on $\mathcal{C}_0$. Then the canonical homomorphism

$$\text{Hom}_{\text{Ab fil}}(\widehat{G}, H \circ g) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}_{\text{Ab fil}}(\widehat{G} \circ i, H)$$

is an isomorphism.

To see that it is injective, one uses the sequence of canonical homomorphisms

$$\text{Hom}(\widehat{G}, H \circ g) \rightarrow \text{Hom}(\widehat{G} \circ i, H) \rightarrow \text{Hom}(\widehat{G}_g, H \circ g) \rightarrow \text{Hom}(\widehat{G}, H \circ g),$$

the last arrow coming from the fact that $\widehat{G}$ is a subfunctor of $\widehat{G}_g$. To verify that the composite is the identity, observe that a morphism of functors

$$\xi : \widehat{G} \longrightarrow H \circ g$$

is determined by its values on objects of $\mathcal{C}$ whose filtration is gross. Indeed, if $A \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, and if A_g is A endowed with the gross filtration, the canonical morphism $A \rightarrow A_g$ defines a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \widehat{G}(A) & \xrightarrow{\xi_A} & (H \circ g)(A) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \widehat{G}(A_g) & \xrightarrow{\xi_{A_g}} & (H \circ g)(A_g), \end{array}$$

which shows that ξ_A is the restriction of ξ_{A_g} to $\widehat{G}(A)$.

Next consider the composite homomorphism

$$\text{Hom}(\widehat{G} \circ i, H) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(\widehat{G}_g, H \circ g) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(\widehat{G}, H \circ g) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(\widehat{G} \circ i, H).$$

It is clear that this is the identity, whence the asserted result.

Theorem 1.10. Let H be a functor on the category $\mathcal{C}_0$ of K -algebras, with values in the category of separated complete filtered abelian groups, and commuting with invariants under a finite group. Then the map from

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Ab\,fil}}(\widehat{G} \circ i, H)$$

to $H(K[X])$ which, to a morphism of functors, associates its value on the element $1 + Xt$ of $\widehat{G} \circ i(K[X])$, is injective. Its image is the subgroup of $H(K[X])$ formed by the elements θ such that, with notation analogous to that of 1.4 and 1.5,

- i) $H(f_1)(\theta) = 0$,
- ii) $\forall n > 1, \quad H(f_n)(u_H^n(\theta)) \equiv u_H^n(\theta) \pmod{F^n H(K[X_1, \dots, X_n])}$.

The theorem follows immediately from Theorem 1.6 and Lemma 1.9, since $H \circ g(K[X])$ does not depend on the chosen filtration on $K[X]$.

The analogous theorem obtained by replacing $\widehat{G}$ by $(\widehat{G})^k$ is also true (cf. 1.7).

When there is no risk of confusion, we write the functor $\widehat{G} \circ i$ simply as $\widehat{G}$. This is legitimate because i identifies $\mathcal{C}_0$ with a subcategory of $\mathcal{C}$.

1.11. Let $\mathcal{C}_g$ denote the category of graded K -algebras, and let

$$j : \mathcal{C}_g \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}$$

be the functor which assigns to a graded K -algebra B the K -algebra B endowed with the filtration canonically defined by its grading. The associated graded functor

$$\mathrm{Gr} : \mathcal{C} \longrightarrow \mathcal{C}_g$$

will be denoted Gr . There is an isomorphism of functors

$$\varepsilon : \mathrm{Id}_{\mathcal{C}_g} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{Gr} \circ j.$$

If $B \in \mathrm{Ob}(\mathcal{C}_g)$, denote by

$$1 + \widehat{B}^+$$

the multiplicative group of elements of

$$\prod_{i=0}^{\infty} B^i$$

having augmentation 1. With the filtration analogous to that on $\widehat{G}$, one obtains a functor

$$\mathcal{C}_g \longrightarrow \mathrm{Ab\,fil}.$$

Furthermore, for every $A \in \mathrm{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, one defines a homomorphism of filtered groups

$$\widehat{G}(A) \longrightarrow 1 + \widehat{\mathrm{Gr} A}^+$$

by sending the series $1 + \dots + a_n t^n + \dots$ to the series $1 + \dots + \bar{a}_n + \dots$, where $\bar{a}_n$ is the class of a_n in $\mathrm{Gr}^n A$. Its kernel is the group $\widehat{G}'(A)$ of formal series such that

$$a_0 = 1, \quad \forall i \geq 1, \quad a_i \in \mathrm{Fil}^{i+1} A.$$

Thus one has a functorial isomorphism in A :

$$\widehat{G}(A)/\widehat{G}'(A) \xrightarrow{\sim} 1 + \widehat{\mathrm{Gr} A}^+.$$

Lemma 1.12. Let $H : \mathcal{C}_g \rightarrow \text{Ab fil}$ be a functor on $\mathcal{C}_g$. Then the canonical homomorphism

$$\rho : \text{Hom}_{\text{Ab fil}}(1 + \hat{\cdot}^+, H) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}_{\text{Ab fil}}(\widehat{G}, H \circ \text{Gr})$$

is an isomorphism.

The homomorphism ρ is defined as the composite

$$\text{Hom}(1 + \hat{\cdot}^+, H) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(1 + \widehat{\text{Gr}(\cdot)}^+, H \circ \text{Gr}) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(\widehat{G}, H \circ \text{Gr}),$$

the last arrow being defined by the homomorphism

$$\widehat{G} \longrightarrow 1 + \widehat{\text{Gr}(\cdot)}^+.$$

We construct an inverse morphism

$$\rho' : \text{Hom}(\widehat{G}, H \circ \text{Gr}) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(1 + \hat{\cdot}^+, H).$$

For this, we show that every morphism of functors from $\widehat{G}$ to $H \circ \text{Gr}$ factors through the canonical morphism

$$\widehat{G} \longrightarrow 1 + \widehat{\text{Gr}(\cdot)}^+.$$

Equivalently, it suffices to show that it vanishes on $\widehat{G}'$, by 1.11. Let $A \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$ and let $x \in \widehat{G}'(A)$. Define a homomorphism of filtered K -algebras

$$K[X_i]_{i \geq 1} \longrightarrow A$$

by sending X_1 to 0 and X_i to the $(i-1)$ -st coefficient of x for $i > 1$. Using this homomorphism, it is enough to verify that the morphism of functors considered vanishes on the element

$$1 + X_2 t + \cdots + X_{n+1} t^n + \cdots.$$

Use the endomorphism f of $K[X_i]_{i \geq 1}$ defined by

$$f(X_i) = X_{i+1} \quad \text{for all } i,$$

and the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \widehat{G}(K[X_i]) & \longrightarrow & (H \circ \text{Gr})(K[X_i]) \\ \widehat{G}(f) \downarrow & & \downarrow H(\text{Gr}(f)) \\ \widehat{G}(K[X_i]) & \longrightarrow & (H \circ \text{Gr})(K[X_i]). \end{array}$$

Now $\text{Gr}(f) = \text{Gr}(f_1)$, where f_1 is the augmentation homomorphism of $K[X_i]_{i \geq 1}$. Since the latter annihilates φ , the analogous diagram written for f_1 shows that $H(\text{Gr}(f))$ annihilates the image of φ in $H \circ \text{Gr}(K[X_i]_{i \geq 1})$, and the result follows.

Passing to the quotient, one associates to every morphism of functors

$$\widehat{G} \longrightarrow H \circ \text{Gr}$$

a morphism of functors

$$1 + \widehat{\text{Gr}}^+ \longrightarrow H \circ \text{Gr}.$$

By composing with j and using the isomorphism ε , one obtains a morphism

$$1 + \hat{\cdot}^+ \longrightarrow H,$$

which defines the desired homomorphism ρ' . It is immediate to verify that ρ and ρ' are inverses of one another.

Theorem 1.13. Let H be a functor on $\mathcal{C}_g$, with values in the category of separated complete filtered abelian groups, and commuting with invariants under a finite group. Then the map from

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Ab\,fil}}(1 + \hat{\cdot}^+, H)$$

to $H(K[X])$, which to a morphism of functors associates its value on the element $1 + X$ of $1 + \widehat{K[X]}^+$, is injective. Its image is the subgroup of $H(K[X])$ formed by the elements θ such that, with notation as in 1.4 and 1.5,

- i) $H(f_1)(\theta) = 0$,
- ii) $\forall n > 1, \quad H(f_n)(u_H^n(\theta)) \equiv u_H^n(\theta) \pmod{F^n H(K[X_1, \dots, X_n])}$.

This is immediate from 1.6 and 1.12. There is an analogous statement replacing $\hat{G}$ by $(\hat{G})^k$.

Remark 1.14. If H is a functor on $\mathcal{C}_g$, with values in abelian groups, commuting with invariants under a finite group, and satisfying the condition

$$\forall B \in \mathrm{Ob}(\mathcal{C}_g), \quad H(B) \simeq \varprojlim_n H(B/B^{\geq n}), \quad B^{\geq n} = \prod_{i \geq n} B^i,$$

then condition ii) of 1.13 is always satisfied if one takes for the filtration on H the filtration by the kernels of

$$H(B) \longrightarrow H(B/B^{\geq n}),$$

which is separated and complete. Indeed, if p_n is the canonical homomorphism

$$K[X_1, \dots, X_n] \longrightarrow K[X_1, \dots, X_n]/K[X_1, \dots, X_n]^{\geq n},$$

then

$$p_n \circ f_n = p_n,$$

and hence

$$H(p_n)[H(f_n) \circ u_H^n(\theta) - u_H^n(\theta)] = 0.$$

This says precisely that

$$H(f_n) \circ u_H^n(\theta) - u_H^n(\theta) \in F^n H(K[X_1, \dots, X_n]).$$

Thus, in order to give a morphism of functors from $1 + \hat{\cdot}^+$ to H , it is enough to give an element of $H(K[X])$ satisfying only condition i) of 1.13.

1.15. Let $H : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathrm{Ab\,fil}$ (respectively $\mathcal{C}_0 \rightarrow \mathrm{Ab\,fil}$, $\mathcal{C}_g \rightarrow \mathrm{Ab\,fil}$) be a functor satisfying the conditions of 1.3 (respectively 1.10, 1.13), and let

$$\xi : (\hat{G})^k \rightarrow H$$

(respectively $(\hat{G} \circ i)^k \rightarrow H$, $(1 + \hat{\cdot}^+)^k \rightarrow H$) be a morphism of functors. We have seen in 1.7 that ξ is determined by its value on the element

$$(\varphi^{(j)})_{j=1, \dots, k}$$

of

$$(\hat{G}(K[X_i^{(j)}]_{j=1, \dots, k; i \geq 1}))^k$$

(respectively similarly). Suppose H is one of the functors

$$\widehat{G}, \quad \widehat{G}_g, \quad \widehat{G}_a, \quad 1 + \widehat{\text{Gr}}^+, \quad \text{etc.}$$

Then the element $\xi((\varphi^{(j)}))$ is a formal series with coefficients in

$$K[X_i^{(j)}]_{i \geq 1, j=1, \dots, k}.$$

The n -th coefficient of this series is called the n -th universal polynomial of ξ . The knowledge of these polynomials is equivalent to the knowledge of ξ .

According to the proof of 1.6, these polynomials are themselves determined by the element

$$\xi(1 + X^{(1)}t, \dots, 1 + X^{(k)}t).$$

The calculation is performed by the method of the proof: one computes the elements

$$\xi(1 + X_1^{(1)}t + \dots + X_n^{(1)}t^n, \dots, 1 + X_1^{(k)}t + \dots + X_n^{(k)}t^n),$$

by decomposing

$$1 + X_1^{(1)}t + \dots + X_n^{(1)}t^n = \prod_{j=1}^n (1 + T_j^{(1)}t)$$

and by using the additivity of ξ . The polynomials thus obtained are symmetric with respect to the $T_j^{(i)}$, for fixed i and variable j , and can be expressed as functions of the $X_j^{(i)}$. Gluing by means of the filtration of H , one thus determines the universal polynomials of ξ . If

$$(\psi^{(1)}, \dots, \psi^{(k)}) \in (\widehat{G}(A))^k,$$

the calculation of $\xi(\psi^{(1)}, \dots, \psi^{(k)})$ is made by substituting the coefficients of the $\psi^{(i)}$ for the $X_j^{(i)}$ in the universal polynomials.

Suppose that there exists an integer m such that the coefficient of t^n in

$$\theta = \xi(1 + X^{(1)}t, \dots, 1 + X^{(k)}t)$$

is a polynomial whose isobaric components have weights between n and m . Then the k -th universal polynomial of ξ has isobaric components whose weights range between k and km . This follows immediately from the calculation just described and from the theorem on symmetric functions.

In particular, if $H = \widehat{G}$, then the n -th universal polynomial of ξ has no component of weight $< n$. Now consider the canonical morphism

$$H \longrightarrow 1 + \widehat{\text{Gr}}^+.$$

Composing it with ξ gives a morphism

$$(\widehat{G})^k \longrightarrow 1 + \widehat{\text{Gr}}^+,$$

which, by the proof of 1.12, factors through

$$(1 + \widehat{\text{Gr}}^+)^k$$

and defines a morphism

$$\bar{\xi} : (1 + \widehat{\cdot}^+)^k \longrightarrow 1 + \widehat{\cdot}^+.$$

One sees at once that the n -th universal polynomial of $\bar{\xi}$ is the same as that of

$$(\widehat{G})^k \longrightarrow 1 + \widehat{\text{Gr}}^+,$$

that is, the isobaric component of weight n of the n -th universal polynomial of ξ .

The same remarks apply to the case $H = \widehat{G}_a$. Then one may define a morphism of functors

$$H \longrightarrow \widehat{\text{Gr}}^+$$

analogously to 1.11, by putting

$$\widehat{B}^+ = \prod_{i \geq 1} B^i$$

for a graded algebra B ; one repeats the same reasoning and reaches the conclusions of the preceding paragraph.

1.16. We finish with an example. Suppose $K = \mathbb{Q}$. Define an endomorphism of the functor $1 + \hat{\cdot}^+$, denoted Todd and called the Todd character, by putting

$$\text{Todd}(1 + X) = \frac{X}{1 - e^{-X}}.$$

The conditions i) and ii) of Theorem 1.13 are immediately verified, which shows that an endomorphism of $1 + \hat{\cdot}^+$ has indeed been defined.

2. Definition of λ -rings; examples

In this paragraph the base ring of paragraph 1 will be $\mathbb{Z}$, except in 2.9. We place ourselves in the category $\mathcal{C}_0$ of 1.8, and write $\widehat{G}$ for the restriction of $\widehat{G}$ to $\mathcal{C}_0$, as in 1.10.

Definition 2.1. A *pre- λ -ring* is a commutative ring K with unit, endowed with a homomorphism of abelian groups

$$\lambda_t : K \longrightarrow 1 + K[[t]]^+$$

such that, for every $x \in K$,

$$\lambda_t(x) = 1 + xt + \cdots.$$

We shall write

$$\lambda_t(x) = \sum_{i \geq 0} \lambda^i(x) t^i.$$

Thus giving a pre- λ -ring structure on a ring K is equivalent to giving a family of maps

$$\lambda^i : K \longrightarrow K \quad (i \in \mathbb{N})$$

such that

- i) $\forall x \in K, \quad \lambda^0(x) = 1,$
- ii) $\forall x \in K, \quad \lambda^1(x) = x,$
- iii) $\forall x, y \in K, \forall n \in \mathbb{N}, \quad \lambda^n(x + y) = \sum_{p+q=n} \lambda^p(x) \lambda^q(y).$

If K, K' are two pre- λ -rings and $f : K \rightarrow K'$ is a ring homomorphism, we say that f is a homomorphism of pre- λ -rings, or a λ -homomorphism, if the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} K & \xrightarrow{\lambda_t} & 1 + K[[t]]^+ \\ f \downarrow & & \downarrow \widehat{G}(f) \\ K' & \xrightarrow{\lambda_t} & 1 + K'[[t]]^+ \end{array}$$

is commutative. This is equivalent to the relations

$$\forall x \in K, \forall i \in \mathbb{N}, \quad \lambda^i(f(x)) = f(\lambda^i(x)).$$

Examples 2.2.

- a) One can give all pre- λ -ring structures on $\mathbb{Z}$. It is enough to give $\lambda_t(1)$, which is then a formal series with integral coefficients subject to the sole condition that it begin with $1 + t$.
- b) Let (T, A) be a commutatively ringed topos, and let K be the “Grothendieck group” of A -modules locally isomorphic to a direct factor of a free A -module of finite type. We know that K can be given a ring structure by the tensor product (Exposé IV), and we now endow it with a pre- λ -ring structure as follows. For every A -module E locally a direct factor of a free module of finite type, let $\lambda^i(E)$ denote the class in K of the i -th exterior power of E , which is again locally a direct factor of a free module of finite type. This defines a function from the category of such A -modules to the abelian group $1 + K[[t]]^+$. It remains to show that this function is additive, which will imply that it factors through K and hence gives the desired structure.

Lemma 2.2.1. Let

$$0 \longrightarrow E' \xrightarrow{u} E \xrightarrow{v} E'' \longrightarrow 0$$

be an exact sequence of A -modules which is locally split, for example with E'' locally a direct factor of a free module of finite type. There exists on $\Lambda^n(E)$ a finite filtration and isomorphisms

$$\Lambda^{n-p}(E') \otimes_A \Lambda^p(E'') \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Gr}^p \Lambda^n(E).$$

Take for $F^p \Lambda^n(E)$ the image of the canonical morphism

$$\Lambda^{n-p}(E') \otimes_A \Lambda^p(E) \longrightarrow \Lambda^n(E) \quad (0 \leq p \leq n).$$

If $p > n$, put $F^p \Lambda^n(E) = \Lambda^n(E)$, and if $p < 0$, put $F^p \Lambda^n(E) = 0$. This does indeed define a finite filtration on $\Lambda^n(E)$.

Define a homomorphism

$$f_p : \Lambda^{n-p}(E') \otimes_A \Lambda^p(E'') \longrightarrow F^p \Lambda^n(E) / F^{p-1} \Lambda^n(E)$$

by

$$f_p(x'_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge x'_{n-p} \otimes x''_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge x''_p) = \text{cl}(u(x'_1) \wedge \cdots \wedge u(x'_{n-p}) \wedge x_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge x_p),$$

where the x_i are lifts in E of the x''_i in E'' . This visibly does not depend on the choice of the x_i . If the exact sequence is locally split, then f_p is an isomorphism, since locally

$$\Lambda^n(E) \simeq \bigoplus_{p+q=n} \Lambda^p(E') \otimes_A \Lambda^q(E'').$$

When E', E, E'' are locally direct factors of free modules of finite type, the $\text{Gr}^p \Lambda^n(E)$ are locally direct factors of free modules of finite type, and hence so are the $F^p \Lambda^n(E)$. Thus one may write in K

$$\lambda^n(E) = \sum_{p=0}^n \text{cl}(\text{Gr}^p \Lambda^n(E)) = \sum_{p=0}^n \lambda^{n-p}(E') \lambda^p(E''),$$

which gives the required additivity.

Let (T, A) and (T', A') be two commutatively ringed topoi, and let

$$f : (T, A) \longrightarrow (T', A')$$

be a morphism of ringed topoi. We know (Exposé IV, 2.7) that f defines a morphism of rings on the corresponding K 's, namely

$$f^* : K_{\text{naif}}^*(T', A') \longrightarrow K_{\text{naif}}^*(T, A).$$

Since inverse image commutes with exterior powers, the corresponding morphism f^* on K is a λ -homomorphism for the structure just defined.

We point out two special cases:

- If X is a scheme, then $K_{\text{naif}}^*(X)$ is thus endowed with a pre- λ -ring structure. This is the case which will be used later in the Seminar, and it may be regarded as the model for the general theory of λ -rings.
- If A is a ring, $X = \text{Spec } A$, and G is a group acting trivially on A , then, taking for (T, A) the topos of sheaves of sets on X on which G acts, the ring K thus obtained is the representation ring of G in the projective A -modules of finite type.

2.3. Let K be a commutative ring with unit. We propose to endow the abelian group

$$\widehat{G}(K) = 1 + K[[t]]^+$$

with a pre- λ -ring structure, functorially in K . To this end, we apply the results of 1.10 to the functor $\widehat{G}$.

First define multiplication by giving a $\mathbb{Z}$ -bilinear morphism of functors

$$\widehat{G} \times \widehat{G} \longrightarrow \widehat{G}$$

through the element $1 + XYt$ of $\widehat{G}(\mathbb{Z}[X, Y])$. This element satisfies 1.7.i; to see that it satisfies 1.7.ii, one must show that in

$$\prod_{i=1}^n (1 + T_i Y t),$$

when expressed by means of the elementary symmetric functions X_j in the T_i , the variable X_n does not occur in the coefficients of t^k for $k < n$. This is evident by degree considerations.

The law so defined will be denoted by the sign $\circ$. Thus, by definition,

$$(1 + Xt) \circ (1 + Yt) = 1 + XYt. \quad (2.3.1)$$

It is distributive by construction, and it is associative and commutative by the diagrams

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \widehat{G} \times \widehat{G} \times \widehat{G} & \longrightarrow & \widehat{G} \times \widehat{G} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \widehat{G} \times \widehat{G} & \longrightarrow & \widehat{G} \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{ccc} \widehat{G} \times \widehat{G} & \longrightarrow & \widehat{G} \times \widehat{G} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \widehat{G} & \xrightarrow{\text{Id}} & \widehat{G}, \end{array}$$

where the meaning of the arrows is evident, and where it is enough to verify commutativity on the elements $1 + Xt, 1 + Yt, 1 + Zt$, respectively $1 + Xt, 1 + Xt$, of $\widehat{G}(\mathbb{Z}[X, Y, Z])$, respectively $\widehat{G}(\mathbb{Z}[X, Y])$, by 1.10; this verification is immediate.

By 1.8, the product under this law of two series is calculated by substituting their coefficients into the universal polynomials of the law. The n -th universal polynomial will be denoted P_n . It is a polynomial in

$$\mathbb{Z}[X_i, Y_j]_{1 \leq i, j \leq n}$$

which is isobaric of weight n with respect to each of the two groups of variables (see 1.15), and symmetric with respect to these two groups. For example,

$$P_2(X_1, X_2; Y_1, Y_2) = X_2 Y_1^2 + Y_2 X_1^2 - 2X_2 Y_2.$$

One also has the following relation: if $K \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C}_0)$, $\psi \in \widehat{G}(K)$, and $a \in K$, then

$$\psi(t) \circ (1 + at) = \psi(at). \quad (2.3.2)$$

As usual, by the standard functorial argument this reduces to the case $K = \mathbb{Z}[X, Y]$, $\psi = 1 + Xt$, $a = Y$, where it is nothing other than (2.3.1).

Applying (2.3.2) to $\widehat{G}(K) = 1 + K[[t]]^+$ with $a = 1$, one sees that $1 + t$ is the unit for this multiplication. To avoid confusion, we sometimes denote it by 1, or by $1_\circ$.

The functor $\widehat{G}$ can now be considered as a functor from $\mathcal{C}_0$ to the category of commutative rings with unit, and hence can be composed with itself. To avoid confusion, choose different indeterminates for each of the two factors in the product of $\widehat{G}$ with itself; we indicate the indeterminate by an exponent when necessary:

$$\widehat{G}^t, \quad \widehat{G}^u, \quad \text{etc.}$$

For $A \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C}_0)$ one has

$$\widehat{G}^u \circ \widehat{G}^t(A) = 1 + \{1 + A[[t]]^+\}[[u]]^+.$$

To define the operations λ^i on $1 + K[[t]]^+$, we are therefore going to give a morphism of functors

$$\widehat{G} \longrightarrow \widehat{G}^u \circ \widehat{G}^t.$$

For this, one must first define a filtration of the functor $\widehat{G}^u \circ \widehat{G}^t$ which permits the gluing of 1.6.

First note that $F^k \widehat{G}$ is an ideal for the law $\circ$. For this follows, for the product

$$\left(1 + \sum_{i \geq k} X_i t^i\right) \circ (1 + Yt),$$

by reducing by functoriality to the case $A = \mathbb{Z}[X_i, Y]_{i \geq 1}$, and using (2.3.2). Therefore $F^n(\widehat{G}^u \circ \widehat{G}^t)$ is defined to be the set of series of the form

$$1 + \psi_1 u + \cdots + \psi_i u^i + \cdots, \quad \psi_i \in F^{[n/i]} \widehat{G},$$

where $[n/i]$ denotes the integral part of n/i .

The element defining the morphism λ_u is

$$1 + \{1 + Xt\}u.$$

The reader will verify as an exercise that the conditions of 1.6 are indeed fulfilled; in fact the filtration was chosen ad hoc.

Again, the operations λ^i are calculated by substitution from

$$\lambda_u(1 + \cdots + X_n t^n + \cdots),$$

and so are determined by universal polynomials. Denote by

$$Q_{i,j}(X_1, \dots, X_{ij})$$

the coefficient of t^j in

$$\lambda^i(1 + \dots + X_n t^n + \dots).$$

It is an isobaric polynomial of weight ij with respect to the variables $X_1, \dots, X_{ij}$ (by a verification analogous to that of 1.15). It is calculated by symmetric functions from the defining element

$$\lambda_u(1 + Xt) = 1 + \{1 + Xt\}_u. \quad (2.3.3)$$

For example,

$$Q_{2,2}(X_1, X_2, X_3, X_4) = X_1 X_3 - X_4.$$

Finally, we indicate the origin of formulas (2.3.1) and (2.3.3). Consider the example 2.2.b, where the operations λ^i are defined by exterior powers of A -modules. We want

$$\lambda_t : K \longrightarrow \widehat{G}(K)$$

to be a λ -homomorphism. Thus on $\widehat{G}$ one must define laws such that, for all A -modules E, F ,

$$\lambda_t(EF) = \lambda_t(E) \circ \lambda_t(F), \quad \lambda_u(\lambda_t(E)) = \widehat{G}_{\lambda_t}^u(\lambda_t(\lambda_u(E))).$$

The relations (2.3.1) and (2.3.3) are precisely the preceding relations applied to the case where E and F are invertible modules.

We shall see in Exposé VI to what extent the desired property is verified.

Definition 2.4. A pre- λ -ring K will be called a λ -ring if the homomorphism of abelian groups

$$\lambda_t : K \longrightarrow 1 + K[[t]]^+$$

is a λ -homomorphism for the pre- λ -ring structure on the second member defined in 2.3. Thus the following relations hold for all $x, y \in K$:

$$\lambda_t(1) = 1 + t, \quad \lambda_t(xy) = \lambda_t(x) \circ \lambda_t(y), \quad \lambda_u(\lambda_t(x)) = \widehat{G}(\lambda_t)(\lambda_u(x)). \quad (2.4.1)$$

In terms of the maps λ^i , the last two relations are equivalent, for $x, y \in K$ and $i, j \in \mathbb{N}$, to

$$\lambda^i(xy) = P_i(\lambda^1(x), \dots, \lambda^i(x); \lambda^1(y), \dots, \lambda^i(y)), \quad (2.4.2)$$

$$\lambda^j(\lambda^i(x)) = Q_{i,j}(\lambda^1(x), \dots, \lambda^{ij}(x)). \quad (2.4.3)$$

We note that here we depart from the usual terminology (cf. [1]), where what we call a pre- λ -ring was called a λ -ring, and our λ -rings were called “special” λ -rings. The reason is that only “special” λ -rings are useful in practice.

Examples 2.5.

- a) We have determined all pre- λ -ring structures on $\mathbb{Z}$. It follows from (2.4.1) that only the structure defined by

$$\lambda_t(1) = 1 + t$$

is capable of being a λ -ring structure. One then has

$$\lambda_t(n) = (1 + t)^n,$$

hence

$$\forall n, n' \in \mathbb{Z}, \quad \lambda_t(n) \circ \lambda_t(n') = (1+t)^n \circ (1+t)^{n'} = (1+t)^{nn'} = \lambda_t(nn'),$$

and

$$\lambda_u((1+t)^n) = (\lambda_u(1+t))^n = (1+\{1+t\}u)^n = \widehat{G}(\lambda_t)((1+u)^n) = \widehat{G}(\lambda_t)(\lambda_u(n)).$$

Thus this is indeed a λ -ring structure. If $\binom{X}{k}$ denotes the polynomial with rational coefficients

$$\frac{1}{k!}X(X-1)\cdots(X-k+1),$$

then

$$\lambda^i(n) = \binom{n}{i}. \quad (2.5.1)$$

b) For every ring K , the pre- λ -ring $1 + K[[t]]^+$ is a λ -ring. First,

$$\lambda_u(1) = \lambda_u(1+t) = 1 + \{1+t\}u = 1 + 1 \cdot u.$$

The other relations are verified by the commutativity of the diagrams

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \widehat{G}^t \times \widehat{G}^t & \xrightarrow{\lambda_u \times \lambda_u} & (\widehat{G}^u \circ \widehat{G}^t) \times (\widehat{G}^u \circ \widehat{G}^t) \\ \circ \downarrow & & \downarrow \circ \\ \widehat{G}^t & \xrightarrow{\lambda_u} & \widehat{G}^u \circ \widehat{G}^t, \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{ccc} \widehat{G}^t & \xrightarrow{\lambda_v} & \widehat{G}^v \circ \widehat{G}^t \\ \lambda_u \downarrow & & \downarrow \widehat{G}^v(\lambda_u) \\ \widehat{G}^u \circ \widehat{G}^t & \xrightarrow{\lambda_v} & \widehat{G}^v \circ \widehat{G}^u \circ \widehat{G}^t, \end{array}$$

which are checked by 1.10 on the elements $1 + Xt$ and $1 + Yt$. For the first,

$$\begin{aligned} \lambda_u(1 + Xt) \circ \lambda_u(1 + Yt) &= (1 + \{Xt\}u) \circ (1 + \{1 + Yt\}u) \\ &= 1 + \{(1 + Xt) \circ (1 + Yt)\}u \\ &= 1 + \{1 + XYt\}u \\ &= \lambda_u((1 + Xt) \circ (1 + Yt)). \end{aligned}$$

For the second,

$$\lambda_v(\lambda_u(1 + Xt)) = 1 + \{1 + \{1 + Xt\}u\}v = \widehat{G}^v(\lambda_u)\lambda_v(1 + Xt).$$

c) The geometric examples of 2.2 will be treated later.

2.6. One can generalize Example 2.5.a as follows. Let K be a commutative ring with unit such that:

- i) K is torsion-free,
- ii) $\forall x \in K, \forall n \in \mathbb{N}, \quad \binom{x}{n} \in K$.

Then, for all $x \in K$ and all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, put

$$\lambda^n(x) = \binom{x}{n},$$

that is,

$$\lambda_t(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \binom{x}{n} t^n = (1+t)^x = \exp(x \operatorname{Log}(1+t)), \quad (2.6.1)$$

where the last identity is considered in $K \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Q}[[t]]$. By multiplicativity of the exponential, this defines a pre- λ -ring structure on K .

To see that it is a λ -ring structure, one must prove the relations (2.4.2), and it is enough to prove them in $K \otimes \mathbb{Q}$, by i). One is then reduced by functoriality to the case $K = \mathbb{Q}[X, Y]$ and to the elements X, Y . In view of the definition of the λ^i , the two sides of the equalities (2.4.2) are polynomials in X, Y , with rational coefficients. It is therefore enough, in order to prove their equality, to show that they take the same value for all integral values of X, Y . But the relations obtained by substituting integral values in X, Y are precisely those expressing that the pre- λ -ring $\mathbb{Z}$ of 2.5.a is a λ -ring. They are therefore satisfied.

Definition 2.7. A *binomial ring* is a ring satisfying the conditions 2.6.i and ii), endowed with the λ -ring structure defined by (2.6.1).

Example 2.8. Let X be a site, K a binomial ring, and $\mathcal{K}$ the sheaf associated to the constant presheaf with value K on X . Then $H^0(X, \mathcal{K})$ is a binomial ring. Indeed, the conditions 2.6 are preserved under passage to an inductive limit. In particular, $H^0(X, \mathbb{Z})$ is a binomial ring.

2.9. Let K be a binomial ring and A a K -algebra. For every series

$$\varphi \in \widehat{G}(A)$$

and every $a \in K$, one can define a series φ^a in the usual way. Writing $\varphi = 1 + \psi$, put

$$\varphi^a = (1 + \psi)^a = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \binom{a}{n} \psi^n (= \exp(a \operatorname{Log} \varphi)), \quad (2.9.1)$$

where the last equality can be written only modulo torsion. These formulas are obtained by substitution from the analogous formulas for $\varphi = 1 + t$. Therefore the following relations, the classical properties of the exponential, remain valid for $a, b \in K$ and $\varphi, \psi \in \widehat{G}(A)$:

$$\varphi^a \varphi^b = \varphi^{a+b}, \quad \varphi^{ab} = (\varphi^a)^b, \quad \varphi^a \psi^a = (\varphi \psi)^a. \quad (2.9.2)$$

Continuation of 2.9

We still suppose that K is binomial. Multiplication, for the law $\circ$, by $\lambda_t(a)$, where $a \in K$, defines a morphism of functors

$$\widehat{G}_K \longrightarrow \widehat{G}_K$$

which is characterized by its value on the element $1 + Xt$ of $G(K[X])$. Thus

$$\lambda_t(a) \circ (1 + Xt) = \lambda_{Xt}(a),$$

and hence

$$\lambda_t(a) \circ (1 + Xt) = (1 + Xt)^a = \exp(a \operatorname{Log}(1 + Xt)) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \binom{a}{n} X^n t^n. \quad (2.9.3)$$

It follows that

$$\lambda_t(a) \circ \varphi = \varphi^a \quad (= \exp(a \operatorname{Log} \varphi)). \quad (2.9.4)$$

Indeed, the two members are additive functors which coincide on $1 + Xt$. From (2.9.3) and 1.15 one obtains that the universal polynomial of degree n defining multiplication by $\lambda_t(a)$ is isobaric of weight n . We denote it by $R_{n,a}$.

Finally, if A is a K - λ -algebra and $b \in A$, then

$$\lambda_t(ab) = (\lambda_t(b))^a. \quad (2.9.5)$$

This follows from $\lambda_t(ab) = \lambda_t(a) \circ \lambda_t(b)$ and from (2.9.4).

3. The operations γ

We still work over the category $\mathcal{C}_0$.

3.1. Let K be a λ -ring. We shall define from the operations λ^i new operations denoted γ^i . They are the operations which are adapted to Chern classes. If E is a vector bundle of rank d , the top Chern class of E is represented, in K -theoretic language, by the alternating sum of the exterior powers. To obtain the n -th class, one first replaces E by $E \oplus \mathbf{1}^{n-d}$, so that the same top-class recipe applies. This motivates the formula below.

Proposition 3.2. Let K be a λ -ring.

i) For every $x \in K$ and every $n \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$\lambda^n(x + n - 1) = (-1)^n \sum_{i=0}^n (-1)^i \lambda^i(x + n).$$

ii) If

$$\gamma^n(x) = \lambda^n(x + n - 1), \quad \gamma_t(x) = \sum_{n \geq 0} \gamma^n(x) t^n,$$

then

$$\gamma_t(x) = \lambda_{t/(1-t)}(x), \quad \text{hence} \quad \lambda_t(x) = \gamma_{t/(1+t)}(x).$$

Thus knowledge of the operations γ is equivalent to knowledge of the operations λ .

Proof. For i),

$$\lambda^n(x + n - 1) = \sum_{i=0}^n \lambda^i(x + n) \lambda^{n-i}(-1).$$

Since $\lambda_t(1) = 1 + t$, one has $\lambda_t(-1) = 1/(1 + t)$, and hence $\lambda^k(-1) = (-1)^k$, giving the desired relation. For ii),

$$\lambda_{t/(1-t)}(x) = \sum_{n \geq 0} \lambda^n(x) t^n (1 - t)^{-n},$$

and

$$t^n (1 - t)^{-n} = \sum_{p \geq n} \binom{p-1}{p-n} t^p.$$

The coefficient of t^p is therefore

$$\sum_{n=0}^p \lambda^n(x) \binom{p-1}{p-n} = \sum_{n=0}^p \lambda^n(x) \lambda^{p-n}(p-1) = \lambda^p(x + p - 1).$$

3.3. If $f : K \rightarrow K'$ is a homomorphism of λ -rings, then f is a λ -homomorphism if and only if, for every $i \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$f(\gamma^i(x)) = \gamma^i(f(x)),$$

or equivalently

$$\gamma_t(f(x)) = \widehat{G}(f)(\gamma_t(x)).$$

3.4. From 3.2 one obtains

$$\gamma^0(x) = 1, \quad \gamma^1(x) = x, \quad \gamma^n(x + y) = \sum_{p+q=n} \gamma^p(x) \gamma^q(y). \quad (3.4.1)$$

Thus γ_t defines a new pre- λ -ring structure. It is not, in general, a λ -ring structure. Let ρ_t denote the automorphism of the functor $\widehat{G}$ induced by the change of variable

$$t \mapsto \frac{t}{1-t}.$$

Then $\gamma_t = \rho_t \lambda_t$. Transporting the λ -ring functor structure of $\widehat{G}$ by ρ_t gives a second structure on $\widehat{G}$, for which $\gamma_t : K \rightarrow \widehat{G}(K)$ is a λ -homomorphism whenever K is a λ -ring.

3.5. The multiplication in this transported structure is the composite

$$\widehat{G} \times \widehat{G} \xrightarrow{\rho_t^{-1} \times \rho_t^{-1}} \widehat{G} \times \widehat{G} \xrightarrow{\circ} \widehat{G} \xrightarrow{\rho_t} \widehat{G}.$$

It will be denoted ∇ . It is determined by

$$\begin{aligned} (1 + Xt)\nabla(1 + Yt) &= \rho_t \left(\rho_t^{-1}(1 + Xt) \circ \rho_t^{-1}(1 + Yt) \right) \\ &= \rho_t \left(\frac{1 + (X+1)t}{1+t} \circ \frac{1 + (Y+1)t}{1+t} \right) \\ &= \rho_t \left(\frac{(1 + ((X+1)(Y+1))t)(1+t)}{(1 + (X+1)t)(1 + (Y+1)t)} \right) \\ &= \frac{1 + (1 + X + Y + XY)t}{(1 + Xt)(1 + Yt)}. \end{aligned} \quad (3.5.1)$$

Thus, for $x, y \in K$,

$$\gamma_t(xy) = \gamma_t(x)\nabla\gamma_t(y). \quad (3.5.2)$$

The universal polynomial of degree n for this law will be denoted P'_n . Its isobaric components have weights between n and $2n$ in each of the two groups of variables, and

$$\gamma^n(xy) = P'_n(\gamma^1(x), \dots, \gamma^n(x), \gamma^1(y), \dots, \gamma^n(y)). \quad (3.5.3)$$

The unit for ∇ is $\gamma_t(1) = 1/(1-t)$.

3.6. The operations λ' of the transported structure are defined by

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \widehat{G} & & \\ 1 + K[[t]]^+ & \xrightarrow{\lambda_u} & 1 + \{1 + K[[t]]^+\}[[u]]^+ \\ \rho_t \downarrow & & \downarrow \widehat{G}(\rho_t) \\ 1 + K[[t]]^+ & \xrightarrow{\lambda'_u} & 1 + \{1 + K[[t]]^+\}[[u]]^+. \end{array} \quad (3.6.1)$$

If γ' denotes the γ -operations attached to these operations λ' , then

$$\gamma'_u(1 + Xt) = \frac{1}{1-u} + \{1 + Xt\}u. \quad (3.6.2)$$

Let $Q'_{i,j}$ be the coefficient of t^j in $\gamma'^i(1 + X_1t + X_2t^2 + \dots)$. It is a polynomial in $\mathbb{Z}[X_1, \dots, X_{ij}]$, whose isobaric components have weights from j to ij . For a λ -ring K and $x \in K$,

$$\gamma_t(\lambda^i(x)) = \lambda^i(\gamma_t(x)), \quad \gamma_t(\gamma^i(x)) = \gamma^i(\gamma_t(x)), \quad (3.6.3)$$

and therefore

$$\gamma^j(\gamma^i(x)) = Q'_{i,j}(\gamma^1(x), \dots, \gamma^{ij}(x)). \quad (3.6.4)$$

The transported pre- λ -ring structure on $\widehat{G}$ is itself a λ -ring structure.

3.7. We denote by $\widehat{G}_\circ$ the functor $\widehat{G}$ with the structure of §2, and by $\widehat{G}_\nabla$ the same functor with the structure of §3. Giving a λ -ring structure on a ring A is equivalent either to giving a ring homomorphism $A \rightarrow \widehat{G}_\circ(A)$ satisfying the usual diagram for λ_t , or to giving a ring homomorphism $A \rightarrow \widehat{G}_\nabla(A)$ satisfying the corresponding diagram for γ_t . Explicitly, the two diagrams are

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\lambda_u} & \widehat{G}_\circ^u(A) \\ \lambda_t \downarrow & & \downarrow \widehat{G}_\circ^u(\lambda_t) \\ \widehat{G}_\circ^t(A) & \xrightarrow{\lambda_u} & \widehat{G}_\circ^u(\widehat{G}_\circ^t(A)) \end{array} \quad (3.7.1)$$

and

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\gamma_u} & \widehat{G}_\nabla^u(A) \\ \gamma_t \downarrow & & \downarrow \widehat{G}_\nabla^u(\gamma_t) \\ \widehat{G}_\nabla^t(A) & \xrightarrow{\gamma_u} & \widehat{G}_\nabla^u(\widehat{G}_\nabla^t(A)). \end{array} \quad (3.7.2)$$

3.8. Let K be a binomial ring. From (2.6.1), for $x \in K$,

$$\gamma_t(x) = \left(\frac{1}{1-t} \right)^x = \exp(-x \operatorname{Log}(1-t)). \quad (3.8.1)$$

For $a \in K$, multiplication by $\gamma_t(a)$ for the law ∇ is characterized by its value on $1 + Xt$:

$$\gamma_t(a) \nabla (1 + Xt) = (1 + Xt)^a = \exp(a \operatorname{Log}(1 + Xt)) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \binom{a}{n} X^n t^n. \quad (3.8.2)$$

Thus the universal polynomial of degree n defining this multiplication is again $R_{n,a}$.

Definition 3.9. Let K be a λ -ring. An *augmented K - λ -algebra* is a K - λ -algebra A , together with a λ -homomorphism of K -algebras

$$\epsilon : A \longrightarrow K.$$

Morphisms are λ -homomorphisms compatible with the augmentations.

Example 3.9.1. Let (X, A) be a locally ringed topos. The Grothendieck group $K^\circ(X)$ of locally free finite-type A -modules has a natural pre- λ -ring structure by exterior powers. There is a natural λ -homomorphism from $H^0(X, \mathbb{Z})$ to $K^\circ(X)$: a section a of the constant sheaf $\mathbb{Z}$ partitions the final object into opens U_n on which $a = n$, and is sent to the class of the locally free module which is A^n on U_n for $n \geq 0$, minus the analogous class on the negative pieces. The rank map is the augmentation. This is the augmented structure used below.

3.10. Let A be an augmented K - λ -algebra. For $n > 0$, define $\operatorname{Fil}^n A$ to be the ideal generated by products

$$\gamma^{i_1}(x_1) \cdots \gamma^{i_k}(x_k), \quad i_1 + \cdots + i_k \geq n, \quad \epsilon(x_i) = 0. \quad (3.10.1)$$

If A is generated as an abelian group by (x_α) , then $\operatorname{Fil}^n A$ is generated over K by

$$\gamma^{i_1}(x_{\alpha_1} - \epsilon(x_{\alpha_1})) \cdots \gamma^{i_k}(x_{\alpha_k} - \epsilon(x_{\alpha_k})), \quad i_1 + \cdots + i_k \geq n. \quad (3.10.2)$$

The filtration is decreasing and multiplicative, and

$$\operatorname{Fil}^0 A = A, \quad \operatorname{Fil}^1 A = \operatorname{Ker} \epsilon.$$

It is functorial for homomorphisms of augmented K - λ -algebras.

Proposition 3.11. Let A be a λ -ring and let $y_1, \dots, y_n$ be elements of A such that $\gamma^j(y_i) = 0$ for $j \geq 2$. Put $x = \sum_i y_i$. Then $\gamma^k(x - n) = 0$ for $k > n$, and, for $1 \leq k \leq n$, $\gamma^k(x - n)$ is the k -th elementary symmetric function of the $y_i - 1$. This follows from

$$\gamma_t(x - n) = \prod_{i=1}^n \gamma_t(y_i - 1).$$

4. λ -rings generated by generators and relations

4.1. Let K be a λ -ring and let $(X_i)_{i \in I}$ be indeterminates. Put

$$A = K[X_i, {}^n X_i]_{i \in I, n \geq 2}.$$

Define

$$\lambda_t(X_i) = 1 + X_i t + \sum_{n \geq 2} {}^n X_i t^n, \quad \lambda_t({}^n X_i) = \lambda^n(\lambda_t(X_i)). \quad (4.1.1)$$

This gives a λ -ring structure on A extending that of K .

Proposition 4.2. For every K - λ -algebra B and every family $(b_i)_{i \in I}$ in B , there exists a unique K - λ -homomorphism $A \rightarrow B$ carrying X_i to b_i . Necessarily it carries ${}^n X_i$ to $\lambda^n(b_i)$, and this condition is sufficient.

4.3. The same construction may be made using γ 's. Let

$$A' = K[X_i, {}^\gamma_n X_i]_{i \in I, n \geq 2},$$

and define

$$\gamma_t(X_i) = 1 + X_i t + \sum_{n \geq 2} {}^\gamma_n X_i t^n, \quad \gamma_t({}^\gamma_n X_i) = \gamma'^n(\gamma_t(X_i)). \quad (4.3.1)$$

This gives a λ -ring satisfying the same universal property, hence canonically isomorphic to A .

Definition 4.4. The preceding λ -ring is the *free λ -ring* over K generated by the family (X_i) .

Definition 4.5. An ideal J of a λ -ring A is a λ -ideal if $\lambda^n(x) \in J$ for every $x \in J$ and $n > 1$. Kernels of λ -homomorphisms are λ -ideals; conversely, if J is a λ -ideal, A/J receives a unique λ -ring structure. The intersection of λ -ideals is a λ -ideal. Thus every family of elements has a smallest containing λ -ideal, generated by the elements and all their iterated λ^n 's.

Definition 4.6. The quotient of the free λ -ring by the λ -ideal generated by prescribed relations (P_i) is called the λ -ring generated by the generators (X_i) subject to the relations (P_i) . Equivalently, one may formulate the same construction in terms of γ -operations.

Proposition 4.7. This quotient has the expected universal property: every family (b_i) in a K - λ -algebra satisfying the relations (P_i) determines a unique K - λ -homomorphism from the quotient to that algebra.

Proposition 4.8. Let $n \geq 0$. In the free λ -ring over K on one generator X , the ideal generated by the $\lambda^k X$, $k > n$, is a λ -ideal. Indeed, after quotienting, one has only to check that if $\varphi \in \widehat{G}(C)$ has no terms of degree $> n$, then $\lambda^k(\varphi) = 0$ for $k > n$. By the splitting principle, it is enough to write

$$\varphi = \prod_{i=1}^n (1 + T_i t),$$

and then

$$\lambda_u(\varphi) = \prod_{i=1}^n (1 + \{1 + T_i t\}u),$$

which has degree n in u .

Corollary 4.9. The λ -ring generated over K by one element X , subject to $\lambda^k(X) = 0$ for $k > n$, is

$$K[X, \lambda^2 X, \dots, \lambda^n X].$$

More generally, for a family (X_i) with bounds (n_i) , the quotient subject to $\lambda^k(X_i) = 0$ for $k > n_i$ is the polynomial ring generated by $X_i, \lambda^2 X_i, \dots, \lambda^{n_i} X_i$.

4.10. Let K be binomial and let A be an augmented K - λ -algebra. Put

$$B = A[X, \gamma^2 X, \gamma^3 X, \dots],$$

the free A - λ -algebra on X , written in γ -coordinates. Extend the augmentation by $\epsilon(X) = 0$, hence $\epsilon(\gamma^i X) = 0$ for $i > 0$. Let M_k be the set of monomials in the variables $\gamma^j X$, counted with weight j , of total weight k , and set $M_0 = \{1\}$.

Lemma 4.11. If $x \in \text{Fil}^p A$, then every coefficient of $\gamma^n(x + X)$ which is homogeneous of weight k in the $\gamma^j X$ belongs to $\text{Fil}^{p+n-k} A$.

Proposition 4.12. For every $k \geq 0$,

$$\text{Fil}^k B = \text{Fil}^k A + \text{Fil}^{k-1} A M_1 + \dots + \text{Fil}^1 A M_{k-1} + \text{Fil}^0 A M_k + B M_{k+1}. \quad (4.12.1)$$

The inclusion from right to left follows from Lemma 4.11. The reverse inclusion is obtained by writing the generators of $\text{Fil}^k B$ as products of γ -operations and reducing, term by term, to the displayed weights.

Remarks 4.13. The proof gives the same assertion for a free λ -algebra on any finite or infinite family of generators, with the evident multi-weight. It is also unchanged when one uses the λ -coordinates, since λ and γ coordinates differ by triangular universal formulas.

Corollary 4.14. Passing to the associated graded ring, one has

$$\text{Gr}^k B \simeq \text{Gr}^k A \oplus \text{Gr}^{k-1} A M_1 \oplus \dots \oplus \text{Gr}^0 A M_k. \quad (4.14.1)$$

Corollary 4.15. If $B' = K[X, \gamma^2 X, \dots, \gamma^n X]$ is the K - λ -algebra generated by one element satisfying $\gamma^k(X) = 0$ for $k > n$, then the λ -ring filtration of B' is exactly the weight filtration in the variables $\gamma^j X$.

5. The elements $\lambda^p(N, x)$

This section will be used only in Exposé VII, §4, in the study of regular immersions; it may be omitted on first reading.

5.1. Let $d \geq 1$. Let A be the $\mathbb{Z}$ - λ -algebra generated by N and x , subject to the relations $\lambda^i(N) = 0$ for $i > d$. Thus

$$A = \mathbb{Z}[N, \dots, \lambda^d N; x, \dots, \lambda^j x, \dots].$$

Put

$$\lambda_{-1}(N) = \sum_{i=0}^d (-1)^i \lambda^i(N). \quad (5.1.1)$$

Lemma 5.2. For every $p \geq 1$, the element $\lambda^p(x \lambda_{-1}(N))$ is divisible by $\lambda_{-1}(N)$.

It is enough, by isobaricity, to prove this for $\lambda^p(\lambda_{-1}(N))$. Let B be the λ -ring generated by $N_1, \dots, N_d$, with $\lambda^i(N_j) = 0$ for $i \geq 2$. The map $N \mapsto \sum_i N_i$ identifies A with the symmetric polynomials in the N_i , and

$$\lambda_{-1}(N) = \prod_{i=1}^d (1 - N_i).$$

If some $N_i = 1$, then $\lambda_t(\lambda_{-1}(N)) = \lambda_t(0) = 1$, so every positive coefficient vanishes. Thus each $\lambda^p(\lambda_{-1}(N))$ is divisible by every $1 - N_i$, hence by their product.

Definition 5.3. Since A is integral, define $\lambda^p(N, x)$ by

$$\lambda^p(N, x)\lambda_{-1}(N) = \lambda^p(x\lambda_{-1}(N)), \quad p \geq 1. \quad (5.3.1)$$

Thus $\lambda^p(N, x)$ is a polynomial in the $\lambda^i(x)$ and $\lambda^j(N)$, isobaric of weight p in the $\lambda^i(x)$. If a λ -ring B contains an element N' with $\lambda^k(N') = 0$ for $k > d$, then $\lambda^p(N', x')$ is defined by substitution; it is independent of the chosen bound d .

5.4. In the λ -ring generated by N, x, y , subject to $\lambda^k(N) = 0$ for $k > d$, the formula (5.3.1) gives

$$\lambda^p(N, x + y) = \lambda^p(N, x) + \lambda^p(N, y) + \sum_{\substack{i+j=p \\ i,j>0}} \lambda^i(N, x)\lambda^j(N, y)\lambda_{-1}(N). \quad (5.4.1)$$

If N, N', x satisfy the corresponding finite-rank hypotheses, then

$$\lambda^p(N + N', x)\lambda_{-1}(N) = \lambda^p(N', x\lambda_{-1}(N)). \quad (5.4.2)$$

5.5. Let A be a λ -ring and let $N \in A$ satisfy $\lambda^k(N) = 0$ for $k > d$. Define on the underlying abelian group of A a new multiplication by

$$x \cdot_N y = xy\lambda_{-1}(N).$$

After adjoining a unit, one obtains a ring $\mathbb{Z} \times A$ with

$$(n, x)(m, y) = (nm, ny + mx + x \cdot_N y).$$

The formulas

$$\lambda_t(n, x) = (1 + t)^n \left(1 + \sum_{p \geq 1} \lambda^p(N, x)t^p \right) \quad (5.5.1)$$

define a pre- λ -ring structure. In fact, when A is a λ -ring, this is a λ -ring structure; it is the one transported from the original structure by multiplication by $\lambda_{-1}(N)$. We denote this augmented λ -ring by $\hat{A}_N$. Its γ -operations satisfy

$$\gamma^p(N, x)\lambda_{-1}(N) = \gamma^p(x\lambda_{-1}(N)). \quad (5.5.2)$$

5.6. Suppose that, in addition, L is an element such that $\lambda^k(L) = 0$ for $k > 1$. Then $\lambda^p(N + L, x)$ is the coefficient of t^p in the series

$$\frac{\sum_{k \geq 1} \lambda^k(N, x)(1 + L + \dots + L^{k-1})t^k}{1 + \sum_{k \geq 1} \lambda^k(N, x)\lambda_{-1}(N)L^k t^k}. \quad (5.6.1)$$

This is obtained by applying (5.4.2) to $N + L$ and using $\lambda_{-1}(L) = 1 - L$.

Proposition 5.7. Let K be a binomial ring, A an augmented K - λ -algebra, and $N \in A$ such that $\lambda^k(N) = 0$ for $k > d$. Then, for every $x \in A$ and every $p \geq 1$,

$$\gamma^p(N, x) \in \text{Fil}^{p-d} A. \quad (5.7.1)$$

Indeed, let A_0 be the K - λ -algebra generated by N'_0, X'_0 , with $\lambda^k(N'_0) = 0$ for $k > d$, and augmented by $\epsilon(N'_0) = \epsilon(X'_0) = 0$. This is a polynomial algebra over K in the variables $\gamma^i(N'_0)$, $1 \leq i \leq d$, and $\gamma^j(X'_0)$, $j \geq 1$, and its λ -filtration is the weight filtration. Put

$$N_0 = N'_0 + d, \quad X_0 = X'_0 + \epsilon(x).$$

For N_0, X_0 , the assertion is equivalent to

$$\gamma^p(N_0, X_0) \gamma^d(N'_0) \in \text{Fil}^p A_0.$$

Since $\gamma^d(N'_0) = (-1)^d \lambda_{-1}(N_0)$, this becomes

$$(-1)^d \gamma^p(X_0 \gamma^d(N'_0)) \in \text{Fil}^p A_0,$$

which is clear because $\gamma^d(N'_0)$ has zero augmentation. A K - λ -homomorphism $A_0 \rightarrow A$, compatible with augmentations and sending N'_0 to $N - d$ and X'_0 to $x - \epsilon(x)$, gives the stated result.

6. Chern ring: opening

Throughout this section the base ring is a fixed binomial ring K . We use the functor G of 1.1, and return to the notation of §1: G denotes the functor there defined and G_i its restriction to $\mathcal{C}_0$.

6.1. In 3.5 and 3.6 we defined morphisms of functors

$$G_i \times G_i \xrightarrow{*} G_i, \quad G_i^\circ \xrightarrow{\gamma'} G_i^\circ \circ G_S, \quad G_i \xrightarrow{a} G_i,$$

where the last map is multiplication, for the law ∇ , by $\gamma_t(a)$ with $a \in K$. By 1.9 these give morphisms

$$G \times G \xrightarrow{*} G, \quad G \xrightarrow{\gamma'} G \circ G_S, \quad G \xrightarrow{a} G.$$

The isobaricity of the universal polynomials involved implies that the first and third images lie in G , while the second lies in the subgroup of formal series in u whose non-zero terms have the prescribed degrees.

Exposé V, 6. Chern ring: completion

Definition 6.2. The functor defined in 6.1 on the category of graded K -algebras, with values in the category of K - λ -algebras, is called the *Chern ring*; its value on $A \in \text{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$ is denoted $\text{Ch}(A)$, or, if there is a risk of confusion, $\text{Ch}_K(A)$.

From formulas (6.1.1), (6.1.2), (6.1.4), and (3.6.2), one deduces the relations

$$(1, 1 + X)(1, 1 + Y) = (1, 1 + X + Y), \quad \lambda^i(1, 1 + X) = 0 \quad \text{for } i \geq 2, \quad (6.2.1)$$

the relations which served in [1] to define the Chern ring. Conversely, from these formulas one can recover the relations (6.1.1) and (6.1.4).

Let us indicate why the Chern ring is introduced. We place ourselves in the situation of Example 3.9, and write A for the graded ring associated, by the filtration defined in 3.10, with the $K^\bullet$ of a commutatively locally ringed topoi; for simplicity suppose that $K^\bullet$ is a λ -ring. The augmentation ring is K . We shall see below that for every element of an augmented λ -ring one can define Chern classes with values in the associated graded ring (6.7). To every locally free sheaf of finite type one can therefore associate an element of $\text{Ch}(A)$, whose component on the factor K is the rank of the sheaf and whose component on the factor $1 + \hat{A}^+$ is the sum of the Chern classes. Formulas (6.2.1) are then the usual formulas giving the Chern classes and the rank of the tensor product of two invertible sheaves and of the exterior powers of an invertible sheaf; in other words, the map just defined from $K^\bullet$ to $\text{Ch}(A)$ is a λ -homomorphism.

6.3. For every graded K -algebra A , denote by $A_{\mathbb{Q}}$ the K -algebra $A \otimes \mathbb{Q}$, graded in the evident way. By 1.13 one defines a functorial homomorphism

$$1 + \hat{A}^+ \xrightarrow{\text{ch}} \hat{A}_{\mathbb{Q}}^+$$

by giving its value on $1 + X$:

$$\text{ch}(1 + X) = \exp(X) - 1. \quad (6.3.1)$$

This homomorphism is compatible with the multiplication defined in 6.1 on $1 + \hat{A}^+$. By 1.13 it is enough to show this for the elements $1 + X, 1 + Y$ of the universal ring $1 + K[X, Y]^+$. One has

$$\begin{aligned} \text{ch}((1 + X) * (1 + Y)) &= \text{ch}\left(\frac{1 + X + Y}{(1 + X)(1 + Y)}\right) \\ &= \text{ch}(1 + X + Y) - \text{ch}(1 + X) - \text{ch}(1 + Y) \\ &= \exp(X + Y) - \exp(X) - \exp(Y) + 1 \\ &= \text{ch}(1 + X) \text{ch}(1 + Y). \end{aligned}$$

Let η be the endomorphism of $\hat{A}_{\mathbb{Q}}^+$, functorial in A , defined by

$$\eta\left(\sum_{k \geq 1} a_k t^k\right) = \sum_{k \geq 1} \frac{(-1)^{k-1}}{(k-1)!} a_k t^k.$$

Then, for every $\varphi \in 1 + \hat{A}^+$,

$$\text{ch}(\varphi) = \eta(\text{Log } \varphi). \quad (6.3.2)$$

Indeed, ch and $\eta \circ \text{Log}$ are two functorial homomorphisms of abelian groups, and it is enough for them to agree on $1 + X$, which is evident.

It follows that ch commutes with the operations of K : again it is enough to show this for $1 + X$, and for $a \in K$ one has

$$\begin{aligned} \text{ch}((1 + X)^a) &= \text{ch}(\exp(a \text{Log}(1 + X))) \\ &= \eta(a \text{Log}(1 + X)) \\ &= a \eta(\text{Log}(1 + X)) \\ &= a \text{ch}(1 + X). \end{aligned}$$

Thus one can extend ch in the evident way to a homomorphism of K -algebras

$$K \times (1 + \hat{A}^+) \longrightarrow K \oplus \hat{A}_{\mathbb{Q}}^+,$$

namely

$$\text{ch}(a, \varphi) = a + \eta(\text{Log } \varphi). \quad (6.3.3)$$

Definition 6.4. The homomorphism

$$\text{ch} : \text{Ch } A \longrightarrow K \oplus \hat{A}_{\mathbb{Q}}^+$$

just defined is called the *Chern character*.

If A is of characteristic zero, that is, is a $\mathbb{Q}$ -algebra, the Chern character is an isomorphism. Indeed, if $\psi \in K \oplus \hat{A}^+$, one may write $\psi = a + \psi_1$, where ψ_1 is of positive degree, and then an inverse morphism is defined by

$$\psi \longmapsto (a, \exp(\eta^{-1}(\psi_1))).$$

Proposition 6.5. Let A be a graded K -algebra. On $\text{Ch}(A)$ consider the filtration defined as follows, the degree filtration:

$$(\text{Ch}(A))_0 = \text{Ch}(A), \quad (\text{Ch}(A))_n = 0 \times (1 + \hat{A}^{\geq n}) \quad (n \geq 1), \quad (6.5.1)$$

where $\hat{A}^{\geq n} = \prod_{i \geq n} A^i$. The following congruences hold.

i) If $n \geq 1$ and $\varphi \in (\text{Ch } A)_n$, writing $\varphi = 1 + a_n + \dots$, then

$$\text{ch}(\varphi) = \frac{(-1)^{n-1}}{(n-1)!} a_n + \dots. \quad (6.5.2)$$

ii) If $\varphi \in (\text{Ch } A)_m$, $\psi \in (\text{Ch } A)_n$, and if $\varphi = 1 + a_m + \dots$, $\psi = 1 + b_n + \dots$, then

$$\varphi * \psi = 1 - \frac{(m+n-1)!}{(m-1)!(n-1)!} a_m b_n + \dots. \quad (6.5.3)$$

Consequently the degree filtration is a ring filtration.

For (i), the Chern character is by construction a morphism of filtered functors; from the congruence $\varphi \equiv 1 + a_n \pmod{(\text{Ch } A)_{n+1}}$ one obtains

$$\text{ch}(\varphi) = \text{ch}(1 + a_n) \pmod{\hat{A}^{\geq n+1}},$$

and, since $\text{ch}(1 + a_n) = \eta(\text{Log}(1 + a_n))$, this is

$$\frac{(-1)^{n-1}}{(n-1)!} a_n + \dots.$$

For (ii), by substitution it is enough to prove (6.5.3) for the torsion-free universal polynomial algebra

$$A = K[X_i, Y_j]_{i,j \in \mathbb{N}}$$

and for $\varphi = 1 + \sum_{k \geq m} X_k$, $\psi = 1 + \sum_{k \geq n} Y_k$. Since K is torsion-free in the universal case, one can embed this algebra in its tensor product with $\mathbb{Q}$, so that ch is injective. Put $\varphi * \psi = 1 + Z_p + \dots$, where Z_p is the first non-zero term different from 1. The multiplicativity of ch , together with (6.5.2), gives

$$1 + \frac{(-1)^{p-1}}{(p-1)!} Z_p + \dots = \left(1 + \frac{(-1)^{m-1}}{(m-1)!} X_m + \dots \right) \left(1 + \frac{(-1)^{n-1}}{(n-1)!} Y_n + \dots \right),$$

which gives the stated value of Z_p by comparing the terms of lowest degree.

6.6. The λ -ring $\text{Ch } A$ is augmented over K : one defines a λ -homomorphism $\text{Ch } A \rightarrow K$ by $(a, \varphi) \mapsto a$. It is therefore equipped with the canonical filtration of an augmented λ -ring. We compare it with the filtration just defined.

Proposition 6.6.1. Let $x \in \text{Ch } A$ be an element of the form $x = (n, 1 + \cdots + a_n)$. Then:

- i) $\lambda^i(x) = 0$ for $i > n$,
- ii) $\lambda^n(x) = (1, 1 + a_1)$,
- iii) $\sum_{i=0}^n (-1)^i \lambda^i(x) = (0, 1 - (n-1)!a_n + \cdots)$,

where the unwritten terms have degree $> n$.

By functoriality, it is enough to prove this in the case where $A = K[X_1, \dots, X_n]$, filtered by weight with respect to the X_i , X_i having weight i , and for the element $(n, 1 + X_1 + \cdots + X_n)$. Embed A in $A' = K[T_1, \dots, T_n]$ by the symmetric functions. Then

$$(n, 1 + X_1 + \cdots + X_n) = \left(n, \prod_{i=1}^n (1 + T_i) \right) = \sum_{i=1}^n (1, 1 + T_i).$$

Hence, by (6.2.1),

$$\lambda_t(x) = \prod_{i=1}^n (1 + (1, 1 + T_i)t),$$

so that

$$\lambda^k(x) = 0 \quad (k > n), \quad \lambda^n(x) = \prod_{i=1}^n (1, 1 + T_i) = \left(1, 1 + \sum_{i=1}^n T_i \right) = (1, 1 + X_1).$$

Finally,

$$\sum_{i=1}^n (-1)^i \lambda^i(x) = \lambda_{-1}(x) = \prod_{i=1}^n (1 - (1, 1 + T_i)) = (-1)^n \prod_{i=1}^n (0, 1 + T_i).$$

By (6.5.3),

$$\prod_{i=1}^n (0, 1 + T_i) = \left(0, 1 + (-1)^{n-1} (n-1)! \prod_{i=1}^n T_i + \cdots \right),$$

hence

$$\lambda_{-1}(x) = (0, 1 - (n-1)!X_n + \cdots).$$

Corollary 6.6.2. Relation 6.6.1(iii) is true for every element X of augmentation n .

For this we shall use the following lemma.

Lemma 6.6.3. For every n , $(\text{Ch } A)_n$ is a λ -ideal of $\text{Ch } A$.

We may suppose $n > 1$. Let $x = (0, \varphi) \in (\text{Ch } A)_n$, and write

$$\lambda^i(0, \varphi) = (0, 1 + Q_{i,1}^i + \cdots + Q_{i,j}^i + \cdots),$$

where the $Q_{i,j}^i$ are the isobaric components of weight j of the Q_i^i of (3.6). For every j , the polynomial $Q_{i,j}^i$ is a polynomial in the first j coefficients of φ . If $j < n$, these coefficients are zero; hence the $Q_{i,j}^i$ are zero, and so the $\lambda^i(x)$ belong to $(\text{Ch } A)_n$. Thus $(\text{Ch } A)_n$ is a λ -ideal.

Let $x = (n, 1 + a_1 + \cdots + a_n + \cdots)$ be an element of augmentation n in $\text{Ch } A$. Then

$$x \equiv (n, 1 + \cdots + a_n) \pmod{(\text{Ch } A)_{n+1}},$$

and therefore

$$\lambda_{-1}(x) \equiv \lambda_{-1}(n, 1 + \cdots + a_n) = (0, 1 - (n-1)!a_n + \cdots),$$

which proves the corollary.

Corollary 6.6.4. Let ϵ be the augmentation homomorphism of $\text{Ch } A$. Then, for every $x \in \text{Ch } A$, one has

$$\gamma^n(x - \epsilon(x)) = (0, 1 + (-1)^{n-1}(n-1)!a_n + \cdots).$$

By definition,

$$\gamma^n(x - \epsilon(x)) = (-1)^n \sum_{i=0}^n (-1)^i \lambda^i(x + n - \epsilon(x)).$$

Since $x + n - \epsilon(x)$ has augmentation n , Corollary 6.6.2 applies to it, giving the result.

Corollary 6.6.5. With the notation of 3.10,

$$\text{Fil}^n \text{Ch } A \subset (\text{Ch } A)_n.$$

This follows from the preceding corollary, which gives $\gamma^n(x - \epsilon(x)) \in (\text{Ch } A)_n$, and from the fact that the two filtrations are ring filtrations and that the elements $\gamma^n(x - \epsilon(x))$, for n and x variable, generate the λ -ring filtration.

Corollary 6.6.7. Let A be a graded K -algebra of characteristic zero, bounded by degree. Then the two filtrations defined on $\text{Ch } A$ are identical.

Suppose that $\text{Fil}^p A = 0$, and let $x = (0, 1 + a_n + \cdots + a_p)$ be an element of $(\text{Ch } A)_n$. Put

$$x' = \left(0, 1 + \frac{(-1)^{n-1}}{(n-1)!} a_n + a_{n+1} + \cdots + a_p \right).$$

Then $\gamma^n(x') = (0, 1 + a_n + \cdots + a'_p)$, since x' has zero augmentation. Hence $x - \gamma^n(x') \in (\text{Ch } A)_{n+1}$. Iterating the operation $p - n$ times, one reaches $(\text{Ch } A)_{p+1} = 0$, and therefore x is written as an element of $\text{Fil}^n \text{Ch } A$. In view of (6.6.5), the two filtrations are identical.

6.7. Now suppose that A is a λ -ring augmented over K , and let ϵ be the augmentation homomorphism. Then A is equipped with its canonical filtration of augmented λ -ring, and one can associate to $\text{Gr } A$ its Chern ring.

If $x \in A$, then $\gamma_t(x - \epsilon(x)) \in \widehat{G}(A)$ by definition of the filtration of an augmented λ -ring. We write $c(x)$ for the image of $\gamma_t(x - \epsilon(x))$ in

$$\widehat{G}(A)/\widehat{G}'(A) = 1 + \widehat{\text{Gr } A}^+.$$

It is called the *total Chern class* of x . We write $c^i(x)$, and call it the i -th Chern class of x , for the i -th coefficient of $c(x)$. Thus

$$c^i(x) = \text{cl}_{\text{Gr}^i A}(\gamma^i(x - \epsilon(x))), \quad c(x) = 1 + c^1(x) + \cdots. \quad (6.7.1)$$

Put

$$\tilde{c}(x) = (\epsilon(x), c(x)). \quad (6.7.2)$$

This is called the *completed Chern class* of x .

Proposition 6.8. The completed Chern class

$$\tilde{c} : A \longrightarrow \text{Ch}(\text{Gr } A)$$

is a K - λ -homomorphism of augmented K - λ -algebras.

It is clear that the homomorphism so defined is additive. To verify that it is multiplicative, write

$$\begin{aligned}\gamma_t(xy - \epsilon(xy)) &= \gamma_t(\epsilon(y)(x - \epsilon(x)))\gamma_t(\epsilon(x)(y - \epsilon(y)))\gamma_t((x - \epsilon(x))(y - \epsilon(y))) \\ &= (\gamma_t(x - \epsilon(x)))^{\epsilon(y)}(\gamma_t(y - \epsilon(y)))^{\epsilon(x)}(\gamma_t(x - \epsilon(x)) \circ \gamma_t(y - \epsilon(y))),\end{aligned}$$

which gives the result by (6.1.2) after passage to the quotient. If $a \in K$, then $\tilde{c}(a) = (a, 1)$, so $\tilde{c}$ is a homomorphism of K -algebras; moreover it is compatible with augmentations.

It remains to see that it is a λ -homomorphism. One must prove the commutativity of the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\gamma_t} & \widehat{G}(A) \\ \tilde{c} \downarrow & & \downarrow \widehat{G}(\tilde{c}) \\ \text{Ch } A & \xrightarrow{\gamma_t} & \widehat{G}(\text{Ch } A). \end{array}$$

By additivity, it is enough to prove it for the elements of K , where it is evident, and for the elements of zero augmentation in A , where it follows, by the definition of c and (6.1.4), from diagram (3.7.2).

Proposition 6.9. Let A be an augmented K - λ -algebra and let $z \in \text{Fil}^m A$. Then

$$\gamma^m(z) = (-1)^{m-1}(m-1)!z \pmod{\text{Fil}^{m+1} A},$$

that is,

$$c^m(z) = \text{cl}_{\text{Gr}^m A} \left((-1)^{m-1}(m-1)!z \right).$$

One must see that these two elements give the same image in $\text{Gr}^m A$, that is, that the m -th Chern class of z is the image of $(-1)^{m-1}(m-1)!z$.

One may write z as a sum

$$\sum a \gamma^{i_1}(x_1) \cdots \gamma^{i_k}(x_k),$$

with $a \in A$, $\epsilon(x_i) = 0$ for all i , and $i_1 + \cdots + i_k \geq m$. We then have

$$\tilde{c}(z) = \sum \tilde{c}(a) \tilde{c}(\gamma^{i_1}(x_1)) \cdots \tilde{c}(\gamma^{i_k}(x_k)).$$

Since $\tilde{c}$ is a λ -homomorphism, one may write

$$\tilde{c}(\gamma^i(x_j)) = \gamma^i(\tilde{c}(x_j)).$$

Taking account of the definition of c and of (6.6.4), one obtains

$$\tilde{c}(\gamma^{i_j}(x_j)) = \left(0, 1 + (-1)^{i_j-1}(i_j-1)! \gamma^{i_j}(x_j) + \cdots \right).$$

By (6.5.3), and since $\tilde{c}(a) = (a, 1)$, one finally gets

$$\begin{aligned}\tilde{c}(z) &= \sum \left(0, \left(1 + (-1)^{i_1+\cdots+i_k-1}(i_1+\cdots+i_k-1)! \gamma^{i_1}(x_1) \cdots \gamma^{i_k}(x_k) + \cdots \right)^a \right) \\ &= \left(0, 1 + \sum_{\substack{(x_1, \dots, x_k) \\ i_1+\cdots+i_k=m}} (-1)^{m-1}(m-1)! a \gamma^{i_1}(x_1) \cdots \gamma^{i_k}(x_k) + \cdots \right) \\ &= (0, 1 + (-1)^{m-1}(m-1)!z + \cdots),\end{aligned}$$

which proves the assertion.

Proposition 6.10. Let K be a binomial ring, R an augmented K - λ -algebra, $N \in R$ an element such that $\lambda^k(N) = 0$ for $k > d$, and $x \in \text{Fil}^i R$. Then

$$\gamma^{d+i}(N, x) - (-1)^{d+i-1}(d+i-1)!x \in \text{Fil}^{i+1} R.$$

One can find elements $z_{\alpha,j} \in R$ and $a_\alpha \in K$ such that

$$x = \sum_{\alpha} a_{\alpha} \gamma^{i_1}(x_{\alpha,1}) \cdots \gamma^{i_k}(x_{\alpha,k}),$$

with $i_1 + \cdots + i_k \geq i$ and $\epsilon(x_{\alpha,j}) = 0$ for every α and every j . Let R_0 be the K - λ -algebra generated by N'_0 and $X_{\alpha,j}$, subject to the relations

$$\gamma^k(N'_0) = 0 \quad \text{for } k > d.$$

Define an augmentation homomorphism $R_0 \rightarrow K$ by $\epsilon(N'_0) = \epsilon(X_{\alpha,j}) = 0$. By (4.9.1), R_0 is the ring of polynomials with coefficients in K in the indeterminates $\gamma^k(N'_0)$, $1 \leq k \leq d$, and $\gamma^p(X_{\alpha,j})$, $p \geq 1$; the λ -filtration of R_0 is its weight filtration, where $\gamma^k(N'_0)$ and $\gamma^k(X_{\alpha,j})$ have weight k (4.12 and 4.15).

Put

$$X_0 = \sum_{\alpha} a_{\alpha} \gamma^{i_1}(X_{\alpha,1}) \cdots \gamma^{i_k}(X_{\alpha,k}).$$

We shall prove 6.10 first for X_0 and $N'_0 = N_0 + d$, which do satisfy the hypotheses of 6.10. In view of the preceding remark about the filtration of R_0 , it is enough to show that

$$\gamma^{d+i}(N_0, X_0) \gamma^d(N'_0) - (-1)^{d+i-1}(d+i-1)!X_0 \gamma^d(N'_0) \in \text{Fil}^{d+i+1} R_0.$$

But $\lambda_{-1}(N_0) = (-1)^d \gamma^d(N'_0)$. Thus this relation becomes

$$(-1)^d \gamma^{d+i}(X_0, (-1)^d \gamma^d(N'_0)) - (-1)^{d+i-1}(d+i-1)!X_0 \gamma^d(N'_0) \in \text{Fil}^{d+i+1} R_0.$$

Putting $z = (-1)^d X_0 \gamma^d(N'_0)$, we have $z \in \text{Fil}^{d+i} R_0$, and the statement is reduced to

$$\gamma^{d+i}(z) - (-1)^{d+i-1}(d+i-1)!z \in \text{Fil}^{d+i+1} R_0,$$

which is just 6.9.

To deduce 6.10 from this particular case, consider the K - λ -homomorphism $R_0 \rightarrow R$ which sends N'_0 to $N - d$ and $X_{\alpha,j}$ to $x_{\alpha,j}$, for every α and j . This homomorphism is compatible with the λ -filtrations and sends N_0 to N and X_0 to x . Hence the result follows.

Proposition 6.11. Suppose that K is of characteristic zero, and let $n \geq 0$ be an integer. Then the functor Ch is an equivalence from the category of graded K -algebras A such that $A_0 = K$ and $A_k = 0$ for $k > n$, to the category of augmented K - λ -algebras Λ such that $\text{Fil}^{n+1} \Lambda = 0$. A quasi-inverse functor is given by $\Lambda \mapsto \text{Gr } \Lambda$.

Let A be a graded K -algebra such that $A_k = 0$ for $k > n$, equipped with the filtration associated to its grading. Then $(\text{Ch } A)_{n+1} = 0$, and hence $\text{Fil}^{n+1} \text{Ch } A = 0$ by (6.6.5). Conversely, if Λ is an augmented K - λ -algebra such that $\text{Fil}^{n+1} \Lambda = 0$, then $\text{Gr}^0 \Lambda = K$ and $\text{Gr}^k \Lambda = 0$ for $k > n$.

We shall define isomorphisms of functors

$$A \longrightarrow \text{Gr}(\text{Ch } A), \quad \Lambda \longrightarrow \text{Ch}(\text{Gr } \Lambda).$$

Since A is of finite grading, the associated gradeds of the λ -ring filtration on $\text{Ch } A$ and of the degree filtration are the same by (6.6.7). Define

$$u : A \longrightarrow \text{Gr}_{\deg}(\text{Ch } A)$$

to be the identity on A_0 , and, for $i \geq 1$ and $a_i \in A_i$,

$$u(a_i) = \text{cl}_{\text{Gr}^i} \left(0, 1 + (-1)^{i-1} (i-1)! a_i \right),$$

then extend by additivity. By relation (6.5.3) this is a homomorphism of graded rings, and it is easy to see that it is compatible with the operations of K . The inverse morphism u^{-1} may be defined as follows: for $i \geq 1$ and $\bar{\varphi} \in \text{Gr}^i(\text{Ch } A)$, the i -th coefficient a_i of φ is independent of the lift of $\bar{\varphi}$ in $(\text{Ch } A)_i$, and one puts

$$u^{-1}(\bar{\varphi}) = \frac{(-1)^{i-1}}{(i-1)!} a_i.$$

Thus u is an isomorphism.

The isomorphism $\Lambda \rightarrow \text{Ch}(\text{Gr } \Lambda)$ is defined by the completed Chern class $\tilde{c}$. To verify that it really defines an isomorphism, it is enough to verify that the homomorphism obtained by passing to associated graded rings is one, the filtrations being discrete. One gets

$$\text{Gr } \Lambda \xrightarrow{\text{Gr}(\tilde{c})} \text{Gr}_\lambda(\text{Ch}(\text{Gr } \Lambda)) \simeq \text{Gr}_{\deg}(\text{Ch}(\text{Gr } \Lambda)) \xrightarrow{u^{-1}} \text{Gr } \Lambda.$$

It remains to show that the composite is the identity. Since the homomorphisms are homomorphisms of graded K -algebras, it is enough, by the definition of the λ -ring filtration of Λ , to show that it is the identity on the $\gamma^i(x)$, where $\epsilon(x) = 0$. One then obtains

$$\text{Gr}(\tilde{c})(\gamma^i(x)) = \text{cl}_{\text{Gr}^i}(\gamma^i(c(x))).$$

But $\gamma^i(\tilde{c}(x)) = (0, 1 + (-1)^{i-1} (i-1)! c^i(x) + \dots)$, by (6.6.4). Therefore

$$\text{cl}_{\text{Gr}^i}(\gamma^i(\tilde{c}(x))) = u(c^i(x)),$$

which shows that $u^{-1} \circ \text{Gr}(\tilde{c}) = \text{Id}$.

Corollary 6.12. If K is of characteristic zero, and if Λ is a K - λ -algebra with discrete filtration, then the completed Chern class

$$\tilde{c} : \Lambda \longrightarrow \text{Ch}(\text{Gr } \Lambda)$$

is an isomorphism.

The proof is contained in that of 6.11.

Definition 6.13. Let A be a graded K -algebra and Λ an augmented K - λ -algebra. A *Chern theory for Λ with values in A* is a λ -homomorphism

$$\Lambda \longrightarrow \text{Ch}(A)$$

compatible with augmentations.

Thus one defines a functor on the category of graded K -algebras, with values in the category of sets, by associating with a graded K -algebra A the set of Chern theories of Λ with values in A , namely

$$\text{Hom}_\lambda(\Lambda, \text{Ch}(A)).$$

Proposition 6.14. The functor defined in 6.13 is representable. If K is of characteristic zero and Λ has discrete filtration, it is represented by the graded ring associated with Λ .

First prove the first assertion. Consider the graded K -algebra generated by generators $c^i(x)$, with $i \geq 1$, $x \in \text{Fil}^1 \Lambda$, $c^i(x)$ of degree i , and take its quotient by the following relations:

- i) $c^k(x+y) = \sum_{i+j=k} c^i(x)c^j(y)$, $k \geq 1$, $x, y \in \text{Fil}^1 \Lambda$,
- ii) $c^k(xy) = P_k''(c^i(x), c^j(y))$ (cf. 6.1), $k \geq 1$, $x, y \in \text{Fil}^1 \Lambda$,
- iii) $c^k(ax) = R_{k,a}(c^i(x))$ (cf. 6.1), $k \geq 1$, $a \in K$, $x \in \text{Fil}^1 \Lambda$,
- iv) $c^k(\gamma^j(x)) = Q_{j,k}''(c^i(x))$ (cf. 6.1), $j, k \geq 1$, $x \in \text{Fil}^1 \Lambda$.

These relations are isobaric, so the quotient is a graded K -algebra Ω . Define a morphism

$$\tilde{c}_0 : \Lambda \longrightarrow \text{Ch}(\Omega)$$

by

$$x \longmapsto (\epsilon(x), 1 + c^1(x - \epsilon(x)) + \cdots).$$

The imposed relations show that this is a Chern theory for Λ with values in Ω . Conversely, if f is a Chern theory with values in a graded K -algebra A , then there is a unique homomorphism $\Omega \rightarrow A$ through which f factors through $\text{Ch}(\Omega)$: it sends, for every $i \geq 1$ and every $x \in \text{Fil}^1 \Lambda$, the element $c^i(x)$ to the i -th coefficient of $f(x)$. This is well defined because f is a λ -homomorphism.

Now suppose that K is of characteristic zero and Λ has discrete filtration. Let n be such that $\text{Fil}^n \Lambda = 0$. Then the graded algebra Ω is zero in degrees $> n$. To show this, it is enough to prove that, for

$$x_1, \dots, x_p \in \text{Fil}^1 \Lambda \quad \text{and} \quad k_1 + \cdots + k_p \geq n,$$

one has

$$c^{k_1}(x_1) \cdots c^{k_p}(x_p) = 0.$$

By hypothesis,

$$\gamma^{k_1}(x_1) \cdots \gamma^{k_p}(x_p) = 0.$$

Applying the λ -homomorphism $\tilde{c}_0$, one gets

$$\gamma^{k_1}(\tilde{c}_0(x_1)) \cdots \gamma^{k_p}(\tilde{c}_0(x_p)) = (0, 1).$$

By (6.6.4) and (6.5.3), this implies

$$(k_1 + \cdots + k_p)! c^{k_1}(x_1) \cdots c^{k_p}(x_p) = 0.$$

Since K is of characteristic zero, the desired result follows.

The universal property of Ω , applied to the canonical homomorphism $\tilde{c}$, gives a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Lambda & \xrightarrow{\tilde{c}} & \text{Ch}(\text{Gr } \Lambda) \\ \tilde{c}_0 \downarrow & \nearrow & \\ \text{Ch}(\Omega) & & \end{array}$$

By Proposition 6.11, the homomorphism $\Omega \rightarrow \text{Gr } \Lambda$ is an isomorphism if and only if the homomorphism

$$\text{Ch}(\Omega) \longrightarrow \text{Ch}(\text{Gr } \Lambda)$$

is one. Since it is visibly surjective, the latter is also surjective; it remains to show that $\text{Ch}(\Omega) \rightarrow \text{Ch}(\text{Gr } \Lambda)$ is injective. By functoriality of Ch , one obtains the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Lambda & \xrightarrow{\tilde{c}_0} & \text{Ch}(\Omega) \\ \tilde{c} \downarrow & & \downarrow \tilde{c} \\ \text{Ch}(\text{Gr } \Lambda) & \xrightarrow[\text{Ch}(\tilde{c}_0)]{} & \text{Ch}(\text{Gr } \Lambda(\text{Ch}(\Omega))). \end{array}$$

Since Ω has bounded degrees, the right vertical arrow is an isomorphism by (6.12). Using 6.11, one therefore obtains a morphism

$$\text{Gr } \Lambda \longrightarrow \Omega$$

whose two composites with $\Omega \rightarrow \text{Gr } \Lambda$ are the identity, by the universal property of Ω .

7. Appendix: the Adams operations ψ^k

We follow here a presentation due to J.-P. Serre.

7.1. Let K be a pre- λ -ring. For $x \in K$, write

$$\frac{d}{dt}(\lambda_t(x))$$

for the derivative with respect to t of $\lambda_t(x)$. Define elements of K , denoted $\psi^k(x)$, by putting

$$\frac{d}{dt}(\lambda_t(x))/\lambda_t(x) = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} (-1)^{k-1} \psi^k(x) t^{k-1}. \quad (7.1.1)$$

The maps $\psi^k : K \rightarrow K$ are additive. Indeed,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d}{dt}(\lambda_t(x+y))/\lambda_t(x+y) &= \frac{d}{dt}(\lambda_t(x)\lambda_t(y))/\lambda_t(x)\lambda_t(y) \\ &= \frac{d}{dt}(\lambda_t(x))/\lambda_t(x) + \frac{d}{dt}(\lambda_t(y))/\lambda_t(y), \end{aligned}$$

and therefore, for every k ,

$$\psi^k(x+y) = \psi^k(x) + \psi^k(y).$$

By (7.1.1), the ψ^k are isobaric polynomials of weight k in the λ^i , $i = 1, \dots, k$. For example,

$$\psi^1(x) = \lambda^1(x) = x, \quad \psi^2(x) = x^2 - 2\lambda^2(x).$$

7.2. Let K be a ring of characteristic zero. Suppose given additive maps $\psi^k : K \rightarrow K$ such that $\psi^1 = \text{Id}_K$. Define a pre- λ -structure on K by

$$\lambda_t(x) = \exp \left(\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} (-1)^{k-1} \psi^k(x) t^k / k \right). \quad (7.2.1)$$

Multiplicativity follows from the additivity of the ψ^k . Thus there is an equivalence between giving a pre- λ -structure on K and giving the corresponding operations ψ^k .

7.3. It is clear from formula (7.1.1) that the ψ^k commute with λ -homomorphisms. If K, K' are pre- λ -rings of characteristic zero, it is necessary and sufficient for a homomorphism $f : K \rightarrow K'$

to be a λ -homomorphism that it commute with the ψ^k . This follows from 7.2, since the λ^i are expressed as polynomials in the ψ^k .

Examples 7.4. i) For $K = \mathbb{Z}$, with its λ -ring structure, one has

$$\frac{d}{dt}(\lambda_t(n))/\lambda_t(n) = n(1+t)^{n-1}/(1+t)^n = n \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} (-1)^{k-1} t^{k-1}.$$

Consequently the ψ^k are all equal to the identity map of $\mathbb{Z}$.

ii) Work in the category $\mathcal{C}_0$ of $\mathbb{Z}$ -algebras (1.8). By 7.3, the operations ψ^k define additive endomorphisms of the functor G on λ -rings. By 1.10 they are characterized by their value on $1 + Xt$. One has

$$\frac{d}{dt}(\lambda_u(1 + Xt))/\lambda_u(1 + Xt) = \frac{1 + Xt}{1 + \{1 + Xt\}u} = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} (-1)^{k-1} \{1 + Xt\}^{\circ k} u^{k-1}.$$

Thus

$$\psi^k(1 + Xt) = 1 + X^k t. \quad (7.4.1)$$

Proposition 7.5. i) If K is a λ -ring, the operations ψ^k satisfy the identities

$$\psi^k(1) = 1, \quad \psi^k(xy) = \psi^k(x)\psi^k(y), \quad \psi^k \circ \psi^{k'} = \psi^{kk'}. \quad (7.5.1)$$

ii) Conversely, if the ψ^k satisfy these identities and if K is of characteristic zero, then K is a λ -ring.

For (i), if K is a λ -ring, $\lambda_t(1) = 1 + t$, hence

$$\frac{d}{dt}(\lambda_t(1))/\lambda_t(1) = \frac{1}{1+t} = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} (-1)^{k-1} t^{k-1},$$

and therefore $\psi^k(1) = 1$.

To prove the second relation of (7.5.1), consider the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} K \times K & \xrightarrow{\lambda_t \times \lambda_t} & \widehat{G}(K) \times \widehat{G}(K) & \xrightarrow{g^k \times g^k} & K \times K \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \circ & & \downarrow \\ K & \xrightarrow{\lambda_t} & \widehat{G}(K) & \xrightarrow{g^k} & K, \end{array} \quad (7.5.2)$$

where the vertical arrows are defined by multiplication, and the maps g^k as follows: the logarithmic derivative is a group homomorphism from $G(K)$ to $K[[t]]$, and the map which to a series assigns its $(k-1)$ -st coefficient, multiplied by $(-1)^{k-1}$, is an additive homomorphism from $K[[t]]$ to K ; g^k is their composite. Clearly $g^k \circ \lambda_t = \psi^k$ by definition (7.1.1).

The second of formulas (7.5.1) therefore expresses the commutativity of the diagram just written. If K is a λ -ring, the left square is commutative, and it is enough to verify the commutativity of the right square. This is a diagram of functor homomorphisms on $\mathcal{C}_0$, with source $\widehat{G} \times \widehat{G}$. By 1.10 it is enough to verify commutativity on $(1 + Xt, 1 + Yt)$. Then

$$g^k(1 + Xt) = X^k, \quad g^k(1 + Yt) = Y^k,$$

and

$$g^k((1 + Xt) \circ (1 + Yt)) = g^k(1 + XYt) = (XY)^k = g^k(1 + Xt)g^k(1 + Yt),$$

which gives the result.

To prove the last relation, first observe that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \widehat{G}_t(K) & \xrightarrow{\lambda_u} & \widehat{G}_u \widehat{G}_t(K) \\
 g^k \downarrow & & \downarrow g_u^k \\
 K & \xrightarrow{\lambda_u} & \widehat{G}^u(K)
 \end{array} \tag{7.5.3}$$

is commutative. As above, it is enough to see this for $1 + Xt$, and one has

$$g_u^{k'} \lambda_u(1 + Xt) = g_u^{k'}(1 + \{1 + Xt\}u) = (1 + Xt)^{\circ k'} = 1 + X^{k'}t,$$

and then

$$g^k(1 + X^{k'}t) = X^{kk'} = g^k(1 + Xt).$$

Consequently

$$\psi^k \circ \psi^{k'} = g^k \circ g_u^{k'} \circ \lambda_u \circ \lambda_t = g^k \circ \lambda_t \circ \psi^{k'}.$$

Moreover

$$\psi^k \circ \psi^{k'} = g^k \circ \lambda_t \circ \psi^{k'} = \psi^k \circ \lambda_t \circ \psi^{k'}.$$

If K is a λ -ring, the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 K & \xrightarrow{\lambda_t} & \widehat{G}(K) \\
 \psi^{k'} \downarrow & & \downarrow \psi^{k'} \\
 K & \xrightarrow{\lambda_t} & \widehat{G}(K)
 \end{array} \tag{7.5.4}$$

is commutative by 7.3, since λ_t is a λ -homomorphism. The desired relations follow at once.

For (ii), if K is of characteristic zero, the logarithmic derivative is an isomorphism from $\widehat{G}(K)$ onto $K[[t]]$, since one can integrate. Therefore two elements of $\widehat{G}(K)$ are equal if and only if, for every k , they have the same image by g^k .

To show that λ_t is a ring homomorphism, it is enough to show that the left square in (7.5.2) is commutative. By the preceding remark, it is enough to show that, for every k , diagram (7.5.2) is commutative; the right square always is. But this is exactly the relation

$$\psi^k(xy) = \psi^k(x)\psi^k(y).$$

To show that λ_t is a λ -homomorphism, it is enough, by 7.3, to show that diagram (7.5.4) is commutative for every k' . By the preceding remark, this is equivalent to showing, for all k, k' , that

$$g^k \circ \psi^{k'} \circ \lambda_t = g^k \circ \lambda_t \circ \psi^{k'},$$

that is, the relations $\psi^{kk'} = \psi^k \circ \psi^{k'}$. Finally, the relation $\lambda_t(1) = 1 + t$ is obtained by integration from the relations $\psi^k(1) = 1$.

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Exposé VI. The $K^\bullet$ of a projective bundle: computations and consequences

Pierre Berthelot

1. Computation of $K^\bullet$ of a projective bundle: the case of locally free sheaves of finite type

In this section $K^\bullet(X)$ denotes the Grothendieck group of locally free sheaves of finite type on a scheme X . The aim is to prove the following structure theorem.

Theorem 1.1. Let S be a quasi-compact scheme, let E be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module of rank $r + 1$, and let

$$X = \mathbf{P}(E)$$

be the associated projective bundle. The structural morphism $f : X \rightarrow S$ gives $K^\bullet(X)$ the structure of a $K^\bullet(S)$ -algebra. If $\xi \in K^\bullet(X)$ denotes the class of $\mathcal{O}_X(1)$, then $K^\bullet(X)$ is a free $K^\bullet(S)$ -module with basis

$$1, \xi, \dots, \xi^r.$$

1.2. Plan of the proof

The proof is divided into three parts.

First, one proves that the powers of ξ generate $K^\bullet(X)$ as a $K^\bullet(S)$ -module. For this it is enough to establish the following facts. If F is locally free of finite type on X , one can find a graded $\mathfrak{S}(E)$ -module M , of finite presentation and flat over $\mathcal{O}_S$, such that $F = \text{Proj}_0(M)$. Such an M admits a finite graded resolution

$$0 \longrightarrow L_{r+1} \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow L_0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow 0$$

by graded $\mathfrak{S}(E)$ -modules locally free of finite type. Finally, each L_i has a finite filtration whose quotients are of the form

$$N \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_S} \mathfrak{S}(E)(n),$$

with N locally free of finite type on S . Applying Proj_0 then gives the required generation by the powers of ξ .

Second, one proves that $1, \xi, \dots, \xi^{r+1}$ are linearly dependent over $K^\bullet(S)$. This is obtained from the canonical epimorphism $f^*E \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(1)$.

Third, one proves that $1, \xi, \dots, \xi^r$ are linearly independent over $K^\bullet(S)$.

Let S be a scheme, let $B = \bigoplus_{n \geq 0} B_n$ be a graded $\mathcal{O}_S$ -algebra, and let M be a graded B -module. If N is a graded B -module, $N(n)$ denotes the graded module defined by

$$N(n)_k = N_{n+k}.$$

A graded B -module is said to be free, respectively locally free, respectively locally free of finite type, if locally on S it is a direct sum, respectively locally a direct sum, respectively locally a finite direct sum, of modules $B(n)$. It is said to be of finite presentation if, locally on S , it admits a presentation by free graded modules of finite type.

For every integer n there is a canonical homomorphism of graded B -modules

$$M_n \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_S} B(-n) \longrightarrow M, \quad (1.2.1)$$

defined by $x \otimes a \mapsto ax$. A free graded module of finite type admits a decomposition

$$M \simeq \bigoplus_{n=n_0}^{n_1} B(-n)^{k_n}. \quad (1.2.2)$$

Proposition 1.2. The integers k_n occurring in a decomposition (1.2.2) are independent of the chosen decomposition.

Indeed, after restricting to an open set where $B_0 = \mathcal{O}_S$, one compares the first non-zero homogeneous component. This determines k_{n_0} ; passing to the quotient and arguing by induction gives all the k_n .

Proposition 1.3. Let S be quasi-compact, let E be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module of finite type, let $X = \mathbf{P}(E)$, and let F be an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module of finite presentation which is flat over S . Then there exists an integer n_0 such that, for all $n \geq n_0$,

- (i) $R^i f_*(F(n)) = 0 \quad (i \geq 1),$
- (ii) $f_*(F(n))$ is locally free of finite type on S ,
- (iii) $M = \bigoplus_{n \geq n_0} f_*(F(n))$ is a graded $\mathfrak{S}(E)$ -module of finite presentation.

The statement is local on S . Since S is quasi-compact, one is reduced to the affine case. If S is noetherian, (i) is Serre's theorem, (ii) follows from EGA III, 7.9.10, and (iii) from the usual comparison between a coherent sheaf on a projective bundle and its associated graded module.

In the general affine case one uses passage to the limit. Write $S = \operatorname{Spec}(A)$ as a filtered projective limit of noetherian affine schemes $S_\lambda = \operatorname{Spec}(A_\lambda)$, with affine transition morphisms. The locally free module E , the scheme X , and the sheaf F descend, after increasing λ , to corresponding data $E_\lambda, X_\lambda, F_\lambda$, with F_λ flat over S_λ . The noetherian case applies to F_λ , and the theorem of change of base gives the assertions after pullback to S .

In this reduction one uses the Cartesian square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{g} & X_0 \\ f \downarrow & & \downarrow f_0 \\ S & \xrightarrow{g_0} & S_0. \end{array}$$

Here S_0 is noetherian, $X_0 = \mathbf{P}(E_0)$, and $F = g^*(F_0)$. The previous paragraph proves the assertion for F_0 , and EGA III, 7.7.5 and 7.8.5 give the required base-change identifications for F .

Corollary 1.4. Under the hypotheses of Proposition 1.3 there exists a graded $\mathfrak{S}(E)$ -module M , of finite presentation and flat over $\mathcal{O}_S$, such that

$$F = \operatorname{Proj}_0(M).$$

Proposition 1.5. Let A be a ring, let B be an A -algebra of finite presentation, and let M be a B -module of finite presentation. Suppose that B and M are flat over A , and that, for every residue field k of A , the $B \otimes_A k$ -module $M \otimes_A k$ has projective dimension at most n . Then M has a resolution of length n by projective B -modules of finite type:

$$0 \longrightarrow L_n \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow L_0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow 0.$$

This is the local criterion of EGA IV, 12.3.2.

Proposition 1.7. Let S be quasi-compact, let E be locally free of rank $r + 1$, let $B = \mathfrak{S}(E)$ with its usual grading, and let M be a graded B -module of finite presentation, flat over S . Then M admits a graded resolution

$$0 \longrightarrow L_{r+1} \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow L_0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow 0,$$

where the L_i are graded B -modules locally free of finite type.

First, M admits a graded epimorphism $L \rightarrow M$ with L locally free of finite type: choose an integer N such that M is generated in degrees $\leq N$, and take

$$L = \bigoplus_{i \leq N} M_i \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_S} B(-i),$$

with the morphism (1.2.1). Repeating the construction for successive kernels gives a global graded resolution. After $r + 1$ steps, Proposition 1.5 shows locally on affine opens that the final kernel is projective over B , hence locally free as a graded B -module; truncation gives the asserted resolution.

Proposition 1.8. Let S be quasi-compact, let E be locally free of finite type, let $B = \mathfrak{S}(E)$, and let L be a graded B -module locally free of finite type. Then L admits a finite decreasing filtration by graded submodules $L^{(m)}$ such that

- (i) $L^{(m)} = L$ for $m \leq m_0$,
- (ii) $L^{(m)} = 0$ for $m \geq m_1$,
- (iii) $\mathrm{gr}^m L \simeq N_m \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_S} B(m)$,

where N_m is locally free of finite type on S .

The question is local on S . Since S is quasi-compact, the degrees of homogeneous bases that occur locally lie between two fixed integers. One argues by induction on the length of this interval. The first step is the canonical map from the lowest non-zero homogeneous component,

$$L_{n_0} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_S} B(-n_0) \longrightarrow L,$$

which locally identifies the corresponding direct summand. The quotient has local homogeneous bases in higher degrees, and induction applies.

1.9. Generation and the relation

Let F be locally free of finite type on X . By Corollary 1.4 and Proposition 1.7, F comes from a graded module M admitting a finite graded resolution by L_i 's. Applying Proj_0 gives an exact sequence of locally free sheaves on X , and therefore in $K^\bullet(X)$

$$\mathrm{cl}(F) = \sum_i (-1)^i \mathrm{cl}(\mathrm{Proj}_0(L_i)).$$

Using the filtration of Proposition 1.8, each term is a sum of classes

$$\mathrm{cl}(f^* N_{ij}(j)) = f^* \mathrm{cl}(N_{ij}) \xi^j.$$

Thus $K^\bullet(X)$ is generated as a $K^\bullet(S)$ -module by the powers of ξ .

For linear dependence, use the canonical epimorphism $f^* E \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(1)$. Its kernel is locally free of rank r . Hence

$$\lambda^{r+1}(f^* E - \xi) = 0.$$

Since $\lambda_t(-\xi) = 1/(1 + \xi t)$, one obtains the relation

$$\sum_{i=0}^{r+1} (-1)^i \lambda^i(E) \xi^{r+1-i} = 0, \quad (1.9.1)$$

equivalently the characteristic equation of ξ associated with the locally free module E .

1.10–1.11. Linear independence

The proof of the linear-independence assertion is due to J.-P. Jouanolou.

Lemma 1.10. With the hypotheses of Theorem 1.1, let F and G be locally free sheaves of finite type on X , and suppose that they have the same class in $K^\bullet(X)$. Then there is an integer n_0 such that, for all $n \geq n_0$,

- (i) $f_*(F(n))$ and $f_*(G(n))$ are locally free of finite type on S ,
- (ii) $\text{cl } f_*(F(n)) = \text{cl } f_*(G(n))$ in $K^\bullet(S)$.

An equality of classes in $K^\bullet(X)$ is a finite integral combination of relations coming from short exact sequences of locally free sheaves. Twisting by $\mathcal{O}_X(n)$ and applying f_* , for n large enough all higher direct images vanish and all direct images are locally free of finite type; the same relations then hold in $K^\bullet(S)$.

Suppose that

$$f^*(x_0) + f^*(x_1)\xi + \cdots + f^*(x_r)\xi^r = 0. \quad (1.11.1)$$

Writing each x_i as a difference of classes of locally free sheaves and adding suitable summands, (1.11.1) is converted into an equality $\text{cl}(F) = \text{cl}(G)$ for locally free sheaves of finite type on X . By Lemma 1.10, for all sufficiently large n one has

$$\sum_{i=0}^r x_i \sigma_{n+i}(E) = 0 \quad \text{in } K^\bullet(S), \quad (1.11.2)$$

where $\sigma_p(E)$ denotes the class of $\mathfrak{S}^p(E)$, and $\sigma_p(E) = 0$ for $p < 0$.

The Koszul complex of the symmetric algebra gives, for $p \geq 1$,

$$\sum_{i=0}^{r+1} (-1)^i \lambda^i(E) \sigma_{p-i}(E) = 0. \quad (1.11.3)$$

Using this relation, one descends by induction from large n in (1.11.2). It follows that (1.11.2) holds for all $n \geq -r$. Taking $n = -r$ gives $x_r = 0$; repeating the argument gives successively all $x_i = 0$. This proves the linear independence and hence Theorem 1.1.

Remark 1.12. Let

$$\sigma_t(E) = \sum_{i \geq 0} \sigma_i(E) t^i.$$

The relation (1.11.3) is equivalent to

$$\lambda_t(E) \sigma_{-t}(E) = 1.$$

It follows in particular that σ_t is additive and extends to a homomorphism

$$K^\bullet(S) \longrightarrow 1 + K^\bullet(S)[[t]]_+.$$

Remark 1.13. Any sequence of $r + 1$ consecutive powers of ξ is a basis of $K^\bullet(X)$ over $K^\bullet(S)$. If

$$x = 1 - \xi^{-1}$$

is the class of a hyperplane section, then $1, x, \dots, x^r$ is also a basis. The dependence relation becomes

$$\sum_{k=0}^{r+1} \lambda^{r+1-k} (\check{E} - r - 1) x^k = 0. \quad (1.13.1)$$

For $E = \mathcal{O}_S^{r+1}$, so that $X = \mathbf{P}_S^r$, this reduces to

$$x^{r+1} = 0.$$

Using relative schemes in Hakim's sense, Theorem 1.1 also makes sense when S is a locally ringed topos; if the final object of the topos is quasi-compact, the proof transports without essential change.

2. Computation of $K^\bullet$ of a projective bundle: the case of perfect complexes

This section is not used in the rest of the Seminar. Here $K^\bullet(X)$ denotes the Grothendieck group of perfect complexes on X .

Theorem 2.1. Let S be quasi-compact, let E be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module of rank $r + 1$, let $X = \mathbf{P}(E)$, and let $\xi \in K^\bullet(X)$ be the class of the complex reduced to $\mathcal{O}_X(1)$ in degree zero. Then $K^\bullet(X)$ is a free $K^\bullet(S)$ -module with basis

$$1, \xi, \dots, \xi^r.$$

2.2. Notation

Let $B = \mathfrak{S}(E)$. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be the category of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules, $\mathcal{G}$ the category of graded B -modules, $\mathcal{G}_0$ the full subcategory of graded B -modules locally free of finite type, and $\mathcal{G}'$ the category of $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules. If $L^\bullet$ is a complex on X , put

$$L^\bullet(n) = L^\bullet \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} \mathcal{O}_X(n).$$

2.3. The functor Proj_0

We shall need to apply Proj_0 to arbitrary graded B -modules, and not only to quasi-coherent ones. If $Y = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ and $f : Y \rightarrow S$, the isomorphism

$$A \simeq f_* \mathcal{O}_Y$$

gives, by adjunction, a morphism of ringed spaces

$$\tilde{f} : (Y, \mathcal{O}_Y) \longrightarrow (S, A)$$

and therefore an exact inverse-image functor

$$\tilde{f}^*(M) = f^{-1}(M) \otimes_{f^{-1}A} \mathcal{O}_Y.$$

For quasi-coherent A -modules this is the usual associated module.

Now let B be graded and quasi-coherent, let M be a graded B -module, and let $X = \text{Proj}(B)$. For an affine open $U \subset S$ and a homogeneous section s of positive degree over U , let $M_{(s),U}$ be the homogeneous component of degree zero of the module of fractions M_s . Thus

$$M_{(s),U} = ((M|_U) \otimes_{B|_U} (B|_U)_s)_0.$$

On the standard affine open

$$D_+(U, s) \simeq \text{Spec}((B|_U)_{(s)})$$

one defines

$$\text{Proj}_0(M)_{U,s} = \tilde{f}_{U,s}^*(M_{(s),U}).$$

If $V \subset U$ is affine, the modules just defined restrict compatibly. If t is another homogeneous section on U , one uses the standard diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} D_+(st) & \xrightarrow{i} & D_+(s) \\ f_{U,st} \downarrow & & \downarrow f_{U,s} \\ U & \xlongequal{\quad} & U \end{array}$$

and the canonical identifications of the localized degree-zero modules to see that the local sheaves glue. The result is a functor

$$\text{Proj}_0 : \mathcal{G} \longrightarrow \mathcal{A}.$$

It is exact, and for quasi-coherent graded modules it is the usual functor of EGA II. Hence by passage to derived categories it gives

$$\text{Proj}_0 : D^+(\mathcal{G}) \longrightarrow D^+(\mathcal{A}).$$

2.4. The functor F_k

For an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module L and an integer k , set

$$F_k(L) = \bigoplus_{n \geq k} f_*(L(n)). \quad (2.4.1)$$

The functor F_k is left exact and therefore has a right derived functor

$$RF_k : D^+(\mathcal{A}) \longrightarrow D^+(\mathcal{G}). \quad (2.4.2)$$

If L is locally free of finite type, then for k sufficiently large it is F_k -acyclic, by the vanishing theorem used above in 1.3.

For every k there is a functorial morphism

$$\beta : \text{Proj}_0(F_k(F)) \longrightarrow F, \quad (2.5.1)$$

constructed on each $D_+(U, s)$ by the usual localization formula: a fraction represented by a homogeneous section of sufficiently high degree is sent to the corresponding local section of F . In the quasi-coherent case this is the canonical morphism of EGA. Passing to derived categories gives

$$\text{Proj}_0 \circ RF_k \longrightarrow \text{id}_{D^+(\mathcal{A})}. \quad (2.5.2)$$

Proposition 2.6. Let S be quasi-compact, let E be locally free of finite type, let $X = \mathbf{P}(E)$, and let $L^\bullet$ be a perfect complex on X . Then, for k sufficiently large,

- (i) $RF_k(L^\bullet)$ is $\mathcal{G}_0$ -perfect,
- (ii) $\text{Proj}_0 RF_k(L^\bullet) \longrightarrow L^\bullet$ is an isomorphism in $D^+(\mathcal{A})$.

The assertion is local on S . One may therefore assume S affine. Since $\mathcal{O}_X(1)$ is ample, the perfect complex $L^\bullet$ is locally, and then globally after refining, represented by a bounded complex whose terms are locally free of finite type. For k sufficiently large all those finitely many terms are F_k -acyclic, and the graded modules $F_k(L^i)$ are $\mathcal{G}_0$ -perfect. This gives (i), and the morphism (2.5.2) is then an isomorphism term by term, giving (ii).

2.7. Decomposition of a $\mathcal{G}_0$ -perfect complex

On $\mathcal{G}$, the functor which associates to a graded B -module its n -th homogeneous component is exact with values in $\mathcal{G}'$; it defines a functor

$$\text{Comp}_n : D^+(\mathcal{G}) \longrightarrow D^+(\mathcal{G}'). \quad (2.7.1)$$

The homomorphism (1.2.1) gives a morphism of functors

$$\text{Comp}_n \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_S} B(-n) \longrightarrow \text{id}_{D^+(\mathcal{G})}. \quad (2.7.2)$$

Let $M^\bullet$ be a $\mathcal{G}_0$ -perfect complex. We shall show that there exists a finite sequence of distinguished triangles

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & P_1^\bullet & & P_2^\bullet & \\ & \swarrow \quad \searrow & & \swarrow \quad \searrow & \\ N_1^\bullet & & M^\bullet & & N_2^\bullet & P_1^\bullet \\ & & & & & \\ & & P_k^\bullet & & & \\ & \swarrow \quad \searrow & & \swarrow \quad \searrow & & \\ \dots & & N_k^\bullet & & P_{k-1}^\bullet & \end{array}$$

where each $P_k^\bullet$ at the last stage is acyclic, the terms $N_i^\bullet$ are of the form

$$N_i^\bullet = K_i^\bullet \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_S} B(d_i),$$

and the $K_i^\bullet$ are perfect complexes on S in the ordinary sense.

Indeed, because $M^\bullet$ is $\mathcal{G}_0$ -perfect and S is quasi-compact, there exists a finite covering of S and an integer d_0 such that, on every open of the covering, $M^\bullet$ is represented by a bounded complex of locally free B -modules of finite type, with no homogeneous generators in degrees $< d_0$. Taking d_0 minimal, the morphism (2.7.2) extracts the part of the lowest degree. Its cone has all homogeneous generators in strictly higher degrees. Repeating the process, and using the finiteness of the degree interval from Proposition 1.8, one obtains the desired finite sequence of triangles.

2.8. Proof of Theorem 2.1

Let $L^\bullet$ be a perfect complex on X . For k sufficiently large put

$$M^\bullet = RF_k(L^\bullet).$$

By Proposition 2.6, $M^\bullet$ is $\mathcal{G}_0$ -perfect and $\text{Proj}_0(M^\bullet) \simeq L^\bullet$. Applying the decomposition of 2.7 and then Proj_0 , one obtains in $K^\bullet(X)$

$$\text{cl}(L^\bullet) = \sum_i \text{cl}(f^* K_i^\bullet(d_i)) = \sum_i f^* \text{cl}(K_i^\bullet) \xi^{d_i}.$$

Thus the powers of ξ generate $K^\bullet(X)$ as a $K^\bullet(S)$ -module.

The dependence relation is the same relation (1.9.1), now interpreted in the Grothendieck group of perfect complexes. For linear independence one uses the $K^\bullet(S)$ -linear homomorphism

$$f_* : K^\bullet(X) \longrightarrow K^\bullet(S).$$

For the structure sheaf and negative twists of the projective bundle one has

$$f_*(1) = 1, \quad f_*(\xi^n) = 0 \quad (-r \leq n < 0).$$

Multiplying a relation among $1, \xi, \dots, \xi^r$ by suitable negative powers of ξ and applying f_* successively gives all its coefficients equal to zero. This completes the proof of Theorem 2.1.

2.8. End of the proof of Theorem 2.1

The proof is finished by induction. Indeed, if $0 \leq s \leq r$ and if $x_j = 0$ for $s < j \leq r$, one has

$$\sum_{i=0}^s f^*(x_i) \xi^i = 0,$$

hence

$$\sum_{i=0}^s f^*(x_i) \xi^{i+r-s} = 0,$$

and consequently $x_s = 0$, by what precedes.

3. Consequences of the structure theorem for the $K^\bullet$ of a projective bundle

Proposition 3.1. Let S be a quasi-compact scheme, let $E_1, \dots, E_n$ be locally free $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules of finite type, let $D(E_i)$ be the flag scheme of E_i , and put

$$X = D(E_1) \times_S \cdots \times_S D(E_n).$$

Then the canonical homomorphism

$$K^\bullet(S) \longrightarrow K^\bullet(X)$$

is injective, whether $K^\bullet$ is defined from locally free $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules of finite type or from perfect complexes.

Using the universal property of flag schemes, one immediately checks that X may be constructed as follows. Consider the sequence of S -schemes $X_1, \dots, X_n$ defined recursively by taking X_k to be the flag scheme of the inverse image of E_k on X_{k-1} ; then $X = X_n$. Thus, by induction, it is enough to treat the case $n = 1$, namely the case in which X is the flag scheme of a locally free $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module E of finite type.

In that case X may in turn be constructed by successive projective bundles. Put $E = F_0$, $S = X_0$, and define $X_1, \dots, X_n$ and, on each X_i , a locally free module F_i by

$$X_k = \mathbf{P}(F_{k-1}), \quad F_k = \text{Ker}(f_k^*(F_{k-1}) \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X_k}(1)),$$

where $f_k : X_k \rightarrow X_{k-1}$ is the structural morphism. It is therefore enough to prove the assertion when X is a projective bundle over S ; this follows immediately from 1.1, respectively 2.1.

Theorem 3.2. Let S be a quasi-compact scheme. The pre- λ -ring $K^\bullet(S)$, defined from the locally free $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules of finite type, is a λ -ring.

Since the homomorphism

$$\lambda_t : K^\bullet(S) \longrightarrow 1 + K^\bullet(S)[[t]]^+$$

is additive, to verify that it is a λ -homomorphism it is enough to verify the universal relations on elements of the form $\text{cl}(E)$, where E is a locally free $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module of finite type. Thus one is reduced to showing that for every pair of elements $E, F \in K^\bullet(S)$, classes of locally free finite-type $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules E, F , the relations V 2.4.2 are satisfied:

$$\lambda^i(EF) = P_i(\lambda^1(E), \dots, \lambda^i(E); \lambda^1(F), \dots, \lambda^i(F)),$$

$$\lambda^j(\lambda^i(E)) = Q_{ij}(\lambda^1(E), \dots, \lambda^{ij}(E)).$$

Since S is quasi-compact, there is a finite covering of S by disjoint open subsets on each of which E and F have constant rank. Since $K^\bullet$ of a finite disjoint union of opens is the product of their $K^\bullet$'s, one may assume that E and F have constant rank on S .

Let

$$X = D(E) \times_S D(F).$$

The homomorphism $K^\bullet(S) \rightarrow K^\bullet(X)$ is injective by 3.1. Hence, to prove the relations V 2.4.2, one may work in $K^\bullet(X)$. There the elements E and F split as sums of classes of invertible sheaves. By additivity, it is enough to verify the same relations for elements ξ, η , classes of invertible sheaves. Written in the form V 2.4.1, they become

$$1 + \xi\eta t = (1 + \xi t) \circ (1 + \eta t), \quad \lambda_u(1 + \xi t) = 1 + \{1 + \xi t\}u.$$

These are precisely the relations V 2.3.1 and 2.3.3 defining the λ -ring structure of $1 + K^\bullet(S)[[t]]^+$.

Theorem 3.3. Let (T, A) be a commutatively ringed topos, and let K denote the Grothendieck group of A -modules locally free of bounded rank on T . Then K , endowed with its canonical pre- λ -structure (V 2.2 b)), is a λ -ring.

To prove that K is a λ -ring, one has to prove the relations V 2.4.1; by additivity, it is enough to prove them for elements E, F which are classes of A -modules locally free of bounded rank. Since the ranks of E and F are bounded, one may decompose T into a finite “disjoint sum” of opens on which E and F have constant rank. By using the compatibility of $K^\bullet$ with finite direct sums, and by writing the relations V 2.4.1 in the form V 2.4.2, one is reduced to the case of A -modules E, F locally free of finite constant rank.

If E has rank n , there is a torsor P under $\text{GL}(n, A)$ such that

$$E = P \times_{\text{GL}(n, A)} A^n,$$

where A^n is considered as a $\text{GL}(n, A)$ -module by the standard representation. One obtains a λ -homomorphism from $R_{\mathbb{Z}}(\text{GL}(n))$ to K by sending a representation of $\text{GL}(n)$ in a free $\mathbb{Z}$ -module of rank p to the class of the locally free A -module $P \times_{\text{GL}(n, A)} A^p$. The class of E is the image of the standard representation. Thus any polynomial relation between the $\lambda^i(E)$ follows from the corresponding relation for the standard representation in $R_{\mathbb{Z}}(\text{GL}(n))$.

The same argument, with two locally free A -modules E, F of ranks n, p , uses a torsor under $\text{GL}(n, A) \times \text{GL}(p, A)$ and reduces the mixed relations between the $\lambda^i(E)$ and the $\lambda^j(F)$ to the representation ring $R_{\mathbb{Z}}(\text{GL}(n) \times \text{GL}(p))$. It remains only to know that, for every group scheme G over $\text{Spec } \mathbb{Z}$, finite product of linear group schemes, the pre- λ -ring $R_{\mathbb{Z}}(G)$ is a λ -ring. For this one may refer to [5], where $R_{\mathbb{Z}}(G)$ is computed explicitly. Alternatively one can reason as in 3.2, using 1.14.

4. Computation of $K^\bullet$ of a flag bundle

4.1

Let S be a scheme and let E be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module of rank n . Let

$$\pi = (p_1, \dots, p_k)$$

be a sequence of integers ≥ 1 with

$$\sum_{i=1}^k p_i = n.$$

The flag functor of type π of E is the functor, on the category of S -schemes, which to an S -scheme $X \xrightarrow{f} S$ assigns the set of chains of quotients of $f^*(E)$

$$(L_{k-1}, \dots, L_1),$$

where L_i is a quotient of L_{i+1} , locally free of rank $p_1 + \dots + p_i$.

This functor is representable by an S -scheme $D_\pi(E)$, endowed with a canonical chain of quotients of the inverse image of E , locally free of ranks

$$p_1, \quad p_1 + p_2, \quad \dots$$

If $\pi = (1, n-1)$, then $D_\pi(E) = \mathbf{P}(E)$. If $\pi = (r, n-r)$, then $D_\pi(E) = G_{r,n}(E)$, the Grassmannian of type $(r, n-r)$ of E . If all p_i are equal to 1, one obtains the usual flag bundle of E , denoted $D(E)$.

Lemma 4.2. Let S be a scheme, let E be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module of rank n , and let

$$\pi = (p_1, \dots, p_i, \dots, p_k), \quad p_1 + \dots + p_k = n.$$

Let $p', p'' \geq 1$ with $p' + p'' = p_i$, and put

$$\pi' = (p_1, \dots, p_{i-1}, p', p'', p_{i+1}, \dots, p_k), \quad \pi'' = (p', p'').$$

Let $L_1, \dots, L_{k-1}$ be the canonical quotients of the inverse image of E on $D_\pi(E)$, and let F be the kernel of $L_i \rightarrow L_{i-1}$. Then there is a canonical S -isomorphism

$$D_{\pi'}(E) \simeq D_{\pi''}(F).$$

The proof is immediate from the functorial definition of flag schemes and is left to the reader.

Lemma 4.3. Let A be a commutative ring with unit, let $n > 0$, let $(c_i)_{1 \leq i \leq n}$ be a family of elements of A , and let C be the A -algebra generated by $\xi_1, \dots, \xi_n$ subject to the relations

$$\sigma_i(\xi_1, \dots, \xi_n) = c_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, n,$$

where the σ_i are the elementary symmetric functions. Let $p_1, \dots, p_k$ be integers ≥ 1 with sum n , and, for $1 \leq j \leq k$, put

$$\xi^{(j)} = (\xi_1^{(j)}, \dots, \xi_{p_j}^{(j)}), \quad \xi_i^{(j)} = \xi_{\sum_{\alpha < j} p_\alpha + i}.$$

Set

$$c_i^{(j)} = \sigma_i(\xi_1^{(j)}, \dots, \xi_{p_j}^{(j)}), \quad 1 \leq j \leq k, \quad 1 \leq i \leq p_j,$$

and let B be the subalgebra of C generated by the $c_i^{(j)}$. Then:

i) The elements

$$(\xi^{(1)})^{\alpha(1)} \dots (\xi^{(k)})^{\alpha(k)}, \quad 0 \leq \alpha_i^{(j)} \leq p_j - i,$$

form a basis of C as a B -module.

ii) The generators $c_i^{(j)}$ of the A -algebra B satisfy the n isobaric relations deduced from

$$\sum_{i=1}^n c_i = \sum_{j=1}^k \sum_{i=1}^{p_j} c_i^{(j)}$$

(the c_i and $c_i^{(j)}$ being assigned weight i), and these n relations generate the ideal of relations among the $c_i^{(j)}$.

Corollary 4.4. The elements of C of the form

$$\xi_1^{\alpha_1} \dots \xi_{n-1}^{\alpha_{n-1}}, \quad 0 \leq \alpha_i \leq n - i,$$

form a basis of C as an A -module.

For the proof of the lemma and of the corollary, we refer to [2], exposé 4, page 4.19, from which they are borrowed.

4.5

Let S be quasi-compact, let E be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module of rank n , and let $\pi = (p_1, \dots, p_k)$ be a sequence of integers ≥ 1 with sum n . Put $X = D_\pi(E)$, and let X be endowed with its canonical chain of quotients L_i . Put $L_0 = 0$, $L_k = f^*(E)$, where $f : X \rightarrow S$ is the structural morphism. For $1 \leq j \leq k$, let F_j denote the kernel of $L_j \rightarrow L_{j-1}$. Let $K^\bullet(X)$ be the Grothendieck group of locally free sheaves of finite type on X , respectively of perfect complexes. Denote by F_j the class of F_j , and by $\lambda_i^{(j)}$ the class of $\lambda^i(F_j)$. In the case where $K^\bullet(X)$ is defined in terms of perfect complexes, the series $\lambda_t(E)$, $\lambda_t(F_j)$ are still given their evident meaning, where E is the class of E . Finally, note that

$$\sum_{j=1}^k F_j = E.$$

Theorem 4.6. With the hypotheses and notation of 4.5, the $K^\bullet(S)$ -algebra $K^\bullet(X)$ is generated by the $\lambda_i^{(j)}$. The ideal of relations among the $\lambda_i^{(j)}$ is generated by the relations deduced from

$$\lambda_t(E) = \prod_{j=1}^k \lambda_t(F_j).$$

Equivalently, $K^\bullet(X)$ is the $K^\bullet(S)$ - λ -algebra generated by $F_1, \dots, F_k$, subject to the relations (cf. V 4.6)

$$\text{i) } \lambda^p(F_i) = 0 \text{ for } p > p_i, \quad \text{ii) } \sum_i F_i = E.$$

We begin with the case where all p_i are equal to 1. The theorem then says the following.

Corollary 4.7. Let S be a quasi-compact scheme, let E be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module of rank n , let X be the flag bundle of E , and let $\xi_1, \dots, \xi_n$ be the classes of the invertible sheaves $F_1, \dots, F_n$ (notation 3.5). Then $K^\bullet(X)$ is the $K^\bullet(S)$ -algebra generated by the ξ_i , subject to the relations

$$\sigma_i(\xi_1, \dots, \xi_n) = \lambda^i(E).$$

The proof is by induction on n . For $n = 1$ the assertion is trivial. Assume it known for $n - 1$, and consider $\mathbf{P}(E)$ with the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow g^*(E) \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathbf{P}(E)}(1) \longrightarrow 0,$$

where g is the structural morphism of $\mathbf{P}(E)$. By Lemma 4.2, X is identified with the usual flag bundle $D(F)$ over $\mathbf{P}(E)$, and the canonical sheaves correspond under this identification. The diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} D(E) = D(F) & \xrightarrow{h} & \mathbf{P}(E) \\ & \searrow f & \downarrow g \\ & & S \end{array}$$

shows that $K^\bullet(S) \rightarrow K^\bullet(X)$ factors through $K^\bullet(\mathbf{P}(E))$. By the induction hypothesis applied to $D(F)$, and by Corollary 3.4, $K^\bullet(X)$ has a $K^\bullet(\mathbf{P}(E))$ -basis consisting of the elements

$$\xi_2^{\alpha_2} \cdots \xi_n^{\alpha_n}, \quad 0 \leq \alpha_i \leq n - i.$$

Moreover, $K^\bullet(\mathbf{P}(E))$ has $K^\bullet(S)$ -basis

$$1, \xi_1, \dots, \xi_1^{n-1}.$$

Thus $K^\bullet(X)$ has, as a $K^\bullet(S)$ -basis, the elements

$$\xi_1^{\alpha_1} \cdots \xi_{n-1}^{\alpha_{n-1}}, \quad 0 \leq \alpha_i \leq n - i.$$

Additivity of λ_t gives

$$\prod_i (1 + \xi_i t) = \lambda_t(E),$$

and hence the relations of the corollary. Conversely, if C is the $K^\bullet(S)$ -algebra generated by ξ_i subject to the relations

$$\sigma_i(\xi_1, \dots, \xi_n) = \lambda^i(E),$$

then there is a surjective homomorphism $C \rightarrow K^\bullet(X)$. By 4.4 this homomorphism sends a basis of C to a basis of $K^\bullet(X)$, hence is an isomorphism.

We now treat the general flag bundle of type π . The usual flag bundle $D(E)$ is obtained from $D_\pi(E)$ by successively constructing the flag bundles of the F_j 's (4.2). It follows that $K^\bullet(D(E))$, considered as a module over $K^\bullet(X)$, has a basis formed by the elements considered in 4.3.i), the $\xi_i^{(j)}$ being the classes of the sheaves analogous to the F_j 's which occur in the splitting of the inverse images of the F_j 's on $D(E)$. Thus $K^\bullet(X)$ is a subring of $K^\bullet(D(E))$, and additivity of λ_t gives

$$\lambda_i^{(j)} = \sigma_i(\xi_1^{(j)}, \dots, \xi_{p_j}^{(j)}).$$

Let B be the subalgebra generated by these elements. By 4.3.i), the same family is a basis of $K^\bullet(D(E))$ both as a B -module and as a $K^\bullet(X)$ -module; hence $K^\bullet(X) = B$, which proves that $K^\bullet(X)$ is generated by the $\lambda_i^{(j)}$. The ideal of relations is then given by 4.3.ii), in view of the $K^\bullet(S)$ -module structure of $K^\bullet(D(E))$, determined by 4.7, and the fact that the $\xi_i^{(j)}$ are the classes of the sheaves occurring in the splitting of the inverse image of E on $D(E)$. This proves the first form of 4.6.

To deduce the second form, observe that the elements F_i of the $K^\bullet(S)$ - λ -algebra $K^\bullet(X)$ satisfy relations i) and ii). If A is the $K^\bullet(S)$ - λ -algebra generated by elements F'_i satisfying i) and ii), there is a $K^\bullet(S)$ - λ -homomorphism $A \rightarrow K^\bullet(X)$ sending F'_i to F_i (V 4.7). By 4.6 this homomorphism is surjective. Since the λ -ideal generated by relations i) and ii) contains the

ordinary ideal generated by the relations of the first form of 4.6, the homomorphism is also injective, hence an isomorphism.

Corollary 4.8. With the hypotheses and notation of 4.5, put

$$c_i^{(j)} = \gamma^i(F_j - p_j), \quad 1 \leq i \leq p_j.$$

Then the $K^\bullet(S)$ -algebra $K^\bullet(X)$ is generated by the $c_i^{(j)}$, and the ideal of relations among them is generated by the relations deduced from

$$\gamma_t(E - n) = \prod_{j=1}^k \gamma_t(F_j - p_j).$$

This is merely another statement of 4.6: one can express the $c_i^{(j)}$ as functions of the $\lambda_i^{(j)}$, and conversely. Moreover, $\lambda_t(E) = \prod \lambda_t(F_j)$ is equivalent to

$$\gamma_t(E - n) = \prod_j \gamma_t(F_j - p_j).$$

4.9

Let S be a scheme. Denote by $G_S^{n,r}$ the Grassmannian of type $(n, r - n)$ of $(\mathcal{O}_S)^r$, with $r \geq n$. As r varies, the $G_S^{n,r}$'s form an inductive system, the morphism

$$G_S^{n,r} \longrightarrow G_S^{n,r+1}$$

being defined by considering $(\mathcal{O}_S^n)^r$ as a quotient of $(\mathcal{O}_S^n)^{r+1}$ by the $(r + 1)$ -st factor. In this system the canonical quotients correspond by inverse image. The inductive system thus defined will be denoted $G_S^{n,\infty}$. Its $K^\bullet$ is defined by

$$K^\bullet(G_S^{n,\infty}) = \varprojlim_r K^\bullet(G_S^{n,r}). \quad (4.9.1)$$

Let F_1, F_2 be the canonical sheaves on $G_S^{n,r}$ (4.5), and denote also by F_1, F_2 their classes in $K^\bullet(G_S^{n,r})$. Put

$$c_i = \gamma^i(F_1 - n).$$

When r varies, the c_i 's are compatible with the transition morphisms and hence define elements, again denoted c_i , of $K^\bullet(G_S^{n,\infty})$.

Proposition 4.10. Let S be quasi-compact. With the notation of 4.9, one has an isomorphism

$$K^\bullet(G_S^{n,\infty}) \simeq K^\bullet(S)[[c_1, \dots, c_n]].$$

Indeed, by 4.8, $K^\bullet(G_S^{n,r})$ is the $K^\bullet(S)$ -algebra generated by

$$c_i = \gamma^i(F_1 - n), \quad 1 \leq i \leq n,$$

and by the $\gamma^j(F_2 - r + n)$, $1 \leq j \leq r - n$, subject to the relations deduced from

$$\gamma_t(F_1 - n) \gamma_t(F_2 - r + n) = \gamma_t(r - n) = 1,$$

that is,

$$\gamma_t(F_2 - r + n) = \frac{1}{\gamma_t(F_1 - n)}.$$

This relation expresses the $\gamma^j(F_2 - r + n)$ in terms of the c_i 's, and gives a series of isobaric relations among the c_i 's (with c_i of weight i) by requiring that the coefficients of $1/\gamma_t(F_1 - n)$ vanish in degrees $> r - n$. These relations generate the ideal of relations among the c_i 's. Thus

$$K^\bullet(G_S^{n,r}) = K^\bullet(S)[c_1, \dots, c_n]/I_r,$$

where I_r is a homogeneous ideal of degree $> r - n$. It follows from (4.9.1) that $K^\bullet(G_S^{n,\infty})$ is the separated completion of $K^\bullet(S)[c_1, \dots, c_n]$ for the topology defined by the I_r 's. This topology is finer than the topology defined by weights; we shall show that it is equivalent to it, which proves the proposition.

Put $A = K^\bullet(S)[c_1, \dots, c_n]/I_r$, and let C be the A -algebra generated by $x_1, \dots, x_n$, subject to

$$\sigma_j(x_1, \dots, x_n) = c_j.$$

By 4.4, the canonical homomorphism $A \rightarrow C$ is injective. In C one has

$$\gamma_t(F_1 - n) = 1 + c_1 t + \dots + c_n t^n = \prod_{i=1}^n (1 + x_i t).$$

Since $1/\gamma_t(F_1 - n)$ is a polynomial, the same is true of $1/(1 + x_i t)$ for every i . Hence the x_i 's are nilpotent, and there is an integer N such that every polynomial of degree $> N$ in the x_i 's, with coefficients in $K^\bullet(S)$, is zero. Consequently every polynomial in A of weight $> N$ is zero, i.e. every polynomial in $K^\bullet(S)[c_1, \dots, c_n]$ of weight $> N$ belongs to I_r . Thus the two topologies considered are equivalent, and the proof is complete.

5. Applications to projective bundles; study of f_*

5.1

In this section, S is a quasi-compact scheme, E is a locally free $\mathcal{O}_S$ -module of rank $r + 1$, and X is the projective bundle associated to E . On X there is the canonical exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow f^*(E) \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(1) \longrightarrow 0,$$

where $f : X \rightarrow S$ is the structural morphism.

The $K^\bullet$'s considered here are those defined using locally free sheaves of finite type. We denote by E, F, ξ the classes of $E, F, \mathcal{O}_X(1)$. Put

$$x = 1 - \xi^{-1}, \quad x' = \xi - 1 = \xi x,$$

and denote by $\bar{x}, \bar{x}'$ the classes of x, x' in $\text{Gr}^1 K^\bullet(X)$. Since $\xi - 1$ and x are in $\text{Fil}^1 K^\bullet(X)$, one has

$$(\xi - 1)x \in \text{Fil}^2 K^\bullet(X), \quad \text{i.e.} \quad x \equiv \bar{x} = x' \pmod{\text{Fil}^2 K^\bullet(X)},$$

or equivalently $\bar{x}' = -\bar{x}$, according to the sign convention for the associated graded used here.

5.2

If G is a locally free finite-type $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, the $R^i f_*(G)$ are not, in general, locally free of finite type on S . Hence one cannot define a homomorphism $f_* : K^\bullet(X) \rightarrow K^\bullet(S)$ as in the case of

$K^\bullet$'s defined from perfect complexes. Theorem 1.1 avoids this difficulty as follows: if $y \in K^\bullet(X)$, one can write uniquely

$$y = a_0 + a_1 \xi^{-1} + \cdots + a_r \xi^{-r}, \quad a_i \in K^\bullet(S), \quad (5.2.1)$$

and one puts

$$f_*(y) = a_0. \quad (5.2.2)$$

It is clear that the homomorphism so defined is additive and satisfies the projection formula, i.e. is $K^\bullet(S)$ -linear. The following relations are verified:

$$f_*(1) = 1, \quad f_*(\xi^n) = 0 \quad (-r \leq n < 0), \quad f_*(\xi^n) = \sigma_n \quad (1 \leq n). \quad (5.2.3)$$

To check the last group of relations, one proceeds by induction on n . If $f_*(\xi^p) = \sigma_p$ for $p \leq n-1$, relation (1.9.1), multiplied by a suitable power of ξ , gives

$$\sum_{i=0}^{r+1} (-1)^i \lambda^i(E) \xi^{n-i} = 0.$$

Applying f_* , one obtains

$$\sum_{i=0}^{r+1} (-1)^i \lambda^i(E) f_*(\xi^{n-i}) = 0,$$

and the result follows at once from relation (1.11.3) and the induction hypothesis.

Proposition 5.3. With the notation and hypotheses of 5.1, for every $k \geq 0$ one has a direct-sum decomposition of $K^\bullet(S)$ -modules

$$\text{Fil}^k K^\bullet(X) = \text{Fil}^k K^\bullet(S) + \text{Fil}^{k-1} K^\bullet(S)x + \cdots + \text{Fil}^{k-r} K^\bullet(S)x^r,$$

where the filtration considered is the augmented λ -algebra filtration defined in V 3.9.1 and 3.10.

First note that x has zero augmentation. Moreover

$$\gamma_t(x) = \lambda_{t/(1-t)}(1 - \xi^{-1}) = \left(1 + \frac{t}{1-t}\right) \left(1 + \frac{\xi^{-1}t}{1-t}\right)^{-1} = \frac{1}{1-xt}.$$

Hence $\gamma^i(x) = x^i$ for all i . Thus $K^\bullet(X)$ is a quotient of the $K^\bullet(S)$ - λ -algebra generated by a generator X subject to the relations $\gamma^i(X) = X^i$ for all i , and the quotient ideal is generated by relation (1.13.1). One may therefore apply V 4.12 and V 4.13(ii), and one is reduced to showing that for every $n \geq 0$

$$x^n \in \text{Fil}^n K^\bullet(S) + \text{Fil}^{n-1} K^\bullet(S)x + \cdots + \text{Fil}^{n-r} K^\bullet(S)x^r.$$

This is clear for $n \leq r$, and the rest follows by induction. Relation (1.13.1) gives

$$x^n = - \sum_{i=0}^r Y^{r+1-i}(E - r - 1) x^{n-r-1+i}, \quad n \geq r+1,$$

and the induction hypothesis applied to the powers $x^{n-r-1+i}$ gives the assertion. The sum is direct because $1, \dots, x^r$ are independent over $K^\bullet(S)$.

Corollary 5.4. The filtration induced by $K^\bullet(X)$ on $K^\bullet(S)$ is identical with the filtration of $K^\bullet(S)$.

Corollary 5.5. Let S be quasi-compact, let $E_1, \dots, E_n$ be locally free $\mathcal{O}_S$ -modules of finite type, let $D(E_i)$ be the flag scheme of E_i , and put $X = D(E_1) \times_S \cdots \times_S D(E_n)$. Then the canonical homomorphism

$$\text{Gr } K^\bullet(S) \longrightarrow \text{Gr } K^\bullet(X)$$

is injective.

The reasoning of 3.1 reduces this to the case where X is a projective bundle over S , and then the assertion follows at once from 5.4.

Corollary 5.6. With the notation and hypotheses of 5.1, $\mathrm{Gr} K^\bullet(X)$ is a free $\mathrm{Gr} K^\bullet(S)$ -module with basis $1, \bar{x}, \dots, \bar{x}^r$. For every k ,

$$\mathrm{Gr}^k K^\bullet(X) = \mathrm{Gr}^k K^\bullet(S) \oplus \mathrm{Gr}^{k-1} K^\bullet(S) \bar{x} \oplus \dots \oplus \mathrm{Gr}^{k-r} K^\bullet(S) \bar{x}^r.$$

Moreover, the elements $1, \bar{x}, \dots, \bar{x}^{r+1}$ are linked by

$$\sum_{i=0}^{r+1} c^i(E) \bar{x}^{r+1-i} = 0,$$

where $c^k(E)$ is the k -th Chern class of E (V 6.7). This is an immediate consequence of 1.1, 5.3, and (1.13.1).

Corollary 5.7. With the notation and hypotheses of 4.5, the $\mathrm{Gr} K^\bullet(S)$ -algebra $\mathrm{Gr} K^\bullet(X)$ is generated by the $\bar{c}_i^{(j)}$, where $\bar{c}_i^{(j)}$ is the class in $\mathrm{Gr}^i K^\bullet(X)$ of $\gamma^i(F_j - p_j)$. The ideal of relations among the $\bar{c}_i^{(j)}$ is generated by the relations deduced from

$$c(E - n) = \prod_{j=1}^k c(F_j - p_j),$$

where c is the total Chern class (V 6.7). This result is proved by copying the proof of 4.6 and using 5.6 (compare [2], Exp. 4).

Corollary 5.8. With the notation and hypotheses of 5.1, for every k

$$f_*(\mathrm{Fil}^k K^\bullet(X)) \subset \mathrm{Fil}^{k-r} K^\bullet(S).$$

This is an immediate consequence of 5.3 and the projection formula.

Proposition 5.9. With the notation and hypotheses of 5.1, for every $i \geq 1$

$$f_*(\lambda^i(F)) = 0 \quad \text{and hence} \quad f_*(\gamma^i(F)) = 0.$$

In particular, putting

$$\lambda_{-1}(F) = \sum_{i \geq 0} (-1)^i \lambda^i(F),$$

one obtains

$$f_*(\lambda_{-1}(F)) = 1.$$

Define a map

$$\bar{f}_* : 1 + K^\bullet(X)[[t]]^+ \longrightarrow 1 + K^\bullet(S)[[t]]^+$$

by

$$\bar{f}_* \left(\sum_{i \geq 0} a_i t^i \right) = \sum_{i \geq 0} f_*(a_i) t^i.$$

It is not in general a group homomorphism; nevertheless, for $\varphi \in 1 + K^\bullet(X)[[t]]^+$ and $\psi \in 1 + K^\bullet(S)[[t]]^+$, one has

$$\bar{f}_*(\varphi g(f^*(\psi))) = \psi \bar{f}_*(\varphi),$$

coefficient by coefficient, by the projection formula. From $E = F + \xi$ one deduces

$$\bar{f}_*(\lambda_t(F)) = \bar{f}_*(\lambda_t(E) \lambda_t(-\xi)) = \lambda_t(E) \bar{f}_*(\lambda_t(-\xi)).$$

But

$$\bar{f}_*(\lambda_t(-\xi)) = \sum_{i \geq 0} (-1)^i f_*(\xi^i) t^i = \sigma_{-t}(E)$$

by (4.2.3). Using relation (1.12.1), one finally obtains

$$\bar{f}_*(\lambda_t(F)) = 1,$$

and the desired relations follow.

Proposition 5.10. With the notation and hypotheses of 5.1, let $z \in K^\bullet(X)$. The condition $z(1 - \xi) = 0$ is necessary and sufficient for the existence of $y \in K^\bullet(S)$ such that

$$\text{i) } z = y \lambda_{-1}(F), \quad \text{ii) } y \lambda_{-1}(E) = 0.$$

Since $E = F + \xi$, one has

$$\lambda_{-1}(E) = \lambda_{-1}(F) \lambda_{-1}(\xi) = \lambda_{-1}(F)(1 - \xi),$$

so the condition is sufficient.

Conversely, suppose $z(1 - \xi) = 0$, or $zx' = 0$. By Remark 1.13 one can write uniquely

$$z = \sum_{i=0}^r a_i (x')^i, \quad a_i \in K^\bullet(S).$$

Moreover, x' satisfies an equation of dependence

$$\sum_{i=0}^r c_i (x')^i + (x')^{r+1} = 0, \quad c_i = (-1)^{r+i+1} Y^{r+1-i} (E - r - 1).$$

Since $zx' = 0$, one obtains

$$a_r (x')^{r+1} = - \sum_{i=1}^r a_{i-1} (x')^i = - \sum_{i=0}^r a_r c_i (x')^i.$$

Using the independence of $1, \dots, (x')^r$, one finds

$$a_r c_0 = 0, \quad a_i = a_r c_{i+1} \quad (0 \leq i < r).$$

Hence

$$z = a_r \left(\sum_{i=0}^{r-1} c_{i+1} (x')^i + (x')^r \right).$$

The expression in parentheses is $\lambda_{-1}(F)$; therefore, putting $y = a_r$, one gets $z = y \lambda_{-1}(F)$. Moreover $yc_0 = 0$, and $c_0 = \lambda_{-1}(E)$, hence $y \lambda_{-1}(E) = 0$.

Proposition 5.11. With the notation and hypotheses of 5.1, let $z \in \text{Gr } K^\bullet(X)$. The condition $z\bar{x}' = 0$ is necessary and sufficient for the existence of $y \in \text{Gr } K^\bullet(S)$ such that

$$\text{i) } z = y c^r(F), \quad \text{ii) } y c^{r+1}(E) = 0.$$

The proof is identical with that of 5.10, after passing to the associated graded rings and using 5.6.

6. Study of the filtration of $K^\bullet(X)$ when X has an ample sheaf

In this section X is a scheme having an ample sheaf L . Recall that in this case the $K^\bullet$'s defined in terms of locally free sheaves of finite type and those defined in terms of perfect complexes are equal (IV 2.9). Let

$$\varepsilon : K^\bullet(X) \longrightarrow H^0(X, \mathbb{Z})$$

be the augmentation homomorphism.

Proposition 6.1. Let X be a quasi-compact scheme with an ample sheaf L . Then $\text{Fil}^1 K^\bullet(X)$ is a nilideal.

Since $\text{Fil}^1 K^\bullet(X)$ is generated by the elements $E - \varepsilon(E)$, where E is the class of a locally free finite-type $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module E , it is enough to show that such an element is nilpotent. Quasi-compactness and the compatibility of $K^\bullet$ with finite direct sums of opens reduce the proof to the case where E has constant rank. Passing to the flag bundle of E , which gives an injection on $K^\bullet$ by 3.1 and preserves the existence of an ample sheaf, reduces further to the case where E is invertible.

Let E^* be the dual of E . For n large enough,

$$E^*(n) = E^* \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} L^{\otimes n}$$

is generated by global sections. Hence there is an integer m and a surjective homomorphism

$$(\mathcal{O}_X)^m \longrightarrow E^*(n),$$

or, after tensoring by $E(-n)$, a surjection

$$(E(-n))^m \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_X.$$

The kernel is locally free of rank $m - 1$. Denoting by L the class of the ample sheaf, one obtains

$$\lambda^m(mEL^{-n} - 1) = 0.$$

But

$$\lambda^m(mEL^{-n} - 1) = (-1)^m \lambda_{-1}^m(mEL^{-n}) = (-1)^m \lambda_{-1}(EL^{-n})^m = (-1)^m (1 - EL^{-n})^m.$$

Thus, for every invertible sheaf E , the element $1 - EL^{-n}$ is nilpotent for n large, or equivalently its product $L^n - E$ by L^n is nilpotent. Finally

$$E - 1 = (L^n - 1) - (L^n - E),$$

and the two terms on the right are nilpotent for n large; hence $E - 1$ is nilpotent.

Corollary 6.2. With the hypotheses of 6.1, let $R \subset K^\bullet(X)$ be a sub- λ -ring generated by the classes of finitely many sheaves. Then the λ -ring filtration of R is discrete, and $R \cap \text{Fil}^1 K^\bullet(X)$ is nilpotent. Moreover, R is a finite-type module over $R \cap H^0(X, \mathbb{Z})$ (V 3.9.1).

Since X is quasi-compact, one can find a finite covering of X by disjoint opens on each of which the sheaves whose classes generate R all have constant rank. The standard argument reduces to the case where these sheaves have constant rank on X ; then R is augmented over $\mathbb{Z}$. If E_i , $i = 1, \dots, k$, are the sheaves whose classes generate R , write E_i for their classes and $x_i = E_i - \varepsilon(E_i)$. Then R is a quotient of the λ -ring generated by the x_i , subject to relations

$$\gamma^j(x_i) = 0 \quad (j > r_i = \varepsilon(E_i)),$$

namely of

$$\mathbb{Z}[x_i, \gamma^j(x_i)]_{1 \leq i \leq k, 2 \leq j \leq r_i}.$$

By Proposition 6.1 the x_i 's and the $\gamma^j(x_i)$'s are nilpotent. Thus the augmentation ideal of R is nilpotent; it is precisely $R \cap \text{Fil}^1 K^\bullet(X)$. Moreover every element of Fil_R^n is represented by a polynomial without components of weight $< n$ in the $x_i, \gamma^j(x_i)$. If m is the largest integer for which some $\gamma^{m-1}(x_i) \neq 0$, and if p is an integer such that all p -th powers of the $x_i, \gamma^j(x_i)$ vanish, then $\text{Fil}_R^n = 0$ for $n > kp(1 + \dots + m)$. Hence the filtration of R is discrete. Since only finitely many monomials in the $x_i, \gamma^j(x_i)$ survive, they form a system of generators of R as a $\mathbb{Z}$ -module, completing the proof.

Corollary 6.3. With the hypotheses of 6.1, let A be a commutative ring. An element $y \in K^\bullet(X) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} A$ is invertible if and only if $(\varepsilon \otimes \text{id}_A)(y)$ is invertible. In particular, if E is a locally free finite-type sheaf on X , everywhere non-zero, then its class in $K^\bullet(X)_{\mathbb{Q}}$ is invertible.

The augmentation ideal of $K^\bullet(X) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} A$ is $\text{Fil}^1 K^\bullet(X) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} A$; by 6.1 it is a nilideal. Thus an element is invertible precisely when its image under the augmentation is invertible.

Corollary 6.4. Let X be quasi-compact with an ample sheaf, and let $f : X' \rightarrow X$ be a proper and perfect morphism. Assume moreover one of the following two conditions:

- i) f is projective, ii) X is noetherian,

so that the “finiteness theorem” holds (III 2.2). Let A be a ring and consider the direct-image homomorphism (IV 2.11)

$$f_* : K^\bullet(X') \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} A \longrightarrow K^\bullet(X) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} A.$$

Assume that there exists $x' \in K^\bullet(X') \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} A$ such that

$$\varepsilon(f_*(x')) \in H^0(X, A)$$

is invertible. Then

$$f^* : K^\bullet(X) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} A \longrightarrow K^\bullet(X') \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} A$$

is injective.

Indeed, the projection formula gives

$$f_*(f^*(x)x') = x f_*(x').$$

The element $f_*(x')$ has invertible augmentation and is therefore invertible by 6.3. Hence the composite

$$x \longmapsto f^*(x) \longmapsto f^*(x)x' \longmapsto f_*(f^*(x)x')$$

is injective, and so f^* is injective.

6.5

Let X be a noetherian scheme of dimension d with an ample sheaf L . We endow $K^\bullet(X)$ with the following filtration (cf. [1]): an element x belongs to $K^\bullet(X)_i$ if and only if, for every closed subset Y of X , there exists a perfect complex $M^\bullet(Y)$ such that

$$\text{i) } \text{cl}(M^\bullet(Y)) = x,$$

$$\text{ii) } \text{codim}(\text{Supp}(H^*(M^\bullet(Y))) \cap Y, Y) \geq i, \quad H^*(M^\bullet(Y)) = \bigoplus_{i \geq 0} H^i(M^\bullet(Y)).$$

The subgroups $K^\bullet(X)_i$ so defined are additive subgroups of $K^\bullet(X)$. Indeed, if $x, x' \in K^\bullet(X)_i$, and if Y is a closed subset of X , with corresponding complexes $M^\bullet$ and $M'^\bullet$, then $x + x'$ is the class of $M^\bullet \oplus M'^\bullet$, and

$$\text{Supp}(H^*(M^\bullet \oplus M'^\bullet)) = \text{Supp}(H^*(M^\bullet)) \cup \text{Supp}(H^*(M'^\bullet)).$$

Since the codimension of a finite union of closed subsets is the lower bound of the codimensions of the closed subsets, one has $x + x' \in K^\bullet(X)_i$.

Proposition 6.6. The filtration 6.5 of $K^\bullet(X)$ is a ring filtration, and

$$K^\bullet(X)_{d+1} = 0.$$

Let $x \in K^\bullet(X)_i$, $x' \in K^\bullet(X)_j$, and let Y be a closed subset of X . There exist perfect complexes $M^\bullet$, $M'^\bullet$ representing x , x' , and such that

$$\text{codim}(\text{Supp}(H^*(M^\bullet)) \cap Y, Y) \geq i,$$

$$\text{codim}(\text{Supp}(H^*(M'^\bullet)) \cap \text{Supp}(H^*(M^\bullet)) \cap Y, \text{Supp}(H^*(M^\bullet)) \cap Y) \geq j.$$

Then xx' is represented by $M^\bullet \otimes M'^\bullet$, and

$$\text{codim}(\text{Supp}(H^*(M^\bullet \otimes M'^\bullet)) \cap Y, Y) \geq i + j$$

by EGA 0_{IV}, 14.2.2.3, since

$$\text{Supp}(H^*(M^\bullet \otimes M'^\bullet)) \subset \text{Supp}(H^*(M^\bullet)) \cap \text{Supp}(H^*(M'^\bullet)).$$

This proves that the filtration is multiplicative. To show $K^\bullet(X)_{d+1} = 0$, take $x \in K^\bullet(X)_{d+1}$ and $Y = X$. There is a perfect complex $M^\bullet$ with $x = \text{cl}(M^\bullet)$ and

$$\text{codim}_X(\text{Supp}(H^*(M^\bullet))) \geq d + 1.$$

Since X has dimension d , this forces $\text{Supp}(H^*(M^\bullet)) = \emptyset$, so $M^\bullet$ is acyclic and $x = 0$.

Lemma 6.7. Let $X = \text{Spec}(A)$ be an affine noetherian scheme, let $x_1, \dots, x_k$ be finitely many points of X , and let E be an invertible $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. Then there exists a section $s \in \Gamma(X, E)$ such that, for every i , s_{x_i} is a basis of E_{x_i} .

Let $M = \Gamma(X, E)$. For every i , choose a closed point $x'_i \in \overline{\{x_i\}}$. The x'_i 's correspond to maximal ideals $\mathfrak{m}_i$ of A , which may be assumed all distinct after changing the index set so that each $\mathfrak{m}_i$ occurs once. Since E is invertible, $M_{\mathfrak{m}_i} \simeq A_{\mathfrak{m}_i}$, hence $M/\mathfrak{m}_i M \simeq A/\mathfrak{m}_i$. Thus

$$\prod_i M/\mathfrak{m}_i M \simeq \prod_i A/\mathfrak{m}_i, \quad A/\prod_i \mathfrak{m}_i \simeq M/\left(\prod_i \mathfrak{m}_i\right)M.$$

Lifting the latter isomorphism gives a homomorphism $A \rightarrow M$ whose localization $A_{\mathfrak{m}_i} \rightarrow M_{\mathfrak{m}_i}$ is an isomorphism modulo $\mathfrak{m}_i$, hence an isomorphism by Nakayama. The image of 1 gives a section s of E which is a basis at the x'_i , and therefore at the x_i .

Lemma 6.8. Let X be a noetherian scheme with an ample sheaf L , let E be an invertible $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module, and let $x_1, \dots, x_k$ be points of X . Then there is an integer n such that, for every $k \geq 1$, there exists a section

$$s \in \Gamma(X, E(kn))$$

which is a basis of $E(kn)_{x_i}$ for every i .

One can find an integer n_0 and a section $f \in \Gamma(X, L^{\otimes n_0})$ such that every x_i belongs to the affine open X_f (EGA II 4.5.4). On X_f , Lemma 6.7 gives a section $t \in \Gamma(X_f, E)$ satisfying the required

conditions; moreover, for some integer n'_0 , the section $f^{\otimes n'_0} t$ extends to all of X . Put $n = n_0 n'_0$. Then $f^{\otimes n'_0} \in \Gamma(X, L^{\otimes n})$; tensoring the section of $E(n)$ obtained above by powers of $f^{\otimes k n'}$ gives, for every $k \geq 0$, a section of $E((k+1)n)$. Since every x_i lies in X_f and t is a basis there, these sections give bases of $E(kn)_{x_i}$ for every $k \geq 1$.

Theorem 6.9. Let X be a noetherian scheme of dimension d with an ample sheaf L . Then

$$\mathrm{Fil}^{d+1} K^\bullet(X) = 0, \quad \text{and a fortiori} \quad (\mathrm{Fil}^1 K^\bullet(X))^{d+1} = 0.$$

The last relation is due to J.-P. Serre in the general case considered here.

First we show that, if E, E' are invertible sheaves on X , with classes E, E' , then $E - E' \in K^\bullet(X)_1$. Let Y be a closed subset of X , let $Y_1, \dots, Y_k$ be its irreducible components, and choose $x_i \in Y_i - \bigcup_{j \neq i} Y_j$. By Lemma 6.8 there are integers n, n' such that, for arbitrary $k, k' \geq 1$, there exist homomorphisms

$$L^{-kn} \xrightarrow{s_k} E, \quad L^{-k'n'} \xrightarrow{s'_{k'}} E'$$

which are isomorphisms at the points x_i . Consider the complex

$$N^\bullet : \quad \dots \longrightarrow 0 \longrightarrow L^{-nn'} \xrightarrow{(s'_n, 0)} E' \oplus L^{-nn'} \xrightarrow{0+s_n} E \longrightarrow 0 \longrightarrow \dots$$

The class of $N^\bullet$ is $E - E'$. Moreover $N^\bullet$ is acyclic at the x_i ; hence $\mathrm{Supp}(H^*(N^\bullet)) \cap Y$ contains no irreducible component of Y , and so has codimension at least 1 in Y . This proves $E - E' \in K^\bullet(X)_1$.

Let $x \in \mathrm{Fil}^{d+1} K^\bullet(X)$. We shall prove that $x = 0$. One may suppose that x has the form

$$x = \gamma^{i_1}(E_1 - F_1) \cdots \gamma^{i_k}(E_k - F_k), \quad i_1 + \cdots + i_k \geq d+1,$$

where the E_i, F_i are classes of locally free finite-type sheaves of the same rank; after decomposing X into finitely many opens, one may assume these ranks are constant. Let X' be the product, over X , of the flag schemes of the E_i, F_i . In $K^\bullet(X')$, their images are sums of classes of invertible sheaves. If ξ, η are classes of invertible $\mathcal{O}_{X'}$ -modules, then

$$\gamma_t(\xi - \eta) = \frac{\gamma_t(\xi - 1)}{\gamma_t(\eta - 1)} = \frac{1 + (\xi - 1)t}{1 + (\eta - 1)t},$$

and therefore

$$\gamma^i(\xi - \eta) = (-1)^{i-1}(\xi - \eta)(\eta - 1)^{i-1}.$$

Since X' is noetherian and has an ample sheaf, the preceding result and 6.6 give

$$\gamma^i(\xi - \eta) \in K^\bullet(X')_i.$$

Using the additivity of γ_t and 6.6, it follows that

$$f^*(\gamma^{i_j}(E_j - F_j)) \in K^\bullet(X')_{i_j},$$

and hence $f^*(x) \in K^\bullet(X')_{d+1}$, where $f : X' \rightarrow X$ is the canonical morphism.

We now deduce that $f^*(x) = 0$. Let r be the relative dimension of X' over X . There exists an element $x' \in K^\bullet(X')$, belonging to a basis of $K^\bullet(X')$ over $K^\bullet(X)$, of the form

$$x' = \prod_{i=0}^r (\xi_i - 1),$$

where the ξ_i 's are classes of invertible sheaves. To prove this, the argument of 3.1 reduces one to the case of a projective bundle over X , where it follows immediately from 1.13. The element x' lies in $K^\bullet(X')_r$ by what precedes, hence

$$x' f^*(x) \in K^\bullet(X')_{d+r+1}.$$

But $\dim X' = d + r$; therefore 6.6 gives $x' f^*(x) = 0$. Since x' is part of a basis of $K^\bullet(X')$ over $K^\bullet(X)$, this implies $f^*(x) = 0$. Since f^* is injective by 3.1, one finally obtains $x = 0$.

Problem 6.10. Under the hypotheses of 6.9, is it true that for every k one has

$$\mathrm{Fil}^k K^\bullet(X) \subset K^\bullet(X)_k?$$

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